

Arabic, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they
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Preface

This book teaches Arabic one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Arabic letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, right-to-left, so you learn to read سلام *and* learn that it means “peace” in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first. (A reader who already reads Arabic simply skims the “letters in this word” notes.)

Arabic changes the etymology game entirely. The Romance and Germanic volumes trace words back to Latin or Germanic roots; Arabic doesn’t need tracing — its roots are on the *surface*. Nearly every Arabic word is built from a **three-consonant root** carrying a core meaning, poured into fixed patterns, so *peace*, *Islam*, *Muslim*, and the greeting *salaam* are visibly one family (s-l-m), the way this book wishes Latin were. That root system is taught as the organizing engine. A recurring thread is Arabic’s long shadow over **Spanish**, another language in this project: the article *al-* smuggled into English *algebra* and *alcohol*, and the sun-letter assimilation still audible in Spanish *azúcar* (from *as-sukkar*) — every such form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of Spanish is assumed.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Arabic out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes:  voice (3)  eyes (7)  pen (8)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 18 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can greet someone in Arabic, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.

Complete AR-C01-practice, the canonical closing checkpoint, and demonstrate the chapter promise: greet someone in Arabic, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.

1.1 *salām* — say “peace” before meeting the page

Your first Arabic greeting is *salām*. For this lesson, keep your eyes off the script. Put the sound and meaning in your ear first; the next two tiny lessons will reveal its written pieces without asking you to swallow four new shapes at once.

The letters in this word

Say it in two easy beats: *sa* — *lām*. Hold the second *a* a little longer: *sa-LAAM*. The last sound is a clean *m*.

salām = peace; as a greeting, “peace to you.”

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

salām sits on the three-consonant root **s-l-m**, carrying the idea of wholeness, safety, and peace. The same family gives *islām*, *muslim*, and *sallama*, “to greet.” Hebrew *shalom* is a close Semitic cousin, and

English borrowed *salaam*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sa — lām*
- *salām*, with the long vowel in the second beat
- “peace,” while offering *salām* to an imagined person

Writing — first microstep

Only after you can say the greeting, meet one isolated shape: **س** is *sīn*, the *s* at the start of *salām*. Notice three small teeth and a trailing bowl. Trace **س** once with a finger, hide it, then air-write the three teeth. Do not decode or copy the complete word yet.

- *Write it:* **س** once, then compare its three teeth with the model

Before you move on

What does *salām* offer? (**Peace.**) Which three consonants carry its root? (**s-l-m.**) Which one shape did you trace? (**س, sīn.**) Say the word once more. Do not decode or copy the complete word yet.

1.2 س and ل — recall one shape, add one

Say *salām*. You already know what it means and traced **س** once. Now recall that shape and add only its next consonant. Arabic runs **right to left**, so the first shape waits on the right.

Script — recall *sīn* and add *lām*

- **س** is *sīn*, the *s* sound you are retrieving from lesson one. From Phoenician **shin** (“tooth”) — and the shape really is a row of teeth.
- **ل** is *lām*, the *l* sound. Notice its tall upright and low curve. From Phoenician **lāmed** (“ox-goad”) — ancestor of Greek *lambda* and Latin **L**.

Slide a finger from right to left under ل س and say *s — l*. Do not build the whole word yet.

Writing — trace, then recall

1. Trace ل once with a finger: three teeth, then the bowl.
2. Trace س once: tall upright, then the low curve.
3. Hide the models. Air-write the three teeth of *sīn*, then the tall *lām*.

Your turn

- *Point to:* ل, and say *sīn*
- *Point to:* س, and say *lām*
- *Write it:* ل س once, leaving them separate

Before you move on

Which way do Arabic words run? (**Right to left.**) Which letter has three teeth? (ل, **sīn.**) Which has the tall upright? (س, **lām.**)

1.3 ا and م — finish سلام without a cliff

Recall ل and س. Add just two shapes, then the spoken word *salām* becomes readable and writable.

Script — observe two new shapes

- ا is *alif*: one clean upright carrying the long *ā* here. From Phoenician ʾālep (“ox”) — ancestor of Greek *alpha* and Latin **A**.
- م is *mīm*: a small round head and a tail; it gives the final *m*. From Phoenician **mem** (“water”) — sibling of Greek *mu* and Latin **M**.

Arabic letters join — and a joined letter **changes shape**. The same letter looks different at the start, the middle and the end of a joined run. Its skeleton never changes (three teeth stay three teeth); only the connectors at its edges do. This is the one habit that makes Arabic read like handwriting rather than like print.

Watch all of it happen in one short word. In سلام, *sīn* reaches leftward into *lām*; *lām* and *alif* fuse into the fixed pair لا; then *alif*, which never joins leftward, forces a pen lift before final *mīm*.

Writing — guided copy, then delayed copy

1. Point right to left: س · ل · ا · م. Say *s · l · ā · m*.
2. Trace سلام once: teeth, tall hook, upright, lift, round-headed *mīm*.
3. Copy سلام once while looking.
4. Cover it. Write it once from memory, then compare and correct one feature.

Before you move on

Read سلام. (**salām, peace.**) What changes when a letter joins, and what stays the same? (**The connectors at its edges change; its skeleton does not.**) Where does the pen lift? (**After alif.**) Write the word once without looking. This is delayed recall, not penmanship perfection.

1.4 *marḥaban* — make room for someone

You can say *salām*. Now learn the light, everyday “hello” by ear before its written form asks anything of your eyes or hand.

The letters in this word

Build three small beats: *mar* — *ḥa* — *ban*. The middle consonant is a warm, breathy sound made deeper in the throat than English *h*. Approximate it gently; clarity matters more than force.

marḥaban = hello / welcome.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

The root **r-h-b** carries spaciousness: *raḥb* is roomy. So *marḥaban* is not an empty signal. It suggests, “There is room for you here.” A warm reply is *marḥabtayn* — literally, “two welcomes.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mar — ḥa — ban*
- *marḥaban*, keeping the middle consonant gentle
- *marḥabtayn*, “two welcomes”

Before you move on

What does the root r-ḥ-b suggest? (**Room, spaciousness.**) Say the three beats of *marḥaban*. The next two lessons reveal its new letter shapes in groups of two and three before you copy the whole greeting.

1.5 ِ and َح — two shapes inside *marḥaban*

Say *marḥaban*. Its sound and welcome already belong to you. Now notice only two of its new written consonants.

Script — observe $rā^ʔ$ and $ḥā^ʔ$

- ِ is $rā^ʔ$, the tapped *r*. It curves down and left. It joins to what comes before it but not to what follows.
- َح is $ḥā^ʔ$, the deep, breathy *ḥ*. Its open bowl has **no dot**.

Trace ِ َح separately. Keep $ḥā^ʔ$ open and dotless.

Your turn

- Say it: $rā^ʔ$, and trace ِ
- Say it: $ḥā^ʔ$, and trace َح
- Write it: ِ َح once from memory, then compare

Before you move on

Which letter refuses to join forward? (ج.) Which one is the dotless open bowl? (ح.) Say *marḥaban* again; the next step adds its final new skeleton and two dot-cousins.

1.6 ثابت (thābit) — steady, firm

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: ثابت

ثابت — *thābit* — “steady, firm”.

Say it: *thābit*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, ث ت ب — مرجبا, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *thābit*
- *thābit*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “steady, firm”? (ثابت, *thābit*.)

1.7 ث ت ب — one bowl, three dot choices

You know ج and ح. Today introduces one shared bowl and three dot patterns — exactly three new shapes — before you copy *marḥaban*.

Script — one skeleton, three letters

- ب = *bā*²: one dot **below**.
- ت = *tā*²: two dots **above**.

- ث = *thāʾ*: three dots **above**.

The dots are not decoration. They decide which letter you wrote. Trace the bowl once, then practise the three dot choices.

ب comes from Phoenician **bēt** (“house”) — ancestor of Greek *beta* and Latin **B**. Put it beside the *alif* you already know, from ʾāleḫ (“ox”), and you have the word *alpha-bet*: the **ox** and the **house**, in that order, still naming every alphabet on earth.

Writing — guided copy, then delayed copy

The greeting uses ب. Its full form is مرحبا.

1. Point right to left: م · ر · ح · ب · ل.
2. Copy مرحبا once while looking.
3. Cover it. Write it once from memory, then check the dot below ب.

Before you move on

Which cousin has one dot below? (ب.) Two above? (ت.) Three above? (ث.) Read and write مرحبا once: *marḥaban*, “welcome.”

1.8 ال (al-) — “the,” hiding in English *algebra*

Before the fuller greetings, one tiny, mighty word: Arabic’s “the.” You’ll need it for *the* peace, *the* goodness — and you already know how to read it.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) No new letters — just ا (alif) and ل (lām), the two you met in *salām*, written together as ال and **attached to the front** of a noun (Arabic glues “the” on; it isn’t a separate word).

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

ال (*al-*, “the”). For roughly 800 years Arabic was the Mediterranean’s language of science and trade, and English and Spanish absorbed its words **with al- still attached**: **algebra** (*al-jabr*), **alcohol** (*al-kuḥl*), **algorithm** (*al-Khwārizmī*), **alchemy**, **almanac**. Learning Arabic *al-* is

meeting an old friend you’ve been carrying in English all along.

Grammar Lens: sun letters and moon letters

Here’s a rule you can *hear*. Before about half the consonants — the **sun letters** (*s, sh, n, r, t, d...*) — the *l* of *al-* assimilates and the next letter **doubles**:

- *al-* + *salām* → **as-salām** (not “al-salām”)
- *al-* + *nūr* → **an-nūr**

Before the **moon letters** (*kh, k, b, m...*) the *l* stays clear: **al-khayr**, **al-bab**. You can still hear this rule fossilized in Spanish *azúcar*, from Arabic *as-sukkar* (“the sugar”) — the *l* long gone, the doubled *s* remaining.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “al-” and three English words hiding it — al-gebra, al-cohol, al-manac
- sun-letter assimilation — *al-* + *salām* → “as-salām”
- moon-letter, no change — *al-* + *khayr* → “al-khayr”

Before you move on

What does **ل** mean, and how does it attach? (“The,” glued to the front of its noun.) What happens before a *sun letter* like *s*? (The *l* assimilates and the letter doubles — *as-salām*.)

1.9 *as-salāmu ‘alaykum* — offer the full greeting by ear

You already own *salām* and *al-*. Now speak the full greeting before decoding or copying its unfamiliar second half.

The letters in this word

Say *as-salāmu* — then *‘alaykum*. In *‘alaykum*, begin with a light tightening deep in the throat. That sound is *‘ayn*; an approximation is enough today.

as-salāmu ‘alaykum = peace be upon you.

The *l* of *al-* blends into the following *s*, so *al-salām* is pronounced *as-salām*. Arabic then places “the peace” beside “upon you” and leaves the verb “is” understood.

The exchange — the reply

The fixed reply is *wa-‘alaykum as-salām*: “and upon you, peace.” Hear the little *wa-* at the front; it means “and.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *as-salāmu* — *‘alaykum*
- the complete greeting once, slowly
- *wa-‘alaykum as-salām*, the reply

Before you move on

What are the two spoken blocks? (**as-salāmu + ‘alaykum.**) Where is the word “is”? (**It is understood.**) Speak the greeting and reply once. The next two lessons reveal the remaining shapes before showing the full line.

1.10 عيد (‘īd) — a feast day

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: عيد

عيد — *ʿīd* — “a feast day”.

Say it: *ʿīd*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, ع ي, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ʿīd*
- *ʿīd*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a feast day”? (عيد, *ʿīd*.)

1.11 ع and ي — open *ʿalaykum* gently

Say *as-salāmu ʿalaykum*. Only after speaking the whole greeting do you meet two shapes from its second block.

Script — observe *ʿayn* and *yāʾ*

- ع is *ʿayn*, the deep opening sound in *ʿalaykum*. Notice its curved hook.
- ي is *yāʾ*, the *y* sound. In isolation it carries two dots below.

Trace each once. Then point right to left at ع ي while saying *ʿ* — *y*.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ع, and say *ʿayn*
- *Trace it:* ي, and say *yāʾ*
- *Write it:* both once from memory, then compare

Before you move on

Which shape begins the throat sound? (ع.) Which has two dots below when isolated? (ي.) No whole phrase yet; two final shapes come next.

1.12 كوخ (kūkh) — a hut

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: كوخ

كوخ — *kūkh* — “a hut”.

Say it: *kūkh*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, و ك, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kūkh*
- *kūkh*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a hut”? (كوخ, *kūkh*.)

1.13 ك and و — complete the greeting after the sound

You can speak the greeting and recognize ع and ي. Add just two shapes, then copy the complete line.

Script — observe two new shapes

- ك is *kāf*, the *k* near the end of *‘alaykum*.
- و is *wāw*, the *w* in the reply’s opening *wa-*, “and.” Like ڤ, it does not join to the letter after it.

Writing — guided copy, then delayed copy

1. Find the familiar peace word inside عليكم السلام.
2. Point through the second block, عليكم, right to left.
3. Copy عليكم السلام once while looking.
4. Cover it. Write عليكم from memory, then compare and correct one shape.
5. Add و before that block to begin the reply: و عليكم.

Before you move on

Which letter gives the *k*? (ك.) Which gives *wa*-, “and”? (و.) Read عليكم السلام, then write the shorter block عليكم without looking.

1.14 *as-salāmu ʿalaykum* — hear, write, repair

Say *as-salāmu ʿalaykum* once. Then turn the page or cover every Arabic model. This lesson adds no shape and no new phrase.

Writing — dictation and repair

1. Hear or read the romanization *as-salāmu ʿalaykum*.
2. Write the Arabic greeting from memory.
3. Reveal عليكم السلام.
4. Compare from right to left. Circle one uncertain shape and repair it once.

Stop after one repaired attempt. Retrieval is the goal; repetition without attention is not.

Before you move on

Read عليكم السلام aloud. Which part did you repair? Cover the model and write only عليكم once more if that repair still feels uncertain.

1.15 صباح الخير (ṣabāḥ al-khayr) — “morning of goodness”

Time-of-day greetings — built, like everything, from roots and the attached *al-*. And a chance to hear two sounds English doesn’t have.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) Two new letters:

- ص = *ṣād*, an **emphatic** (heavy, dark) “s” — a *different* letter from the light س you know.
- خ = *khāʾ*, a throat-scrape from the back of the mouth — the **same sound as Spanish j** (as in *José*), or the *ch* in Scottish *loch*.

With the rest known, read صباح (*ṣabāḥ*, “morning”) and خير (*khayr*, “goodness”).

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

صباح (*ṣabāḥ*), root **ṣ-b-h** (dawn/waking: *ṣubḥ* “dawn,” *aṣḥaḥa* “to become / reach morning”). خير (*khayr*, “good, goodness”), root **kh-y-r**. Together الخير صباح = “**morning of the goodness**.” Note *al-khayr* keeps its *l* — خ is a *moon letter* — a clean contrast with *as-salām*.

Why it’s said this way

The reply mirrors it beautifully: النور صباح (*ṣabāḥ an-nūr*) — “morning of the **light**” (*al-* + *nūr*, sun-letter *n* assimilated). You wish someone goodness; they wish you light back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ṣabāḥ al-khayr” — the heavy ṣ, then the throat-scrape kh
- why *al-khayr* keeps its *l* (خ is a moon letter)
- the reply — “ṣabāḥ an-nūr” (“morning of light”)

Before you move on

Read **الخير صباح**. What are the two roots? (*ṣ-b-ḥ* “morning,” *kh-y-r* “goodness.”) Why is it *al-khayr* but *as-salām*? (خ is a moon letter — *l* stays; *s* is a sun letter — *l* assimilates.)

1.16 **الخير مساء** (*masāʾ al-khayr*) — “evening of goodness”

The evening twin of *ṣabāḥ al-khayr* — and Arabic’s tidy habit of naming morning and evening as matched events.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) One new mark:

- **ء** = *hamza*, a **glottal stop** — the little catch in the middle of “uh-oh.” At the end of **مساء** it closes the word: *masāʾ*.

Everything else — **ا س م** and the **الخير** you read last lesson — is already yours.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

مساء (*masāʾ*, “evening”), root **m-s-w**: *amsā*, “to become / reach evening” — the *exact mirror* of *aṣbaḥa* (“to reach morning”). Arabic names the two ends of the day as matched events, each with its own “to become” verb, where French *soir* and Spanish *tarde* both merely meant “late.” **الخير مساء** = “evening of goodness”; reply **النور مساء** (*masāʾ an-nūr*), “evening of light.”

Why it’s said this way

The symmetry is the point: morning and evening are greeted with the *same* structure (“[time] of goodness”) and answered with the *same* structure (“[time] of light”). Learn one pair, you have both.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “masāʾ al-khayr” — the glottal catch at the end of *masāʾ*
- the mirror — *aṣbaḥa* (reach morning) / *amsā* (reach evening)
- the reply — “masāʾ an-nūr”

Before you move on

Read الخير مساء. What does the mark ء (hamza) do? (A glottal stop — the catch in “uh-oh.”) How does Arabic treat morning and evening differently from French/Spanish? (As matched “to become” events, not just “late.”)

1.17 شكرا (shukran) — “thank you”

The word for gratitude — and a chance to watch the root-and-pattern engine do its trick on a brand-new root.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Arabic.) Two new letters:

- ش = *shīn*, “sh” — it is simply س (*sīn*) **plus three dots** on top (the dots-on-a-skeleton idea again).
- ك = *kāf*, “k” — already met inside *‘alaykum*.

Read شكرا right to left → *shukran*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

شكرا (*shukran*), root **sh-k-r** (*gratitude*): *shukr* (“thanks”), *shākir* (“thankful”), *mashkūr* (“thanked”). Look closely: *shākir* and *mashkūr* sit in the **exact same patterns** as *kātib* (“writer”) and *maktūb* (“written”) from the root engine — *fāʿil* (the doer) and *mafʿūl* (the done-to). Learn a pattern once and it works on every root. And it travels: this same Semitic root **sh-k-r**, carried through Persian, is the source of Hindi/Urdu *shukriyā* (“thanks”).

Why it's said this way

The reply is gentle: عفوًا (*ʿafwan*), “it’s nothing / you’re pardoned” — from a root meaning to forgive or waive. You thank; they wave it away.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- read right to left — shuk · ran → “shukran”
- how ش is just س with three dots
- the pattern echo — *shākir/mashkūr* like *kātib/maktūb*

Before you move on

Read شكرا. What is its root, and what two familiar patterns do *shākir* and *mashkūr* follow? (*sh-k-r*; the *kātib / maktūb* patterns — doer and done-to.) The reply to *shukran*? (*ʿafwan*.)

1.18 Chapter 1 — the day of greetings

A dozen letters, learned one greeting at a time, and now the whole day of Arabic greetings and their fixed replies.

You’ll want to know — Read them back

Sound each out **right to left** before checking:

Read		Meaning
سلام	<i>salām</i>	peace
مرحباً	<i>marḥaban</i>	welcome / hi
عليكم السلام	<i>as-salāmu ʿalaykum</i>	peace be upon you
الخير صباح	<i>ṣabāḥ al-khayr</i>	good morning
الخير مساء	<i>masāʾ al-khayr</i>	good evening
شكرا	<i>shukran</i>	thank you

The exchange — greetings and replies

When	Greeting	Reply
casual	<i>marḥaban</i>	<i>marḥabtayn</i> (“two welcomes”)
any time	<i>as-salāmu ʿalaykum</i>	<i>wa-ʿalaykum as-salām</i>
morning	<i>ṣabāḥ al-khayr</i>	<i>ṣabāḥ an-nūr</i> (“morning of light”)
evening	<i>masāʾ al-khayr</i>	<i>masāʾ an-nūr</i>
thanks	<i>shukran</i>	<i>ʿafwan</i> (“it’s nothing”)

Two engines did all of it: the three-consonant **root** (*s-l-m*, *sh-k-r*, *ṣ-b-ḥ*...) and the attached **al-** with its sun/moon assimilation (*as-salām* but *al-khayr*). The letters arrived inside real words — about a dozen of them, half the alphabet — never as a chart to memorize.

Your turn

- *Say it*: all six greetings, right to left
- *Say it*: each greeting with its reply — “as-salāmu ʿalaykum” / “wa-ʿalaykum as-salām”
- *Say it*: greet, then thank — “ṣabāḥ al-khayr!” ... “shukran.”
- *Write it*: hear *salām*, write سلام without looking, then compare and repair one shape

Before you move on

Read all six greetings aloud, right to left. Name the two “engines” that build them. (The three-consonant *root*, and the attached *al-* with sun/moon assimilation.)

Next chapter: introducing yourself — *ismī*... (“my name is...” — and how Arabic marks “you” by **gender** (*anta* to a man, *anti* to a woman), a different axis from the formal/informal split of the European languages.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes:  voice (3)  eyes (8)  pen (5)  Hands-free start: first 8 of 16 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can introduce myself in Arabic, give my name, and understand the other person’s name.

The whole introduction exchange, run once to a man and once to a woman: give a name, ask for one back, and close with tasharrafa.

2.1 اسم (ism) — “name”

To introduce yourself you need “name” — and it needs no new letters.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Arabic.) All three are from Chapter 1: ا (alif), س (sīn), م (mīm). Read اسم right to left → **ism**.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

اسم (*ism*, “name”), root **s–m–w**. It is a **Semitic** word, cousin of Hebrew *shem* (“name”) — the same pairing you saw with *salām* / *shalom*. It has *no* tie to the Indo-European *name* / Latin *nōmen*: Arabic is a different family entirely, and its word for “name” is its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- read right to left — “ism”
- its Hebrew cousin — *shem*

Before you move on

What family does اسم belong to, and what Hebrew word is its cousin? (Semitic; *shem*. Not related to English *name*.)

2.2 ي (-ī) — “my,” a letter stuck on the end

Arabic has no separate word for “my” — it glues one letter onto the noun.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) ي (*yāʾ*), met in *ʿalaykum* — here it does a new job: attached to the end of a noun, it means “my.”

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

Arabic builds “my” by **suffix**, not a separate word: اسم (*ism*, “name”) + ي (-ī, “my”) = اسمي (*ismī*, “my name”). This is the same trick as the attached **al-** (“the”) from Chapter 1 — Arabic loves to fasten little pieces onto a word rather than string separate words together.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ism” + “-ī” → “ismī” (“my name”)
- the pattern — Arabic glues “my” on, like it glued “the” (*al-*)

Before you move on

How does Arabic say “my,” and what is “my name”? (A suffix ي (-ī) glued on; *ismī*.)

2.3 اسمي ... (ismī ...) — “my name is...,” with no “is”

Assemble it — and notice the missing word.

You’ll want to know — The phrase, assembled

- ism (name) + -ī (my) + your name.

اسمي ... = “my-name ...” → “**my name is...**”

Ismī Arun. → “My name is Arun.”

Grammar Lens: no word for “is” — again

Recall from *as-salāmu ‘alaykum* (Ch. 1) that Arabic sets two words side by side and lets “is” be understood. So *ismī Arun* is literally “my-name Arun.” Arabic shares this **zero copula** with the Dravidian languages (Tamil *eṇ peyar Arun*) — two unrelated families meeting on the same habit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ismī ...” with your name
- notice — no word for “is”

Before you move on

Give your name in Arabic. (*Ismī ...*) What does Arabic leave out, and which other family does the same? (The verb “is” — the zero copula, shared with the Dravidian languages.)

2.4 أَنْتَ (anta / anti) — “you,” marked by *gender*

To ask a name you need “you” — and Arabic’s is unlike any you’ve met: it changes with the *listener’s* gender.

The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) Two new letters: ا (alif with a hamza seat, a glottal “a”-start) and ت (*tā*?, “t” — the ب/ت/ث skeleton from Ch. 1, two dots above). The final vowel is a mark: أَنْتَ *anta*, أَنْتِ *anti*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

أَنْتَ is “you” — but Arabic splits it by the listener’s **gender**: *anta* to a man, *anti* to a woman. (Note the Semitic *-ta/-ti* ending — the same *t* that marks “you” in Hebrew *atta/att*.)

Grammar Lens: a different axis of “you”

The European and Dravidian tracks split “you” by **register** (familiar vs. respectful — *tū/vous*, *nī/nīṅaḷ*). Arabic splits it by **gender**: *anta* (to a man) vs. *anti* (to a woman). Same pronoun, a wholly different distinction — you choose by *who you’re talking to*, not how formal you are.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “anta” (to a man), “anti” (to a woman)
- the contrast — European/Dravidian split by register, Arabic by gender

Before you move on

How does Arabic split “you,” and how is that different from French or Tamil? (By **gender** — *anta* (m.) / *anti* (f.); the others split by register.)

2.5 ما (mā) — “what”

The question-word — and you already read it as a warm-up in Chapter 1.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Arabic.) No new letters: م (*m*) + ا (*alif*, long *ā*) → ما *mā*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

ما (*mā*, “what”) is the everyday question-word for things. (Arabic has a second, *māḍā*, for “what” before verbs; *mā* is the one you want before a noun, as in “what [is] your name?”)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mā” (“what”)
- “mā ismuka?” — “what [is] your name?”

Before you move on

What does ما mean, and when is it used? (“What,” before a noun.)

2.6 ما اسمك؟ (mā ismuka / ismuki) — “what’s your name?”

Assemble the question — what + your-name — no “is,” gender in the suffix.

You’ll want to know — The phrase, assembled

- اسمك = اسم (*ism*, name) + ك (*kāf*, the “your” suffix) — and it too is **gendered**: *ismuka* (a man’s name), *ismuki* (a woman’s).

ما اسمك = literally “**what** [is] **your-name**?”

No “is,” the possessive glued on, the gender carried in the suffix.

Grammar Lens: the matched suffixes

“My name” takes ي (*-ī*), “your name” takes ك (*-ka/-ki*). The suffixes are the grammar of the exchange. Answer with *ismī Arun*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mā ismuka?” (to a man), “mā ismuki?” (to a woman)
- ask, then answer — “mā ismuka?” / “ismī ...”

Before you move on

What does ما اسمك؟ literally say, and where is the gender marked? (“What your-name?”; in the suffix — *-ka* (m.) / *-ki* (f.).)

2.7 تشرفنا (tasharrafnā) — “pleased to meet you”

The warm close — and it presents the meeting as an honour.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Arabic.) Uses ت (*tāʾ*, just met), ش (*shīn*) and ر (*rāʾ*) from Ch. 1, plus ف (*fāʾ*, “f”).

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

تشرفنا (*tasharrafnā*), root **sh-r-f** (*honour, nobility*): *sharaf* (“honour”), *sharīf* (“noble” — the *Sharīf* of Mecca, and distantly the title behind English *sheriff*). *tasharrafnā* means literally “**we have been honoured**” — to meet you is presented as an honour received. A more literal option is سعيدة فرصة (*furṣa saʿīda*, “a happy occasion”).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tasharrafnā”
- the root family — *sharaf* (honour), *sharīf* (noble)

Before you move on

What does تشرفنا literally mean, and from what root? (“We have been honoured”; *sh-r-f*, “honour.”)

2.8 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

You could already greet someone. Every lesson since has been building one short exchange: give your name, ask for theirs, close warmly. Here it is whole.

The exchange

Read right to left:

Arabic	English
ميرا اسمي. (<i>ismī Mira</i>)	My name is Mira.
ما اسمك؟ (<i>mā ismuka</i>)	What's your name?
أرون اسمي. (<i>ismī Arun</i>)	My name is Arun.
تشرفنا. (<i>tasharrafnā</i>)	Pleased to meet you.

You'll want to know — the pieces

Every piece from the root-and-suffix engine:

- **ism** ← root *s-m-w* (Hebrew *shem*, not English *name*)
- the glued **-ī** (“my”) and **-ka/-ki** (“your”)
- **tasharrafnā** ← root *sh-r-f* (“honour”; *sharīf*, *sheriff*)

Two Arabic habits: it drops “is” entirely (the **zero copula**, shared with the Dravidian languages), and it marks “you” by **gender** (*anta/anti*), not register.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, right to left
- your own introduction — “ismī ..., tasharrafnā”
- ask it back — “mā ismuka?” (to a man) / “mā ismuki?” (to a woman)

Before you move on

Give your name, ask someone else's, say you're pleased. (*Ismī ... / Mā ismuka? / Tasharrafnā.*) Two things Arabic does differently from the European tracks? (No word for “is” — zero copula; and “you” split by *gender*, not register.)
 Next chapter: *kayfa ḥāluka?* (“how are you?”) and *al-ḥamdu lillāh* — the responding cycle.

2.9 ثمن (thaman) — a price

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: ثمن

ثمن — *thaman* — “a price”.

Say it: *thaman*. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, ن, ث ت, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *thaman*
- *thaman*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a price”? (ثمن, *thaman*.)

2.10 ن، ث ت — one bowl, four dot-patterns

In Lesson 3 you drew ب (*bāʾ*) — a boat-bowl with **one dot below** — and met the idea that the **dots make the letter**. Now the promised payoff: the *same* bowl, with the dots moved and multiplied, gives you three more common letters. Learn the bowl once; the dots do the rest.

Script — The bowl family — a truth-table

Every letter here is the **same shallow boat-bowl** you already draw for $bā^ʔ$. Only the dots change:

letter	sound	the dots
ب $bā^ʔ$	b	one dot below (from Lesson 3)
ن $nūn$	n	one dot above
ت $tā^ʔ$	t	two dots above
ث $thā^ʔ$	th	three dots above
ح $hā^ʔ$	ḥ	no dot (a bigger hook — Lesson 3's cousin)

Read it as a dial: **below** → **1 above** → **2 above** → **3 above**. The pen-stroke is identical each time; your only real decision is *how many dots*, and *on which side*.

Script — Draw them

- ن ($nūn$) — the bowl, then **one dot above**. ($nūn$ sits a little deeper than $bā^ʔ$ when it stands alone, but joined, it is the shared skeleton + one dot.) From Phoenician **nun**, “fish” — ancestor of Greek *nu* and Latin **N**.
- ت ($tā^ʔ$) — the bowl, then **two dots above**. From Phoenician **taw**, “mark” — the great-grandparent of Latin **T** (and the word *tattoo*-like “mark” survives in *taw* meaning a cross-mark).
- ث ($thā^ʔ$) — the bowl, then **three dots above** (drawn as a little triangle of dots).

Script — Where you have seen them — أنت

The Chapter 2 word أنت ($anta / anti$, “you”) is built from exactly these: an *alif* (with a small **hamza** seat you will meet in Lesson 6), then ن ($nūn$, one dot above) joined to ت ($tā^ʔ$, two dots above). So أنت is, in dots, “bowl-with-one-above, bowl-with-two-above” — you can now read the skeleton of a real word.

Your turn

- *Write it:* the same bowl four times, then dot them — ب (1 below), ن (1 above), ت (2 above), ث (3 above)
- *Say it:* the dial — “below, one above, two above, three above — b, n, t, th”
- *Write it:* the joined pair نـت ($n\bar{u}n \rightarrow t\bar{a}^2$), the core of أنت

Before you move on

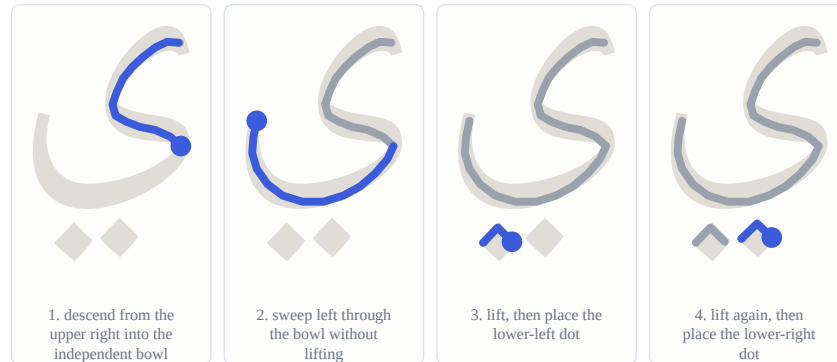
What single feature separates ب, ن, ت, ث? (**The dots** — same bowl; one below / one above / two above / three above.) Which two of them build the Chapter 2 word أنت (“you”)؟ (ن $n\bar{u}n$ and ت $t\bar{a}^2$.) What Latin letters descend from $n\bar{u}n$ and taw ? (**N** and **T**.) Next: ي ($y\bar{a}^2$), the two-dots-below letter — and your name.

2.11 ي ($y\bar{a}^2$) — the last dot-letter, and “my name”

One more member of the bowl family, and it is a **triple threat**: ي ($y\bar{a}^2$) is a consonant *y*, **and** the long vowel $\bar{i}$, **and** the little suffix $-\bar{i}$ meaning “**my**.” With it you can finally write a whole Chapter 2 phrase in your own hand: اسمي (“my name”).

Script — ي (yāʾ) — two dots below

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ل ي ا, independent Yaa at 00:33.2–00:35.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ي is written, stroke by stroke

Break it apart:

1. **the body** — the boat-bowl (standing alone) or a tooth (when joined).
2. **two dots BELOW** — the mark that completes the bowl-family dial: *bāʾ* had one below, *yāʾ* has **two** below.

So the full “below/above” set is now closed: ب one-below, ي two-below; ن one-above, ت two-above, ث three-above. *Yāʾ* comes from Phoenician **yod**, “hand” — the ancestor of Greek *iota* and Latin **I / J** (and the reason we say “not one **iota**,” the smallest letter).

You’ll want to know — Its three jobs

- **consonant y** — as in *yawm* (“day”).
- **long vowel ī** — a *seat* for the “ee” sound.
- **the suffix ي “my”** — the Chapter 2 possessive. Glue *-ī* onto a noun and it becomes “my _____,” exactly as *ism* (“name”) + *-ī* → *ismī* (“my name”).

Script — Assemble — first اسم, then اسمي

You already know every letter of اسم (*ism*, “name”) from Lessons 1–3: ا (alif) · س (sīn) · م (mīm). Write it right-to-left:

1. ا (*alif*) — the upright; it **does not join** forward, so the pen lifts.
2. س (*sīn*) — three teeth, joining into...
3. م (*mīm*) — round head + tail. → اسم.

Now add ي for “my.” *Mīm* joins forward to *yāʾ*, giving اسمي (*ismī*):

- اسمي = *alif* · *sīn* · *mīm* · *yāʾ* = *i-s-m-ī* = “**my name**.”

Read it back, right to left, and you have written a phrase you will say every time you introduce yourself.

Your turn

- Write it: ي — body + **two dots below**
- Say it: the closed dial — “ب one-below, ي two-below; ث/ت/ن one/two/three above”
- Write it: اسم (*ism*), then extend to اسمي (*ismī*, “my name”)

Before you move on

Where do *yāʾ*’s dots sit, and how many? (**Two, below.**) Name *yāʾ*’s **three** jobs. (Consonant *y*; long vowel *ī*; the suffix *-ī* “**my**.”) Spell اسمي letter by letter, right to left. (*alif* · *sīn* · *mīm* · *yāʾ* — “my name.”) Next: the little **vowel marks** — and how one of them flips أنت from “you (m.)” to “you (f.)”

2.12 مُدَرِّس (mudarris) — a teacher

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: مُدَرِّس

مُدَرِّس — *mudarris* — “a teacher”.

Say it: *mudarris*. Look at its shape as you say it: the lessons that follow take pieces of it, the short-vowel marks َ, ِ and ُ, and the doubling mark ّ, and write each one on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mudarris*
- *mudarris*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a teacher”? (مُدَرِّس, *mudarris*.)

2.13 َ ِ ُ — the short vowels the abjad usually hides

In the first writing cluster you learned Arabic is an **abjad**: short vowels are **usually left out**. This lesson shows the marks that a beginner’s book *does* print when it wants to be clear—the **ḥarakāt**—and one of them delivers the neatest payoff in the whole set: the difference between “you (m.)” and “you (f.)” is a **single dash**.

Script — The ḥarakāt — three short-vowel marks

These are small marks written **around** a consonant, not letters in their own right. On the letter *bāʾ* (ب):

mark	name	where	sound	example
َ	<i>fatha</i>	a slash above	“a”	بَ = <i>ba</i>
ِ	<i>kasra</i>	a slash below	“i”	بِ = <i>bi</i>
ُ	<i>damma</i>	a tiny <i>wāw</i> above	“u”	بُ = <i>bu</i>

Stop at these three vowel marks. The next four-minute micro-lesson adds the separate ideas “no vowel,” “double this consonant,” and the *-an* ending. Their shapes wait there so this page never asks you to absorb two writing steps at once.

You’ll want to know — The payoff — أَنْتَ vs أَنْتِ

Here is why the marks matter. The Chapter 2 word أَنْتَ (“you”) is the *same* consonant skeleton for a man and a woman — *alif · nūn · tāʾ*. What splits them is a single ḥaraka on the final ت:

- أَنْتَ — $tāʾ + \text{fatḥa}$ (the “a” slash above) = **anta**, “you” to a **man**.
- أَنْتِ — $tāʾ + \text{kasra}$ (the “i” slash below) = **anti**, “you” to a **woman**.

One dash up or down carries the whole gender distinction you learned in the introductions chapter. Leave the mark off — as normal Arabic does — and أَنْتَ serves both, the reader deciding from context.

Your turn

- *Write it:* on ب — *fatḥa* above (*ba*), *kasra* below (*bi*), *damma* above (*bu*)
- *Say it:* the flip — “أَنْتَ *anta* (man, slash above) vs أَنْتِ *anti* (woman, slash below)”

Before you move on

What are the **ḥarakāt**, and does everyday text show them? (The short- **vowel marks** — *fatḥa/kasra/damma*; normally **left off**, since Arabic is an abjad.) Which mark, and where, turns *anta* into *anti*? (A *kasra* — the “i” slash—**below** the final $tāʾ$, instead of the *fatḥa* above.) You have now made one consonant skeleton say *anta* or *anti* with one tiny mark.

2.14 أَهْلًا (ahlan) — welcome

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: أَهْلًا

أَهْلًا — *ahlan* — “welcome”.

Say it: *ahlan*. Look at its shape as you say it: the lessons that follow take pieces of it, the no-vowel mark : and the ending َ, and write each one on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ahlan*
- *ahlan*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “welcome”? (أَهْلًا, *ahlan*.)

2.15 ْ ُ َ — stop, double, or add *-an*

You already know the three short-vowel marks. Keep those shapes in mind. This lesson adds exactly three more marks, one job at a time.

Script — Three marks, three instructions

Each mark sits around a consonant. It changes how you read that consonant; it is not another full letter.

mark	name	instruction
ْ	<i>sukūn</i>	stop: no vowel follows this consonant
ُ	<i>shadda</i>	hold or double this consonant
َ	<i>fathatan</i>	add the ending <i>-an</i>

Look at the last mark in شَكَرًا (*shukran*, “thank you”). The small doubled stroke above the final letter supplies *-an*. You have seen the word before; today you are learning what that one mark tells the reader.

Your turn

- *Write it:* draw ˘ once — a small circle above the line; say “no vowel”
- *Write it:* draw ˆ once — a small *w* above the line; say “double”
- *Write it:* draw ˊ once — two light slashes above the line; say “-an”
- *Say it:* point in order — *sukūn, shadda, faṭḥatan*

Before you move on

Which mark means “no vowel”? (˘, *sukūn*.) Which doubles a consonant? (ˆ, *shadda*.) Which gives *shukran* its *-an* ending? (ˊ, *faṭḥatan*.) Trace each once more without rushing.

2.16 ء and ٱ — the glottal catch

The marks in the last lesson supplied vowels. **Hamza** is different: it writes a real consonant sound.

Script — The catch in “uh-oh”

Say English “uh-oh” slowly. The little catch between the two syllables is a **glottal stop**. Arabic writes that consonant with ء, called **hamza**.

Hamza often sits on a **seat**. At the start of أنت (*anta/anti*, “you”), it rides above ٱ, producing ٱ̣. The *alif* supplies the seat; the hamza marks the glottal-stop consonant.

That gives *alif* two roles you must keep separate:

- ٱ can carry long *ā*.
- ٱ̣ can be an *alif* seat bearing the consonant ء.

Hamza is therefore not another short-vowel mark. Its sound is the catch itself.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “uh-oh” and feel the glottal catch
- *Write it:* ء alone, then ٱ̣ on its *alif* seat
- *Point to:* أَنْتَ / أَنْتِ — the same initial hamza in both

Before you move on

Is hamza a vowel mark? (**No.**) What sound does it write? (**A glottal stop.**) What is ^h? (**Hamza riding on an alif seat.**)

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (3) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask an Arabic speaker how they are, answer that I am well, and change the ending of the question to match a man or a woman.

The whole how-are-you exchange, run once to a man and once to a woman, with bi-khayr written out by hand.

3.1 حاج (ḥājj) — a pilgrim

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: حاج

حاج — ḥājj — “a pilgrim”.

Say it: ḥājj. Look at its shape as you say it: the next lesson takes one piece of it, ح, خ, and writes it on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ḥājj
- ḥājj, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a pilgrim”? (حج, ḥājj.)

3.2 ح, خ, ج — the dots trick, on a brand-new body

Before the new letters, point once to ّ, ّ, and ّ. Say their jobs: “no vowel”, “double”, “-an”. If one feels slow, trace it once. Then leave the marks behind for today.

Back in Lesson 4 you learned a whole family of letters that share one **bowl** and differ only by dots. Arabic does the *same trick* on a **second** skeleton — a curvy **hook-and-tail body** — giving three more common letters. Learn the body once; the dots do the rest, exactly as before.

Script — The hook-and-tail family

Every letter here is the **same shape**: a rounded **hook** at the top flowing into a **tail that drops below the line**. Only the dot changes:

letter	sound	the dot
ح ḥāʾ	ḥ — a deep, breathy “h” (from the throat)	no dot
خ khāʾ	kh — like the <i>ch</i> in Scottish “ loch ”	one dot above
ج jīm	j — as in “ jam ”	one dot below

It is the bowl-family idea reborn: one skeleton, the dots deciding everything. Say the dial — **no dot / above / below** → **ḥ / kh / j**.

Script — Draw them

- ح (ḥāʾ) — the hook body, then the descending tail; **no dot**. From Phoenician **ḥēth** (“fence”) — the ancestor of Latin **H**.
- خ (khāʾ) — the **same** body, plus **one dot above**. (Arabic built *khāʾ* from *ḥāʾ* by adding the dot — no separate Latin cousin, but you already know the shape.)

- ج (*jīm*) — the same body, plus **one dot below**. From Phoenician **gīml** (“camel”) — the great-grandparent of Greek *gamma* and Latin **C/G**.

Script — Where you’ve seen it — خیر

You have already read خیر (*khayr*, “good/well”) inside the Chapter 1 greeting الخير صباح (*ṣabāḥ al-khayr*, “good morning”). It **opens with** خ — the hook-body plus one dot above. You now know the first letter of a word you’ve been saying since Lesson... one.

Your turn

- *Write it:* the same hook-and-tail body three times, then dot them — ح (none), خ (above), ج (below)
- *Say it:* the dial — “no dot, above, below — ḥ, kh, j”
- *Say it:* “خ opens خیر — the ‘good’ in *ṣabāḥ al-khayr*”

Before you move on

What do ح, خ, ج share, and what tells them apart? (One **hook-and-tail body**; the **dots** — none / above / below.) Which sound is خ, and where’s its dot? (**kh**, like *loch*; **one above**.) Which Chapter 1 word opens with خ? (خير, in *ṣabāḥ al-khayr*.) Next: ك (*kāf*) and ر (*rā*) — the last letters you need to write it.

3.3 ك and ر — an angular k, and an r that won’t hold hands

Two more shapes, and then — next lesson — you can write خیر. Meet ك (*kāf*, “k”) and ر (*rā*, “r”). One is angular and new; the other revisits a rule you learned on the very first day.

Script — ك (*kāf*) — the angular k

Break it apart:

1. **the body** — an **angular upright**, bending like an open corner (not a curve — a hard angle).

2. **the inner stroke** — a small *hamza*-like flick tucked **inside** the angle.

ك is *kāf*, a clean “k.” From Phoenician **kaph** (“palm of the hand”) — the ancestor of Greek *kappa* and Latin **K**. It joins its neighbours, changing shape by position like the other connectors.

Script — ر (rā) — the little downward curve that breaks

Break it apart — there’s just *one piece*:

1. **the curve** — a short stroke that **curves down below the baseline** and stops. No dot, no loop.

ر is *rā*, “r.” From Phoenician **rēsh** (“head”) — ancestor of Greek *rho* and Latin **R**. And here is the important rule: like **alif** (Lesson 1), **rā does not join to the letter after it** — it is one of the **six non-joiners**. So *rā* forces the pen to **lift**, just as *alif* did in *سلام*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ك — angular body + the inner flick
- *Write it:* ر — one short downward curve below the line
- *Say it:* “*rā*, like *alif*, **breaks** — no joining the next letter”
- *Say it:* “*kaph* → K, *rēsh* → R — the Phoenician cousins again”

Before you move on

Describe ك: angular or curved, and what sits inside? (**Angular** body with a small **inner stroke**.) What Latin letters descend from *kāf* and *rā*? (**K** and **R**.) What rule does ر share with **alif**? (It is a **non-joiner** — the pen **lifts** after it.) Next: you assemble خير — and answer “how are you?”

3.4 خير and بخير — writing “good,” and how you say you’re well

Everything comes together. With خ (Lesson 7), ي (Lesson 5), and ر (Lesson 8), you can now write خير (*khayr*, “good”) — the

word hiding in every “good morning” you’ve greeted with — and then بخير (*bi-khayr*, “well”), the everyday answer to “how are you?”

Script — Assemble خير — right to left

Write it starting on the **right**, moving **left**:

1. خ ($khā^o$) — the hook-body with **one dot above, reaching left** into...
2. ي ($yā^o$) — joined in the middle (its two dots below), flowing into...
3. ر ($rā$) — the little down-curve. Remember Lesson 8: $rā$ is a **non-joiner**, so it simply ends the word — but $yā^o$ **does** join into it from the right.

Read back, right to left: خ · ي · ر = $kh \cdot \bar{i} \cdot r$ = خير, “good.” (The root **kh-y-r** means “good, best, choice” across Semitic — the same three consonants carry the meaning, vowels laid on top, just like Arabic always works.)

Script — Then بخير — “(I’m) well”

Glue ب (bi -, “in / with”) onto the front — $bā^o$ from Lesson 3, its one dot below — and it joins straight into the $khā^o$:

- بخير = $bā^o \cdot khā^o \cdot yā^o \cdot rā$ = **bi-khayr**, literally “**in goodness**” — what you say when someone asks *kayfa ḥāluk?* (“how are you?”). “*Al-ḥamdu lillāh, bi-khayr*” — “Praise God, (I’m) well.”

You have now written a **real reply** in a real conversation, in your own hand.

Your turn

- Write it: خير, right to left — “ $khā^o$ (dot above), $yā^o$, $rā$ — lift”
- Write it: بخير — add *bi-* on the right: “ $bā^o$ joins into $khā^o$ ”
- Say it: “the root **kh-y-r** = good; *bi-khayr* = ‘in goodness’ = ‘I’m well’”

Before you move on

Spell خیر letter by letter, right to left. (*khāʾ* · *yāʾ* · *rā* — “good.”) Which letter ends it, and does anything join *after* it? (*rā* — **no**, it’s a non-joiner; the pen lifts.) What does بخیر literally mean, and when do you say it? (“**In goodness**” — the answer to “how are you?”, *kayfa ḥāluk?*.) You can now hand-write a greeting *and* its reply — the Arabic script is yours.

3.5 كيف (kayfa) — “how”

Chapter 2 gave you ما (*mā*, “what”). Here is its partner: كيف (*kayfa*, “how”). Two question words, and you can already build with both.

Two words from the marks lessons: say *mudarris* and *ahlan*, and what each means.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) ك (*kāf*) and ي (*yāʾ*) you have written — *kāf* in the writing set, *yāʾ* in اسمي. The last letter, ف (*fāʾ*, the *f*), is **new**; the writing track hasn’t reached it yet, so read it for now and draw it later.

Right to left: ك · ي · ف → *kay-fa*.

Note the **ay** in the middle — the *yāʾ* is doing double duty again, this time as part of a diphthong, exactly as it did as a long *ī* in *ismī*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

كيف is a **question word**, so it doesn’t behave like the root-and-pattern nouns you’ve been meeting — it just *is*. But the letters **k–y–f** do form a root elsewhere:

word	meaning
kayfiyya	quality, manner — literally “ how-ness ”
kayyafa	to adapt, adjust (to make a thing fit <i>how</i> it must be)
takyīf	adaptation — and, in modern Arabic, air conditioning

So the abstract noun for “quality” is built straight from the word

“how.” Arabic does this constantly: take a word, run it through a pattern, get a concept.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*kayfa*” — “how”
- the pair — “مَا *mā* (what) · كيف *kayfa* (how)”
- “*kayfiyya*” — and hear “how-ness”

Before you move on

What does كيف mean? (“**How**.”) Which Chapter 2 word is its partner? (مَا, “what”.) Which letter in it is new? (ف, *fāʾ* — the *f*.) What is *kayfiyya*? (“**Quality**” — literally *how-ness*, built from this very word.) Next: the word Arabic asks about when it asks how you are — and it isn’t “you.”

3.6 حال (ḥāl) — “state, condition”

English asks “how are **you**?” Arabic asks about something else entirely — your حال, your *state*. Get this word and the whole question falls open.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) Three letters, **all already yours**: ح (*ḥāʾ*, the deep throat *h*, from the hook-family lesson), ا (*alif*), ل (*lām*).

Right to left: ح · ا · ل → ḥāl. And remember from the writing set: *alif* **breaks** the join, so ḥā- then -l.

Why it’s said this way

Here is the payoff. حال comes from the root ḥ–w–l, “**to turn, to change**.” Look what grows from it:

word	meaning	the turning inside
ḥāl	state, condition	how things have turned out
ḥawla	around	turning <i>round</i> something
taḥwīl	transformation, transfer	making something turn into another
ḥawl	a year	one full turn of the seasons
aḥwāl	circumstances (plural of ḥāl)	the way things stand

So a “state” in Arabic is not a fixed thing you *are* — it’s the position you have **turned to**. The language builds “condition” out of motion. Compare what you already know: Spanish *estar* (“to be, temporarily”) came from Latin *stāre*, “to **stand**.” Two languages, two metaphors for the same idea — one **stands**, one **turns**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ḥāl” — deep ḥ from the throat, not an English *h*
- “ḥāl · ḥawla · taḥwīl” — hear the root turning
- the contrast — “Arabic **turns**, Spanish *estar* **stands**”

Before you move on

What does حال mean? (“**State, condition.**”) What root is it from, and what does that root mean? (ḥ–w–l, “**to turn, change.**”) So what is a “state,” literally? (**How things have turned.**) What is ḥawl? (“**A year**” — one full turn.) Next: bolt a “your” onto it and you have the question.

3.7 كَيْفَ حَالُكَ؟ (kayfa ḥāluka?) — “how are you?”

Everything in this question is already yours. You are not learning a new phrase — you are **bolting three known pieces together**.

You'll want to know — The assembly

piece	where you met it
كيف <i>kayfa</i> — “how”	last-but-one lesson
حال <i>hāl</i> — “state”	last lesson
ك <i>-ka</i> / <i>-ki</i> — “your”	new , but see below

→ *حالك؟ كيف* = “**how** [is] **your state?**”

Grammar Lens — The suffix you already half-know

In Chapter 2 you attached *ي* (*-ī*, “my”) to a noun: *ism* → **ismī** (“my name”). The suffix for “**your**” works **identically** — it just clips onto the end:

- *حالك* *hāluka* — “your state,” said **to a man**
- *حالك* *hāluki* — “your state,” said **to a woman**

And look at that split: **-ka** to a man, **-ki** to a woman. That is exactly the *أنتَ* / *أنتِ* (*anta* / *anti*) division from Chapter 2 — Arabic marking gender, not formality, where Spanish and French mark register. The same *fatha* / *kasra* mark that flipped *anta* to *anti* flips *hāluka* to *hāluki*. **One letter, one mark, both meanings.**

Grammar Lens — No verb at all

Notice what is **missing**: there is no “is,” no “are.” Just *how* — *your-state*. This is the **zero copula** you met with *اسمي* (“my name [is] ...”): Arabic simply doesn’t need a verb to join a thing to its description.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to a man — “*kayfa hāluka?*”
- to a woman — “*kayfa hāluki?*”
- the parallel — “*ismī* my name · *hāluka* your state”
- the missing word — “how · your-state — **no 'is'**”

Before you move on

What does *كيف حالك؟* literally say? (“**How [is] your state?**”)
 Which suffix means “your,” and how does it split? (**-ka** to a man,
-ki to a woman — the *anta/anti* split again.) Which Chapter 2
 suffix does it copy? (**-ī**, “my,” as in *ismī*.) What word is absent from
 the sentence? (“**Is**” — the zero copula.) Next: how to answer.

3.8 بخير (bi-khayr) — “well”

The answer to *kayfa ḥāluka?* — and you have **already written this word by hand**. Nothing here is new; it is two old pieces stuck together.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) ب (*bāʾ*), خ (*khāʾ*), ي (*yāʾ*), ر (*rāʾ*) — every one of them from the writing set, where you assembled *خير* and then *بخير* letter by letter. Right to left: ر · ي · خ · ب.

You’ll want to know — The two pieces

خير (*khayr*) — “good, goodness.” You have met it before without being told: it is sitting inside the Chapter 1 greeting *الخير صباح* (*ṣabāḥ al-khayr*, “morning of **the good**”). The greeting was never a fixed lump — it was always *ṣabāḥ* + *al-* + *khayr*.

ب (*bi-*) — “in, with.” A one-letter preposition, and like *ال* (*al-*) from Chapter 1, it does not stand alone: it **glues** onto the front of the next word.

→ *بخير* = *bi-* + *khayr* = “in goodness.”

You’ll want to know — What you actually say

- — *كيف حالك؟ kayfa ḥāluka?* (“How is your state?”)
- — *شكراً بخير, bi-khayr, shukran.* (“Well, thank you.”)

Literally: “In goodness, thanks.” Not “I am fine” — Arabic doesn’t need the “I am” any more than the question needed an “is.”

You'll want to know — The bi- you have heard before

That same ب opens the most-spoken phrase in the language: الله بسم (*bismillāh*, “in the name of God”) — *bi-* + *ism* (the very word from Chapter 2!) + *allāh*. One tiny letter, doing the same job.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*bi-khayr*” — “in goodness”
- the callback — “*ṣabāḥ al-khayr ... bi-khayr*”
- the exchange — “*kayfa ḥāluka? — bi-khayr, shukran.*”
- “*bismillāh*” — and find *ism* inside it

Before you move on

What does بخير literally mean? (“**In goodness.**”) Where had you already met *khayr*? (Inside الخير صباح — “morning of the good.”) What kind of word is ب? (A **one-letter preposition** that attaches, like *al-*.) What is missing from the answer, again? (Any word for “**I am.**”) Next: the answer Arabic gives even more often.

3.9 لله الحمد (al-ḥamdu lillāh) — “praise be to God”

Ask an Arabic speaker how they are and this, more often than *bi-khayr*, is what comes back. It also hides the best root story in the chapter.

You'll want to know — The letters

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) ا ل م د ح ل and ه ل ل — **every letter is one you have written**: *alif*, *lām*, *ḥāʿ*, *mīm*, *dāl*, *hāʿ*. Nothing new to draw.

You'll want to know — The pieces

piece	meaning	where from
ال <i>al-</i>	“the”	Chapter 1
حمد <i>ḥamd</i>	praise	new , root ḥ–m–d
ل <i>li-</i>	“to, for”	a one-letter preposition, like <i>bi-</i>
الله <i>allāh</i>	God	<i>al-</i> + <i>ilāh</i> , “ the god”

→ لله الحمد = “**the** praise [is] **to** **God**.” Zero copula once more.

Note الله itself: it is *al-* (the article you learned in Chapter 1) fused onto *ilāh*, “a god.” The word is literally “**the** **God**.” Its Semitic cousins are Hebrew *El* and *Elohim* — the same family pairing as *salām* / *shalom* from Chapter 1.

Why it's said this way

ḥ–m–d means “**to** **praise**.” Run it through Arabic's patterns:

word	pattern meaning
ḥamd	praise (the plain noun)
maḥmūd	praised
ḥamīd	praiseworthy
aḥmad	“more praiseworthy” — the name Ahmad
muḥammad	“the much-praised one” — the name Muhammad

So the most frequently used phrase in the language and the most common given name on earth are built from **the same three consonants**. This is the root engine doing exactly what Chapter 1 promised: three letters, and a whole family of meanings drops out.

You'll want to know — Using it

- — كيف حالك؟ *kayfa ḥāluka?*
- — لله الحمد. *al-ḥamdu lillāh.*

It works as “fine, thanks” — said whether things are going well or badly, which is part of its point.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*al-ḥamdu lillāh*”
- the root — “*ḥamd · ḥamīd · aḥmad · muḥammad*”
- “*allāh*” — and hear *al-* + *ilāh*, “**the** god”
- the full exchange — “*kayfa ḥāluka? — al-ḥamdu lillāh.*”

Before you move on

What does **الحمد لله** literally say? (“**The praise [is] to God.**”) What root is *ḥamd* from? (**ḥ–m–d**, “to praise”.) Which two names come out of that root? (**Aḥmad** and **Muḥammad** — “the much-praised.”) What is *allāh* made of? (*al-* + *ilāh* = “**the** god”; cousin of Hebrew *El*.) Next: practice the whole exchange.

3.10 Practice — the whole exchange

Chapter 1 let you greet. Chapter 2 let you introduce yourself. This chapter closes the loop: you can **ask after someone and answer back**.

The exchange

	Arabic	literally
A	عليكم السلام (<i>as-salāmu</i> <i>^calaykum</i>)	peace [be] upon you
B	السلام وعليكم (<i>wa-^calaykum</i> <i>as-salām</i>)	and upon you, peace
A	حالك؟ كيف (<i>kayfa</i> <i>ḥāluka?</i>)	how [is] your state?
B	بخير لله، الحمد. (<i>al-ḥamdu lillāh</i> , <i>bi-khayr</i>)	the praise [is] to God — in goodness
B	اسمك؟ ما وأنت؟ (<i>wa-anta? mā</i> <i>ismuka?</i>)	and you? what [is] your name?

Read down the right-hand column. **Not one line contains a verb “to be.”** Arabic just puts the two things next to each other.

You’ll want to know — the pieces

phrase	built from
<i>kayfa ḥāluka</i>	<i>kayfa</i> + <i>ḥāl</i> + -ka/-ki
<i>bi-khayr</i>	bi- + <i>khayr</i> (already inside <i>ṣabāḥ</i> <i>al-khayr</i>)
<i>al-ḥamdu lillāh</i>	<i>al-</i> + <i>ḥamd</i> + li- + <i>allāh</i>
<i>ismuka</i>	<i>ism</i> + -ka/-ki — the same suffix as <i>ḥāluka</i>

Three attaching pieces — **al-**, **bi-**, **li-** — and two suffixes, **-ī** and **-ka/-ki**. That is most of the chapter.

Grammar Lens — gender

Every “you” here splits. Say the pair aloud:

to a man

to a woman

kayfa ḥāluka?

kayfa ḥāluki?

mā ismuka?

mā ismuki?

anta

anti

One vowel mark decides — the *fathā* / *kasra* pair.

Your turn

- *Say it*: the full exchange, both parts, to a man
- *Say it*: it again, to a woman — every *-ka* becomes *-ki*
- *Write it*: بخير — you have every letter
- *Say it*: the roots met so far — “**s-l-m** peace · **ḥ-w-l** turn · **kh-y-r** good · **ḥ-m-d** praise”

Before you move on

Ask “how are you?” to a woman. (*Kayfa ḥāluki?*) Give both answers. (*Bi-khayr* / *al-ḥamdu lillāh*.) What do *al-*, *bi-* and *li-* have in common? (All **attach** to the next word — they never stand alone.) What single word is absent from every line of the dialogue? (“**Is**” — the zero copula.) Which root gave both a common phrase and a common name? (**ḥ-m-d** — *al-ḥamdu lillāh* and *Muḥammad*.) Next chapter: **farewells** — and the root that started it all comes back.

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can close a conversation in Arabic, choosing between maʿa s-salāma and ilā l-liqāʾ.

The four-chapter conversation end to end – greet, name, how-are-you, farewell – with every -ka swapped to -ki on the second run.

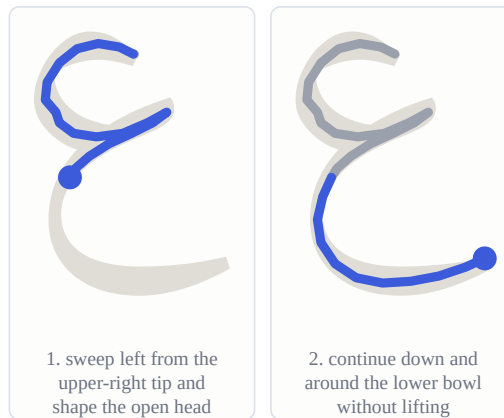
4.1 ع (ʿayn) — the eye that became an O

Point to َ, ّ, ّ: “no vowel”, “double”, “-an”.

This is the letter people think of when they think “Arabic.” ع (ʿayn) writes a sound made **deep in the throat** — one English simply does not have. And its history holds the best surprise in the whole alphabet: this consonant is the ancestor of our vowel O.

Script — Draw it

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ع, independent Ayn at 00:03.1–00:04.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ع is written, stroke by stroke

Break it apart — *an open curve, then a bowl*:

1. **the open-mouth curve** on top — like a small **c** opening to the left.
2. **the bowl below**, when *‘ayn* stands alone or ends a word — a scoop underneath.

Joined in the middle of a word it flattens into a little wedge; standing alone it shows the full curve-over-bowl. It is a **connector**, so it changes coat by position like *sīn* and *lām*.

Script — A third dots-family

You know the **bowl** family (ث/ت/ن/ب) from Lesson 4 and the **hook-and-tail** family (ح/خ/ج) from Lesson 7. *‘ayn* opens a **third**: its skeleton is shared with غ (*ghayn*), which is the **same shape plus one dot above**. Same trick, third time — by now you should expect it.

Script — The surprise: ^ʿayn → O

^ʿayn comes from Phoenician **ʿayin**, meaning “**eye**” — and the oldest forms were drawn as one. When the **Greeks** borrowed the Phoenician alphabet, they had **no throat-sound** like ^ʿ. So they did what borrowers do with a sign they can’t use: they **repurposed** it — and turned the eye-shaped letter into the vowel **omicron**, our **O**.

So the round **O** you write is a Phoenician **eye**, and Arabic’s ^ʿayn is the same sign that kept its original consonant job. (Compare the thread so far: ^ʾālep→**A**, ^bēt→**B**, ^mem→**M**, ^kaph→**K**, ^rēsh→**R** — and now ^ʿayin→**O**.)

Script — Where you’ve heard it

You have been *saying* this sound since Chapter 1: عليكم السلام (*as-salāmu ʿalaykum*) — the ^ʿ in *ʿalaykum* is this letter. And the farewell you’ll write two lessons from now, مع السلامة, opens with it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ع — the open curve, then the bowl beneath
- *Say it:* the sound, from the throat — as in *ʿalaykum*
- *Say it:* the family — “^ʿayn ع, and *ghayn* غ = the same shape **plus one dot**”
- *Say it:* “^ʿayin = **eye** → the Greeks made it **O**”

Before you move on

Describe ع’s two pieces. (An **open-mouth curve** on top, a **bowl** below when isolated or final.) What did Phoenician ^ʿayin mean, and what letter did the Greeks turn it into? (“**Eye**”; they had no such sound, so they made it the vowel **O**.) Which letter shares its skeleton? (غ *ghayn* — one dot above.) Next: ه and the feminine ending ة.

4.2 ه and ة — the loop, and the ending that means “feminine”

Two related shapes. ه (*hāʾ*) is a plain “h” — and the most **shape-shifting** letter you’ve met, wearing four genuinely differ-

ent coats. Then ḥ , a letter built *out of* it, whose whole job is to say one grammatical thing: **this word is feminine**.

Script — ḥ ($h\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$) — the loop that never looks the same

Break it apart — there is really just *one piece*:

1. **the loop** — a closed round body.

But that loop **changes shape a lot by position** more than any letter so far: standing alone it's a neat circle-ish loop; at the start it opens out; in the middle it becomes a small figure-of-eight pinched in the centre; at the end it trails. Same letter, four faces — the four-coats rule from Lesson 2 taken to its extreme.

From Phoenician **hē** — the ancestor of Greek *epsilon* and Latin **E**. (Another one for the family tree: $\text{ālep} \rightarrow A$, $\text{bēt} \rightarrow B$, $\text{hē} \rightarrow \mathbf{E}$, $\text{mem} \rightarrow M$, $\text{ayin} \rightarrow O$.)

Script — ḥ ($t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$ marbūṭa) — the “tied $t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$ ”

Now look carefully at this:

- $\text{ḥ} = h\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$'s loop, **no dots**.
- $\text{ḥ} = \text{the same loop} + t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$'s two dots above.

Its name says exactly what it is: $t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$ marbūṭa, “the **tied-up $t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$** ” — a ḥ ($t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$, Lesson 4) whose ends have been **tied into a loop**. It appears **only at the end of a word**, and it is the standard mark of a **feminine** noun or adjective.

You already know its partner: back in Lesson 4 you learned ḥ with **two dots above**. Put those same two dots on a $h\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$ loop and you get the feminine ending. Nothing new to memorise — just two known pieces combined.

Where you've seen it: the farewell **مع السلامة** ($ma^c a s\text{-}sal\bar{a}ma$) ends in ḥ — *salāma* is feminine. That's the next lesson.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ḥ — the loop; then try it isolated and final, feel it change
- *Write it:* ḥ — the same loop, **plus $t\bar{a}^{\text{ḥ}}$'s two dots above**

- *Say it:* the name — “*tāʾ marbūʿa*, the **tied** *tāʾ* — it marks the feminine”
- *Say it:* “*hē* → Greek epsilon → Latin **E**”

Before you move on

What makes **ه** unusual among the letters you’ve learned? (Its **loop changes shape** dramatically by position — four very different coats.) What is **ة** made of, and what does its name mean? (*hāʾ*’s loop + **tāʾ**’s **two dots**; “**tied tāʾ**”.) What does **ة** tell you about a word, and where can it appear? (That it is **feminine**; only at the **end**.) Next: assembling the farewell **مع السلامة**.

4.3 مع السلامة — the goodbye, and a word you already know

The closing move. **مع السلامة** (*maʿa s-salāma*) is how Arabic says goodbye — literally “**with safety**,” *go in peace*. And the heart of it is a word you wrote **all the way back in Lesson 3**: سلام. Everything since has been leading here.

Script — Part 1 — مع (maʿa, “with”)

Two letters, both known:

1. م (*mīm*, Lesson 3) — round head, joining left into...
2. ع (*ʿayn*, Lesson 10) — the open curve over its bowl, closing the word.

→ مع = *maʿa*, “with.”

Script — Part 2 — السلامة (as-salāma, “the safety”)

Look at what this is made of:

- ال — the **al-** (“the”), *alif* + *lām*, both from Lessons 1–2. You’ve read it since Chapter 1 in خيرال and عليكم سلامال.
- سلام — the **exact word you assembled in Lesson 3**: *sīn* · *lām* · *alif* · *mīm*.

- ة — the $\text{tā}^{\text{ʔ}}$ *marbūṭa* from Lesson 11, marking *salāma* as **feminine**.

So $\text{السلامة} = \text{al-} + \text{salām} + \text{-a}$. You are not learning a new word; you are **adding two edges** to one you already own.

Script — The root s-l-m, one more time

salām, *salāma*, *islām*, *muslim* — all from the Semitic root **s-l-m**, “peace, safety, wholeness.” The greeting you learned first (عليكم السلام , “peace be upon you”) and the farewell you learn last (مع السلامة , “with safety”) come from the **same three consonants**. Arabic opens and closes a conversation with one idea.

Script — Assemble it — right to left

1. م then $\text{ع} \rightarrow \text{مع}$
2. lift; $\text{ا} + \text{ل}$ (the *al-*), the *lām* joining into...
3. $\text{س} \cdot \text{ل} \cdot \text{ا}$ — and remember the لا ligature, and that *alif* **breaks**...
4. م , then ة to close.

$\rightarrow \text{السلامة مع}$

Your turn

- *Write it:* مع — *mīm* into عayn
- *Write it:* السلامة — “the *al-*, then your Lesson-3 word, then the feminine ة ”
- *Say it:* “*ma^{ca} s-salāma* — **with safety**”
- *Say it:* the bookend — “ عليكم السلام to greet, مع السلامة to part — same root **s-l-m**”

Before you move on

What does مع السلامة literally mean? (“**With safety**.”) Which earlier word sits inside السلامة , and what was added? (سلام from Lesson 3 — plus ال in front and ة behind.) What does the final ة signal? (*salāma* is **feminine**.) What root ties the first greeting to

the last farewell? (s-l-m — peace/safety.) You can now hand-write an Arabic conversation from hello to goodbye.

4.4 مع (ma^ca) — “with”

Two letters, both already yours, and a word that will carry the whole chapter.

You’ll want to know — The letters

(Skim if you read Arabic.) م (mām) from Lesson 3 of the writing set, and ع (ʿayn) from Lesson 10 — the throat sound whose Phoenician ancestor meant “eye,” and which the Greeks recycled into the vowel O.

Right to left: م · ع → ma^ca. The ʿayn is not a vowel; it is a constriction deep in the throat. Take your time with it.

You’ll want to know — The word

مع (ma^ca) = “with, together with.”

It is a **preposition**, and unlike ال (al-) or bi- (bi-) from Chapter 3, it is a **free-standing word** — it does not glue onto the next one. Compare:

	attaches?
ال al- “the”	yes
bi- “in/with”	yes
li- “to”	yes
مع ma ^c a “with”	no

So Arabic has *two* words touching on “with”: the one-letter bi- (bi-, “in/ by means of,” as in *bi-khayr*) and the full word مع (ma^ca, “accompanied by”). *Bi-khayr* is “**in** goodness”; *ma^ca* is standing **next to** something.

Why it’s said this way

ma^ca ← Semitic **cimma*, and its Hebrew cousin is עִם (ʿim), “with.” The same pairing you met with **salām** / **shalom** in Chapter 1 and **ism** / **shem** in Chapter 2. Three chapters, three cousins — the family resemblance is systematic, not a coincidence.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “*ma^{ʿa}*” — the *ʿayn* from the throat
- *Say it:* the contrast — “*bi-khayr* **in** goodness · *ma^{ʿa}* **with**”
- *Say it:* the cousin — “*ma^{ʿa}* · Hebrew *ʿim*”
- *Write it:* مع — *mīm* joining into *ʿayn*

Before you move on

What does مع mean? (“**With**.”) Does it attach to the next word, like *al-* and *bi-*? (**No** — it stands alone.) What is the difference between *bi-* and *ma^{ʿa}*? (*Bi-* = “**in/by** means of”; *ma^{ʿa}* = “**accompanied by**.”) What is its Hebrew cousin? (*ʿim*.) Next: the word it goes with — and you already know most of it.

4.5 السلامة (as-salāma) — “the safety”

This looks like a long new word. It isn’t. It is **one word you learned in Chapter 1** with a piece added at each end.

You’ll want to know — Taking it apart

piece	what it is	met in
ال	<i>al-</i> , “the”	Ch. 1
سلام	<i>salām</i> , “peace”	Ch. 1 — the very first word
ة	<i>tā^ʾ marbūʿa</i> , feminine ending	writing Lesson 11

→ السلامة = *al-* + *salām* + *-a* = “**the safety**.”

Every letter is one you have already written by hand.

You’ll want to know — The pattern that changed the meaning

Arabic doesn’t just add endings — it pours a root into a **shape**. Here the root **s-l-m** goes into the pattern *fa^ʿāla*, which turns a thing into **the state of being that thing**:

word	meaning
salām	peace
salāma	safety, soundness, wellbeing — <i>the state of being at peace</i>

Same three consonants, one new shape, a new but related word. This is the engine Chapter 1 promised, working in front of you.

You'll want to know — Two small rules, both already learned

1. The sun letter. *S* (س) is a **sun letter**, so the *l* of *al-* assimilates to it: written الس, but said **as**-salāma, not *al-salāma*. The same thing happens in عليكم لأمالس — the greeting you have said since Chapter 1.

2. The feminine ة. *Tāʾ marbūṭa* marks *salāma* as **feminine**. Arabic abstract nouns very often are.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “as-salāma” — with the doubled *s*, not *al-s*
- *Say it:* the build — “salām ... salāma ... as-salāma”
- *Say it:* the pattern — “peace → **the state of** peace”
- *Write it:* السلامة

Before you move on

What three pieces make السلامة? (*al-* + **salām** + ة.) What did the *faʿāla* pattern do to the meaning? (Turned “peace” into “**the state of** being at peace” — safety.) Why is it *as-salāma* and not *al-salāma*? (س is a **sun letter**; the *l* assimilates.) What does the ة tell you? (The word is **feminine**.) Next: put *maʿa* in front of it.

4.6 السلامة مع (maʿa s-salāma) — “goodbye”

Put the last two lessons together and the farewell falls out. You have already **hand-written** this phrase; now it means something.

You'll want to know — The assembly

مع (*ma^ca*, “with”) + السلامة (*as-salāma*, “the safety”) → السلامة مع
— “**with safety**.”

Said as one run: *ma^ca s-salāma* — the *a* of *ma^ca* swallows the *al*’s vowel, and the sun-letter rule doubles the *s*.

It is not “goodbye” in the English sense of a plain sign-off. It is a **wish**: *go in safety*.

You'll want to know — The circle closes

Look at what Chapter 1 opened with and what Chapter 4 closes with:

	phrase	root
first greeting	عليكم السلام <i>as-salāmu</i> <i>^calaykum</i>	s-l-m
last farewell	مع السلامة <i>ma^ca</i> <i>s-salāma</i>	s-l-m

The same three consonants. Arabic begins and ends a conversation with one idea — peace, safety, wholeness. The root engine you met in the very first lesson has been running the whole time; here it simply comes back round.

The family, one more time: *salām* (peace), *salāma* (safety), *islām* (submission, i.e. entering peace), *muslim* (one who does so).

You'll want to know — English does the same trick

Goodbye looks like a single word. It is worn down from *God be with ye*. So the English farewell is also built on “**with**” — you are being commended to something protective as you go.

language	farewell	literally
Arabic	<i>ma^ca s-salāma</i>	“ with safety”
English	<i>goodbye</i>	“God be with ye”
Spanish	<i>adiós</i>	“to God”
French	<i>adieu</i>	“to God”

Four languages, one instinct: as someone leaves, hand them over to safekeeping.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*ma‘a s-salāma*”
- the bookend — “*as-salāmu ‘alaykum ... ma‘a s-salāma*”
- the root aloud — “**s · l · m**”
- “goodbye ← God be **with** ye”

Before you move on

What does مع السلامة literally mean? (“**With safety**.”) What root is it built on, and where have you met that root before? (**s-l-m** — the Chapter 1 greeting *as-salāmu ‘alaykum*, and *salām* itself.) So what does Arabic open and close a conversation with? (**The same idea** — peace/safety.) What is English *goodbye* worn down from? (“**God be with ye**.”) Next: a second farewell, and a word Spanish borrowed.

4.7 اللقاء إلى (ilā l-liqāʾ) — “see you”

The other everyday farewell — and the one with a surprise waiting inside Spanish.

You’ll want to know — A note on the letters

(*Skim if you read Arabic.*) Two pieces here are **beyond what the writing track has covered**, so read them for now and draw them later:

- ق (*qāf*) — a *k* made far back against the soft palate, deeper than ك (*kāf*). It is **not** in the letter set you have been writing from.
- ا in ي — this is *alif maqṣūra*, “shortened alif”: it wears **yāʾ’s skeleton with no dots** and is pronounced as a long *ā*. You already know from writing Lessons 4–5 that dots are what separate letters sharing a body; this is that same principle, taken one step further.

The rest — ا ل ع — you have written.

You'll want to know — The two pieces

piece	meaning
إلى <i>ilā</i>	“to, until”
اللقاء <i>al-liqāʾ</i>	“the meeting”

→ اللقاء إلى = “**until the meeting**.”

لقاء (*liqāʾ*) comes from the root **l-q-y**, “**to meet**.” The final ء is the *hamza* from writing Lesson 6 — a glottal stop, a real consonant here, not decoration.

Note ل is a sun letter too, so *al-liqāʾ* doubles the *l*, just as *as-salāma* doubled the *s*.

Why it's said this way

Spanish says goodbye like this:

hasta luego — “**until** later” *hasta mañana* — “**until** tomorrow”

Same shape as *ilā l-liqāʾ*: “**until**” + **a future point**. But it goes further — Spanish *hasta* is itself an **Arabic loanword**, from *ḥattā* (“until”). Of the roughly four thousand Arabic words Spanish took during the eight centuries of al-Andalus, most are nouns; *hasta* is one of the rare borrowed **function words**.

So Spanish did not merely copy the pattern — it borrowed the very word that builds it.

language	farewell	shape
Arabic	<i>ilā l-liqāʾ</i>	until + the meeting
Spanish	<i>hasta luego</i>	until (← <i>ḥattā</i>) + later
French	<i>à bientôt</i>	to + soon
Italian	<i>a presto</i>	to + soon

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*ilā l-liqāʾ*” — double the *l*
- the two farewells — “*maʿa s-salāma* · *ilā l-liqāʾ*”

- the loan — “*hasta* ← *ḥattā*”
- the root — “**l · q · y** — to meet”

Before you move on

What does إالى literally say? (“**Until the meeting.**”) What root is *liqāʿ* from? (**l–q–y**, “to meet”). Which two letters here has the writing track **not** reached? (ق *qāf*, and ى *alif maqṣūra*.) What is *alif maqṣūra*? (**Yāʿ’s body with no dots**, pronounced long *ā*.) Which Spanish word for “until” came from Arabic? (***Hasta*** ← *ḥattā*.) Next: practise the whole conversation, hello to goodbye.

4.8 Practice — the whole conversation

Four chapters. Greet, introduce, ask after someone, part. Here it all is in one piece.

You’ll want to know — The full exchange

	Arabic	literally
A	عليكم السلام (<i>as-salāmu ʿalaykum</i>)	peace [be] upon you
B	السلام وعليكم (<i>wa-ʿalaykum as-salām</i>)	and upon you, peace
A	ما اسمك؟ (<i>mā ismuka?</i>)	what [is] your name?
B	تشرفنا ...، اسمي (<i>ismī ... tasharrafnā</i>)	my name [is] ..., we are honoured
A	حالك؟ كيف (<i>kayfa ḥāluka?</i>)	how [is] your state?
B	بخير لله، الحمد (<i>al-ḥamdu lillāh, bi-khayr</i>)	the praise [is] to God — in goodness
A	مع السلامة (<i>maʿa s-salāma</i>)	with safety
B	إلى اللقاء (<i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>)	until the meeting

Read the right-hand column top to bottom. **Not one line contains a verb “to be.”** The zero copula has held for four chapters.

Why it's said this way

Everything you have learned sits on a handful of three-consonant roots:

root	meaning	words you know
s-l-m	peace, safety	<i>salām, as-salāmu</i> <i>ʿalaykum, salāma,</i> <i>maʿa s-salāma</i>
s-m-w	name	<i>ism, ismī, ismuka</i>
ḥ-w-l	to turn	<i>ḥāl, kayfa ḥāluka</i>
kh-y-r	good	<i>ṣabāḥ al-khayr,</i> <i>bi-khayr</i>
ḥ-m-d	to praise	<i>al-ḥamdu lillāh,</i> <i>Muḥammad</i>
l-q-y	to meet	<i>liqāʾ, ilā l-liqāʾ</i>

Six roots. A whole conversation.

Grammar Lens — The small attaching pieces

piece	job	example
ال <i>al-</i>	the	<i>al-khayr</i>
بـ <i>bi-</i>	in / by	<i>bi-khayr</i>
لـ <i>li-</i>	to	<i>lillāh</i>
يـ <i>-ī</i>	my	<i>ismī</i>
كـ <i>-ka / -ki</i>	your (m./f.)	<i>ismuka, ḥāluki</i>

And مع *maʿa*, the one that **doesn't** attach.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the full dialogue, both parts, addressing a **man**
- *Say it:* it again to a **woman** — every *-ka* becomes *-ki*
- *Write it:* السلامة مع — every letter is one you have drawn
- *Say it:* the bookend — “السلام to open, السلامة to close”

Before you move on

Give a complete greeting-to-farewell exchange. (The dialogue above.) Which root opens **and** closes it? (s-l-m.) Which piece of

the chapter doesn't glue onto the next word? (ما *ma^a*.) What single word is absent from every literal translation? (“**Is**” — the zero copula.) Which Spanish word came from Arabic *ḥattā*? (***Hasta***.) You can now hold — and hand-write — a short Arabic conversation from beginning to end.

Chapter 5

Yes and No

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can answer a question in Arabic with $na^c am$ or $lā$, and write $lā$ as the single joined $lām$ - $alif$ shape.

Say the yes/no pair and form $lā$ as one $lām$ - $alif$ ligature rather than two separate letters.

5.1 نعم ($na^c am$) — yes

A short word to mean yes — with one sound English simply doesn't have.

You'll want to know — The word

نعم = yes, said $na^c am$. Arabic reads **right to left**, so its three letters run:

ن (n) · ع (°) · م (m) → **na-°a-m**

The middle letter ع is the famous °ayn — a *pharyngeal* sound made deep in the throat, a tight squeeze with no English equivalent. Don't worry about mastering it today; just know that the little apostrophe-like mark in $na^c am$ (the °) is standing in for a real, throaty consonant, not a pause.

You'll want to know — Saying yes, and other ways

$na^c am$ is the clear, standard **yes** — polite and safe anywhere. Two neighbours you'll also hear:

- أَجَل (*ajal*) — a more formal, emphatic “yes, indeed.”
- In everyday speech, many dialects say أَيَوَّه (*aywa*) for a casual “yeah.”

And a useful twist: said as a question, **na^cam?** also means “**pardon?** / **you were saying?**” — the same stretch English gives “yes?”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “na^cam” — feel the ع squeeze in the middle of the throat
- right to left — م · ع · ن
- as a question — “na^cam?” = “pardon?”

Before you move on

How do you say yes in Arabic? (**na^cam**, نَعَمْ.) Which way does the script run? (**Right to left.**) What is the ع in the middle — a pause or a sound? (A **sound** — the throaty *‘ayn*, with no English match.) What does *na^cam?* mean when you say it as a question? (“**Pardon?**”)

5.2 لā (lā) — no

Two letters, one long vowel — and one of the most recognisable words in the language.

You’ll want to know — The word

لā = **no**, said lā (a long *aah*). It’s just two letters — ل (l) + ا (the long ā, *alif*) — but they’re written joined into one sweeping shape, لā, a *lam-alif* that Arabic always writes as a single unit. It’s one of the first letter-joins learners recognise on sight.

You’ll want to know — More than an answer

lā isn’t only the reply “no.” It is Arabic’s great word of **negation**, and it opens the most-spoken sentence in the language — the first half of the *shahada*:

الله إلا إله لا — *lā ilāha illā llāh* — “**There is no** god but God.”

That opening **lā** is your word. The same *lā* also negates present-tense verbs — لا أعرف *lā aʿrif*, “I do **not** know” — so, like Spanish *no*, one little word is both the answer “no” and the sentence’s “not.”

Grammar Lens — Yes and no, together

You now have the pair:

	Arabic	said
yes	نعم	<i>naʿam</i>
no	لا	<i>lā</i>

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “lā” — a long, open *aah*
- the join — ج + ل written as one, لا
- the pair — “naʿam / lā”

Before you move on

How do you say no in Arabic? (**lā**, لا.) What two letters make it, and how are they written? (ج + ل, joined as a single *lam-alif* لا.) Which famous sentence does *lā* open? (The *shahada* — *lā ilāha illā llāh*.) Besides “no,” what job does *lā* do? (It **negates verbs** — *lā aʿrif*, “I don’t know.”)

Chapter 6

Please

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can attach *min faḍlik* to a request in Arabic and change its ending for a man or a woman.

Say min faḍlik with the heavy dād, take it apart as 'from your grace', and offer law samaḥt as the alternative.

6.1 فضلك من (min faḍlik) — please

Arabic doesn't say "please" — it asks for something *from your grace*.

You'll want to know — The phrase

فضلك من — read right to left, **min faḍlik** — is two pieces:

من (*min*, "from") + فضلك (*faḍl* + *-ik/-ak*, "your grace/bounty")
→ "from your grace."

faḍl is a warm, weighty word — "grace, favour, bounty, generosity" (you'll meet it as the name *Faḍl*). Saying *min faḍlik* casts the request as drawing on the other person's generosity — not a command, a courtesy.

Grammar Lens — A gender note (Arabic marks "you")

The ending changes with **whom you address** — and, unwritten, only the vowel moves:

- to a **woman**: *min faḍlik* (the ل said *-ik*)
- to a **man**: *min faḍlak* (the ل said *-ak*)

The spelling فضلك is the same for both; the short vowel that distinguishes them isn't normally written. One sound to respect: the ض (*ḍ*) is an **emphatic** d, said with a heavier, deeper tongue than a plain *d*.

You'll want to know — Another everyday “please”

Just as common, especially getting someone's attention:

سمح لـ — *law samaḥt* — literally “**if you permit**” (*law* “if” + *samaḥt* “you permitted”). Same politeness, a different image — permission rather than grace.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “min faḍlik” — feel the heavy ض
- taken apart — “from your grace”
- the alternative — “law samaḥt” = “if you permit”

Before you move on

How do you say please in Arabic? (**min faḍlik**, فضلك من.) What does it literally mean? (“**From your grace**” — *faḍl* = grace/bounty.) What changes between saying it to a man vs a woman? (The ل ending — *-ak* to a man, *-ik* to a woman; spelling unchanged.) What's the other common “please,” and what does it mean? (**law samaḥt** — “if you permit.”)

Chapter 7

Sorry

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can apologise in Arabic with *āsif* or *āsifa*, choosing the form that matches who is speaking.

Say the apology twice – āsif for a man, āsifa for a woman – then the ungendered ma^cdhira.

7.1 آسف / آسفة (āsif / āsifa) — sorry

You already know *من فضلك*, “please.” Arabic’s word for “sorry” teaches a new lesson entirely: it isn’t a fixed word at all — **it changes with the speaker.**

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

آسف (*āsif*, said by a man) and آسفة (*āsifa*, said by a woman) both mean “**sorry**.” They come from the verb آسَفَ (*asifa*), “to grieve, to be filled with regret” — so saying *āsif* is describing yourself as *grieved* / *regretful*, the way you’d say “I am tired” or “I am happy.”

That’s the key: آسف **is an adjective**, and Arabic adjectives **agree with the gender of the person they describe**. A man says آسف; a woman says آسفة — the extra *ṣ* (*tā² marbūṭa*) is the everyday feminine ending you’ll meet across Arabic adjectives. English “sorry” never changes no matter who says it; Arabic “sorry” always tells you the speaker’s gender in the same breath.

Why it's said this way

For a quick, **ungendered** “excuse me / pardon” — squeezing past someone, interrupting, a light apology — Arabic reaches for معذرة (*ma^cdhira*), from the root ر-ذ-ع (“to excuse”), the same root as عذر (*‘udhr*, “an excuse”) and the verb يعتذر (*ya^ctadhiru*, “to apologize”). Unlike *āsif/āsifa*, معذرة **doesn’t change with gender** — it’s a noun, not an adjective, so anyone says the same word. Use آسف/أسفة when you mean a real, felt “I’m sorry” (and remember to match your own gender); reach for معذرة for the light, everyday “pardon me.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a man says — “*āsif*”
- a woman says — “*āsifa*”
- the ungendered one — “*ma^cdhira*” = excuse me / pardon

Before you move on

What’s unusual about آسف / أسفة compared to English “sorry”? (**It’s a gendered adjective** — *āsif* for a man, *āsifa* for a woman — where English never changes.) What root gives *āsif*, and what does it mean? (أسف *asafa*, “to grieve, regret.”) What’s the ungendered word for a quick “excuse me,” and what root is it from? (معذرة *ma^cdhira*, from ر-ذ-ع “to excuse.”)

Chapter 8

Days of the Week

Modes: ⇨ voice (1) ⇨ eyes (1) ⇨ Hands-free start: none of the 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name any day of the Arabic week and say which two days break the counting pattern.

Name al-jumʿa and as-sabt beside the counted days, and place as-sabt next to Hebrew shabbāt.

8.1 الأحد to الخميس (al-aḥad to al-khamīs) — Sunday to Thursday, by the numbers

Most European and North Indian languages name their weekdays for planet-gods. Arabic does something completely different: it just **counts** them.

Grammar Lens — The pattern: definite article + ordinal number

Five of Arabic’s seven days are simply “**the [number]th**” — the definite article ال (*al-*) plus an ordinal built on the number word:

Arabic	literally	from the number	day
الأحد (<i>al-aḥad</i>)	“the first ”	<i>wāḥid</i> , “one”	Sunday
الاثنين (<i>al-ithnayn</i>)	“the second ” (lit. “the two”)	<i>ithnān</i> , “two”	Monday
الثلاثاء (<i>ath-thulāthāʿ</i>)	“the third ”	<i>thalātha</i> , “three”	Tuesday
الأربعاء (<i>al-arbiʿāʿ</i>)	“the fourth ”	<i>arbaʿa</i> , “four”	Wednesday
الخميس (<i>al-khamīs</i>)	“the fifth ”	<i>khamṣa</i> , “five”	Thursday

No moon, no war-god, no planets at all — just **day one, day two, day three...** This also tells you something about the week itself: counting starts from **Sunday**, so Sunday is “day one” — the Arabic week, like the Jewish and much of the Christian calendar tradition, begins where the European Monday-first convention doesn’t.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “al-aḥad” — the first, Sunday
- count up — “al-ithnayn, ath-thulāthāʿ, al-arbiʿāʿ, al-khamīs” — second through fifth
- contrast — no planet-gods here, just numbers

Before you move on

How does Arabic name Sunday through Thursday? (**As ordinal numbers** — “the first” through “the fifth,” not planet-gods.) Which number is Sunday, and what does that tell you about the week? (“**The first**” — the Arabic week counts starting from **Sunday**.) What Arabic prefix turns a number into “the [x]th day”? (ال *al*-, the definite article.)

8.2 الجمعة and السبت (al-jum^a, as-sabt) — Friday and Saturday

Five days counted off — and then two days important enough to get **real names** instead of numbers.

You'll want to know — The two named days

- الجمعة (*al-jum^a*) = “**the gathering**,” from جمع (*jama^a*), “to gather, collect.” This is the day of the congregational Friday prayer (*ṣalāt al-jum^a*) — the most religiously significant day of the Islamic week, and important enough to earn its own name rather than a number.
- السبت (*as-sabt*) = “**the Sabbath**.”

You'll want to know — Be honest about how السبت differs from Latin's *Sabbatum*

You may remember Latin borrowed the word **Sabbatum** from Hebrew to replace its own pagan *diēs Saturnī* — a loanword crossing from a Semitic language into an Italic one. Arabic's سبت (*sabt*) is a different kind of relationship entirely: Arabic is **itself a Semitic language**, in the same family as Hebrew. So **as-sabt and Hebrew shabbāt aren't borrower-and-lender — they're cousins**, both descending from the same ancient Semitic root س-ب-ت meaning “to rest, to cease.” Where Latin **borrowed** a foreign word, Arabic simply **inherited** a family word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “al-jum^a” — the gathering, Friday
- “as-sabt” — the Sabbath, Saturday
- the contrast — Latin borrowed “Sabbatum”; Arabic's “sabt” is a blood relative of Hebrew “shabbāt”

Before you move on

Why does الجمعة break the counting pattern? (It's named for the congregational Friday prayer — “the gathering” — not counted

as a number.) How is Arabic's السبت different from Latin's borrowed **Sabbatum**? (**Arabic and Hebrew are both Semitic languages** — *as-sabt* and *shabbāt* are **cousins** from a shared root, not a loanword crossing between unrelated language families.)

Chapter 9

Four Core Colours

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name black, white, red and blue in Arabic and give each colour’s feminine form.

Run the four colours in the masculine, then again in the feminine – ḥamrāʾ, zarqāʾ – on the same template.

9.1 أسود / أبيض (aswad / abyad) — black and white, a whole new gender pattern

You’ve already met a gendered adjective — آسفة/أسف (“sorry”), which just added a feminine ending. Color words go further: they reshape the **whole word**, front and back, for gender.

Grammar Lens — The pattern: masculine أ--- / feminine ---اء

- أسود (aswad, masculine) / سوداء (sawdāʾ, feminine) — “**black**”
- أبيض (abyad, masculine) / بيضاء (bayḍāʾ, feminine) — “**white**”

Notice the shape: the masculine form **starts** with أ (a hamza-alif), and the feminine form **drops** that opening letter but **adds** -اء (-āʾ) at the end instead. This isn’t the simple “add one letter” pattern āsif/ āsifa used — it’s a **dedicated template** Arabic reserves specifically for **colors and physical characteristics** (this same shape appears again for red and blue in the next lesson).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- masculine — “aswad, abyad” — black, white
- feminine — “sawdāʾ, baydāʾ” — black, white
- notice the shape — إ--- drops, ---اء appears

Before you move on

What’s the masculine/feminine pair for black? (أسود **aswad** / سوداء **sawdāʾ**.) For white? (أبيض **abyad** / بيضاء **baydāʾ**.) How is this gender-shape different from *āsif/āsifa*? (**It reshapes the whole word** — losing the opening أ and gaining a closing -اء — a template reserved for colors and physical traits, not just adding a simple ending.)

9.2 أزرق / أحمر (ahmar / azraq) — red and blue, the same template again

Two more colors — and the exact same shape you just learned.

Grammar Lens — The pattern holds

- أحمر (*aḥmar*, masculine) / حمراء (*ḥamrāʾ*, feminine) — “**red**”
- أزرق (*azraq*, masculine) / زرقاء (*zarqāʾ*, feminine) — “**blue**”

Same recipe every time: masculine opens with إ, feminine drops that opening and closes with -اء instead. Once you’ve internalized this template from black and white, the whole family of **classic, old** Arabic colors slots into it (yellow أصفر/صفراء, green أخضر/خضراء, too) — one pattern, several colors. (Newer colors like brown, gray, purple, orange, and pink use a **different** pattern entirely, borrowed from nouns — so “every color” would overstate it; this template belongs specifically to Arabic’s oldest, core color set.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- masculine — “aḥmar, azraq” — red, blue
- feminine — “ḥamrāʾ, zarqāʾ” — red, blue
- all four masculine forms in a row — “aswad, abyad, aḥmar, azraq”

Before you move on

What’s the masculine/feminine pair for red? (أحمر **aḥmar** / حمراء **ḥamrāʾ**.) For blue? (أزرق **azraq** / زرقاء **zarqāʾ**.) Does every Arabic color use this same template? (**No** — Arabic’s classic, oldest colors (black, white, red, blue, yellow, green) share **one** template, masc. ا--- / fem. ---اء; newer colors like brown or purple use a different, noun-based pattern instead.)

Chapter 10

Family

Modes: ⇄ voice (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my father, mother, brother and sister in Arabic.

Say akh and ukht, show how ukht is built from the same root plus a feminine -t, and place both beside their Hebrew cousins.

10.1 أب, أم (ab, umm) — father and mother

Two short, ancient words — each just two or three letters — sitting at the root of Semitic family vocabulary across several languages, not just Arabic.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

- أب (*ab*) = “**father**.” A short, ancient Semitic root, cousin of Hebrew אב (*av*) and Aramaic אבא (*abba*) — the very word behind “**Abba, Father**” in the New Testament.
- أم (*umm*) = “**mother**.” Equally ancient, cousin of Hebrew אם (*em*).

These aren’t borrowings between Arabic and Hebrew — both descend from the same ancient Semitic family vocabulary, the way *pater* and English *father* are cousins through PIE rather than one copying the other.

Why it's said this way

أم stays productive in everyday Arabic naming: أم + a child's name forms a **kunya**, an honorific “**mother of** _____” (and أبو, *abū*, does the same for fathers — “**father of** _____”). Someone might be known publicly as *Umm Khālīd*, “mother of Khālīd,” rather than by their own given name — a naming custom still very much alive today.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ab” — father — then “umm,” mother
- the Hebrew cousins — “ab/av, umm/em”
- the naming pattern — “Umm + [child's name]” = mother of _____

Before you move on

What are Arabic's words for father and mother? (أب **ab**, أم **umm**.) What are their Hebrew cousins? (**av**, **em** — not borrowings, both from the same ancient Semitic root.) What naming pattern does **umm** still form today? (**Umm** + [child's name], “mother of _____,” a living honorific.)

10.2 أخ, أخت (akh, ukht) — brother and sister

Unlike the color words you just learned (a whole reshaped template for masculine/feminine), siblings here use the **simplest** possible gender marker.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

- أخ (*akh*) = “**brother**” — another short, ancient Semitic root, cousin of Hebrew אָח (*ach*).
- أخت (*ukht*) = “**sister**” — the **same root**, plus a plain feminine -ت (-*t*) ending, cousin of Hebrew אחות (*achot*).

So *ukht* isn't a separate word — it's *akh* wearing the ordinary feminine

ending, the simple pattern you already know from آسف/أسف (*āsif/āsifa*, “sorry”), not the elaborate colors template.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “akh” — brother — then “ukht,” sister
- the shared root plus a simple ending — akh + -t
- the Hebrew cousins — “akh/ach, ukht/achot”

Before you move on

What are Arabic’s words for brother and sister? (أخ **akh**, أخت **ukht**.) How is *ukht* built from *akh*? (**The same root, plus a plain feminine -ت ending** — the simple pattern, not the colors’ elaborate template.) What are their Hebrew cousins? (**ach, achot**.)

10.3 The name exchange, cold

Eight lessons ago this book taught you to give your name and ask for somebody else’s, and has not asked since. Say the whole exchange from memory before you read another line.

The two words

word	letters, right to left	what it is
اسم <i>ism</i>	<i>alif · sīn · mīm</i>	name — root s–m–w , cousin of Hebrew <i>shem</i>
ما <i>mā</i>	<i>mīm · alif</i>	what, standing before a noun

Neither needed a new letter. اسم has no tie to English *name* or Latin *nōmen* — the resemblance is an accident, and the real cousin is Hebrew.

Grammar Lens: four suffixes and no verb

glued on	means	gives
ي -ī	my	اسمي <i>ismī</i>
ك -ka	your, to a man	اسمك <i>ismuka</i>
كِ -ki	your, to a woman	اسمكِ <i>ismuki</i>

Arabic has no separate word for *my*. It fastens ي, the *yāʾ*, onto the end of the noun — the habit that also fastens ل for *the*. The suffixes are the grammar of the exchange, and the two written forms of *your name* are identical on the page.

There is no word for **is** either. *Ismī Arun* is literally *my-name Arun* — the zero copula, shared with the Dravidian languages.

The two words: أنت, split by the listener

أنت is *alif* with a hamza seat, then *nūn*, then *tāʾ* — one skeleton for both genders. What splits them is a vowel mark that everyday text leaves off: أنت *anta* to a man, أنتِ *anti* to a woman.

The European and Dravidian tracks split *you* by **register**. Arabic splits it by the **listener's gender** instead — and the Semitic *-ta* / *-ti* ending is the same *t* that marks *you* in Hebrew *atta* / *att*.

The exchange

تَشَرَّفْنَا *tasharrafnā* closes it — letters *tāʾ* · *shīn* · *rāʾ* · *fāʾ*, root **sh-r-f**, honour: *sharaf* (honour), *sharīf* (noble, the title behind English *sheriff*). The polite close is not *pleased to meet you* but **we have been honoured**.

- *Say it*: ask a man for his name — *mā ismuka?*
- *Say it*: ask a woman — *mā ismuki?*
- *Say it*: answer with your own — *ismī ...*
- *Say it*: close the exchange — *tasharrafnā*
- *Recall*: the verb Arabic left out of every line above

Before you move on

Name the Hebrew cousin of اسم. (*Shem*.) Say which axis Arabic uses to split أنت, where register would be the obvious choice. (**The listener's gender.**) Give the literal sense of تشرفنا. (***We have been honoured.***) And say where the gender of the question sits. (**In the suffix** — *-ka* to a man, *-ki* to a woman.)

Chapter 11

Head and Hand

Modes: ⇄ voice (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the head and the hand in Arabic.

Say yad, set it against its near-identical Hebrew twin, and contrast how much further raʿs drifted.

11.1 رأس (raʿs) — the head

One more ancient Semitic root — and a word still hard at work in modern political vocabulary, the same way Latin’s *caput* is in English.

You’ll want to know — The word

رأس (raʿs) = “head” — an ancient Semitic root, cousin of Hebrew ראש (rosh), the very word inside **Rosh Hashanah**, “head of the year.”

Why it’s said this way

Arabic builds رئيس (raʿīs), “**president, chief, head [of an organization]**,” directly on this same root — literally “the one who is the head.” That’s exactly the move English makes with Latin *caput*: **captain** (“head” of a unit), **capital** (“head” city). Different language families, the same very human idea — the person or place “at the head” is the one in charge.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “raʿs” — head
- “raʿīs” — president, literally “the head [one]”
- the Hebrew cousin — “raʿs / rosh”

Before you move on

What does رأس mean, and what’s its Hebrew cousin? (“**Head**” — cousin of **rosh**, as in Rosh Hashanah.) What word is built on it for “president,” and what does it literally mean? (رئيس *raʿīs*, “the head [one]” — the same “head = leader” idea as English *captain/capital* from Latin *caput*.)

11.2 يد (yad) — the hand

Some words wear their age lightly — worn down, reshaped, disguised. This one hasn’t changed much at all.

You’ll want to know — The word

يد (*yad*) = “**hand**” — a short, ancient Semitic root. Its Hebrew cousin is spelled and pronounced almost **identically**: יד (*yad*). Where *raʿs/rosh* show a family resemblance, *yad/yad* is closer to twins — one of the more strikingly unchanged shared words across the whole Semitic family.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “yad” — hand
- the Hebrew twin — “yad” — almost the same word
- contrast — “raʿs/rosh” changed more than “yad/yad” did

Before you move on

What does يد mean? (“**Hand.**”) How does it compare to its Hebrew cousin? (**Nearly identical** — both *yad* — one of the more strikingly unchanged shared words across the Semitic family.)

11.3 How are you, cold

Ask after somebody and answer them back, both parts, without reading on. If the question came out as a memorised noise rather than three pieces you can name, this page is for you.

The two words

word	letters, right to left	what it is
كيف <i>kayfa</i>	<i>kāf</i> · <i>yāʿ</i> · <i>fāʿ</i>	how — a question word, partner to ما
حال <i>ḥāl</i>	<i>ḥāʿ</i> · <i>alif</i> · <i>lām</i>	state, condition — root ḥ-w-l , to turn

The ح is the deep throat *ḥ*, not an English *h*. And حال is the whole point of the question: English asks after **you**, Arabic asks after your **state** — the thing that turns and changes, which is exactly what its root means.

Grammar Lens: the same suffix, one lesson on

كيف حالك؟ bolts three pieces you already own together: *how* + *state* + *your*. The suffix behaves identically to the one that gave you اسمي, and it splits the same way.

to a man

كيف حالك؟ *kayfa ḥāluka*

to a woman

كيف حالك؟ *kayfa ḥāluki*

Literally: **how** — **your-state**. No *is*, no *are*. The same zero copula that ran through the name exchange runs through this one.

How to answer: two replies where English has one

بخير *bi-khayr* is ب (in) plus خير (*khayr*, good) — literally *in goodness*. You had met *khayr* long before you were told: it sits inside the morning greeting الخير صباح, *morning of the good*.

الله الحمد *al-ḥamdu lillāh* comes back more often than *bi-khayr* does. Every letter in it is one you can write — *alif*, *lām*, *ḥāʿ*?, *mīm*, *dāl*, *hāʿ*? — and it says **the praise is to God**, from the root **ḥ–m–d**, to praise.

The exchange

- *Say it*: ask a man — *kayfa ḥāluka?*
- *Say it*: ask a woman — *kayfa ḥāluki?*
- *Say it*: the plain answer — *bi-khayr*, *shukran*
- *Say it*: the commoner answer — *al-ḥamdu lillāh*
- *Recall*: the three attaching pieces inside these lines — *al-*, *bi-*, *li-*

Before you move on

Give the root behind حال and what it means. (ḥ–w–l, to turn or change.) Give the literal sense of بخير. (*In goodness*.) Give the literal sense of الله الحمد. (**The praise is to God**.) And name the question word that partners كيف. (ما.)

Chapter 12

Seasons

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four seasons in Arabic and say why the Islamic months do not stay inside them.

*Say *rabīʿ*, *ṣayf*, *kharīf*, *shitāʾ*, then explain the lunar calendar’s drift against the solar seasons.*

12.1 ربيع, صيف, خريف, شتاء — the four seasons

Four words for the turning year — and a genuine reminder that the tidy four-season picture is a **temperate-climate** habit of mind, not a universal one.

You’ll want to know — The four seasons

Arabic	meaning
ربيع (<i>rabīʿ</i>)	spring
صيف (<i>ṣayf</i>)	summer
خريف (<i>kharīf</i>)	autumn
شتاء (<i>shitāʾ</i>)	winter

Why it’s said this way

ربيع (*rabīʿ*) does double duty: it also names **two months** of the Islamic calendar, **Rabīʿ al-Awwal** and **Rabīʿ al-Thānī** (“first/second Rabīʿ”). That’s worth pausing on, because the **Islamic calendar is lunar** — its months drift across all four solar seasons over

roughly a 33-year cycle, unmoored from any actual spring. So a month named “Rabī^c” won’t reliably fall in spring at all; the name is a fossil from an earlier calendar, kept even as the lunar calendar carried the months loose from the seasons they were once named for.

More broadly: the tidy four-season year assumes a temperate climate with four clearly distinct weather patterns. Much of the Arabic-speaking world spans very different climates — desert, Mediterranean, tropical — where a strict four-way split maps onto lived experience less cleanly than it does further north. The four words above are the standard Modern Standard Arabic vocabulary, useful and real, but not necessarily the only or most natural way every Arabic-speaking region actually experiences the year.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “rabī^c, ṣayf, kharīf, shitā³” — spring, summer, autumn, winter
- the calendar twist — “rabī^c” also names two Islamic months
- the honest note — lunar months drift free of the solar seasons

Before you move on

What does ربيع do besides name a season? (**Names two Islamic calendar months**, Rabī^c al-Awwal/al-Thānī.) Why don’t those months reliably fall in spring? (**The Islamic calendar is lunar** — its months drift across all four seasons over a ~33-year cycle.) Is the four-season frame equally natural everywhere Arabic is spoken? (**Not necessarily** — it fits temperate climates better than the desert/tropical/Mediterranean climates found across much of the Arabic-speaking world.)

Chapter 13

Water and Bread

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name water and bread in Arabic and say which of the two sits on a regular root.

Say māʾ with its irregular plural miyāh, then khubz from the clean root kh-b-z.

13.1 ماء, خبز (māʾ, khubz) — water and bread

Two everyday words — and a study in contrasts: one of them is one of Arabic’s genuinely **oddest** common nouns, and the other is about as **regular** as a word gets.

You’ll want to know — ماء — an old, irregular word

ماء (māʾ) = “**water**.” This word is short but **irregular**: its plural (مياه, *miyāh*) and the forms it takes when attached to another noun don’t follow Arabic’s ordinary noun patterns the way most words do. Words this basic — for water, fire, blood, mouth — are often among the oldest in any language family, and old words wear their irregularities proudly; they were already worn smooth by daily use long before the grammar of the rest of the language settled into its regular patterns.

You’ll want to know — خبز — clean, regular, and freshly made

خبز (*khubz*) = “**bread**” — built cleanly on the root خ-ب-ز (*kh-b-z*), “**to bake**.” Where *māʾ* is a fossil, *khubz* is transparent: the noun for the baked

thing, straight from the verb for baking it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “mā” — water — then “miyāh,” its irregular plural
- “khubz” — bread — from kh-b-z, “to bake”
- the contrast — one word is a worn-smooth fossil, the other freshly transparent

Before you move on

What’s unusual about ماء? (It’s **genuinely irregular** — its plural *miyāh* and attached forms don’t follow the ordinary pattern, typical of very old, basic words.) What root is خبز built on, and what does that root mean? (ز-ب-خ, “to bake.”)

Chapter 14

Months

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the months in Arabic and tell the borrowed civil calendar apart from the Islamic one.

Say the Latin-sounding civil months, then the first Hijri months, and state what each calendar is used for.

14.1 ديسمبر to يناير — Latin names, borrowed whole, running beside a second calendar

Here's a genuinely different kind of honesty this lesson needs: Arabic doesn't have **one** answer to "what are the months called" — it has **two full calendars**, used for different purposes, side by side.

You'll want to know — Gregorian months

For the everyday, civil, solar calendar, Modern Standard Arabic simply **borrow**s the familiar Latin-derived month names you already know from Spanish/French/English:

Arabic	≈
يناير (<i>yanāyir</i>)	January
فبراير (<i>fabrāyir</i>)	February
مارس (<i>māris</i>)	March
أبريل (<i>abrīl</i>)	April
مايو (<i>māyū</i>)	May
يونيو (<i>yūniyū</i>)	June
يوليو (<i>yūliyū</i>)	July
أغسطس (<i>aghustus</i>)	August
سبتمبر (<i>sibtambir</i>)	September
أكتوبر (<i>uktūbar</i>)	October
نوفمبر (<i>nūfambir</i>)	November
ديسمبر (<i>dīsambir</i>)	December

You can hear the Latin (and French) originals right through the Arabic sounds — this is a straightforward, recent borrowing for civil/business use, not an ancient Arabic-invented system.

One more honest wrinkle: these Latin-derived names are the everyday convention in Egypt, the Gulf, and much pan-Arab media — but the Levant and Iraq (Syria, Lebanon, Jordan, Palestine, Iraq) traditionally use a **third**, completely different set for these same twelve solar months, of **Syriac** origin: الثاني كانون (*Kānūn al-Thānī*, January), شباط (*Shubāt*, February), آذار (*Ādhār*, March), and so on. So depending on the country, an Arabic speaker’s civil-calendar month name might come from Latin *or* from Syriac — a third naming system, not just two.

Why it’s said this way

For **religious life** — Ramadan, Hajj, and the Islamic calendar generally — Arabic uses an entirely **separate** set of month names, from the **lunar Hijri calendar**: محرم (*Muḥarram*), صفر (*Ṣafar*), ربيع (*Rabīʿ*), الثاني/الأول (*Rabīʿ al-Awwal/al-Thānī* — the very “Rabīʿ” from the seasons lesson), and eight more, none of which correspond to a fixed solar month. Because the Hijri calendar has **no leap-month correction**, these twelve lunar months drift steadily across all four solar seasons over a roughly 33-year cycle — so Ramadan, for instance, doesn’t fall in the same season every year.

Two calendars, two jobs: the borrowed Latin names for the ordinary business week, the older lunar names for religious observance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “yanāyir, fabrāyir, mārīs” — January, February, March — hear the Latin
- the second calendar — “Muḥarram, Şafar, Rabī^c al-Awwal” — entirely different names
- the honest point — two calendars, two purposes, both in everyday use

Before you move on

Where do Arabic’s civil month names (*yanāyir, mārīs...*) come from? (**Borrowed Latin/European names**, recent civil-calendar loans.) What runs alongside them for religious life? (**The Hijri lunar calendar**, with its own entirely different 12 month names — *Muḥarram, Şafar, Rabī^c al-Awwal...*) Why do Hijri months drift across the seasons? (**No leap-month correction** — the lunar year is shorter than the solar year, so the calendar drifts over a ~33-year cycle.)

Chapter 15

Noon and Midnight

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say noon and midnight in Arabic and recognise *az-ẓuhr* as the name of the midday prayer.

*Say *az-ẓuhr* and *muntaṣaf al-layl*, and name the religious sense Arabic's noon carries.*

15.1 الظهر, منتصف الليل — noon and midnight

Noon in Arabic isn't just a clock-time word — it's tied directly into the rhythm of daily prayer.

You'll want to know — الظهر — noon, and a prayer

الظهر (*az-ẓuhr* or *adh-dhuhr*) = “**noon**” — from the root ز-ه-ظ (*z-h-r*), “**to appear, become visible**” (the sun standing at its highest, most visible point). Be honest about what makes this word different from Spanish's *mediodía*: الظهر **is also the name of the midday Islamic prayer**, *ṣalāt al-ẓuhr*. For a Muslim, “noon” and “time for the noon prayer” are the same word — this isn't a neutral clock-time term the way “noon” or *mediodía* are in cultures where the day isn't organized around five fixed prayer times.

You'll want to know — الليل منتصف — a transparent “half of the night”

الليل منتصف (*muntaṣaf al-layl*) = “**midnight**,” literally “**the half of the night**.” منتصف (*muntaṣaf*) comes from the root ف-ص-ن (*n-ṣ-f*), “**half**” (the

same root as نصف, *niṣf*, “a half”), and الليل (*al-layl*) is simply “**the night**.” This one is fully transparent — no erosion, no double meaning, just “the middle of the night,” structurally exactly like Latin’s *media nox*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “aḏ-ḏuhr” — noon, also the midday prayer
- “muntaṣaf al-layl” — literally “the half of the night”
- the honest point — Arabic noon carries a religious meaning that mediodía doesn’t

Before you move on

What does الظهر name besides the time of day? (**The midday Islamic prayer**, *ṣalāt al-ḏuhr*.) What does الليل منتصف literally mean, and what root gives it “half”? (“**The half of the night**” — *muntaṣaf*, from ف-ص-ن *n-ṣ-f*, “half.”) Is Arabic’s word for noon a neutral clock-time word the way Spanish’s *mediodía* is? (**No** — it’s bound up with the daily prayer schedule.)

Chapter 16

Telling Time

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask what time it is in Arabic and answer with the hour.

Ask kam as-sāʿa? and answer with the ordinal hour, including the one-o'clock exception.

16.1 الساعة — one word for “hour,” “clock,” and “a moment”

Arabic’s word for “hour” isn’t native Arabic at all — it’s a very old borrowing, and it still carries three meanings at once.

Why it’s said this way

ساعة (*sāʿa*) = “**hour**” — but also “**clock/watch**” (as an object) and “**a while, a moment**” (as in “wait a *sāʿa*”). According to the historical linguist Theodor Nöldeke, Arabic *ساعة* was borrowed from **Aramaic** ܫܥܬܐ (*šāʿatā*) — the same Semitic root that gives Hebrew its word for hour, שעה (*šāʿā*). This borrowing happened long before Islam, deep in Arabic’s pre-Islamic contact with Aramaic-speaking communities — so unlike some of the religiously-tied vocabulary you’ve seen (like *aḏ-ḏuhr*), *sāʿa* is simply an old, everyday loanword, carrying no special religious weight.

Grammar Lens: الساعة؟ كم — “how much is the hour?”

Arabic asks the time with كم الساعة؟ (*kam as-sāʿa?*), literally “**how much/ how many is the hour**” — and answers with الساعة + an ordinal number (“the second,” “the third...):

الثانية الساعة. — “It is two o’clock.” (literally “the hour [is] the second”) الثالثة الساعة. — “It is three o’clock.” (literally “the hour [is] the third”)

Be honest about the one exception: **one o’clock breaks this pattern**. You’d expect the ordinal *al-ūlā* (“the first”), but Arabic actually says الساعة الواحدة (*as-sāʿa al-wāḥida*) — using **al-wāḥida**, the plain **cardinal** “one,” not the ordinal. So the rule is “ordinal numbers from two o’clock onward, except one o’clock, which uses the cardinal instead” — a genuine irregularity, not a typo. This is still a different grammatical shape than Spanish’s *la una/las dos* or French’s *une heure/deux heures*, both of which use plain cardinal numbers throughout, with no ordinal/cardinal split at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “sāʿa” — hour, clock, or a while, depending on context
- “kam as-sāʿa?” — what time is it?
- “as-sāʿa al-thāniya” — it is two o’clock, an ordinal number
- “as-sāʿa al-wāḥida” — it is one o’clock, the one exception, using the cardinal “one” instead

Before you move on

What language did Arabic borrow ساعة from, and what Hebrew word is its cousin? (**Aramaic** *šāʿatā*; cousin of Hebrew *šāʿā*.) What three things can ساعة mean? (**Hour, clock/watch, and a while/moment**.) Does Arabic use cardinal or ordinal numbers to tell the time — and is there an exception? (**Ordinal** from two o’clock onward — “the hour is the *second*” — but **one o’clock is the exception**, using the cardinal *al-wāḥida*, “one,” instead of the

ordinal.)

Chapter 17

Asking Someone's Age

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask how old someone is in Arabic and give my own age without using a verb.

Ask kam ʿumruka? and answer ʿumrī ʿishrūna sanaʾ – age as a noun you possess, no verb anywhere.

17.1 عمرک؟ کم — asking age with a noun, not a verb

You've seen Romance languages **have** their years, Germanic languages **be** their years, and Classical Latin itself use a third construction (“born” + accusative of duration). Arabic does something structurally different again: it doesn't use a verb for this at all.

You'll want to know — عمر — life, lifetime, age

عمر (*ʿumr*) = “age, lifetime, life span” — from the root ع-م-ر (*ʿ-m-r*), broadly tied to the idea of **living, dwelling, flourishing** (the same root behind the personal name ʿUmar, and words for “building, habitation”). Age in Arabic isn't something you *have* or *are* — it's expressed as a possessed noun: “**your** ʿumr,” “**my** ʿumr.”

Grammar Lens: **عمرک؟ کم** — no verb needed

عمرک؟ کم — “How old are you?” (to a man) — literally “**how much [is] your** *‘umr*.” (*kam ‘umruka?*) **عشرون عمري سنة.** — “I am twenty years old.” — literally “**my** *‘umr* [is] twenty years.” (*‘umrī ‘ishrūna sana.*)

Notice there’s **no verb “to be” at all** in the present tense here — Arabic simply juxtaposes two nouns (“my age” / “twenty years”), exactly the way it forms ordinary present-tense sentences without *is/are*. So this is a genuinely **fourth shape** for the concept: not Romance’s “I **have** twenty years,” not Germanic’s “I **am** twenty years [old],” not Latin’s “**born** twenty years [so far],” but “**my age** [is] twenty years” — age as a possessed noun-quantity, stated without any verb at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*‘umr*” — age, lifetime, life span
- “*kam ‘umruka?*” — how old are you? (to a man)
- “*‘umrī ‘ishrūna sana*” — my age is twenty years, no verb at all

Before you move on

What does **عمر** literally mean, and what root is it from? (“**Age, lifetime**” — root **ع-م-ر**, tied to living/flourishing.) Does Arabic use a verb to state age, the way Romance (“have”), Germanic (“be”), or Latin (“born” + duration) do? (**No** — it juxtaposes “my age” and the number, with no verb needed at all.) What does **عمرک؟ کم** literally ask? (“**How much [is] your** *‘umr*?”)

17.2 The letters that wrote my name

Write **اسمي** and **خير** by hand, right to left, without looking below. Both were drawn stroke by stroke in the writing set and neither has been asked for since.

Script: one bowl, four letters

letter	dots	where it sits
ب <i>bāʾ</i>	one below	inside بخير
ن <i>nūn</i>	one above	inside أنت
ت <i>tāʾ</i>	two above	inside تشرفنا, أنت
ث <i>thāʾ</i>	three above	—

One shallow boat-bowl, drawn the same way every time. Only the dots change, and the dots **are** the letter. Two of these four build the word for *you*: an *alif* with a hamza seat, then *nūn*, then *tāʾ*.

Script: the letter with three jobs

ي *yāʾ* is the same bowl body with **two dots below** — a tooth when joined. It does three separate jobs, and you have used all three:

- consonant **y**, as in *yawm*, a day
- the long vowel **ī**, a seat for the *ee* sound
- the suffix **ي**, glued on to mean **my**

That third job is what turns اسم into اسمي. Four letters, right to left: *alif* · *sīn* · *mīm* · *yāʾ*.

Script: the marks everyday text leaves off

The **ḥarakāt** are three small marks written around a consonant, not letters of their own: *fatha* above for *a*, *kasra* below for *i*, *damma* above for *u*. Arabic is an abjad, so ordinary text leaves them out — and one of them carries the whole difference between أنت and أنت.

Hamza is not one of them. It writes a real consonant: the glottal catch in the middle of English *uh-oh*. Written alone it is ء; riding an *alif* seat it is إ, which is how the word for *you* begins.

Script: خير, taken apart

خ *khāʾ* belongs to the hook-and-tail family — a rounded hook flowing into a tail that drops below the line, with **one dot above**. Its plain cousin ح has no dot and چ takes one below.

Write these out:

- خـ right to left — $khāʾ$ with its dot, into $yāʾ$, then $rā$, and lift
- glue ّ on the front — بخـ, its one dot below, joining straight into the $khāʾ$
- اسمي — $alif \cdot sīn \cdot mīm \cdot yāʾ$

Nothing joins after ّ, which is why the pen lifts there.

Before you move on

Name the one feature that separates ث ن ب. (**The dots** — one below, one above, two above, three above.) Give $yāʾ$'s three jobs. (**Consonant y, long vowel ī, the suffix meaning my.**) Say whether hamza is a vowel mark. (**No** — a glottal stop.) And say what ّ adds to بخـ. (**In** — in goodness.)

Chapter 18

Weather

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what the weather is doing in Arabic – hot, cold, or raining.

Say *aṭ-ṭaqs*, then the verbless *al-jaw ḥārr* / *al-jaw bārid*, then *innahā tumṭir*, which does take a verb.

18.1 الطقس — weather and ritual, one root

Here’s an unexpected pairing: Arabic’s word for “weather” shares its root with the word for religious “rites.”

You’ll want to know — طقس — weather, and its plural means “rites”

الطقس (*aṭ-ṭaqs*) = “**the weather**” — from root س-ق-ط (*ṣ-q-s*). Its plural, طقوس (*ṭuqūs*), means “**rites, religious ceremonies, liturgy**” — the same root covering both “atmospheric conditions” and “prescribed ritual observances.” (Casual speech often prefers الجو (*al-jaw*, “the atmosphere”) instead, keeping *aṭ-ṭaqs* for more formal or written use.)

You’ll want to know — حار الجو / بارد — hot and cold, still verbless

حار الجو. — “It’s hot.” — literally “**the atmosphere [is] hot.**” (*al-jaw ḥārr*.) بارد الجو. — “It’s cold.” — literally “**the atmosphere [is] cold.**” (*al-jaw bārid*.)

Same pattern as *عمرك؟ كم* from the AGE lesson: **no verb “to be”** at all — just two nouns/adjectives sitting side by side.

You’ll want to know — *تمطر إنها* — but rain gets its OWN personal verb

تمطر إنها. — “It’s raining.” — literally “**she is raining.**” (*innahā tumṭir* — from *مطر*, *maṭar*, “rain,” the same root gives *تمطر*, *tumṭir*, “is raining.”)

Unlike *hot* and *cold*, rain isn’t a verbless adjective sentence — Arabic uses an actual **personal verb**, *tumṭir* (“is raining”), with a **feminine dummy pronoun**, *إنها* (*innahā*, “she/it”), standing in as the subject. So within Arabic’s own weather vocabulary, hot/cold stay verbless while rain gets a real, conjugated verb — echoing the same “rain behaves differently from other weather” pattern Latin shows in its dedicated *pluit*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “aṭ-ṭaqṣ” — weather, same root as “ṭuqūs,” rites
- “al-jaw ḥarr. al-jaw bārid.” — it’s hot/cold, no verb
- “innahā tumṭir” — it’s raining, with an actual verb

Before you move on

What does the plural of *طقس* mean, and what’s the connection to “weather”? (*طقوس*, “**rites, religious ceremonies**” — sharing the same root.) Do *حار الجو* and *بارد الجو* use a verb? (**No** — verbless, like *kam ʿumruka?*.) Does *تمطر إنها* use a verb? (**Yes** — *tumṭir*, “is raining,” with a feminine dummy pronoun.)

Chapter 19

Numbers One to Five

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can count from one to five in Arabic.

Count wāḥid to khamṣa, then separate the Arabic number WORDS from the Indian-origin digit shapes.

19.1 خمسة أربعة, ثلاثة, اثنان, واحد — one through five

Before the numbers themselves — an honest correction to a very common mix-up: “Arabic numerals” (the digit shapes **0**, **1**, **2**, **3**...) are **not** these words, and don’t come from Arabic at all.

You’ll want to know — خمسة, أربعة, ثلاثة, اثنان, واحد — the words

Arabic	Transliteration	Meaning
واحد	<i>wāḥid</i>	one
اثنان	<i>ithnān</i>	two
ثلاثة	<i>thalātha</i>	three
أربعة	<i>arbaʿa</i>	four
خمسة	<i>khamṣa</i>	five

These are ordinary Semitic-root Arabic words, built the same way Arabic builds any noun — nothing to do with the shapes of the digits you write.

Why it's said this way

Here's the correction: the **digit shapes 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9** that English calls “Arabic numerals” didn't originate in Arabic at all — they were invented in **India**, appearing in Indian mathematical texts and inscriptions centuries before reaching the Arab world. The 9th-century Persian mathematician **al-Khwārizmī** (whose name gives English **algorithm**) wrote an influential treatise on calculating with these **Hindu numerals**, which carried the system into the Islamic world and then, via Latin translations, into Europe. So “Arabic numerals” is really a transmission credit, not an origin credit — the shapes are Indian; only their route to Europe ran through Arabic mathematics. The **words** you're learning here (*wāḥid*, *ithnān*, *thalātha*...) are a completely separate thing: genuine, native Arabic vocabulary, unrelated to that digit-shape history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “wāḥid, ithnān, thalātha, arbaʿa, khamṣa” — one through five
- the honest correction — “Arabic numerals” (the digit SHAPES) are actually Indian in origin, not these Arabic WORDS

Before you move on

What are the Arabic words for one through five? (**wāḥid, ithnān, thalātha, arbaʿa, khamṣa.**) Where did the digit shapes 0-9 actually originate, and who's credited with carrying them to Europe? (**India** — carried into the Islamic world and then Europe largely through **al-Khwārizmī**'s writings.) Are “Arabic numerals” the same thing as these Arabic number words? (**No** — completely separate: one is a set of written digit shapes with Indian origins, the other is native Arabic vocabulary.)

Chapter 20

Numbers Eleven to Twenty

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can count from eleven to twenty in Arabic and build the teens as 'X and ten'.

Build the teens as additive X-^cashar compounds, then say ^cishrūn, which is not built that way at all.

20.1 عشر أحَد، عشرون — plain compounds, then a genuinely different twenty

Eleven through fifteen build the same simple way every time. Then twenty breaks the pattern completely — it isn't built the way you'd expect at all.

You'll want to know — عشر خمسة – عشر أحَد — “X and ten”

Arabic	literally
عشر أحَد	<i>aḥada ^cashar</i> — “one-ten” (11)
عشر اثنا	<i>ithnā ^cashar</i> — “two-ten” (12)
عشر ثلاثة	<i>thalāthata ^cashar</i> — “three-ten” (13)
عشر أربعة	<i>arba^cata ^cashar</i> — “four-ten” (14)
عشر خمسة	<i>khamṣata ^cashar</i> — “five-ten” (15)

Every one of these is the counting-word (from the AGE and NUM-1-5 lessons) plus **عشر** (*‘ashar*, “**ten**”) — a straightforward additive compound, the same shape Spanish builds in *once-quince* and Latin in *ūndecim-quīndecim*.

You’ll want to know — **عشرون** — NOT “two-ten,” a genuinely different word

Here’s the honest surprise: **twenty** is **not** built from “two” + “ten” the way 11-15 were built. **عشرون** (*‘ishrūn*, “twenty”) is its **own**, distinct word — a special **plural-like form** built directly on the same “ten” root, **ع-ش-ر** (*‘sh-r*), rather than a compound of *ithnān* (“two”) and *‘ashar* (“ten”). That root, *‘ashar/‘ishrūn*, is the same Semitic “ten” root behind Hebrew’s **עשר** (*eser*, “ten”) — and, coincidentally, resembles the Indo-European “ten” root that gives English its own **-teen** suffix, though the two roots are **not** related: Arabic and English inherited “ten” from two entirely separate language families, so this is a parallel, not a shared borrowing or common ancestor.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “aḥada *‘ashar*, *ithnā ‘ashar*, *thalāthata ‘ashar*” — 11, 12, 13, “X and ten”
- “*‘ishrūn*” — twenty, its OWN word, not “two-ten”

Before you move on

How are 11-15 built in Arabic? (**X** + **‘ashar** — “one-ten,” “two-ten,” and so on, a plain additive compound.) Is **عشرون** (twenty) built the same way, as “two-ten”? (**No** — it’s a distinct, standalone plural-like form built on the same “ten” root, not a compound of “two” and “ten.”) What root does **‘ashar/‘ishrūn** share with Hebrew? (**ע-ש-ר**/ע-ש-ר, the Semitic root for “ten,” giving Hebrew’s *eser*.)

Chapter 21

Dog and Cat

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a dog and a cat in Arabic.

Say kalb beside Hebrew kelev, then qitt beside Latin cattus, flagging that the cat link is still debated.

21.1 کلب, قط — a solid root, and the word that closes the loop

Spanish has a genuine dog-word mystery, and German another by way of English. Arabic’s dog-word has no such mystery — and its cat-word turns out to be a long-lost cousin of nearly every European cat-word there is.

Why it’s said this way

کلب (*kalb*, “dog”) traces to **Proto-Semitic *kalb-** — the exact same root behind **Hebrew**’s own word for dog, כָּלֵב (*kelev*) (the name **Caleb** is traditionally connected to this same root, though some scholars instead derive it from *kol-lev*, “whole-hearted”). Unlike Spanish’s *perro* or the English word that replaced “hound,” *kalb* is a solid, well-attested, unmysterious Semitic root, shared across the whole Semitic family (Aramaic, Akkadian, and more).

Why it's said this way

Here's how this whole arc most likely ties together: **قَطّ** (*qitt*, “**cat, tomcat**”) is not just a coincidence-sounding lookalike — it's widely **compared** to the exact same ancient **Afro-Asiatic** root behind Latin's **cattus** (alongside Nubian *kadis*, mentioned back in the Spanish and Latin lessons). Be honest about the uncertainty here, though: linguists don't fully agree on the relationship. Some argue *qitt* and *cattus* both descend from a **shared** ancestor; others have proposed that *kadis* (and even *qitt* itself) could be a **later** borrowing **from** Arabic rather than an independent cousin, reversing the direction. What's not in serious dispute is that Arabic's word for “cat” sits in the same tangled word-family as Spanish's *gato*, French's *chat*, Italian's *gatto*, and German's *Katze* — one root (or a tight cluster of related roots), spreading out in every direction from wherever cats were first domesticated, even if the exact family tree is still being worked out.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kalb” — dog, a solid Semitic root, cousin of Hebrew's *kelev*
- “qitt” — cat, most likely a distant cousin of Latin's *cattus* and every European cat-word there is

Before you move on

What root does **كَلْب** trace to, and what's its Hebrew cousin? (**Proto-Semitic *kalb-**; cousin of Hebrew **כֶּלֶב**, *kelev*.) Is **قَطّ**'s relationship to Latin's *cattus* fully settled? (**No** — widely compared, most likely from a shared Afro-Asiatic root, but linguists still debate the exact relationship and direction.) What does this most likely mean for Arabic's word for “cat” compared to Spanish's *gato*, French's *chat*, and German's *Katze*? (**They most likely belong to the same tangled ancient word family** — spreading in every direction from the region where cats were first domesticated.)

Chapter 22

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name green and yellow in Arabic and trace *aṣfar* to the same root as *ṣifr*, 'zero'.

Say akḥḍar beside khuḍār, 'vegetables', then aṣfar beside ṣifr, and follow ṣifr into English zero and cipher.

22.1 أخضر، أصفر — “greens” you’d recognize, and a hidden zero

Arabic’s green word hides an English-style pun. Its yellow word hides something even better — the exact root behind the word “zero” itself.

Why it’s said this way

أخضر (*akḥḍar*, “**green**”) comes from the root ر-ض-خ (*kh-ḍ-r*, “**to be green**”). That same root gives خضار (*khuḍār*, “**vegetables**”) — echoing the exact same move English makes when it calls vegetables “**greens**.” The same root also names the mysterious Quranic figure الخضر (*al-Khiḍr*), “**the Green One**” — traditionally said to be called this because the ground turned green wherever he sat or prayed.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s the real surprise: أصفر (*aṣfar*, “**yellow**”) shares its root, ر-ف-ص (*ṣ-f-r*), with صفر (*ṣifr*, “**zero, empty, void**”) — the **exact** Arabic

word that gave English both **zero** (via Italian *zefiro/zero*) and **cipher** (via Medieval Latin *cifra*). So the same three-letter Arabic root sits behind “yellow” and behind the number **zero** itself. The sources don’t fully explain *why* “emptiness” and “yellow” share a root — but the shared root itself, connecting Arabic’s yellow-word straight back to the origin of “zero,” is genuine and well documented.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “akhḍar” — green, same root as “khuḍār,” vegetables
- “aṣfar” — yellow, same root as “ṣifr,” zero
- the connection — “aṣfar, ṣifr, zero, cipher” — one Arabic root, reaching all the way into English math vocabulary

Before you move on

What root does أخضر share with “vegetables,” and what English phrase does this echo? (ر-ض-خ, *kh-ḍ-r* — echoes English calling vegetables “**greens**.”) What Quranic figure shares this root, and what does his name mean? (الخضر, *al-Khiḍr* — “**the Green One**.”) What word does أصفر share its root with, and what two English words trace back to it? (صفر, *ṣifr*, “zero, empty” — the source of English **zero** and **cipher**.)

22.2 The head and the hand

Touch your head, then your hand, and give the Arabic for each. Both arrived a dozen lessons ago in single words and have not been asked for since.

Across the family: five words older than Arabic

Arabic	meaning	Hebrew cousin
رأس <i>raʿs</i>	head	ראש <i>rosh</i>
يد <i>yad</i>	hand	יד <i>yad</i>
أب <i>ab</i>	father	אב <i>av</i>
أم <i>umm</i>	mother	אם <i>em</i>
أخ <i>akh</i>	brother	אח <i>ach</i>

These are not borrowings in either direction. Both languages inherited them, and يد *yad* is the most striking of the set: spelled and said almost identically on both sides, worn down hardly at all in several thousand years.

رأس *raʿs* is the word inside *Rosh Hashanah*, the head of the year.

Across the family: what the roots still build

None of these roots is a museum piece.

- رئيس *raʿīs* — **president, chief** — is built straight on *head*, the same way English *capital* and *captain* grow out of Latin *caput*.
- أم *um* and أبو *abu* still form the **kunya**, a living honorific: *mother of* and *father of*, plus a child's name.
- أخت *ukht* is أخ *akh* with a single letter added — the simplest gendering in the language, against the reshaped templates the colour words needed.

Grammar Lens: an age is a thing you own

عمر *ʿumr* is **age, lifetime, life span**, from the root ع-م-ر, tied to living and flourishing.

كم عمرك؟ *kam ʿumruka?* — literally **how much is your lifetime?**

The Romance languages **have** their years; the Germanic ones **are** their years. Arabic does neither. It hangs the same *your* suffix on a noun and drops the verb altogether, exactly as the name and wellbeing questions do.

Your turn

- *Say it:* head, then hand — *raʿs ... yad*
- *Say it:* father, mother, brother, sister — *ab, umm, akh, ukht*
- *Say it:* ask a man his age — *kam ʿumruka?*
- *Say it:* ask a woman — *kam ʿumruki?*
- *Recall:* the word for president, and the body part it is built on

Before you move on

Name which word in this set has changed least from its Hebrew cousin. (يد — both *yad*.) Give the word for president and its literal base. (رئيس, from *head*.) Say what turns أخ into its feminine. (**One added letter** — أخت.) And give the literal wording of the age question. (**How much is your lifetime.**)

Chapter 23

You're Welcome

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can reply to shukran with ʿafwan, and use the same word to say excuse me.

Say ʿafwan as the reply to thanks, unpack the root 'to erase' behind it, and hear the same -an ending it shares with shukran.

23.1 عفو (ʿafwan) — “you’re welcome,” from a root meaning “to erase”

Your very first Arabic lesson already used this word once, in passing, as the reply to *shukran*. Here it gets its own full treatment — starting with a root that literally means “to erase.”

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

عفو (ʿafwan), root ʿ-f-w (ع-ف-و): the root’s core sense is “**to erase, obliterate, remove**” — and “to pardon, forgive” grows directly out of that, since forgiving something is, metaphorically, **erasing** it. The same root gives العفو (al-ʿAfwu, “**the Supreme Pardoner**”), one of the **99 names of Allah** in Islamic tradition.

You’ll want to know — Be honest: ʿafwan does more than one job

ʿAfwan answers *shukran* as “**you’re welcome**” — but depending on tone and context, the exact same word also does duty as “**excuse me,**” “**par-**

don,” or “sorry.” One root, one word, several closely related jobs — all growing from that same “erase/pardon” sense.

Grammar Lens: the same ending as shukran itself

Look closely at the spelling: عفوؑا ends in the same **tanwīn fatḥ** (“-an”) you already met in شكرؑا (*shukran*) — the indefinite accusative ending. Neither word is a full sentence with its own verb; both are fixed, idiomatic accusative forms functioning as a complete conversational turn on their own. The grammar you learned once, for *shukran*, already explains *ʿafwan* too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “عفوؑا” — *ʿafwan*, “you’re welcome”
- the root ʿ-f-w — “to erase” → “to pardon”
- the shared ending — *shukran* and *ʿafwan* both end in the same **tanwīn fatḥ**, “-an”

Before you move on

What does the root ʿ-f-w literally mean, before it comes to mean “pardon”? (“**To erase, obliterate.**”) Besides “you’re welcome,” what other jobs can *ʿafwan* do? (“**Excuse me,**” “**pardon,**” “**sorry**” — context-dependent.) What grammatical ending does *ʿafwan* share with *shukran*? (The **tanwīn fatḥ**, “-an” — both are fixed indefinite- accusative forms, not full sentences.)

23.2 Please, sorry, thank you

Say yes, please, sorry and thank you in Arabic, in that order, before reading on. Four short words, each taught once, none asked for since.

You'll want to know: three of the four bend

word	to a man	to a woman
please	فضلك من <i>min faḍlak</i>	فضلك من <i>min faḍlik</i>
sorry	آسف <i>āsif</i>	أسفة <i>āsifa</i>
yes	نعم <i>naʿam</i>	نعم <i>naʿam</i>

Naʿam is the clear standard **yes**, safe anywhere, and it has spoken neighbours you will also hear. *Min faḍlik* is the only one of the three whose bend is **invisible**: the written form does not change at all, because only the unwritten short vowel moves.

آسف is stranger than English *sorry*, because it is not a fixed word — it is a **gendered adjective**, from the verb *asifa*, to grieve or regret. So a woman apologising says a different word from a man. For a quick, ungendered *excuse me*, Arabic reaches for معذرة *maʿdhira* instead.

Script: the two letters inside شكرا

ش *shīn* is not a new shape at all: it is س *sīn* with **three dots** on top — the same trick the boat-bowl plays, where ب takes one dot below, ت two above and ث three above. The dots do the work; the skeleton is shared.

The other new letter in the word is ك *kāf*.

Writing: what changes when letters join

Write these out:

- سلام right to left — *sīn · lām · alif · mīm*
- شكرا — *shīn* with its three dots, then *kāf*, *rāʾ*, *alif*

What changes when a letter joins is the **connector at each edge**. What stays is the **skeleton** — which is why a letter you learned standing alone is still readable buried in the middle of a word.

Why it's said this way

The reply to thanks is عفو *ʿafwan* — *it is nothing, you are pardoned* — from a root meaning to forgive or waive. English answers gratitude by accepting it. Arabic answers by **waving it away**: you thank, and they erase the debt.

Before you move on

Give the two forms of *sorry* and what makes them differ. (آسف and آسفة — a gendered adjective.) Give the reply to شكرا and its literal force. (عفوا — it is nothing, you are pardoned.) Say what ش is made of. (س plus three dots.) And say which courtesy word bends without the spelling changing. (فضلك من.)

Chapter 24

See You Tomorrow

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can part from someone in Arabic with *ilā l-ghad*, ‘until tomorrow’.

Say *ilā l-ghad*, point to the *ilā* already known from *ilā l-liqāʾ*?, and follow *gh-d-w* from ‘dawn’ to ‘tomorrow’.

24.1 الغد إلى (*ilā l-ghad*) — “see you tomorrow,” the same *ilā* again

You already have the pattern: **ilā** + a future point = “see you [then].” Here it is again, with “tomorrow” filling the slot.

You’ll want to know — The two pieces, one already familiar

الغد إلى (*ilā l-ghad*) = “until tomorrow”:

- إلى (*ilā*) — “until,” the exact same word from *ilā l-liqāʾ* (“see you [later]”).
- الغد (*al-ghad*) — “tomorrow,” root **gh-d-w** (غ-د-و).
- Note ل is a sun letter, so *al-ghad* would assimilate — but غ (*ghayn*) is a **moon letter**, so here the *l* stays put: *al-ghad*, not doubled the way *al-liqāʾ* and *as-salāma* were.

Why it's said this way

Gh-d-w's core sense is “**to go out at dawn, early morning**” — and “**tomorrow**” grows directly out of that “early morning” sense. This is **not** a one-off coincidence: this **exact** shift also happened in Latin, where *māne* (“morning”) became French's *demain* and Spanish's *mañana* (“tomorrow”). Two completely unrelated language families — Semitic and Indo-European — independently building “tomorrow” out of “morning.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ilā l-ghad” — “until tomorrow”
- the reused piece — ilā, already known from ilā l-liqāʾ
- the root echo — gh-d-w, “dawn/morning” → “tomorrow,” the same shift as Latin *māne* → *mañana*/*demain*

Before you move on

What word does **ilā l-ghad** share with **ilā l-liqāʾ**? (**Ilā**, “until.”) What does the root **gh-d-w** literally mean, before it comes to mean “tomorrow”? (“**To go out at dawn, early morning.**”) Is this morning-to-tomorrow shift unique to Arabic? (**No** — Latin's *māne* (“morning”) independently became French's *demain* and Spanish's *mañana*, “tomorrow,” the same way.)

24.2 Every way to leave

Give both Arabic farewells and the literal meaning of each, without reading on. Then spell the longer one, right to left.

Script: the throat sound and the shape-shifter

ﺥ *ʿayn* is two pieces: an **open-mouth curve** on top, like a small *c* facing left, and a **bowl** beneath it when the letter stands alone or ends a word. It opens a **third** dots-family — the bowl and the hook-and-tail were the first two — and its dotted partner is ڭ *ghayn*.

ه *hāʾ* is the opposite kind of letter: one closed loop, no dots, and the most **shape-shifting** thing in the alphabet. It wears four genuinely different coats depending on where it sits in the word.

Script: السلامة مع, letter by letter

Write these out:

- مع — *mīm*, its round head joining left into *ʿayn*
- السلامة — *alif* · *lām*, then *sīn* · *lām* · *alif* · *mīm*, then the tied *ḍ*

Both letters of مع were already yours. And السلامة is not a long new word: it is ل plus the very first word you ever wrote, plus a tied *tāʾ* on the end.

Grammar Lens: one pattern, one rule

Arabic does not only add endings; it pours a root into a **shape**. The root **s-l-m** poured into *faʿāla* turns *peace* into **the state of safety** — *salām* becomes *salāma*.

Then the sun-letter rule bites: س is a sun letter, so the *l* of ل assimilates to it. Written الس, said **as-salāma**.

مع *maʿa* is a preposition and it **stands alone**, unlike ل and ب, which fasten onto the next word.

You'll want to know: the other farewell

إلى *ilā l-liqāʾ* is إلى (*until*) plus اللقاء (*the meeting*), from the root **l-q-y**, to meet. So Arabic does not say *goodbye*; it says **until the meeting** — the same move Spanish makes with *hasta luego, until later*.

Two shapes in it run past the writing set: the ل with its hamza below, and the ق *qāf*. Read them for now.

The exchange

- *Say it:* greet, give your name, ask after them, and part — the whole arc, to a man
- *Say it:* part with safety — *maʿa s-salāma*
- *Say it:* part until the meeting — *ilā l-liqāʾ*
- *Recall:* the root that both opens the book's greeting and closes its farewell

That last one is the joke the language plays on you: **s-l-m** is the root of the first thing you learned to say and the last. *salām, salāma, islām, muslim* — peace, safety, wholeness, all one family.

Before you move on

Give the three pieces of السلامة. (ال + *salām* + ة.) Give the root inside اللقاء and its sense. (**l-q-y**, to meet.) Name the letter that wears four different coats. (هـ.) And say whether مع attaches to the next word. (**No** — it stands alone.)

Chapter 25

Day

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say 'day' in Arabic and recognise its cognate in Hebrew's Yom Kippur.

Say yawm, run it across the Semitic family, and mark the Egyptian sun-word origin as unsettled.

25.1 يوم (yawm) — “day,” a word shared across the whole Semitic family

This word is bigger than Arabic — it's one of the oldest, most widely shared words across the entire Semitic language family.

You'll want to know — يوم — “day”

يوم (yawm) — “day” — root **y-w-m**. Arabic's day-names can compound with *yawm* — الجمعة يوم (*yawm al-jum^a*, “day of the gathering”) is the full, formal way to say “Friday,” the exact same “day-of-X” construct-state pattern as Latin's *diēs Lūnae* — but colloquially, the bare day-name alone (*al-jum^a*, *as-sabt*, already taught earlier) is just as common. *Yawm* itself is also the ordinary, standalone word for “a day.”

Why it's said this way

Yawm traces to **Proto-Semitic *yawm-** — and this isn't just an Arabic word with foreign relatives, it's a genuinely **Common Semitic** word, found with the same shape and meaning across the whole family:

Hebrew **יֹמִי** (*yōm* — yes, the *yom* in **Yom Kippur**, “Day of Atonement”), Akkadian **ūmum**, and Aramaic **yawmā**. Four different Semitic languages, one shared ancient word for “day.”

Why it’s said this way

Some scholars push the trail back even further, to a proposed **Proto-Afroasiatic** root, ***yam-** (“day”) — and speculatively connect it to Egyptian **imy**, meaning “sun” (literally “the eye”). Be honest: this deeper connection is a genuinely **proposed**, citable scholarly idea within comparative Afroasiatic linguistics — but a minority one, not accepted by most Egyptologists (standard Egyptian dictionaries gloss *imy* as a common grammatical form, “who/which is in,” not “sun,” and ordinary Egyptian for “day” is an unrelated word, *hrw*). Not settled fact the way the Semitic-family cognates are.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “yawm” — “day”
- the Semitic family — yawm, yōm (Yom Kippur), ūmum, yawmā
- the honest deeper speculation — possibly Egyptian “sun,” not settled

Before you move on

What Hebrew word, familiar from a well-known holiday name, is **yawm**’s direct cognate? (**Yōm**, as in **Yom Kippur**.) Name two other Semitic languages that share this exact word for “day.” (**Akkadian** *ūmum*, **Aramaic** *yawmā*.) Is the proposed Egyptian “sun” connection settled fact? (**No** — a genuinely proposed but speculative deeper link.)

Chapter 26

Night

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say ‘night’ in Arabic and point to layl inside the midnight phrase I already know.

Say layl, find it inside muntaṣaf al-layl, and pair it with yawm as the other pan-Semitic half of the day.

26.1 ليل (layl) — “night,” yawm’s partner across the whole Semitic family

You’ve already met *layl* once, tucked inside *muntaṣaf al-layl* (“midnight”). Now it gets the same standalone treatment *yawm* just did — and the same pan-Semitic family story.

You’ll want to know — ليل — “night”

ليل (layl) — “night” — is the word already hiding inside **muntaṣaf al-layl** (“midnight,” Chapter 15, literally “the half of the night”). Root **l-y-l**.

Why it’s said this way

Just like *yawm*, **layl** is a genuine **Common Semitic** word, not an Arabic-only term with distant relatives. It traces to **Proto-Semitic** **layl-*, cognate with Hebrew לילה (*layla/laylah* — the same word in the famous Passover question, “*mah nishtana ha-layla ha-zeh*,” “why is **this night** different”), Aramaic/Syriac **lēlyā**, and Akkadian **līliātum**. Day and night, *yawm* and *layl*, are **both** words the whole Semitic

family has shared for millennia.

Why it's said this way

Be honest about one genuine scholarly debate: linguists don't fully agree on whether Proto-Semitic had this simple **triradical** **layl-* form, or a **reduplicated** **laylay-* form instead (the doubled shape possibly surviving in some daughter languages' declension patterns). This is a real, open question in comparative Semitics — not settled the way the basic Hebrew/Aramaic/Akkadian cognate set is.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “layl” — “night,” already met inside *muntaṣaf al-layl*
- the Semitic family — *layl*, *layla* (Hebrew), *lēlyā*, *līlīātum*
- *yawm* and *layl* — day and night, both pan-Semitic words

Before you move on

Where have you already met **layl** before this lesson? (**Muntaṣaf al-layl**, “midnight.”) What Hebrew word, from a famous Passover question, is *layl*'s direct cognate? (**Layla/laylah.**) Is the exact Proto-Semitic shape of this word — triradical or reduplicated — fully settled? (**No** — a genuine, open scholarly debate.)

Chapter 27

Good Night

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good night in Arabic and explain why the phrase actually talks about the morning.

Say tuṣbiḥ ‘alā khayr, translate it as ‘may you wake into goodness’, and trace tuṣbiḥ back to ṣabāḥ al-khayr’s own root.

27.1 خیر علی تصبح (tuṣbiḥ ‘alā khayr) — wishing the morning, not the night

Every “good night” you’ve learned in other languages wishes a peaceful **night**. Arabic’s everyday version does something completely different — it skips the night and wishes the **morning** instead.

You’ll want to know — خیر علی تصبح — “may you wake into goodness”

خیر علی تصبح (tuṣbiḥ ‘alā khayr) is the most common everyday Arabic “good night” — but it literally means “**may you wake up into goodness**.” Break it down:

- تصبح (tuṣbiḥ) — the ordinary imperfect (“you become”) of أصبح (aṣbaḥa, “**to become morning, to wake up**”) — the **exact same root**, ح-ب-ص (ṣ-b-ḥ), as ṣabāḥ in ṣabāḥ al-khayr (“good morning,” Chapter 1). No special subjunctive or jussive form is

involved — a plain statement doing the work of a blessing, the same way English “you’ll sleep well” can function as a wish without any special grammar.

- على (*‘alā*) — “upon.”
- خير (*khayr*) — “goodness” — the same word already met in **masā’ al-khayr** (“good evening”).

Put together: not “sleep well,” but “**may your waking be good.**” (This particular form, *tuṣbiḥ*, addresses one **man**; a woman is *tuṣbiḥi* [تصبحي], a group is *tuṣbiḥū* [تصبحوا].)

Why it’s said this way

Here’s the genuinely different part: the everyday “good night” of English, French, German, and Spanish wishes something about the **night itself**. Arabic’s everyday version does the opposite: it’s grammatically about the **morning that follows**, built from the same “waking” root already hiding in *ṣabāḥ*. Notice what’s genuinely absent: ليل (*layl*, “night,” last lesson) doesn’t appear anywhere in this phrase at all. It reuses pieces you already have (*ṣ-b-ḥ*, *khayr*) but points them at a **different moment in time** than every other language’s farewell.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*tuṣbiḥ ‘alā khayr*” — literally “may you wake into goodness”
- the shared root — *tuṣbiḥ* and *ṣabāḥ*, both from *ṣ-b-ḥ*
- the honest twist — this “good night” is really about the morning, not the night

Before you move on

What does خير على تصبح literally mean? (“**May you wake up into goodness.**”) What root does *tuṣbiḥ* share with *ṣabāḥ al-khayr*? (*ṣ-b-ḥ*, “morning/to become morning.”) Unlike English, French, and German’s “good night,” what moment in time does Arabic’s everyday version actually point to? (**The morning that follows,**

not the night itself.)

Chapter 28

Going and Coming

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Arabic for 'he went' and 'he came', read the three-consonant root under each, and explain why Arabic dictionaries list a verb as 'he did' rather than 'to do'.

Say the going/coming pair, name the weak letter that vanishes from $jāʾa$ and point to where it comes back, and restate the root-and-pattern engine dhahaba opened.

28.1 ذَهَبَ (dhahaba) — “he went,” and the engine under every Arabic word

Every word so far has been a thing, a quality, or a fixed courtesy. Now a **verb** — and the machine that builds nearly every word in the language.

You'll want to know — The letters in this word

Three letters, one of them new.

- د ($dāl$) — a small hook resting on the line, sounding like English *d*. It is a **non-joiner**: like *alif*, it will not connect to whatever follows it.
- ذ ($dhāl$) — that same hook with **one dot above**. The dot is the entire difference. Its sound is the *th* of English **this** — voiced — never the *th* of *thin*.
- ه ($hāʾ$) and ب ($bāʾ$) are already yours.

Right to left: ذ stands alone, then هب joins into one piece. *Dha-ha-ba*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

ذَهَبَ (*dhahaba*) = “**he went**.” Its root is the bare consonant skeleton ذ-ه-ب. Keep those three consonants, pour a different set of vowels between them, and out comes a different word carved from the same idea:

- ذَهَبَ (*dhahaba*) — “he went.”
- ذَهَب (*dhahab*) — “gold.”
- مَذْهَب (*madhhab*) — “a **way one goes**,” and so the word for a **school of Islamic law**.

That last one is not luck. Putting *ma-* in front of a root gives the **place or the way** of its action, and English already owns two words from that same place-noun family: مَسْجِد (*masjid*), “place of prostration,” worn down through Spanish into **mosque**; and مَغْرِب (*maghrib*), “place of sunset,” kept whole as the **Maghreb**. The pattern is already in your vocabulary. Only the root is new.

Grammar Lens — Arabic has no “to go”

English dictionaries list a verb as “**to go**.” Arabic dictionaries cannot — the language has no infinitive. The form they list is ذَهَبَ, “**he went**”: third person, masculine, singular, finished. Grammarians name each vowel pattern with a dummy root, ل-ع-ف (*f^c-l*, “to do”), so this shape is called فَعَلَ (*fa^cala*). Every verb in these three chapters wears it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- right to left — ذ, then هب — “dhahaba,” he went
- the root — dh-h-b — then dhahab, “gold,” and madhhab, “a school of law”
- the citation form — Arabic lists “he went,” never “to go”

Before you move on

What single mark separates ج from ذ, and what does it do to the sound? (**One dot above** — it turns *d* into the *th* of “this.”) Name two other words built on ذ-ه-ز. (***Dhahab***, “gold,” and ***madhhab***, “a school of law.”) In what form does an Arabic dictionary list a verb? (“**He went**” — *dhahaba* — because Arabic has no infinitive.)

28.2 جاء (jāʾa) — “he came,” and a root that hides one of its own letters

Dhahaba was the tidy case: three consonants, three vowels, nothing hidden. Its opposite number is where the engine gets interesting.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

No new letters here — this word is built entirely from shapes you already have.

- ج (*jīm*) — the hook-and-tail body with **one dot below**, sounding like the *j* of English *jam*.
- ا (*alif*) — the clean downstroke, here carrying a long *ā*.
- ء (*hamza*) — the glottal stop, the catch in “uh-oh,” sitting on the line by itself at the end.

Right to left: ج joined, then ء standing apart. *Jāʾa* — two beats, with a hard little stop at the end.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

جاء (*jāʾa*) = “**he came**.” Its root is ا-ي-ج — and one of those three consonants is missing from the word you just read. That is the point. Arabic calls و and ي **weak** letters. Poured into the *faʿala* shape, the root would give *jayaʾa*, which no Arab mouth wants to say; the ي dissolves and its vowel stretches into the long *ā* you hear. The skeleton is still there, though, and it walks straight back out in مَجِيء (*majīʾ*), “**an arrival**” — the same *ma-* place-and-way prefix met in *madhhab*, with the ي restored in plain sight.

So the irregularity is not chaos. It is a second rule, applied everywhere a weak letter lands in the middle. Being honest about one thing: جاء is the written, formal verb. To tell someone “come here” in ordinary speech you say تَعَالِ (*ta^cāla*), which comes from a completely **different root** meaning “to be high” — originally “come up here.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — “dhahaba, jā^ʔa” — he went, he came
- the vanished letter — root j-y-^ʔ, and the ي back in place in “majī^ʔ”
- the everyday imperative — “ta^cāla,” from another root entirely

Before you move on

Which letter of جاء’s root never appears in the word itself, and where does it come back? (ي — restored in مَجِيء, *majī^ʔ*, “an arrival.”) What are Arabic’s two **weak** letters? (و and ي.) What word does an Arabic speaker actually use for “come here,” and is it from this root? (***Ta^cāla*** — **no**, a different root meaning “to be high.”)

Chapter 29

Saying and Seeing

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Arabic for 'he said' and 'he saw', read the letters qāf and alif maqṣūra, and name the doer, done-to, place and instrument words each root builds.

Say raʿā, read its dotless alif maqṣūra, follow the root out into raʿy 'opinion' and mirʿāh 'mirror', and restate the pattern family qāla laid out.

29.1 قال (qāla) — “he said,” and a letter you have been reading unnamed

One letter has turned up in Arabic words since the farewell *ilā l-liqāʿ* without ever being introduced. Its own verb is the right place to name it.

You'll want to know — The letters in this word

One new letter, and it is a sound English does not have.

- ق (qāf) — **two dots above** a bowl-shaped body. Joined mid-word it looks much like *bāʿ*'s bowl; alone or final it drops a deep round tail below the line. Its sound is a *k* made far back at the **uvula**, at the top of the throat — heavier and darker than English *k*.
- ا (alif) and ل (lām) are yours already.

Read قال right to left: *qāf*, long *ā*, *lām*. Be honest about the sound: in most everyday spoken Arabic ق is not said that way at all — in Cairo and Damascus it becomes a glottal stop, and across much of the Gulf a hard *g*. The uvular version is the formal one.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

قَالَ (*qāla*) = “**he said**.” Root ق-و-ل — and the same disappearing act as *jāʿa*, with the other weak letter. The plain shape would give *qawala*; the و dissolves and the vowel stretches to *ā*. It reappears the moment the pattern changes: قَوْل (*qawl*), “**an utterance, a saying**.” Now watch one skeleton fill four different pattern-slots:

- قَائِل (*qāʾil*) — “a **speaker**,” the **doer** shape.
- مَقُول (*maqūl*) — “**spoken**,” the **done-to** shape.
- مَقَالَة (*maqāla*) — “an **article**, an essay,” the same *ma*-place-and-way prefix that gave *madhhab*.

Those first two are the very patterns met back in *shukran*, which paired *shākīr* (“thankful”) with *mashkūr* (“thanked”). Learn a pattern once and it works on every root — which is why Arabic vocabulary grows in families rather than one word at a time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “qāla” — he said — with the deep uvular q
- the weak letter returning — qāla, then qawl, “a saying”
- the family — qāʾil, a speaker; maqūl, spoken; maqāla, an article

Before you move on

How many dots does ق carry, and where is its sound made? (**Two, above** — at the **uvula**, far back in the throat.) Which letter of the root ق-و-ل vanishes in *qāla*, and which word brings it back? (و — restored in قَوْل, *qawl*, “a saying.”) What does مَقَالَة mean, and which earlier word shares its pattern? (“**An article**” — the same *ma*-

shape as *madhhab*.)

29.2 رَأَى (raʾā) — “he saw,” and how seeing becomes having an opinion

A weak letter has hidden in the middle of the last two verbs.
This time it hides at the **end** — and it wears a shape of its own.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

One new shape, and it is a shape you can almost already read.

- ر (rāʾ) — the little downward curve, a tapped *r*, and a non-joiner.
- ا — *alif* carrying **hamza**, the glottal catch, riding on top.
- ي (alif maqṣūra, “the shortened alif”) — this is the new one, and it is simply ي (yāʾ) **stripped of its two dots**. Same body, no dots.
Despite the *yāʾ* body it sounds like a long *ā*, and it only ever turns up at the **end** of a word. The farewell *ilā l-ghad* already carried it, unnamed.

Right to left: *rāʾ*, then *alif-with-hamza*, then the dotless tail. *Ra-ʾā*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

رَأَى (raʾā) = “**he saw**.” Root ر-أ-ي. The weak ي is the **last** consonant this time, and instead of vanishing outright it surfaces as that dotless ي. Three verbs, three placements of weakness: middle in *jāʾa* and *qāla*, final here. Each has its own regular rules.

The family this root grows is the good part:

- رَأْي (raʾy) — “an **opinion**.” Literally a *seeing*. English does the very same thing with “**in my view**” and “the way **I see it**” — two unrelated languages reaching for one metaphor.
- مِرْآة (mirʾāh) — “a **mirror**.” This is the **instrument** shape, *mi-* plus the root: “the thing you see with.” It is a sibling of the *ma-* place shape behind *madhhab* and *maqāla*.
- رُؤْيَا (ruʾyā) — “a **vision**, a dream.”

Seeing, opinion, mirror, vision: four words, one skeleton, no memorising four unrelated forms.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “raʾā” — he saw — ending on a long ā spelled with a dotless yāʾ
- the metaphor — “raʾy,” an opinion, literally a seeing
- the instrument — “mirʾāh,” a mirror, the thing you see with

Before you move on

What is ى made of, and what does it sound like? (ى *yāʾ* **without its dots** — sounding like a long ā, only ever at the end of a word.) What does رَأْي mean, and what English turn of phrase makes the same move? (“**An opinion**” — literally a seeing, like “**in my view**.”) What is مِرْآة, and what pattern builds it? (**A mirror** — the *mi-* **instrument** shape, “the thing you see with.”)

Chapter 30

Knowing and Eating

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Arabic for ‘he knew’ and ‘he ate’, tell ʿarafa apart from ʿalima, and say plainly which of these verbs has an English cousin and which has none.

Say akala with no new letters left to learn, run its doer and done-to forms, place it beside Hebrew akhal, and restate the ʿarafa root family and its Spanish loan.

30.1 عرف (ʿarafa) — “he knew,” and a root that crossed into Spain

Back to a plain, regular root after three weak ones — and to a word that split into two where English has only one.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

One new letter, and it belongs to a family already half-known.

- ع (ʿayn) — the throat-tightening sound with no English equal, met in ʿalaykum and ʿafwan.
- ر (rāʾ) — the tapped *r*, a non-joiner.
- ف (fāʾ) — the new one: a small loop with a tail, carrying **one dot above**, sounding like English *f*. Its partner is ق (qāf) from the *qāla* lesson: mid-word the two bodies are the same shape, and only the dots separate them — **one** dot for *f*, **two** for *q*. A fourth dots-family.

Right to left: *ʿayn*, *rāʾ*, *fāʾ* — *ʿa-ra-fa*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

عَرَفَ (*ʿarafa*) = “**he knew, he recognised**” — the plain *faʿala* shape, no weak letters, root ف-ر-ع. Its family:

- مَعْرِفَة (*maʿrifa*) — “**knowledge**,” the *ma-* shape.
- عُرْف (*ʿurf*) — “**custom**,” what is commonly known.
- الْعَرِيف (*al-ʿarīf*) — “**the one who knows**,” the expert or overseer. Spanish took the word in during the centuries of Arab rule and keeps it as **alarife**, “master builder.” The palace gardens above Granada, the **Generalife**, are usually read as جَنَّة الْعَرِيف (*jannat al-ʿarīf*), “the garden of the *ʿarīf*” — though scholars disagree about that second element, so treat it as the leading reading, not a settled one.

Arabic splits “know” in two. عَرَفَ is knowing a *person* or a *place* — recognising. Knowing a *fact* is a different verb, عَلِمَ (*ʿalima*). Spanish cuts the same way with *conocer* and *saber*, French with *connaître* and *savoir*; English collapses both into one word. That second root gives عَالِم (*ʿālim*), “a scholar,” whose plural عُلَمَاء (*ʿulamāʾ*) English borrowed as **ulema**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the dots — ف one dot, ق two dots, one body between them
- “*ʿarafa*” — he recognised — beside “*ʿalima*,” he knew a fact
- the loan — *al-ʿarīf*, Spanish *alarife*, the Generalife in Granada

Before you move on

What tells ف and ق apart? (**The dots** — one above for *f*, two for *q*.) Which of Arabic’s two “know” verbs is *ʿarafa*, and what languages make the same split? (**Recognising a person or place**, against *ʿalima* for a fact — as **Spanish** *conocer/saber* and **French** *connaître/savoir* do.) What Spanish word and what Granada palace

carry al-^ʿarīf? (**Alarife**, “master builder,” and the **Generalife**.)

30.2 أَكَلَ (akala) — “he ate,” and an honest word about cousins

The sixth and last verb of the set — and the one that needs no new letters at all, which is what a course built on words rather than alphabets eventually earns you.

You’ll want to know — The letters in this word

Nothing new. Every shape here has been taught already.

- ا — *alif* with **hamza** riding on top, the glottal catch, opening the word with a clean *a*.
- ك (kāf) — the angular *k*.
- ل (lām) — the tall hook.

Right to left: *a-ka-la*. Six chapters ago this word would have needed a lesson of its own just to be sounded out; now it reads itself.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

أَكَلَ (akala) = “**he ate**.” Root ا-ك-ل, and the plain *fa^ʿala* shape once more. Its family runs through the patterns already collected:

- أَكَلَ (akl) — “**eating**,” and so “**food**.”
- مَأْكُولَات (ma^ʾkūlāt) — “**foodstuffs**,” the **done-to** shape from *maqūl*, made plural: the things that get eaten.
- آكِل (ākīl) — “an **eater**,” the **doer** shape, where the root’s own *alif* and the pattern’s *alif* fuse into the long ī.

Now the honest part, because a false cousin is worse than none: **there is no English relative of this word**. Arabic and English are not related languages, and almost none of these six verbs has an English descendant — what English took from Arabic were nouns for goods and sciences, not everyday verbs. What *akala* does have is a **Semitic**

twin: Hebrew אָכַל (*akhal*), “he ate,” the same three consonants in the same order, with the Hebrew noun *okhel*, “food,” standing beside Arabic *akl* — the same family resemblance heard in *salām* and *shalom*, and in *yad* and *yad*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “akala” — he ate — then “akl,” food
- the two patterns — “ākil,” an eater; “maʿkūlāt,” foodstuffs
- the honest cousin — no English relative, but Hebrew “akhal”
- all six — dhahaba, jāʾa, qāla, raʾā, ʿarafa, akala

Before you move on

What two pattern-shapes give آكِل and مَأْكُولَات, and what do they mean? (**Doer** and **done-to** — “an eater” and “foodstuffs.”) Does *akala* have an English cousin? (**No** — Arabic and English are unrelated; claiming one would be inventing it.) What is its Semitic twin? (**Hebrew** אָכַל, *akhal*, “he ate.”)

Chapter 31

Understanding, Reading, Writing

Modes:  eyes (4)  Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Arabic for 'he understood', 'he read', 'he asked' and 'he wrote', and build a whole family of nouns off each root using the doer, done-to and ma- place shapes I already know.

Run ب-ت-ك through every pattern the track has taught — kitāb, kātib, maktūb, maktab, maktaba — naming the earlier word that wears each shape (qā'il and qāri' for the doer, maqūl and mafhūm and maqrū' for the done-to, madhhab and mas'ala for the ma- place), then place the root beside Hebrew katav and English ketubah.

31.1 فهم (fahima) — “he understood,” and the vowel that makes a state

Six verbs so far, every one of them a deed. This one is not: it happens inside a person — and Arabic marks that in the vowels.

The letters in this word

Nothing new in فهم itself: ف (*fā'*, one dot), ه (*hā'*) and م (*mīm*), with *fā'*'s two-dotted partner ق the pair sorted out in *ʿarafa*. That is twice running — أكل needed no new letters either.

One letter does need naming, because every word-family ahead reaches for it: و (*wāw*). You have read it unnamed inside قَوْل (*qawl*), “a saying.” It is a **non-joiner**, a small loop with a tail under the line, and it holds two jobs — the consonant *w*, and the long vowel *ū*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

فَهِمَ (*fahima*) = “**he understood.**” Root ف-ه-م.

Listen to the middle vowel. *Dhahaba*, *qāla*, *‘arafa* and *akala* all ran *a-a-a*, the فَعَلَ (*fa‘ala*) shape. *Fahima* runs *a-i-a*: فَعِلَ (*fa‘ila*), which Arabic keeps for **states** rather than deeds. Understanding is not performed; it arrives.

- فَهْمَ (*fahm*) — “**understanding**,” the bare thing.
- مَفْهُومَ (*mafhum*) — “**understood**,” the **done-to** shape of *mashkūr* and *maqūl*, its long *ū* riding that و. As a noun it is “**a concept**”: a thing that has been understood.

And the flat statement *akala* insisted on holds here too: ف-ه-م **has no English relative**. *Fathom* is Germanic; the resemblance is noise. No Hebrew twin worth the claim, either.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- two words needing no new letters — *akala*, then *fahima*
- the two shapes — *akala*, *a-a-a*; *fahima*, *a-i-a*
- “*fahima*,” he understood — then *fahm*, understanding; *mafhum*, a concept
- the dots once more — ف one, ق two, one body between them
- three roots, three ideas — *ma‘rifa*, knowledge; *fahm*, understanding; *akl*, food
- the honest line — no English cousin here, as with *akala*

Before you move on

Which vowel of *fahima* differs from *akala*, and what does it mark? (The middle *i* — فَعِلَ, a state rather than a deed.) What is مَفْهُومَ? (“**Understood**,” and so “**a concept**” — the done-to shape of *maqūl* and *mashkūr*.) Does *fahima* have an English cousin? (No — *fathom* is Germanic.) Which letter was named here, and where had

you read it? (ق, *wāw* — inside *qawl*.)

31.2 قرأ (*qaraʿa*) — “he recited,” and the word English spells Quran

One root in this chapter did give English a word — exactly one, and it is not the word for reading.

The letters in this word

ق (*qāf*, two dots) and ر (*rāʿ*) are yours. The third is ا, *hamza* on an *alif* seat, closing the word.

Hamza is the homeless consonant. It has a sound of its own — the catch in “uh-oh” — but usually no letter, so it borrows a **seat**, and which seat depends on the vowels around it:

- ا — hamza on l, as in قَرَأَ and in أَنْتَ.
- ؤ — hamza on و, the letter named last lesson.
- ئ — hamza on ي, which gives up its dots to carry it.
- ء — and where no seat suits, hamza alone on the line, closing جاءَ.

Four spellings, one consonant. The seat is bookkeeping; the hamza is the sound.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

قَرَأَ (*qaraʿa*) = “**he read**” — nearer the root’s heart, “**he recited aloud**.” Reading here is done with the voice. Root ق-ر-أ, plain *faʿala* shape.

- قَارِئ (*qārīʿ*) — “a **reader**,” the **doer** shape of *qāʿil*, hamza on its dotless *yāʿ* seat.
- مَقْرُوء (*maqrūʿ*) — “**read**,” the **done-to** shape of *mafḥūm*, long *ū* on the و, hamza left seatless at the end.
- قُرْآن (*qurʿān*) — “**the recitation**,” the thing recited. English writes it **Quran**, or **Koran**. Its long *ī* is the alif-and-hamza

fusion already met in أَكِل (ākil), “an eater.”

That single loan is the shape of the whole story. Arabic gave English *algebra*, *alcohol*, *coffee*, *sugar* and *admiral* — goods and sciences, nouns nearly every one. Out of أ-ر-ق travelled not “to read” but the name of a book. The nearer relative is Hebrew קָרָא (*qara*), “he read.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- hamza’s seats — إ on alif, و on wāw, ئ on dotless yāʾ, ء on nothing
- “qaraʾa,” he recited — then qārīʾ, a reader
- the done-to pair — mafhūm, a concept; maqrūʾ, read — both on wāw
- the borrowed word — qurʾān, “the recitation,” English Quran
- the fused alif — ākil, an eater; qurʾān

Before you move on

Which three seats can hamza take, and what happens to the yāʾ when it serves? (إ, و and ي — the yāʾ drops its dots: ئ.) Which English word descends from أ-ر-ق, and what does it mean in Arabic? (**Quran** — “**the recitation**.”) Which letter carries the long ū of مَقْرُوء (و.) Which earlier word shares the fused Ā? (أَكِل, ākil, “an eater.”)

31.3 سأل (saʾala) — “he asked,” and the Arabic word for answerable

Hamza sat at the end of the last word. Here it sits in the middle — and as the vowels shift around it, it changes seats without changing sound at all.

The letters in this word

Nothing new: س (*sīn*), ا (hamza on its *alif* seat) and ل (*lām*). Right to left, *sa-ʿa-la*.

What is worth doing is watching that seat move while the root holds still:

- سَأَلَ (*saʿala*) — the *a* keeps hamza on ا.
- سُؤَالَ (*suʿāl*) — the *u* pulls it onto و.
- سَائِلَ (*sāʿil*) — the *i* pulls it onto dotless ي.

One consonant, one root, three spellings — exactly the rule laid out with *qaraʿa*, now doing its work inside a single family.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

سَأَلَ (*saʿala*) = “**he asked**.” Root س-أ-ل, the plain *faʿala* shape.

- سُؤَالَ (*suʿāl*) — “**a question**.”
- سَائِلَ (*sāʿil*) — “an **asker**,” the doer shape that also gave *qārīʿ*, “a reader.”
- مَسْأَلَة (*masʿala*) — the *ma-* shape: “a **matter**, a **problem**” — a thing asked about.
- مَسْؤُولَ (*masʿūl*) — the **done-to** shape, literally “**asked-of**,” and so “**responsible**”; as a noun, “an **official**.” Arabic builds accountability out of being the one who gets questioned, which is a fair account of what accountability is.

The Hebrew twin is exact: שָׁאַל (*shaʿal*), “he asked” — Arabic *s* against Hebrew *sh*, the same swap heard between *salām* and *shalom*. Its passive participle is the name שָׂאֻל (*Shaʿul*), English **Saul**: “asked for.” From the Arabic root, English took nothing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the seat moving — *saʿala* on *alif*, *suʿāl* on *wāw*, *sāʿil* on dotless *yāʿ*

- “saʿala” — he asked — then suʿāl, a question
- the two doers — qāriʿ, a reader; sāʿil, an asker
- masʿala, a matter — masʿūl, asked-of, and so responsible
- the twins — Arabic saʿala, Hebrew shaʿal, and the name Saul

Before you move on

Which three seats does hamza take across *saʿala*, *suʿāl* and *sāʿil*? (**Alif, wāw, dotless yāʿ** — one consonant, three spellings.) What does مَسْئُول mean literally, and what does it mean in use? (“**Asked-of**” — and so **responsible**, or an official.) Which two words here wear the doer shape? (*Sāʿil*, an asker, and *qāriʿ*, a reader.) What does the name **Saul** mean? (“**Asked for**” — from Hebrew *shaʿal*, twin of سَأَلَ.)

31.4 كَتَبَ (kataba) — “he wrote,” and the root that furnishes a library

The chapter closes on the root every Arabic grammar reaches for first. Three letters — and you already own every pattern they need.

The letters in this word

ك (kāf), ت (tāʿ, two dots) and ب (bāʿ, one dot below) were taught long ago. New is how they sit together: **all three join**, so كَتَبَ is one unbroken run of pen — unlike ذَهَبَ, where *dhāl* refuses to connect, or أَكَلَ, where the *alif* stands off alone.

One old mark earns its keep too: put ّة (*tāʿ marbūṭa*) on مَكْتَبَ (*maktab*) and you get مَكْتَبَةٌ (*maktaba*). One letter, and an office becomes a library.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

كَتَبَ (*kataba*) = “**he wrote**.” Root ك-ت-ب, plain *faʿala* shape. Now pour it through the patterns this track has handed you:

- كِتَابَ (*kitāb*) — “a **book**.” A written thing.
- كَاتِبَ (*kātib*) — “a **writer**,” the **doer** shape of *qāʿil* and *qāriʿ*.

- مَكْتُوب (*maktūb*) — “**written**,” the **done-to** shape of *maqūl* and *mafḥūm* — and in speech, what has been written for you: **fate**.
- مَكْتَب (*maktab*) — the **ma- place** shape of *madhḥab* and *masjid*: the place of writing, a **desk**, an **office**.
- مَكْتَبَة (*maktaba*) — that place plus ة: a **library**.

Five words off one root, not one of them learned separately. That is the whole return on the root system, collected in one lesson.

No English word descends from ب-ت-ك. English does hold one from the same **Semitic** root, by way of Hebrew: a **ketubah**, the written Jewish marriage contract — כְּתוּבָה (*ketubbah*), “a written thing,” from כָּתַב (*katav*), “he wrote.” That is *maktūb*’s own pattern in the other language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- three joined letters — kāf, tāʔ, bāʔ — “kataba,” he wrote
- the doers — qāʔil, qāriʔ, kātib
- the done-to run — maqūl, mafḥūm, maqrūʔ, maktūb
- the ma- place shape — madhḥab, masʔala, maktab
- the letter that moves — maktab, an office; maktaba, a library
- the Semitic twin — Hebrew *katav*, English *ketubah*

Before you move on

Name five words built here from ب-ت-ك. (*Kitāb*, *kātib*, *maktūb*, *maktab*, *maktaba*.) Which pattern gives “office,” and which two earlier words wear it? (**The ma- place shape** — *madhḥab* and *masʔala*.) Which two earlier words share *kātib*’s doer shape? (*Qāʔil* and *qāriʔ*.) What single letter turns an office into a library? (ة.) Which English word comes from this root? (**None** — but **ketubah** comes from its Hebrew twin *katav*.)

Chapter 32

Taking, Thinking, Helping, Loving

Modes: 👁 eyes (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the Arabic for 'he took', 'he thought', 'he helped' and 'he loved', and tell a plain verb from a rebuilt one — doubled, stretched or prefixed — by what the shape does to the root's meaning.

*Say the chapter's four verbs against the four shapes they wear —
ʾakhadha plain, fakkara doubled, sāʿada stretched, ʾaḥabba prefixed —
then run the done-to shape across maktūb, maʾkhūdh and maḥbūb and
restate the ma- engine dhahaba opened.*

32.1 أخذ (ʾakhadha) — “he took,” and the last of the plain verbs

The last chapter changed the **vowels** inside a root. This one changes the **shape** of the verb itself — a doubled letter, a stretched vowel, a prefix. The verb here is the plain one, kept to measure the other three against.

The letters in this word

No new letters, and three worth re-reading:

- ا — hamza on its *alif* seat, opening the word as it opens اكل.
- خ (*khāʾ*) — the hook family's **one dot above**, the *ch* of Scottish “loch.”

- ذ (dhāl) — dāl with **one dot above**, the *th* of “this,” the letter that opened ذهب.

Right to left: *ʔa-kha-dha*. Note what the page does with it. كتب ran as one unbroken piece; أخذ cannot, because *alif* is a non-joiner. It breaks into أ and خذ — the two-piece shape of ذهب.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

أَخَذَ (*ʔakhadha*) = “**he took**.” Root أ-خ-ذ, the plain فَعَلَ shape — the last verb in this book to wear it unaltered.

- أَخَذَ (*akhadh*) — “**taking**.”
- آخَذَ (*ākhidh*) — “one **taking**,” the **doer** shape of *kātib*, where the root’s own *alif* and the pattern’s fuse into long Ā — the fusion seen in أَكَلَ (*ākil*), “an eater.”
- مَأْخُذٌ (*maʔkhūdh*) — “**taken**,” the **done-to** shape of *maktūb*.

Its Hebrew twin is אָחַז (*ʔahaz*), “he seized.” Two regular swaps carry you across: Arabic خ answers Hebrew א, and Arabic ذ answers Hebrew ז. Those are standing correspondences between the languages, not guesses about this pair. English took nothing from either.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the letters — hamza on alif, khāʔ, dhāl — “ʔakhadha,” he took
- the same opening — أَكَلَ, then أَخَذَ, hamza on its alif seat
- which words break — kataba into one piece, ʔakhadha and dhahaba into two
- the dot that makes dhāl — dāl, then dhāl, the *th* of “this”
- the fused alif — ākil, an eater; ākhidh, one taking
- the done-to pair — maktūb, written; maʔkhūdh, taken

Before you move on

Which letter keeps أخذ from running as one piece, and which Chapter 31 verb did run as one? (**The alif**, a non-joiner — against كتب.) What turns د into ذ? (**One dot above** — *d* becomes the *th* of “this.”) Which two words fuse their alifs into ĩ? (*Ākil* and *ākhidh.*) Which Hebrew consonants answer Arabic خ and ذ? (ן and ז — in תִּנֶּחֱזַק, *ʿahaz.*)

32.2 فَكَّرَ (fakkara) — “he thought,” and a root rebuilt by doubling

Every verb so far has been a bare root with vowels poured between its letters. Arabic can also **rebuild** a root, and the first way it does so is by doubling one letter.

The letters in this word

ف, ك and ر are all yours, and all three join, so فَكَّرَ runs as one piece.

The new thing is not a letter but a mark: َ (*shadda*), the little *w* riding the ك of فَكَّرَ. It says “**sound this consonant twice**” — *fak-ka-ra*, not *fa-ka-ra*. You met it among the ḥarakāt and on the tail of *shukran*; here it is load-bearing, because that doubling is the whole difference between one verb and another.

Everyday Arabic prints no *shadda*, as it prints no short vowels; the reader supplies it.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

فَكَرَ (*fakkara*) = “**he thought**, he pondered.” Root ف-ك-ر.

Doubling a root’s middle consonant is no irregularity. It is a pattern with a name and a job: فَعَّلَ (*fa^cala*), which grammarians number **Form II**, and it generally means doing the root **hard, repeatedly**, or **to something else**. *Fakkara* is thinking worked at, while the bare root holds the raw material:

- فَكَّرَ (*fikr*) — “**thought**,” thinking as such.
- فِكْرَةٌ (*fikra*) — “**an idea**,” one thought, closed by the same ّ that made a library out of an office.

- تَفَكَّرَ (*tafkār*) — “**thinking**,” the activity, on Form II’s own noun shape.
- مُفَكِّرٌ (*mufakkir*) — “**a thinker**.” Form II builds its doer with a مُ (*mu-*) prefix, not the long *ā* of *kātib*. A rebuilt verb gets a rebuilt doer.

No English cousin here, and no Hebrew twin worth the claim.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the doubling — fa-ka-ra, then fak-ka-ra, shadda on the kāf
- “fakkara,” he thought — then fkr, thought; fikra, an idea
- plain beside rebuilt — ʾakhadha, then fakkara
- the two doers — kātib, a writer; mufakkir, a thinker
- the done-to shape holding steady — maktūb, maʾkhūdh

Before you move on

What does the **shadda** instruct, and which letter carries it in فَكَّرَ? (**Double the consonant** — it rides the ك.) What is Form II, and what does it do to a root? (فَعَّلَ, middle letter **doubled** — the root done hard, repeatedly, or to something else.) How does Form II build its doer, against *kataba* and ʾakhadha? (مُفَكِّرٌ with **mu-**, against كَاتِب and آخَذَ with a long *ā*.)

32.3 سَاعَدَ (*sāʿada*) — “he helped,” from a root meaning good fortune

The second way Arabic rebuilds a root is gentler than doubling: it stretches a vowel. What comes out is a verb pointed at somebody else.

The letters in this word

Nothing new: س (*sīn*), ا (*alif*, here carrying long *ā*), ع (*ʿayn*) and د (*dāl*).

Two things are worth noticing. ساعد breaks in two — سا, then عد — because *alif* will not join forwards, the split that broke أخذ and ذهب while كتب ran whole. And ع sits **inside** a word here, joined on both sides, where in عرف it opened one: the *ʿayn* changes shape by position more than almost any letter, while its throat-tightening sound never changes.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

سَاعَدَ (*sāʿada*) = “**he helped**.” Root س-ع-د — which on its own does not mean helping at all. It means **good fortune**:

- سَعِيد (*saʿīd*) — “**happy**, fortunate,” also the name **Saeed**.
- سَعَادَة (*saʿāda*) — “**happiness**.”

Stretch the vowel after the first root letter — فَاعَلَ (*fāʿala*), **Form III** — and the verb turns outward: doing the root **with** or **toward** another person. *Sāʿada* is bringing your good fortune to bear on somebody. That is Arabic’s account of helping.

- مُسَاعَدَة (*musāʿada*) — “**help**, assistance.”
- مُسَاعِد (*musāʿid*) — “**an assistant**,” on the same مُ doer prefix that gave *mufakkir*.

English carries one name from this root: the ruling family آل سُعود (*Āl Saʿūd*) is what is said in **Saudi** Arabia — a family name, not a borrowed verb. Hebrew’s טַוֵּן (*saʿad*), “to sustain,” is the twin; a מִסְעָדָה (*misʿada*) is a restaurant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pieces — سا, then عد — “sāʿada,” he helped
- which break — ʾakhadha and sāʿada in two, kataba in one
- the *ʿayn* opening ʿarafa, then joined inside sāʿada
- the root before the help — saʿīd, happy; saʿāda, happiness

- doubled against stretched — fakkara’s shadda, sā^cada’s long ā
- the two mu- doers — mufakkir, a thinker; musā^cid, an assistant

Before you move on

What does Form III do to a root, and to its meaning? (**Stretches the vowel after the first letter** — فاعَلَ — and aims the action **at somebody else**.) What does د-ع-س mean before it means helping? (**Good fortune** — sa^cid, “happy.”) Which mark makes fakkara Form II, and does sā^cada carry one? (**The shadda** on the ك — and **no**.) Which English place-name carries this root? (**Saudi** Arabia, from آل سُعود.)

32.4 أَحَبَّ (ʾaḥabba) — “he loved,” and the four shapes together

The last verb of the chapter, and the last of its four shapes: plain, doubled, stretched — and now prefixed.

The letters in this word

Three letter-shapes for four consonants. ا (hamza on its *alif* seat), ح (ḥā^ʔ, the hook family’s undotted member, a hard breath from deep in the throat) and ب (bā^ʔ) — with the **shadda** on that final ب doubling it: أَحَبَّ is ʾa-ḥab-ba.

The mark is the one that rode the ك of فَكَّرَ, doing a different job: there it built a new verb, here it only spells a root whose last two letters are the same.

On the page the word breaks after the *alif* — أ, then حَبَّ — the two-piece split of ساعد and أخذ once again.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

أَحَبَّ (ʾaḥabba) = “**he loved**,” and more mildly “he liked.” Root ح-ب-ح. The ا on the front is **Form IV**, أَفْعَلَ (ʾafʿala): the prefix that makes a root **bring about** its own idea. Love, on this account, is something a person causes.

- حُبَّ (ḥubb) — “love.”

- حَبِيب (ḥabīb) — “**beloved**,” feminine حَبِيبَة (ḥabība); add the “my” ending of اسمي (ismī) and it is حَبِيبِي (ḥabībī), “my beloved.”
- مَحْبُوب (maḥbūb) — “**beloved, well-liked**,” the **done-to** shape of maktūb and maʾkhūdh.

Hebrew’s ordinary verb for loving, אָהַב (ahav), is **not** a relative. The real twin is חָבִיב (ḥaviv), “dear,” which is ḥabīb exactly. No English word descends from ח-ב-ב: ḥabībī travels through music, not dictionaries.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the chapter’s four — ʾakhadha, fakkara, sāʿada, ʾaḥabba
- the four shapes — plain, doubled, stretched, ʾa- prefix
- “ʾaḥabba,” he loved — then ḥubb, love; ḥabīb, beloved
- the pieces — أ alone, then حَبَّ, as ساعد split into سا and عد
- the done-to run — maktūb, maʾkhūdh, maḥbūb
- the ma- place shape from the first verb lesson — madhhab, maktab
- the rebuilt doers — mufakkir; musāʿid

Before you move on

Name this chapter’s four verbs and the shape each wears.
 (ʾAkhadha plain, fakkara doubled, sāʿada stretched, ʾaḥabba prefixed — Forms I to IV.) What does Form IV’s أ do? (**Makes the root bring about its own idea.**) Why does حَبَّ carry a shadda, and is it fakkara’s reason? (**Because the root’s last two letters are both ب — not a Form II doubling.**) Which Hebrew word is ḥabīb, and which root first showed you the ma- shapes? (חָבִיב — while ahav is no relation — and ב-ה-ז, in madhhab.)

Chapter 33

Asking for a Drink

Modes: 👁 eyes (5) 🖱 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name tea, milk, sugar and coffee in Arabic and ask for any of them politely, and I can tell at sight whether an Arabic noun is feminine.

Say the chapter's drinks and name which of them Arabic built and which it borrowed — ḥalīb from ḥalaba, 'he milked', against shāy and sukkar, which arrived with no root at all — then read the ʾ off qahwa as a gender marker, place it beside maktaba and as-salāma, and order each drink with min fadlik, answering ʿafwan.

33.1 شاي (shāy) — “tea,” and a word with no root

Every Arabic word you have taken apart so far had a root under it. This one does not — and that absence is the lesson.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ش (shīn) has been on the page since شكرًا (shukran): the sīn skeleton with three dots above it. Then ا (alif), the non-joiner, and ي (yāʾ).

So شاي breaks where alif forces it to break: شا, then ي. That is the same two-piece split you met in أحبّ — ا standing alone, then حبّ.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

شاي (shāy) = “tea.”

Now the honest part. Take كتب (kataba): its root pours into كتاب

(*kitāb*, a book), كَاتِب (*kātib*, a writer), مَكْتَب (*maktab*, an office) and مَكْتَبَة (*maktaba*, a library). Try that with *shāy* and nothing comes out. There is no shape it fills, no doer, no place, no done-to. That is because **shāy is borrowed**, and a borrowed word arrives without a root. Arabic took it through Persian چای (*chāy*), which took it from the **northern Chinese chá**. Your own language took the same Chinese word by the other road. Traders on the southern coast of China said it *tê*, Dutch ships carried that form to Europe, and it became English **tea**, French **thé**, German **Tee**. Overland through Persia it stayed *chá*: Russian **chay**, Turkish **çay**, Arabic **shāy**. So *shāy* and *tea* are not merely similar. They are the two ends of one word, separated by which way it left China.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- shīn, alif, yāʾ — “shāy,” tea
- where it breaks — shā, then yāʾ, as أَحَبَّ broke after the alif
- what a root gives — kitāb, kātib, maktab, maktaba
- what shāy gives — nothing, because it was borrowed
- the overland road — Chinese chá, Persian chāy, Arabic shāy
- the sea road — Hokkien tê, Dutch, English tea

Before you move on

Why can you not build a word family from شاي? (**It has no Arabic root** — it was borrowed, and borrowed words arrive without one.) Name what ب-ت-ك builds, for contrast. (***Kitāb*, *kātib*, *maktab*, *maktaba***.) Which language handed *shāy* to Arabic, and which language did that one take it from? (**Persian**, from **Chinese**.) Is English *tea* a relative? (**Yes** — the same Chinese word, carried by sea rather than overland.)

33.2 حليب (ḥalīb) — “milk,” and the verb underneath it

Yesterday’s word had no root to stand on. This one has a root so plain you can hear the verb inside the noun.

The letters in this word

Nothing new again. ح (ḥāʾ) is the undotted member of the hook-and-tail family — the body it shares with خ (khāʾ, one dot above) and ح (jīm, one dot below). It is the hard breath from deep in the throat that opens أَحَبَّ (ʾaḥabba).

Then ل (lām), ي (yāʾ) carrying the long ī, and ب (bāʾ).

All four join, so حليب runs as one unbroken stroke — the opposite of شاي, which had to stop at its *alif*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

حليب (ḥalīb) = “milk.” Root ح-ل-ب, and its verb is حَلَبَ (ḥalaba), “he milked.” So the noun is simply the milked thing.

You have met this exact transparency before. خبز (khubz, bread) sits on ز-ب-خ, “to bake”: the baked thing. Arabic does this constantly — name the action, and the everyday noun falls out of it.

The pattern ḥalīb wears, فَعِيل (faʿīl), is one to keep. It takes a root and hands back a quality or a result you can hold.

Hebrew has the word unchanged: חָלַב (ḥalav), “milk,” the same root doing the same job — the family resemblance already heard in *salām* and *shalom*.

One caution, because a good story is not the same as a true one. The Syrian city حَلَب (Ḥalab, English **Aleppo**) is often explained as a milk name. It is not: Ḥalab appears in Bronze Age records centuries before Arabic was written, so the milk account is a later invention hung on a name that already existed. No English word descends from ح-ل-ب at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the hook family — ḥāʾ no dot, khāʾ one above, jīm one below

- ḥāʾ, lām, yāʾ, bāʾ — “ḥalīb,” milk
- the verb under it — “ḥalaba,” he milked
- the same move in bread — khubz, from kh-b-z, to bake
- the pattern — faʿīl, as in ḥalīb
- the borrowed one against the built one — shāy, then ḥalīb
- the Hebrew twin — ḥalav

Before you move on

What does the root ح-ل-ب mean as a verb? (**To milk** — so *ḥalīb* is the milked thing.) Which earlier word works the same way? (**Khubz** — bread, from *kh-b-z*, to bake.) Which of the chapter’s words so far has no root at all? (**Shāy** — it was borrowed.) Is Aleppo named for milk? (**No** — the name is far older than Arabic; that story is folk etymology.)

33.3 سكر (sukkar) — “sugar,” and an Arabic article stuck to a Spanish word

Another traveller — and this one left a piece of Arabic grammar behind in Spain.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. س (*sīn*), the low comb; ك (*kāf*), the angular *k*; and ر (*rā*), the little downward curve that **breaks** — a non-joiner, like *alif*. So سكر joins from *sīn* to *kāf*, and *rā* hangs off the end.

Written fully it is سُكَّر, and the mark over the ك is the **shadda**. You have seen it do two jobs. On فَكَّر (*fakkara*) it built a new verb out of an old root. Here it does the quieter job it did on أَحَبَّ: it spells a letter the word already owns twice over — *suk-kar*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

سُكَّر (*sukkar*) = “**sugar**.” Like *shāy*, and unlike *ḥalīb*, it is **borrowed**: no Arabic root, no family of shapes. Its road west starts in **Sanskrit**, where *śarkarā* meant “grit, gravel”

— sugar named for its coarse grains. **Persian** took it as *shakar*, Arabic as *sukkar*, and Arabic carried it into medieval **Latin** as *succarum*. From there: Italian **zucchero**, French **sucre**, German **Zucker**, English **sugar**.

Then **Spanish**, which shows what the others hide. Spanish for sugar is **azúcar** — and that opening *a-z-* is Arabic’s own ﺍﻝ (*al-*), the article, welded onto the front of the noun. Spanish borrowed **al-sukkar** whole and never took it apart.

You know why the *l* vanished: س is a **sun letter**, so *al-* + *sukkar* is said **as-sukkar**, as *al-* + *salām* is said **as-salām**. Spanish kept the sound, not the spelling. English holds *algebra* and *alcohol*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- sīn, kāf, rā — and rā breaks, so nothing joins after it
- “sukkar,” sugar — the shadda doubling the kāf, suk-kar
- the shadda’s two jobs — fakkara built a verb, ʾaḥabba spelled one
- the road — Sanskrit śarkarā, Persian shakar, Arabic sukkar
- the article that stayed — as-sukkar, Spanish azúcar
- the sun letter — al- plus salām said as-salām
- borrowed, borrowed, built — shāy, sukkar, ḥalīb
- the letters before it — shīm, alif, yāʾ; then ḥāʾ, lām, yāʾ, bāʾ

Before you move on

Which letter in سكر refuses to join what follows? (**Rā**.) What is the shadda doing here, and which earlier verb used it the same way? (**Only spelling a doubled letter** — as in ʾaḥabba, not as in fakkara.) What language did *sukkar* come from before Persian? (**Sanskrit** — śarkarā, “grit.”) What is hiding at the front of Spanish **azúcar**? (**Arabic al-**, said *as-* before a sun letter.)

33.4 قهوة (qahwa) — “coffee,” the tied tāʾ, and asking for all of it

The chapter closes on a word your own language already borrowed — and on the small letter at its end that tells you the word is feminine.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ق (qāf, two dots above), the *k* made far back in the throat; ه (hāʾ), the loop that changes shape wherever it stands; و (wāw), a non-joiner like *rā*; and then ۀ.

ۀ is the tāʾ **marbūṭa**, the “tied tāʾ” — an ه with tāʾ’s two dots on it. It appears only at the end of a word.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

قهوة (qahwa) = “coffee.”

Here is what the ۀ buys you. Arabic nouns carry **gender**, and Arabic usually **shows** you which is which: a noun ending in ۀ is almost always **feminine**. That is a rule you apply on sight, not a list to memorise. You have watched it work already:

- مَكْتَب (maktab), an office, becomes مَكْتَبَة (maktaba), a library.
- سَلَام (salām), peace, becomes السَّلَامَة (as-salāma), the safety — the root م-ل-س wearing an ending and a pattern.

So *qahwa* is feminine, while *shāy*, *ḥalīb* and *sukkar* are masculine — and the ending alone told you.

The road out of Arabic is short and well lit. Ottoman **Turkish** took *qahwa* as **kahve**; Venetian traders took *kahve* as Italian **caffè**; from Italian came French **café**, German **Kaffee** and English **coffee**. The English word in your mouth is this Arabic one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- qāf, hāʾ, wāw, tāʾ marbūṭa — “qahwa,” coffee
- the tied tāʾ — an hāʾ wearing tāʾ’s two dots, only at a word’s end

- what it marks — feminine; maktab becomes maktaba, salām becomes as-salāma
- gendered — qahwa feminine; shāy, ḥalīb, sukkar masculine
- order each — “shāy, min faḍlik”; “qahwa, min faḍlik”; “ḥalīb, min faḍlik”; “sukkar, min faḍlik”
- the answer to thanks — “ʿafwan,” think nothing of it
- ḥalīb joined throughout, sukkar’s rā broke, and the wāw breaks here
- built against borrowed — ḥalaba gave ḥalīb; shāy and sukkar gave nothing

Before you move on

Which of this chapter’s words is feminine, and how can you tell? (*Qahwa* — **it ends in ʾ.**) Name two earlier words with that ending. (*Maktaba* and *as-salāma*.) Ask for each drink politely. (*Shāy, qahwa, ḥalīb, sukkar* — each with *min faḍlik*, “from your grace.”) What do you answer when someone thanks you? (*ʿAfwan*.) Which word here was built from a verb? (*Ḥalīb*, from *ḥalaba* — the others travelled in.)

33.5 The courtesies, doing real work

Order tea politely, accept when it is offered, and thank them. Three words you have met and one you met in this chapter. No reading first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- tea, please — *shāy, min faḍlik*
- coffee with milk and sugar, please — *qahwa maʿa ḥalīb wa-sukkar, min faḍlik*
- accept — *naʿam*
- thank them, and hear the reply — *shukran ... ʿafwan*

- a man apologises, then a woman — *āsif ... āsifa*

The courtesy kit was four separate single-word lessons long ago. This is the first time it has had to carry a real transaction.

How to answer: the reply that erases the debt

Say شكرًا and what comes back is عفوا — *it is nothing*, from a root about forgiving and waiving. English accepts thanks; Arabic **waves them away**. The exchange has two halves and you now own both.

آسف is a **gendered adjective**, so it changes with the speaker. When you want a quick, ungendered *excuse me* — squeezing past somebody in a café — the word is معذرة *ma^cdhira*.

You'll want to know: the invisible bend

من فضلك changes with whom you address and the page does not show it: only the unwritten short vowel moves, *faḍlak* to a man and *faḍlik* to a woman.

كم عمرک؟ hides the same suffix, and hides a verb too — literally **how much is your lifetime**. Arabic neither *has* its years nor *is* them; it owns them, as a noun, with nothing in between.

Script: shapes inside the words above

Write these out:

- شكرًا — *shīn* with its three dots, then *kāf*, *rā*², *alif*
- شاي — the same *shīn*, then *alif*, then *yā*²

ش is س carrying three dots, and ك is *kāf*. Both words start with the same letter, and in both the letter keeps its skeleton while the connectors at its edges change to suit its neighbours.

Before you move on

Give the reply to thanks and its literal force. (عفوا — it is nothing.)
Say what a woman says for *sorry*. (آسفة.) Say why من فضلك looks identical for both genders. (**Only the unwritten vowel moves.**)
And say what stays constant when a letter joins its neighbours. (**Its skeleton.**)

Chapter 34

Asking for Food

Modes:  eyes (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for salt, meat, cheese and food in Arabic, and I can build the word for a restaurant myself out of a root and the ma- place shape.

Name ط as the emphatic partner of ت beside ص under س and ض under د, then pour ط-ع-م through the ma- place shape that already gave maktab and madhhab to generate maṭʿam, ‘a restaurant’, and ask for the chapter’s foods with min faḍlik.

34.1 ملح (milḥ) — “salt,” and the sailor hiding in it

A word for something you can hold in one hand — whose root stretches from a mineral to the open sea to a compliment.

The letters in this word

Nothing new, but one shape is worth a second look. م (*mām*), ل (*lām*), ح (*ḥāʾ*) — all three join, so ملح is one run of pen.

The ح is the hook-and-tail letter that opened حليب (*ḥalīb*), but at the **end** of a word it grows its full tail and swings below the line: open at the start of *ḥalīb*, closed and tailed at the end of *milḥ*.

قهوة made the same point at the other end of a word: ّ exists only in final position.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

مِلْح (*milḥ*) = “salt.” Root م-ل-ح, and this is a root that has gone travelling inside its own language:

- مَلَّاح (*mallāḥ*) — “a sailor.” The man of the salt water. It wears the doubled *lām* shape Arabic keeps for trades and habits.
- مَلِيح (*malīḥ*) — “handsome, pleasant.” Salty, said of a person. Arabic reached for the same idea English reaches for when it calls a person *the salt of the earth*.

Note *malīḥ*’s shape: فَعِيل (*faʿīl*), the same pattern that gave you حَلِيب (*ḥalīb*). A root plus that pattern hands back a quality. Hebrew has מֶלַח (*melaḥ*), “salt,” unchanged — one more Semitic twin. English is **not** in this family: *salt* comes down from Latin *sāl* and its Germanic cousins. And unlike *sukkar*, nothing here was borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- mīm, lām, ḥāʾ — “milḥ,” salt
- ḥāʾ in two places — opening ḥalīb, closing milḥ with its tail
- the root’s reach — mallāḥ, a sailor; malīḥ, handsome
- the faʿīl pattern twice — ḥalīb, malīḥ
- the Hebrew twin — melaḥ; and no English relative, only Latin *sāl*
- the borrowed one for contrast — *sukkar*, from Sanskrit by way of Persian
- the letters just behind — sīn, kāf, rā; qāf, hāʾ, wāw, tāʾ marbūʿa

Before you move on

What else does م-ل-ح give besides salt? (*Mallāḥ*, a sailor, and *malīḥ*, handsome.) Which pattern do *malīḥ* and *ḥalīb* share? (*Faʿīl*.) Why does the ح of *milḥ* not look like the ح of *ḥalīb*? (**It is at the end of the word**, so it takes its full tailed shape.) Does

English *salt* belong to this family? (**No** — it descends from Latin *sāl*.)

34.2 لحم (*laḥm*) — “meat,” and the town on the seam

This word and its Hebrew twin are the same root — and they mean different foods. There is a town whose name proves it.

The letters in this word

Nothing new, and something pleasing: لحم is ملح read the other way about. The same shapes — ل (*lām*), ح (*ḥāʾ*), م (*mām*) — in a different order, and so a different root and a different word.

That is the root system stated as plainly as it can be. The letters are not the word. The **order** is the word.

Here ḥāʾ sits in the **middle**, so it wears its joined-both-sides shape: neither ḥalīb’s open opening nor milḥ’s tailed ending.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

لَحْم (*laḥm*) = “**meat**.” Root ل-ح-م.

Now the twin, and it is the best one in this book. Hebrew’s לֶחֶם (*leḥem*) is the same root — and it means **bread**.

Neither language changed the meaning. The old Semitic root named **the staple food**, and each people filled it with whatever theirs was: meat where herds mattered, bread where grain did.

English already owns the proof. The town is لحم بيت (*Bayt Laḥm*) in Arabic and לֶחֶם בֵּית (*Bēt Leḥem*) in Hebrew — one name, in which *bayt* and *bēt* both mean “a house of.” English calls it **Bethlehem**: house of bread on one side of the seam, house of meat on the other.

And notice what Arabic did **not** do. It had this root available for bread and did not use it. Arabic’s bread is خُبْز (*khubz*), built on ز-ب-خ, “to bake” — the baked thing, as ḥalīb is the milked thing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- lām, ḥāʾ, mīm — “laḥm,” meat
- the same shapes reordered — mīm, lām, ḥāʾ is “milḥ,” salt
- ḥāʾ in the middle, joined on both sides
- the twin that shifted — laḥm is meat, Hebrew leḥem is bread
- the town on the seam — Bayt Laḥm, Bēt Leḥem, Bethlehem
- Arabic’s own bread — khubz, from kh-b-z, to bake
- the salt root’s reach — mallāḥ, malīḥ
- qahwa’s letters and its feminine ending — qāf, hāʾ, wāw, tāʾ marbūṭa

Before you move on

What separates لحم from ملح? (**Only the order of the letters** — the whole root system.) What does Hebrew *leḥem* mean, and why is that no contradiction? (**Bread** — the root named the **staple food**.) Which English place name carries both? (**Bethlehem**.) What is Arabic’s own word for bread, and where from? (**Khubz**, from ز-ب-خ, “to bake.”)

34.3 جبن (jubn) — “cheese,” and where the root system stops

The root system has been paying you back for chapters. This word is where it politely declines to.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ج (*jīm*) is the third of the hook-and-tail family: the body of ح (*ḥāʾ*) and خ (*khāʾ*), marked by one dot **below**. Then ب (*bāʾ*), one dot below, and ن (*nūn*), one dot above.

Dots are the whole difference here, as they were between the ḥāʾ of لحم and the khāʾ of خبز.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

جُبْن (*jubn*) = “**cheese**.” In everyday speech you will more often hear جُبْنَة (*jibna*) — and that ending is the ة you now recognise on sight, doing its usual work.

Now the honest part, because you have been taught to trust roots and this is where that trust needs a limit.

جُبْن also means “**cowardice**,” and جَبَان (*jabān*) is “**a coward**.” Same letters, same order. So is a cheese a coward?

No. Arabic’s dictionaries list these as **separate entries** — words spelled alike, not one idea branching. Compare a real root: ح-ل-م carries salt into *mallāḥ*, the sailor of salt water, and into *malīḥ*, a salty compliment. You can feel the thread. Between cheese and cowardice there is none, and inventing one would be the mistake the milk story made of Aleppo.

Two words can share three letters by accident. Arabic has many roots and few letters.

English took none of this: **cheese** comes from Latin **cāseus**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- jīm, bā³, nūn — “jubn,” cheese
- the hook family by dots — ḥā³ none, khā³ one above, jīm one below
- the everyday form — jibna, with the tied tā³
- the accident — jubn is also cowardice, jabān a coward
- the verdict — separate words, not one root branching
- a real branching — milḥ, mallāḥ, malīḥ
- meat and salt — laḥm, milḥ, the same shapes reordered

Before you move on

What separates ج from ح and خ? (**One dot below**.) What else do the letters of *jubn* spell? (**Cowardice** — *jabān* is a coward.) Are cheese and cowardice one root? (**No** — separate words that look

alike.) Name a root that really does branch. (م-ل-ح — *milh*, *mallāh*, *malīh*.) What does the ending on *jibna* tell you? (**Feminine**, as *qahwa* is.)

34.4 طَعَام (ṭaʿām) — “food,” and a restaurant you can build yourself

A new root, a new letter — and a word you will not have to be taught, because you already own the shape it comes in.

The letters in this word

One letter to name at last. ط is ṭāʾ, the **emphatic** partner of ت (tāʾ): the same *t*, said with the tongue flat, so the syllable goes dark around it.

Arabic keeps a small set of emphatic pairs, and you have met the others without being told they were a set:

- ص (ṣād) is the emphatic س (sīn) — the ص of صباح (*ṣabāḥ*).
- ض (ḍād) is the emphatic د (dāl) — the ض of من فضلك (*min faḍlik*).
- ط (ṭāʾ) is the emphatic ت (tāʾ) — this one.

Then ع (*ʿayn*), the throat sound already named, ا (*alif*) and م (*mīm*). Ṭāʾ joins; *alif* does not, so طَعَام runs طعا, then م.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

طَعَام (ṭaʿām) = “**food**.” Root ط-ع-م, whose verb طَعِمَ (ṭaʿima) means “**he tasted**,” and whose bare noun طَعْم (ṭaʿm) is “**taste, flavour**.”

So Arabic has two ways to speak of eating. أَكَلَ (*akala*) is the plain act — he ate. ط-ع-م goes through the tongue: tasting, and so the food that gets tasted.

Now take the م **place shape** you own. It made مَكْتَب (maktab), the place of writing, from ب-ت-ك, and مَذْهَب (madhhab) from ب-ه-ذ. Put ط-ع-م through it:

مَطْعَم (maṭʿam) — the place of eating. **A restaurant.**

Nobody taught you that word. The pattern did.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ṭāʾ, ʿayn, alif, mīm — “ṭaʿām,” food
- the emphatic set — ṣād under sīn, ḍād under dāl, ṭāʾ under tāʾ
- where you had them — ṣabāḥ, min faḍlik, now ṭaʿām
- the verb and the bare noun — ṭaʿima, he tasted; ṭaʿm, taste
- two ways to eat — akala the act, ṭaʿima the tasting
- the ma- place shape — madhhab, maktab, so maṭʿam, a restaurant
- the chapter’s foods — milḥ, laḥm reversing its letters, jubn, ṭaʿām
- order them — “laḥm, min faḍlik”; “jubn, min faḍlik”
- and the odd old one — māʾ, water, whose plural miyāh keeps no pattern

Before you move on

Which plain letter is ط the emphatic partner of, and name the other pairs. (ت — with ص under س and ض under د.) What does ط-ع-م mean as a verb? (**To taste.**) Build “restaurant” from it, and name the earlier words in that shape. (**Maṭʿam** — like **maktab** and **madhhab**.) Ask for the chapter’s foods politely. (**Milḥ, laḥm, jubn, ṭaʿām** — each with **min faḍlik**, “from your grace.”) Which everyday word keeps no pattern at all? (**Māʾ** — its plural **miyāh** is irregular.)

34.5 Pardon, and until tomorrow

Say *see you tomorrow* and *good night* in Arabic. Each was taught in a single lesson and neither has come back. Then say what the second one literally wishes you.

You'll want to know: one word, several jobs

عفوا *ʿafwan* answers *shukran* as **you are welcome**. But the same word, on a different tone, does duty as **excuse me** and as **pardon** — somebody stepping past you in a corridor says it, and so does somebody who did not quite hear you.

One word, three jobs, and the root explains all three: **ʿ-f-w** is about **erasing**. Whatever was owed or intruded upon is wiped off.

You'll want to know: until tomorrow

إلى الغد *ilā l-ghad* is the farewell pattern you already own with a new word in the slot: إلى (*until*) — the very same *ilā* as in *ilā l-liqāʿ*⁹ — plus الغد, tomorrow.

The root **gh-d-w** means **to set out at dawn**. Arabic's *tomorrow* therefore grows out of *early morning*: the next day is named after the hour you start it.

Why it's said this way

تصبح خير *tuṣbiḥ ʿalā khayr* is the everyday **good night** — and it wishes you nothing whatever about the night.

Literally it is **may you wake up into goodness**. English, French, German and Spanish all wish the sleeper a peaceful *night*; Arabic looks straight past it to the morning on the other side. *Tuṣbiḥ* carries the same root as the morning greeting, and خير is the goodness you already answer *how are you* with.

So the two halves of the phrase are borrowed from two things you met long before bedtime came up at all.

Script: the throat letter and the loop

Write these out:

- ع — the open-mouth curve, then the bowl beneath it
- عفوا, then على — the same letter opening both

ع *ʿayn* is a curve above a bowl, and it heads a **third** dots-family, with غ *ghayn* as its dotted partner. It sits at the front of two of the three phrases on this page.

هـ $hā^ʔ$ is the shape-shifter: one loop, no dots, four different coats by position. Its dotted relative ڤ is the tied $tā^ʔ$ that closes feminine words.

Before you move on

Name two jobs عفا does besides *you are welcome*. (**Excuse me and pardon.**) Give the literal sense of the root behind *tomorrow*. (**To set out at dawn.**) Say what خير على تصبح actually wishes. (**That you wake into goodness** — the morning, not the night.) And name ع's dotted partner. (غ.)

Chapter 35

The People You Introduce

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name and introduce a neighbour, a son, a daughter and a friend in Arabic, and say what single letter genders a pair of them.

Take *ṣadīq* back to ص-د-ص, ‘to be truthful’, and run the family *ṣidq*, *ṣādīq*, *ṣadaqa* and *aṣḍiqāʾ*, naming the faʿīl pattern it shares with *ḥalīb* and *malīḥ* and the doer shape it shares with *qāʾil* and *kātib*, then line up the people already owned — *ab*, *umm*, *akh*, *ukht* — against *jārī*, *ibn*, *bint* and *ṣadīqī*.

35.1 جَار (jār) — “neighbour,” and a root with a letter in hiding

After a chapter of things you order, a chapter of people you introduce — starting with the one who lives next door.

The letters in this word

Nothing new, and it is short: ج (*jīm*, the hook-and-tail body with one dot below), ا (*alif*) and ر (*rā*). Both ا and ر are non-joiners, so جَار barely joins at all — compare طَعَام, which broke once before its *mīm*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

جَار (*jār*) = “a neighbour.” Add the “my” ending of اِسْمِي (*ismī*) and you have جَارِي (*jārī*), “my neighbour” — which is how the word

usually arrives in a conversation.

Now listen to the root. You can hear only *j* and *r*. But an Arabic root wants three consonants, and the missing one is in hiding: the root is ج-و-ر, and its و has collapsed into that long *l*.

You have watched this before. قال (*qāla*), “he said,” is ل-و-ق with the same disappearing و. Arabic calls these **hollow** roots, and the hidden letter comes back when the word changes shape:

- جَاوَرَ (*jāwara*) — “he lived alongside.” There is the و, in the open.
- جِيرَان (*jīrān*) — “**neighbours**,” where it returns as a long *ī*.

Hebrew’s גֵּר (*ger*), a resident outsider living among a people, comes from the same Semitic root for dwelling alongside.

English **neighbour** is no relative — it is Germanic, the *nigh-dweller*. Two unrelated languages built one word out of one idea, worth noticing **because** it is not descent.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- jīm, alif, rā — “jār,” a neighbour
- with the my ending — “jārī,” my neighbour, as ismī is my name
- the hidden letter — the root is j-w-r, and the wāw is inside the alif
- the same hiding place — qāla, he said, from q-w-l
- where it comes back — jāwara; jīrān, neighbours
- the hook family by dots — ḥāʾ, khāʾ, jīm
- the restaurant you built — maṭʿam, the place of eating
- the honest non-cousin — English neighbour, the nigh-dweller

Before you move on

What is جار’s third root letter, and where has it gone? (و — collapsed into the long *alif*, as in *qāla* from ل-و-ق.) Where does it resurface? (**In *jāwara* and *jīrān*.**) How do you say “my

neighbour”? (*Jārī* — the ending of *ismī*.) Is English *neighbour* related? (**No** — Germanic, the *nigh-dweller*.)

35.2 ابن, بنت (ibn, bint) — son and daughter, one letter apart

A pair you can learn in one move, because Arabic has already shown you the move it uses.

The letters in this word

Nothing new in either. ابن is ا (alif), ب (bā², one dot below) and ن (nūn, one dot above) — two letters that share a bowl and differ only by where the dot sits.

بنت is the same ب and ن, then ت (tā², two dots above) on the end. Both words join throughout, unlike جار, which stopped twice.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

ابن (*ibn*) = “a son.” بنت (*bint*) = “a daughter.”

What separates them is one ت, and nothing else.

You have met that letter doing that job. أخ (*akh*) is a brother; أخت (*ukht*) is a sister. Same word, one ت added for the feminine. Arabic does not build a separate word for the woman; it marks the word it has. (This is the bare cousin of the ð that marks *qahwa* feminine — same letter, tied instead of open.)

On the root, tradition and comparison disagree. Arab grammarians file ابن under ب-ن-ي, “to build” — a son as what a house is built of, which is a lovely idea. Comparative scholars are less sure: Hebrew בן (*ben*) and בַּת (*bat*) show the same bare shape, more like a very old primitive word than something derived from a verb. Hold it loosely. Hebrew *bat* is *bint* with the **n** swallowed into the **t**. And *ibn* stands in plain sight inside names English carries: **Ibn Sīnā**, the physician the Latin west called Avicenna. No English **word** descends from it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alif, bā^ʔ, nūn — “ibn,” a son
- bā^ʔ, nūn, tā^ʔ — “bint,” a daughter
- the dots that separate bā^ʔ and nūn — one below, one above
- the move you already knew — akh, then ukht
- and the parents beside them — ab, a father; umm, a mother
- the loosely held root — b-n-y, to build, as the grammarians have it
- the Hebrew pair — ben, bat
- the neighbour, and the emphatic ṭā^ʔ of ṭa^cām — jāri; ṭa^cām, maṭ^cam

Before you move on

What is the only difference between ابن and بنت? (**An** added ت — as with *akh* and *ukht*.) And the parents? (**Ab** and *umm*.) What root do grammarians give *ibn*, and why hold it loosely? (ي-ن-ب, “to build” — but Hebrew *ben* and *bat* suggest an older bare word.) Where does *ibn* appear in a name English knows? (*Ibn Sīnā*, Avicenna.)

35.3 صديق (ṣadīq) — “friend,” the one who is true to you

The chapter closes on a word whose root is not about company at all. It is about telling the truth.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ص (*ṣād*) is the emphatic س, first met in صباح (*ṣabāḥ*) — heavy and dark where *sīn* is light. Then د (*dāl*), ي (*yā^ʔ*) carrying the long ī, and ق (*qāf*). د is a non-joiner, so صديق breaks after it: صد, then يق.

The feminine is صديقة (*ṣadīqa*) — the ّة, tied on the end, doing what it did to *qahwa*: the open ت of بنت and أخت in its tied form.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

صَدِيق (*ṣadīq*) = “a friend.” Root ص-د-ق, and the root means “to be truthful, to be sincere.”

A friend, in Arabic, is defined by honesty rather than proximity. The family agrees:

- صِدْق (*ṣidq*) — “truth, sincerity.”
- صَادِق (*ṣādiq*) — “truthful,” the **doer** shape worn by قَائِل (*qāʾil*, a sayer) and كَاتِب (*kātib*, a writer).
- صَدَقَة (*ṣadaqa*) — “voluntary alms.” A gift given for its own sake: a **true** gift, as against one owed.
- أَصْدِقَاء (*aṣḍiqāʾ*) — “friends.”

And now the pattern. صَدِيق is فَعِيل (*faʿīl*) — the shape of حَلِيب (*ḥalīb*), the milked thing, and مَلِيح (*malīḥ*), the salty one. Root plus *faʿīl* hands back a quality made into a person or a thing.

This is the machinery that turned سَلَام (*salām*) into السَّلَامَة (*as-salāma*): one root, several patterns, several words.

English took nothing from ص-د-ق. *Friend* is Germanic, from an old word for loving.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ṣād, dāl, yāʾ, qāf — “ṣadīq,” a friend
- the emphatic pair — sīn light, ṣād heavy, as in ṣabāḥ
- what the root means — to be truthful; a friend is one who is true
- the family — ṣidq, ṣādiq, ṣadaqa, aṣḍiqāʾ
- the doer shape — qāʾil, kātib, ṣādiq
- the faʿīl shape — ḥalīb, malīḥ, ṣadīq
- the feminine — ṣadīqa, tied tāʾ, as as-salāma has it
- this chapter’s people — jāri with its two non-joiners, ibn, bint, ṣadīqī

- and the family you had — *ab*, *umm*, *akh*, *ukht*

Before you move on

What does *ق-د-ص* mean, and what does that make a friend? (**To be truthful** — the one who is true to you.) Name the family. (*Ṣidq*, *ṣādiq*, *ṣadaqa*, *aṣḍiqāʿ*.) Which earlier words wear *ṣadīq*'s *faʿīl* pattern, and which wear *ṣādiq*'s *doer* shape? (*Ḥalīb* and *malīḥ*; *qāʿīl* and *kātib*.) Introduce the people you can now name. (*Jārī*, *ibn*, *bint*, *ṣadīqī* — beside *ab*, *umm*, *akh*, *ukht*.) What does the *ī* of *ṣadīqa* do? (**Marks it feminine** — as on *qahwa* and *as-salāma*.)

35.4 The name exchange, with somebody else in the room

Ask a woman her name, answer with your own, and close politely. This chapter has given you a neighbour, a friend, a son and a daughter — so run the exchange, then introduce one of them.

The exchange

Say these aloud:

- ask a man — *mā ismuka?*
- ask a woman — *mā ismuki?*
- answer — *ismī ...*
- close — *tasharrafnā*
- now name your neighbour, your friend, your son, your daughter into the same frame

Every line above is missing a verb, and none of them feels short. That is the zero copula doing its work: *my-name Arun*, with the *is* understood.

Grammar Lens: the suffix set, whole

noun	glued on	result
اسم <i>ism</i>	-ي <i>-ī</i>	اسمي my name
اسم <i>ism</i>	ك <i>-ka</i>	اسمك your name, to a man
اسم <i>ism</i>	كِ <i>-ki</i>	اسمك your name, to a woman

اسم is three letters, all from the first writing set: *alif* · *sīn* · *mīm*. What follows it is never a separate word. Arabic has no free-standing *my* — it glues ي on, the same habit that glues ا for *the* and ب for *in*. The two *your* forms are **identical on the page**. Only the unwritten vowel separates them, which is why the ear does the work the eye cannot.

The two words

ما *mā* is *mīm* plus *alif* and means **what** — the form you want before a noun, where *mādā* is the one for verbs.

Two of these words have histories worth holding onto. اسم shares its root **s-m-w** with Hebrew *shem* and has no tie to English *name* at all. And تشرفنا comes from **sh-r-f**, honour: *sharaf*, *sharīf*, and at a long distance English *sheriff*. It does not mean *pleased to meet you*. It means **we have been honoured**.

Grammar Lens: which axis splits you

أنت is one skeleton — hamza-seated *alif*, *nūn*, *tāʾ* — for both genders. أنت *anta* addresses a man, أنت *anti* a woman, and the split is Semitic: the same *t* marks *you* in Hebrew *atta* and *att*.

The European and Dravidian tracks split *you* by **register**. Arabic splits it by **who is listening**. Two languages can make the same distinction in form and mean something entirely different by it.

Before you move on

Give the root behind تشرفنا and what the word literally claims. (**sh-r-f**, honour — *we have been honoured*.) Name the axis Arabic uses for أنت. (**The listener's gender**.) Say how Arabic builds *my*.

(A **glued suffix** **ـي**, never a separate word.) And say which *what* goes before a noun. (ما.)

Chapter 36

Cups, Plates, and More Than One

Modes:  eyes (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for oil, a cup, a plate and a spoon in Arabic, and I can tell a broken plural from a sound one and say which kind of noun usually takes which.

Set the mi- tool shape of mil^caga and mir²āh against the ma- place shape of maṭ^cam and maktab, then sort the plurals: akwāb, aṭbāq and malā^ciq re-poured into a new shape against qahawāt and ṣadīqāt, which only add an ending — and ask for each thing with min fadlik.

36.1 زيت (zayt) — “oil,” and a letter you already knew

One new letter to name — and you will find you already own it, because it is an old letter wearing a dot.

The letters in this word

ز is zāy, the z. And here is all there is to it: ز is ر (rā) with **one dot above**.

That is the abjad’s favourite trick. ب, ن and ت share one bowl and differ by dots. ح, خ and ج share one hook. Now ر and ز share one curve.

Everything rā does, zāy does: it hangs below the line and **refuses to join** what follows — the non-joiner that ended سكر.

Then ي (yā²) and ت (tā²). So زيت is ز alone, then يت joined.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

زَيْت (*zayt*) = “oil” — in the first place olive oil, and by extension oil of any kind. Root ت-ي-ز, which also gives:

- زَيْتُون (*zaytūn*) — “olives.”
- زَيْتُونَة (*zaytūna*) — “an olive,” one of them, with the tied ة making the single thing out of the collective.

And now Spain. You met **azúcar** and found Arabic’s **al-** welded onto its front. The same thing happened here, twice over:

- الزَّيْت (*az-zayt*) became Spanish **aceite**, “oil.”
- الزَّيْتُونَة (*az-zaytūna*) became Spanish **aceituna**, “an olive.”

ز is a **sun letter**, which is why *al-* is said *az-* — the assimilation that makes *al-* + *sukkar* into *as-sukkar*. Spanish took the sound it heard, article and all. Portuguese did the same with **azeite**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- zāy is rā plus one dot above, and it breaks as rā breaks
- the dot families — bā[◌], nūn, tā[◌]; ḥā[◌], khā[◌], jīm; rā and zāy
- zāy, yā[◌], tā[◌] — “zayt,” oil
- the olives — zaytūn; one olive, zaytūna
- the welded article — az-zayt gave aceite, as-sukkar gave azúcar
- the friend and his root — ṣadīq, from ṣ-d-q, to be true
- the pair one letter apart — ibn, bint

Before you move on

What is ز, described from a letter you had? (**Rā with one dot above** — and it breaks the same way.) What does ت-ي-ز give besides oil? (**Zaytūn** and **zaytūna**.) Which Spanish words carry

this root with Arabic's article stuck on, and which one did *sukkar* give? (*Aceite* and *aceituna*; *azúcar*.) Why *az-* rather than *al-*? (ج is a sun letter.)

36.2 كُوب (kūb) — “a cup,” and more than one of them

A short, useful word — and the door into the thing about Arabic nouns that surprises every learner.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ك (kāf), the angular *k*; و (wāw), here carrying the long *ū*; and ب (bāʾ).

و is a non-joiner, so كُوب goes كو, break, ب. Another non-joiner: ج ended *sukkar*, ج opened *zayt*, and و splits this.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

كُوب (kūb) = “a cup.” Root ب-و-ك.

Now say “cups.” In English you add an *s*. In Arabic you do something else entirely:

أَكْوَاب (akwāb).

Nothing was added to the end. The root ب-و-ك was taken out of one shape and **poured into another**, أَفْعَال (afʿāl). Arabic calls this a **broken plural**, and it is not an exception — it is how most ordinary Arabic nouns make their plurals.

You have seen a root move between shapes many times: ب-ت-ك became *kitāb*, *kātib*, *maktab*, *maktaba*. A broken plural is that same machinery pointed at number instead of meaning. So this is not a new rule to learn. It is a rule you already have, doing a job you did not expect it to do.

On where *kūb* came from, honesty first. It sits close to a cup-word that travelled all round the Mediterranean — Latin **cuppa**, behind English **cup** and French **coupe**. Whether Arabic took it from that family, or the resemblance is coincidence, is **not settled**: a resemblance worth knowing, not a descent worth claiming.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- kāf, wāw, bāʾ — “kūb,” a cup
- more than one — “akwāb,” and nothing was added to the end
- what happened instead — the root was poured into the shape afʿāl
- the same machinery you had — kitāb, kātib, maktab, maktaba
- ask for one — “kūb māʾ, min faḍlik” — a cup of water, from your grace
- and answer the thanks — “ʿafwan”
- the odd old word for water — māʾ, whose plural miyāh follows no pattern
- the non-joiners — zāy in zayt, dāl in ṣadīq, wāw here

Before you move on

How does Arabic make “cups” out of كُوب? (*Akwāb* — the root is **re-poured into a new shape**, not given an ending. That is a **broken plural**.) Which earlier root shows the same shape-changing machinery? (ك-ت-ب — *kitāb, kātib, maktab, maktaba*.) Ask for a cup of water politely. (*Kūb māʾ, min faḍlik*.) And reply to thanks? (*ʿAfwan*.) Did Arabic get *kūb* from Latin *cuppa*? (**Unsettled** — a resemblance, not a claim.)

36.3 طبق (ṭabaq) — “a plate,” and a broken plural that repeats

One broken plural is a surprise. Two in the same shape is a pattern — and a pattern you can use.

The letters in this word

Nothing new. ط (*ṭāʾ*) is the emphatic ت, named when you built طعام (*ṭaʿām*) — the dark, flat-tongued *t*, standing beside ص under س and ض under د.

Then ب (*bāʾ*) and ق (*qāf*). All three join, so طبق runs unbroken — unlike كوب, which had to stop at its *wāw*.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

طَبَق (*ṭabaq*) = “**a plate, a dish.**” Root ط-ب-ق.

Its plural is أَطْبَاق (*aṭbāq*).

Say that beside أَكْوَاب (*akwāb*) and listen. Same opening أَ, same long ā before the last letter, same nothing-added-at-the-end. Both are the shape أَفْعَال (*afʿāl*). So the broken plural is not chaos: it is a small set of shapes, and you have now met the commonest one twice.

The root itself means **to cover, to lie in layers** — a plate being the flat thing that covers. Which is why the same root gives:

- طَابِق (*ṭābiq*) — “**a storey**” of a building. A layer of house. And notice its shape: that is the **doer** form of *ṣādiq* and *kātib*.
- طَبَقَة (*ṭabaqa*) — “**a layer**,” and so “**a social class**,” with the tied ʿ on the end.

A plate, a floor and a social class, off one idea about layers. And the plates themselves belong somewhere you already built: مَطْعَم (*maṭʿam*), the place of eating.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ṭāʾ, bāʾ, qāf — “ṭabaq,” a plate
- the emphatic set once more — ṣād, ḍād, ṭāʾ
- the two broken plurals — akwāb, aṭbāq, both in the shape afʿāl
- what the root means — to cover, to lie in layers
- its other children — ṭābiq, a storey; ṭabaqa, a layer or a class
- where the plates live — maṭʿam, the place of eating

- the oil, whose *zāy* is *rā* plus a dot — *zayt*, *zaytūn*

Before you move on

What shape do أَكْوَاب and أَطْبَاق share? (*Af^cāl* — the broken plural you have now met twice.) What does ق-ب-ط mean? (**To cover, to lie in layers.**) Name two more words it builds. (*Tābiq*, a storey, and *ṭabaqa*, a layer or a class.) Which plain letter is ط the emphatic partner of? (*Tā^ʔ*.) Where would you find a stack of *aṭbāq*? (**In a maṭ^cam** — the place of eating.)

36.4 مَلْعَقَة (*mil^caqā*) — “a spoon,” the tool shape, and two ways to say more than one

The last word, and it pays two debts at once: the shape that makes tools, and the question of how Arabic counts past one.

The letters in this word

Nothing new: م (*mīm*), ل (*lām*), ع (*ʿayn*, the throat sound), ق (*qāf*) — and then ḍ, the tied *tā^ʔ*.

That ḍ tells you, before anything else, that مَلْعَقَة is **feminine** — the signal you read off قَهْوَة (*qahwa*), صَدِيقَة (*ṣadiqa*) and طَبَقَة (*ṭabaqa*).

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

مَلْعَقَة (*mil^caqā*) = “a spoon.” Root ل-ع-ق, whose verb لَعَقَ (*la^ciqā*) means “he licked, he lapped.” A spoon is the thing you lap with. Two shapes now stand side by side, differing by one vowel:

- م, the **place** shape: مَكْتَب (*maktab*), the place of writing; مَطْعَم (*maṭ^cam*), the place of eating.
- م, the **tool** shape: مِرْآة (*mir^ʔāh*), the thing you see with; مَلْعَقَة (*mil^caqā*), the thing you lap with.

Ma- builds a room. *Mi-* puts something in your hand.
Now the plurals this chapter has been circling.

Broken — the root re-poured, nothing added: أَكْوَاب (*akwāb*), أَطْبَاق (*aṭbāq*), مَلَاعِق (*malā^ciq*), spoons.

Sound — an ending added, the word left intact. Arabic uses it for the *ṣ* words: قَهْوَة gives قَهَوَات (*qahawāt*), and صَدِيقَة gives صَدِيقَات (*ṣadīqāt*). The rule of thumb: a noun in *ṣ* usually takes the added ending, and most other everyday nouns break. *Mil^caqā* is the honest reminder that “usually” is doing work — it ends in *ṣ* and breaks anyway.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- mīm, lām, ʿayn, qāf, tāʾ marbūṭa — “mil^caqā,” a spoon
- the verb under it — “la^ciqā,” he lapped
- the place shape — maktab, maṭʿam
- the tool shape — mirʾāḥ, mil^caqā
- the broken plurals — kūb with its breaking wāw gives akwāb; aṭbāq; malā^ciq
- the sound plurals — qahwa gives qahawāt, ṣadīqa gives ṣadīqāt
- the tied tāʾ marking feminine — qahwa, ṣadīqa, ṭabaqa, mil^caqā
- ask for each — “kūb, min faḍlik”; “ṭabaq, min faḍlik”; “mil^caqā, min faḍlik”
- and the oil — zayt, whose Spanish child is aceite

Before you move on

What separates م from مـ? (**Ma-** makes a place, **mi-** a tool — *maktab* and *maṭʿam* against *mirʾāḥ* and *mil^caqā*.) What does ل-ع-ق mean? (**To lap**.) Name this chapter’s broken plurals, and a sound one. (**Akwāb, aṭbāq, malā^ciq; qahawāt or ṣadīqāt.**) What does the *ṣ* on *mil^caqā* tell you? (**Feminine** — and unusually for a *ṣ* word, it still breaks.) Ask for a spoon politely. (**Mil^caqā, min faḍlik.**)

36.5 The hand that holds the spoon

Pick up the spoon this chapter gave you and name the part of the body doing it. Then name the one at the other end. Both words came once, a long way back.

Across the family: the inherited stock

Arabic	meaning	Hebrew cousin
يد <i>yad</i>	hand	יָד <i>yad</i>
رأس <i>raʿs</i>	head	רֹאשׁ <i>rosh</i>
أب <i>ab</i>	father	אָב <i>av</i>
أم <i>umm</i>	mother	אִמָּה <i>em</i>
أخ / أخت <i>akh / ukht</i>	brother / sister	אָח <i>ach</i>

Neither language borrowed these from the other; both inherited them. يد has barely moved at all — two letters, one syllable, and its Hebrew cousin is said almost the same way after several thousand years. أخ is أخت with one letter added. Set that beside the colour words, which needed a whole reshaped template to change gender, and the contrast is the point: the oldest words take the cheapest endings.

Why it's said this way

رئيس *raʿīs*, **president** or **chief**, is built on *head* with nothing borrowed — Arabic reached for its own oldest word, the way English reached for Latin *caput* to make *capital* and *captain*. أم and أبو are still forming names today. Add a child's name and you have a **kunya**: *mother of* and *father of*, used as an honorific in ordinary speech.

Script: the two halves of the farewell

Write these out:

- مع — *mīm*, round head, joining left into *ʿayn*
- السلامة — ال, then *sīn* · *lām* · *alif* · *mīm*, then the tied ة

مع needed no new letters when you first wrote it. And السلامة is not a new word: it is ال wrapped round the very first word you learned to draw, with a tied *tāʾ* closing it — the same ة that closes ملعقة, the spoon in your hand.

Your turn

- *Say it:* hand, head — *yad, raʿs*
- *Say it:* the four relatives — *ab, umm, akh, ukht*
- *Recall:* the word for president, and the body part underneath it

Before you move on

Name the word in this set that has changed least from its Hebrew cousin. (يد.) Say what separates أخ from أخت. (**One added letter.**) Name the letter that closes both السلامة and ملعقة. (ة, the tied *tāʾ*.) And give the chief built on the word for head. (رئيس.)

Chapter 37

The Tense That Was Missing

Modes: ⇄ voice (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can put a verb in the present tense for myself with the أ- prefix, and I can say لا أفهم – ‘I do not understand’ – which is the sentence a beginner needs most and which this book was one form away from for six chapters.

Eleven verbs taught as third-person past forms become first-person present forms, and each of them is then denied – so a reading list turns into a speaking stock on one prefix.

37.1 أكتب (aktub) — the tense that was missing

Eleven verbs in this book and every one of them is a **past** tense, third person, masculine: *kataba*, “he wrote.” Nothing here has ever happened now, and nothing has ever happened to **you**.

You’ll want to know: the أ- in front

كتب — *kataba* — **he wrote** · أكتب — *aktub* — **I write**

سأل — *saʿala* — **he asked** · أسأل — *asʿal* — **I ask**

The past tense marks who is speaking at the **end** of the word. The present marks it at the **front**, with a prefix, and أ is the prefix for *I*. Nothing is added at the back at all.

Grammar Lens: the front of the word, not the back

root	past, he	present, I
ب-ت-ك	كتب	أكتب
ل-أ-س	سأل	أسأل
ب-ب-ح	أحب	أحب

The third row is a warning as much as an example: أَحَبَّ is *he loved* and *I love* on the page, and only the vowels tell them apart — *aḥabba* against *uḥibb*. Arabic does not usually write those vowels. Context does the work, and this is where a reader starts needing it.

That *أ* is old. Hebrew and Aramaic mark their first person the same way, at the front, with the same letter. It is older than either language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — *kataba ... aktub*
- the second pair — *saʿala ... asʿal*
- *uḥibb* — I love
- the one this book most needs, in romanization — *afham*, I understand

Before you move on

Where does the past tense mark the person, and where does the present? (**Past at the end; present at the front.**) Which letter is the prefix for *I*? (أ.) And why can أَحَبَّ be read two ways? (**The vowels that separate them are not written.**)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

37.2 لا أفهم (lā afham) — I do not understand

لا has been in this book since chapter five, named there as the word that negates a present-tense verb. The book had no present-tense verb until the lesson before this one.

- *Recall*: the item before this — the prefix that means *I*, on *aktub*

You'll want to know: أفهم لا

أفهم لا — *lā afham* — **I do not understand.**

Two words, and both halves were already in the book: لا from chapter five, and فهم — *fahima*, “he understood” — from chapter thirty-one. All that was missing was the prefix the last lesson taught.

لا goes in **front** of the verb, which is where the chapter-five lesson said it goes, and the verb keeps its own shape.

Grammar Lens: the same operation on every verb you own

said	means
أكتب	I write
أكتب لا	I do not write
أسأل لا	I do not ask

Nothing moves and nothing is added at the end. This is the operation a beginner uses more than any other, and this book could not perform it on any verb until this chapter.

One note on the page rather than the language: فاء, the letter in the middle of أفهم, has no lesson in this track's script ladder yet, so the sentence is printed whole here, in the lesson that owns it, and named in romanization wherever else it appears.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *lā afham*
- the affirmative it denies — *afham*
- *lā aktub ... lā asʿal*

Before you move on

Where does لا stand in relation to the verb? (**In front of it.**) Which two chapters supplied the halves of this sentence? (**Five**, for لا, and

thirty-one, for فهم.) And what did the sentence need that neither of them had? (**The present tense**, from the lesson before this one.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

37.3 Now, and not

Two items landed in this chapter and one of them was a whole tense. Name the prefix, and name the sentence it unlocked.

Your turn

- *Say it*: three verbs in the past, as the book taught them — *kataba*, *saʿala*, *fahima*
- *Say it*: the same three in the present, for yourself — *aktub*, *asʿal*, *afham*
- *Say it*: each of them denied — *lā aktub*, *lā asʿal*, *lā afham*
- *Recall*: the very first verb this book taught, nine chapters back — *dhahaba*

Before you move on

Which end of the verb carries the person in the present tense? (**The front.**) Where does ٴ go? (**In front of the whole verb.**) And how many new words did *lā afham* need? (**None** — both halves were already taught, and only the tense was missing.)

Chapter 38

Two at Once

Modes: ⇐ voice (4) 👁 eyes (2) ⇐ Hands-free start: first 1 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can join two nouns with و, offer a choice with أو, turn a clause against the one before it with لكن, and accept what somebody said with حسناً.

The pantry and family of chapters 33-36 – tea, coffee, milk, sugar, salt, meat, cheese, food, a cup, a spoon, a son, a daughter, a neighbour, a friend – becomes combinable for the first time, joined, offered and turned.

38.1 و (wa-) — and

Chapter one taught the reply to the greeting and said of it: *hear the little wa- at the front; it means and*. That sentence taught nothing. This book has thirty-six chapters of vocabulary and has never joined two words.

You'll want to know: و

والحليب الشاي — *ash-shāy wa-l-ḥalīb* — **the tea and the milk**.

واللحم الملح — *al-milḥ wa-l-laḥm* — **the salt and the meat**.

One letter, and it is **written joined to the word that follows it**, never with a space after it. That is why it looks like part of the next word and why it has been on the page in front of you since chapter one without ever being a word you owned.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

و is the same conjunction Hebrew and Aramaic write with a single letter, in the same job, and it has held that job for three thousand years. It is by a wide margin the commonest word in written Arabic: Arabic prose strings clauses with و where English would use a full stop, so a page of Arabic has far more *ands* in it than a page of English ever does.

Note that و is also the letter *wāw*, the long *ū* inside كُوب and يَوْم. One shape, two jobs, told apart by whether it stands alone at the head of a word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ash-shāy wa-l-ḥalīb*
- *al-milḥ wa-l-laḥm*
- three at once — *ash-shāy wa-l-ḥalīb wa-s-sukkar*
- the greeting reply that carried it all along — *wa-^calaykum as-salām*

Before you move on

Is و written with a space after it? (**No** — it is joined to the word it introduces.) Which two languages write the same conjunction with the same single letter? (**Hebrew and Aramaic.**) And where has it been sitting since chapter one? (**At the front of the greeting reply.**)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

38.2 و (aw) — or

و gives somebody both things. Nothing in this book has ever made anybody choose.

- *Recall:* the joiner from the lesson before, and where it is written — *wa-*, joined on

You'll want to know: أو

الحليب أو الشاي — *ash-shāy aw al-ḥalīb* — **the tea or the milk.**

Unlike و, this one stands as its own word with a space on each side. It sits where و sits, between the two things, and nothing else in the sentence changes.

Look at the shape: أ — the hamza-carrying alif you know from أكل — followed by و, the letter that on its own means *and*. Arabic's two coordinators are one letter apart and mean opposite things.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

أو is Semitic ^ʿ*aw*, the same word Hebrew keeps. It is the whole apparatus a host needs: two nouns, أو between them, and the question particle a later lesson in this book will add. Until this lesson the corpus could name coffee, tea, milk and sugar and could not offer any one of them against another.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ash-shāy aw al-qahwa*
- the same pair joined instead of split — *ash-shāy wa-l-qahwa*
- and hear the difference — one hands you both, one makes you pick
- *bi-sukkar aw bi-dūn* — with sugar or without

Before you move on

Which joiner is written joined to the next word, and which stands apart? (و joins on; أو stands apart.) Which letter do they share? (و.) And which of them makes somebody choose? (أو.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

38.3 لكن (lākin) — but

Two joiners so far. One adds, one chooses, and neither of them can disagree with anything.

- *Recall:* the two items before this one — *wa-*, *aw*

You'll want to know: لكن

أسمع لكن لا أكتب — *asma^c lākin lā aktub* — **I hear, but I do not write.**

And with the sentence chapter thirty-seven built, whose verb carries a letter the script ladder has not reached: *asma^c lākin lā afham*, **I hear, but I do not understand.**

لا الحليب لكن حلو الشاي — *ash-shāy ḥulw lākin al-ḥalīb lā* — **the tea is sweet but the milk is not.**

و puts two clauses on the same side. لكن turns the second one against the first, and it stands at the head of the clause it turns.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

Look at the first two letters: لا, the negator this book taught in chapter five, with an old particle behind it. Arabic's *but* has a *not* inside it. English did the same thing by a different road. **But** is Old English *be-ūtan*, “be **out**, except” — and *out* is still visible in it if you look. Two unrelated languages built their adversative out of a word for leaving something aside.

In writing you will also meet لكنْ with a shadda, which takes a following noun in the accusative. The plain لكن in this lesson joins clauses and asks nothing of what follows.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *asma^c lākin lā afham*
- the same two clauses with the other joiner — *asma^c wa-afham*
- and hear what changed — the second clause no longer argues
- *ash-shāy wa-l-ḥalīb ... ash-shāy lākin lā al-ḥalīb*

Before you move on

Which word is hiding at the front of لكن? (لا, the negator from chapter five.) Which English word was built the same way? (**But**, from *be-ūtan*, “be out.”) And what does لكن do that و cannot? (**Turn the second clause against the first.**)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

38.4 حسناً (ḥasanan) — all right

نعم and لا answer a question. Neither of them says *I am following you*, and a conversation needs that more often than it needs an answer.

- *Recall*: the joiner from the lesson before, and the negator inside it — *lākin*

You'll want to know: حسناً

حسناً — *ḥasanan* — all right; fine; very well.

... لكن حسناً, — *ḥasanan, lākin* ... — all right, but ...

The ending is one you have written twice already. شكرًا and عافان wear the same ة, the two-stroke *tanwīn* over an alif that turns an Arabic adjective into an adverb. The root here is حَسَن, *ḥasan*, “good, beautiful.” So *ḥasanan* is literally *goodly*.

Grammar Lens: agreeing, and half-agreeing

said	does
نعم	answers a question
حسناً	accepts what was said
... لكن حسناً,	accepts, and then turns

The third row is the shape almost every real disagreement takes. A learner who can only say نعم or لا has to accept or refuse whole; this is the first thing in the book that lets them do neither.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ḥasanan*
- the three words with the same ending — *shukran*, *ʿafwan*, *ḥasanan*
- the half-agreement — *ḥasanan*, *lākin* ...

Before you move on

What does the *ṭ* ending do to an Arabic adjective? (**Turns it into an adverb.**) Which two words in this book already wear it? (شُكْرًا and *ʿafwan*.) And what does حَسْبُ do that نَعَمْ does not? (**Accepts what was said**, without answering a question.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

38.5 Two at once

Three joiners landed in this chapter. Name them, and say for each one whether it adds, chooses, or turns — and which of the three is written joined to the word after it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ash-shāy wa-l-qahwa*, then *ash-shāy aw al-qahwa*
- *Say it:* the half-agreement — *ḥasanan*, *lākin* ...
- *Recall:* five lessons back, the prefix that means *I* — on *aktub*

Your turn: the distant band — every noun in the pantry, two at a time

This is what the chapter actually bought. Chapters thirty-three to thirty-six taught a pantry and a family that could only ever be named one item at a time — and every one of them is now combinable. Take them two at a time, cold, from memory.

Say these aloud:

- the four drinks and their sweetener — *ash-shāy wa-l-qahwa wa-l-ḥalāb wa-s-sukkar*

- the same four as a choice, two at a time — *shāy aw qahwa, ḥalīb aw sukkar*
- what is on the table — *al-milḥ wa-l-laḥm wa-l-jubn*, and over it all *aṭ-ṭaʿām*
- what you eat it with — *kūb wa-milʿaqa*
- the people — *ibn wa-bint, jār wa-ṣadīq*
- one of each, turned — *ash-shāy lākin lā al-qahwa*

Before you move on

Which of this chapter's joiners has a negator inside it? (لكن.) Which one is a single letter with no space after it? (و.) And which word accepts what somebody said without answering a question? (حسنًا.)

38.6 How are you, joined up

Ask after a woman and answer as yourself, both parts. Then answer again using one of the joining words this chapter gave you.

The exchange

Say these aloud:

- ask a man, then a woman — *kayfa ḥāluka? ... kayfa ḥāluki?*
- answer with both replies joined — *bi-khayr wa-l-ḥamdu lillāh*
- answer with a reservation — *bi-khayr, lākin ...*
- accept what you hear — *ḥasanan*

For a long stretch this exchange could only be said one way, because there was nothing to join it with. This chapter is the first time the answer can carry two clauses.

Grammar Lens: what the question actually asks

English asks after **you**. Arabic asks after your **حال** — your *state*.
حال *ḥāl* is *ḥāʾ · alif · lām*, with the deep throat *ḥ*, and its root **ḥ-w-l** means **to turn, to change**. So the question is not *are you well* but *how stands the thing about you that shifts*.
كيف is the question word, partner to **ما**, and the phrase bolts three owned pieces together: *how + state + your*. There is no verb in it at all, exactly as there is none in the name sentence.

How to answer: two replies, both literal

reply	literally
بخير <i>bi-khayr</i>	in goodness — بـ (<i>in</i>) plus خير (<i>good</i>)
الحمد لله <i>al-ḥamdu lillāh</i>	the praise is to God — root ḥ-m-d , to praise

خير was hiding in the morning greeting long before it was named, and *al-ḥamdu lillāh* comes back more often in real speech than *bi-khayr* does. Neither is a polite noise: both say something, and both say it with a preposition glued to the front.

Before you move on

Give the root behind **حال** and its sense. (**ḥ-w-l**, to turn or change.)
 Give the literal reading of **بخير**. (***In goodness***.) Give the literal reading of **الحمد لله**. (***The praise is to God***.) And name the question word that partners **كيف**. (**ما**.)

Chapter 39

Denying, and Asking

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can deny a nominal sentence with ليس, a past-tense verb with ما and a present-tense verb with لا, refuse two things at once with لا ... ولا, and turn any of them into a yes-or-no question with هل.

Three negators sorted by the kind of sentence each one owns, then every one of them asked back with هل – so نعم and لا, taught in chapter 5 as answers, finally have a question to answer.

39.1 ليس (laysa) — is not

حسن اسمي — *my name is Hasan* — is a complete Arabic sentence with no verb in it, and it is the sentence shape this book teaches best. Try to deny it with لا and there is no verb for لا to stand in front of.

- *Recall:* the joiner two lessons back that has لا hiding inside it — *lākin*

You'll want to know: ليس

حسن ليس اسمي — *ismī laysa Ḥasan* — **my name is not Hasan.**

ماء ليس الحليب — *al-ḥalīb laysa māʾan* — **milk is not water.**

Arabic leaves the present-tense *is* out. To deny a sentence that never had one, the language supplies a word that exists only for that job — and ليس is it.

Notice the َ on ماءً: ليس puts what follows it in the accusative, which is the one grammatical demand it makes and the reason its predicate wears a tanwīn where the affirmative would not.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

Arab grammarians read ليس as لا — the negator of chapter five — welded to أيس, an old word meaning *there is*. So the word began as *there-is-not*, and it still behaves like a verb: it takes person endings, even though nothing it denies is a verb. It is a fossil doing a job nothing else in the language does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the affirmative, then the denial — *ismī Ḥasan ... ismī laysa Ḥasan*
- *al-ḥalīb laysa māʿan*
- *ash-shāy laysa ḥalībān*

Before you move on

Why can a nominal sentence not be denied with لا? (**There is no verb for لا to stand in front of** — Arabic leaves *is* out.) What are the two pieces grammarians find inside ليس? (لا and أيس, *there is*.) And what does ليس do to the word after it? (**Puts it in the accusative.**)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

39.2 ما (mā) — did not

لا denies a present-tense verb and ليس denies a sentence with no verb at all. Eleven verbs in this book are in the **past**, and neither of those two touches them.

- *Recall*: the item before this one, and what it demands of the word after it — *laysa*

You'll want to know: ما

ما كتب — *mā kataba* — **he did not write.**

ما أكل — *mā akala* — **he did not eat.**

Arabic uses a **different word** to negate the past from the one it uses for the present. لا in front of a past-tense verb is not a weaker sentence; it is the wrong word.

Grammar Lens: three negators, three kinds of sentence

negator	denies	example
لا	a present-tense verb	<i>lā aktub</i>
ما	a past-tense verb	<i>mā kataba</i>
ليس	a sentence with no verb	<i>ismī laysa Ḥasan</i>

That is the whole of A1 Arabic negation in three rows, and this chapter is where the second and third of them arrive.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

You have written these two letters before. اسمك ما — *what is your name?* — opens chapter two, and that ما means *what*. It is the same word. Semitic languages carry one very general particle that Arabic puts to work as *what*, as *not*, and as *as long as*, and only its position in the sentence tells you which one you are reading.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kataba ... mā kataba*
- the present beside the past — *lā aktub ... mā kataba*
- the two jobs of the same two letters — *mā ismuka? ... mā akala*

Before you move on

Which negator goes with a past-tense verb, which with a present, and which with no verb? (ليس, لا, ما) Which question word is

spelled the same as this one? (ما, *what.*) And what tells the two apart? (**Where they stand in the sentence.**)
 Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

39.3 لا ... ولا ... — neither, nor

The last chapter taught the joiner that adds. This lesson uses it to refuse — which is the one place a coordinator and a negator arrive as a single written word.

- *Recall:* the negator of the past, from the lesson before — *mā*

You'll want to know: لا ... ولا ...

حليب ولا شاي لا — *lā shāy wa-lā ḥalīb* — **neither tea nor milk.**

One لا in front of the first thing, and ولا — the joiner و written onto a second لا — in front of the next. English needs two different words, *neither* and *nor*; Arabic uses the same word twice and glues the *and* onto the second.

Grammar Lens: the mirror of the joiner

said	means
والحليب الشاي	the tea and the milk
حليب ولا شاي لا	neither tea nor milk
The second line is the first with a لا put in front of each thing. Nothing else changes — and the definite article drops, because you are refusing tea in general rather than a particular cup of it.	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *lā shāy wa-lā ḥalīb*
- the affirmative it mirrors — *ash-shāy wa-l-ḥalīb*
- *lā qahwa wa-lā sukkar*

Before you move on

How many negators does *neither ... nor* need in Arabic? (**Two, and they are the same word.**) What is welded onto the second one? (و, the joiner.) And what happens to the definite article? (**It drops** — the refusal is general.)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

39.4 هل (hal) — a question is coming

نعم and لا were taught in chapter five as answers. Thirty-four chapters later this book still cannot ask the question they answer.

- *Recall:* the double refusal from the lesson before — *lā shāy wa-lā ḥalīb*

You'll want to know: هل

هل أنت بخير — *hal anta bi-khayr?* — **are you well?**

هل كتب — *hal kataba?* — **did he write?**

Put هل at the front of any statement and it becomes a yes-or-no question. Nothing else in the sentence moves — no word order changes, no ending changes.

Arabic **needs** the word. English asks by moving the verb in front of the subject; Bengali and Urdu ask by letting the voice rise. Written Arabic does neither: the particle carries the whole question, which is why a page of Arabic tells you a question is coming before you have read any of it.

Grammar Lens: what the particle replaces

language	how a yes-or-no question is marked
English	the verb moves in front of the subject
Arabic	هل at the front, and nothing moves

A negative asks the same way, and that is the ordinary way to check something you suspect: *hal laysa hunāka shāy?* Answer either with نعم

or with لا.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hal anta bi-khayr?* — and answer it *naʿam* or *lā*
- *hal kataba?*
- the statement, then the question — *anta bi-khayr ... hal anta bi-khayr?*

Before you move on

What moves when an Arabic statement becomes a yes-or-no question? (**Nothing** — هل goes at the front.) Why can it not be done with the voice alone, as in Bengali or Urdu? (**Written Arabic marks it with a particle.**) And which two words answer it? (نعم and لا, from chapter five.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

39.5 Denying, and asking

Arabic has three negators and each one owns a different kind of sentence. Name all three, and say what each one denies.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the verbless sentence denied — *ismī laysa Ḥasan*
- *Say it:* the past denied — *mā kataba*
- *Say it:* the present denied — *lā aktub*, and *lā afham*
- *Say it:* both refused at once — *lā shāy wa-lā ḥalīb*
- *Say it:* each of those asked back — put *hal* in front and change nothing else
- *Recall:* six lessons back, the word that accepts what was said — *ḥasanan*

Before you move on

Which negator would you use for *حسن اسمي*, which for *كتب*, and which for *أكتب*? (ليس, then ما, then لا.) What does *هل* ask of the sentence it fronts? (**Nothing at all** — it only marks it.)

39.6 Every way to leave, asked and denied

Give both farewells and what each one literally says. Then use this chapter's question particle to ask whether somebody is leaving, and its negator to answer that they are not.

The exchange

- *Say it*: the whole arc — greet, give your name, ask after them, part
- *Say it*: part with safety — *ma^a s-salāma*
- *Say it*: part until the meeting — *ilā l-liqā'*
- *Recall*: the one root that opens the greeting and closes the farewell

Everything above stands on a handful of three-consonant roots, and the farewell uses the same one the first greeting did. **s-l-m** gives *salām*, *salāma*, *islām*, *muslim* — peace, safety, wholeness, one family.

Grammar Lens: with, until, and the pattern between them

مع *ma^a* is *mām* plus *ayn* and means **with**. It is a preposition that **stands apart** — unlike *إلى* and *في*, which fasten onto the word after them. Its Hebrew cousin is *im*.

السلامة is *إلى* + *salām* + *ة*, and the middle piece has been poured into the pattern *fa^aala*, which converts a thing into **the state of** that thing: *peace* becomes *safety*. Then the sun-letter rule bites, so *الس* is read **as-**, and the phrase is *as-salāma*, never *al-salāma*.

You'll want to know: until the meeting

إلى (until) plus اللقاء (*the meeting*), root **l-q-y**, to meet. Arabic does not name the parting; it names **the next meeting** and points at it.

Spanish does the same thing with *hasta luego*, *until later*, and both leave the listener holding a future rather than an ending. The **هـ** with its hamza below and the **ق** *qāf* both sit outside the writing set, so read them.

Before you move on

Give the three pieces of **السلامة**. (**ال** + *salām* + **ة**.) Say whether **مع** attaches to the next word. (**No**.) Give the root inside **اللقاء** and its sense. (**ل-ق-ي**, to meet.) And name the root that both opens and closes this book's first four chapters of speech. (**س-ل-م**.)

Chapter 40

Why, That, and When

Modes: ⇨ voice (5) 👁 eyes (1) ⇨ Hands-free start: first 1 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask why with لماذا, answer it with لأن, report what I write or think with أُن, and put one event beside another in time with حينما.

The first three-clause Arabic sentence in this track: an acceptance, an objection and a reason, built from حسناً, لكن and لأن over the present tense of chapter 37.

40.1 لماذا (limādhā) — why

This book can ask *what, how, how much* and — since the last chapter — *yes or no*. It has never been able to ask for a reason.

- *Recall:* the particle from the lesson before, and what it moves — *hal*, and nothing

You'll want to know: لماذا

لماذا؟ — *limādhā?* — **why?**

It is a compound and every piece is recoverable: ل, the preposition *for*, plus ماذا, *what* — which is itself ما plus ذا, *this*. Arabic's *why* is transparently **for-what-this**.

And the ما inside it is the same particle the last chapter taught as the negator of the past tense, and the same one chapter two taught as *what* in اسمك ما. Three jobs, one word, told apart by where it stands.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

لماذا and هل are the two ends of Arabic questioning. هل asks for a yes or a no and adds no information; لماذا asks for a whole clause back, and the next lesson supplies the word that clause begins with.

The letter ل in the middle of this word has no lesson in this track's script ladder yet, so the word is printed whole here, in the lesson that owns it, and named in romanization wherever else it appears.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *limādhā?* — on its own
- the question words this book now owns — *mā, kayfa, kam, hal, limādhā*
- the pieces it is built from — *li- ... mā ... dhā*

Before you move on

What are the three pieces of لماذا? (ل for, ما what, ذا this.) Which of them has the book already taught twice, in two different jobs? (ما — what in chapter two, did not in chapter thirty-nine.) And what does لماذا ask for that هل does not? (**A whole clause.**)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

40.2 لأن (li-anna) — because

The lesson before this taught the question. A question nobody can answer is worse than no question at all.

- *Recall:* the item before this, and the three pieces inside it — *limādhā*

You'll want to know: لأن

لا أكتب لأنني أسمع لا — *lā aktub li-annanī lā asma^c* — **I am not writing because I do not hear.**

Look at the first letter. *limādhā* opens with ل, *for*, and so does this word — with اُنْ, *that*, behind it instead of a question word. Arabic's *why* and *because* are one particle apart, and both are visibly built out of pieces rather than borrowed whole.

لْ needs a subject after it, so for *I* it becomes لِأَنْنِي, *li-annanī*. That is one ending on one word, and it is the only thing the construction asks of you.

Grammar Lens: the claim, then the reason

head word	what follows it
لكن	an objection
لأن	a reason

Both stand at the head of the clause they govern, and both come **after** the claim they attach to. Put them in one sentence and you have the shape of an argument.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the question, then the answer word — *limādhā?* ... *li-anna*
- *lā aktub li-annanī lā asma^c*
- an objection and a reason in one breath — *ḥasanan, lākin* ... *li-anna*
- ...

Before you move on

Which letter do *limādhā* and اُنْ share, and what does it mean? (ل, *for*.) What follows it in each? (**A question word** in one, **a complementiser** in the other.) And which comes first, the claim or the reason? (**The claim**.)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

40.3 اُنْ (anna) — that

fakkara — *he thought* — has been in this book since chapter thirty-two, and nobody has ever been able to say **what** they think.

- *Recall*: the reason word from the lesson before, and the piece behind its ل — *li-anna*

You'll want to know: أَنْ

أَنْ أَكْتُبُ — أَكْتُبُ أَنَا سَامِي جَارِي — *aktub anna Sāmī jāri* — **I write that Sami is my neighbour.**

أَنْ takes a whole sentence and makes it the object of a verb of writing, saying, knowing or thinking. Everything before it is the frame; everything after it is the reported thing.

You met it one lesson ago without being told: لَأَنْ is ل plus this word. The shadda over the ن is the doubling mark, and it belongs to the word — this is **anna**, with the *n* doubled, not **ana**.

Grammar Lens: what follows it

The clause after أَنْ is a **nominal** sentence — two nouns side by side, the shape chapter two taught — and أَنْ puts the first of them in the accusative, in the same way لَيْسَ does to what follows it. Two particles, one grammatical habit, and it is worth seeing them together. English lets *that* be dropped: *I think it is good*. Arabic does not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *aktub anna Sāmī jāri*
- the word it hides in — *li-anna ... anna*
- with the verb from chapter thirty-two, in romanization — *fakkara anna ...*

Before you move on

Where have you already read أَنْ? (**Inside** لَأَنْ, in the lesson before.)
 What kind of clause follows it? (**A nominal sentence**, whose first noun goes into the accusative.) And can it be dropped, the way English drops *that*? (**No**.)
 Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

40.4 حينما (ḥīnamā) — when

أُ hangs a sentence off a **verb**. This lesson's word hangs one off a **moment**.

- *Recall*: the complementiser from the lesson before — *anna*

You'll want to know: حينما

كتب جاء، حينما — ḥīnamā jā^ʿa, kataba — **when he came, he wrote.**

أسمع حينما أكتب — aktub ḥīnamā asma^c — **I write when I hear.**

The clause it opens can come first or second, and Arabic marks the seam with a comma when it comes first — which is the same rule English follows and one of the few places the two languages punctuate alike.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

حين is an ordinary noun meaning **a time, a moment**, and ما is the same general particle you have now met three times: as *what* in chapter two, as the past-tense negator in chapter thirty-nine, and inside *limādhā* in this chapter. Stuck onto حين it makes *at-the-moment-that*. Arabic writes another word here, ^cindamā, built the same way on a preposition meaning *at*. It is the commoner of the two in modern prose and it needs a letter this track's script ladder has not reached, so it is named in romanization and left for a script lesson. حينما costs no new letters at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ḥīnamā jā^ʿa, kataba
- the same joined the other way round — kataba ḥīnamā jā^ʿa
- aktub ḥīnamā asma^c

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of حينما (حين, a moment, and ما.) How many jobs has that ما now done in this book? (**Three** — *what, did not*, and this one.) And when does Arabic put a comma at the seam? (**When the time clause comes first**, as English does.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

40.5 Why, that, and when

Four items landed in this chapter and three of them share a piece with another. Name all four, and say which piece each one shares.

Your turn

- *Say it*: the question and its answer — *limādhā? ... li-anna ...*
- *Say it*: a reported thought — *aktub anna Sāmī jāri*
- *Say it*: a moment — *hīnamā jāʿa, kataba*
- *Say it*: the three-clause sentence — *ḥasanan, lākin lā afham li-annanī lā asma^c*
- *Recall*: six lessons back, the particle that makes any statement a question — *hal*
- *Recall*: eleven lessons back, the joiner written with no space after it — *wa-*

Before you move on

Which two of this chapter's words begin with the same ل? (*limādhā* and لَأْ.) Which particle sits inside لَأْ? (أْ.) And which of the four hangs a clause off a moment rather than off a verb? (حينما.)

40.6 Words that carry their own reason

Name the plate and the spoon in Arabic and spell each one aloud. Then use this chapter's *why* and *because* to explain where the spoon got its name.

Why it's said this way

word, spelled out	root	what the root means
ملعقة <i>mil^caqā — mīm</i> · <i>lām</i> · <i>ʿayn</i> · <i>qāf</i> · <i>qā</i>	ق-ع-ل	he licked, he lapped
طبق <i>ṭabaq — ṭā^ʔ</i> · <i>bā^ʔ</i> · <i>qāf</i>	ق-ب-ط	to cover, to fit over

So a spoon is **the licking-thing** and a plate is **the covering-thing**. Nothing in either word had to be learned as an arbitrary noise: the root says what the object is for, and the shape says it is an object. *أطباق* is the plural of *طبق*, in the same broken shape as *أكواب*. One broken plural is a surprise; two in the same shape is a **pattern**, and a pattern is something you can use on the next word.

Your turn: because, and when

Say these aloud:

- ask why the spoon is called that, then answer — *limādhā? ... li-anna*
...
- until tomorrow — *ilā l-ghad*
- the other farewell built on the same word — *ilā l-liqā^ʔ*

إلى الغد is the same *ilā*, **until**, with a new word in the slot. And الغد has its reason inside it too: the root **gh-d-w** means **to set out at dawn**, so *tomorrow* in Arabic is named after the hour you begin it.

Why it's said this way

خير على تصبح is the everyday **good night**, and it says nothing about the night. Literally: **may you wake up into goodness**. English, French, German and Spanish all wish the sleeper a quiet *night*. Arabic looks past the night to the far side of it — *tuṣbiḥ* carries the morning root, and خير is the goodness the wellbeing answer already uses. The phrase is built entirely from two things met long before bedtime came up.

How to answer: the word that erases what was owed

عفوا *ʿafwan* answers thanks as **you are welcome**, and the same word, on a different tone, means **excuse me** and **pardon**. The reason is the root **ʿ-f-w**, to **erase**: a debt, an intrusion or a mistake, all wiped away by one word.

Before you move on

Say what the root under ملعقة means. (**He licked.**) Say what the root under الغد means. (**To set out at dawn.**) Give the literal wish inside خير على تصبح. (**That you wake into goodness.**) And give the root under عفوا. (**ʿ-f-w**, to erase.)

Chapter 41

Calling Somebody, and Asking Again

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) 👁️ eyes (2) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can call somebody by name with يا, ask them to say it again with فضلك من كرّر, and run the whole first meeting of chapters one to four with the repair kit inside it.

The greeting, name and wellbeing exchanges of chapters 1-4 – untouched for more than a hundred lessons – are run cold and then broken on purpose, so the learner uses أفهم لا، عفوًا and فضلك من كرّر to get the conversation back.

41.1 يا (yā) — calling somebody

Chapter two taught you to give your name and to ask for somebody else's. Forty chapters later you still cannot **call** them by it.

- *Recall:* the time joiner from the lesson before — ḥīnamā

You'll want to know: يا

يا حسن — yā Ḥasan — **Hasan!** (calling him)

يا جار — yā jār — **neighbour!**

Arabic does not address a person with a bare name. *حسن* on its own is a statement *about* Hasan; *يا حسن* is speaking *to* him. The particle is not optional politeness — it is how the language marks the difference between naming somebody and calling them.

Two letters, both long since yours, and no ending changes on the name.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

يا is pan-Semitic and English has no particle of its own to match it. The one place English reaches for something similar is old translation — *O Lord, O Israel* — where the *O* is standing in for exactly this. It sounds archaic in English and is entirely everyday in Arabic. It goes before a title or a kin term as readily as before a name: *يا ابن يا*, بنت, *yā ṣaḍīqī*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *yā Ḥasan*
- *yā jār ... yā ṣaḍīqī*
- the name alone, then called — *Ḥasan ... yā Ḥasan*

Before you move on

What is the difference between *حسن* and *يا حسن*? (**One names him; the other calls him.**) Does the name change shape after it? (**No.**) And what does English use where Arabic uses *يا*? (**Nothing, ordinarily** — only *O* in old translation.)
Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

41.2 فضلك من كرّر — say it again, please

Chapter thirty-seven gave you the first thing a lost learner says. Saying it only helps if you can also ask for the sentence back.

- *Recall*: the particle from the lesson before, and what it turns a name into — *yā*

You'll want to know: كَرِّر

كَرِّر — *karrir* — **repeat**.

كَرِّر من فضلك — *karrir min faḍlik* — **say it again, please**.

The *please* is not new: chapter six taught it. What is new is the verb, and the shape it comes in — this is the first **command** in the book, and Arabic builds one by stripping the present tense back to its bare stem.

Look at the shadda. كَرِّر doubles its middle letter, which is the same Form II shape as *fakkara* in chapter thirty-two — a pattern that means *do it thoroughly, do it repeatedly*. On the root ك-ر-ر, “to return”, that gives exactly *do it again*.

Grammar Lens: the repair kit, whole

when

you did not follow

you want it again

you are grateful for it

say

lā afham

karrir min faḍlik

shukran

The inventory that measured this track said the repair kit was strong with one hole in it: sorry, excuse me, pardon, please and thank you were all taught, and *I do not understand* and *say it again* were not. Those two are what chapters thirty-seven and forty-one add, and between them they needed one new verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *karrir*
- *karrir min faḍlik*
- the whole kit in order — *lā afham ... karrir min faḍlik ... shukran*
- and get their attention first — *yā Ḥasan, karrir min faḍlik*

Before you move on

Which chapter taught the *please* in this sentence? (**Six.**) Which earlier verb wears the same doubled shape? (***fakkara***, chapter thirty-two.) And what does that shape add to a root? (**Doing it thoroughly, or again.**)

Source: Unicode Arabic chart.

41.3 Calling somebody, and asking again

Two items landed in this chapter: one gets somebody's attention and one asks them for the sentence back. Name both.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yā Ḥasan, karrir min faḍlik*
- *Say it:* the reason you are asking — *lā afham li-annanī lā asma^c*
- *Recall:* four lessons back, the particle that fronts a question — *hal*
- *Recall:* nine lessons back, the word that accepts what was said — *ḥasanan*
- *Recall:* five lessons back, ask why, then report the answer — *limādhā? ... aktub anna ...*
- *Recall:* ten lessons back, refuse both at once — *lā shāy wa-lā ḥalīb*

Your turn: the distant band — the first meeting, and what to do when it goes wrong

The exchange this book opened with was taught more than a hundred lessons ago and has not been asked for since. It is also the exact place a beginner loses the thread. Run it cold, and put the new chapter inside it.

Say these aloud:

- the greeting and its reply, and hear the 9 at the front of the reply — *as-salāmu ʿalaykum ... wa-ʿalaykum as-salām*
- the name exchange — *mā ismuka? ... ismī ... tasharrafnā*
- the wellbeing exchange — *kayfa ḥāluka? ... bi-khayr, al-ḥamdu li-llāh*

- now lose the thread and rescue it — *‘afwan, lā afham. karrir min faḍlik*
- thank them, and close — *shukran ... ma‘a s-salāma*

Before you move on

Five chapters ago this book could not say a verb in the present, deny a nominal sentence, join two nouns, ask a yes-or-no question, give a reason, or say that it had not understood. Say the sentence that was one tense away for thirty-one chapters. (*lā afham.*) Say what you ask next. (*karrir min faḍlik.*) And say how you get somebody’s attention first. (*yā plus their name.*)

41.4 Why you have to ask for it back

Name the three short-vowel marks and say whether ordinary text prints them. Then say what this chapter taught you to do when a word arrives without enough of it to go on.

Script: one bowl, four letters

letter	dots
ب <i>bāʾ</i>	one below
ن <i>nūn</i>	one above
ت <i>tāʾ</i>	two above
ث <i>thāʾ</i>	three above

One shallow boat-bowl, four letters. The dots **are** the letter, so a smudge or a bad line is not a small error — it is a different word. Two of the four build أنت: hamza-seated *alif*, then *nūn*, then *tāʾ*.

Script: the letter with three jobs

ي *yāʾ* is the same bowl with **two dots below** — a tooth when joined — and it does three jobs at once:

- the consonant **y**
- the long vowel **ī**

- the suffix **ي**, meaning **my**
- Write it: اسم, then اسمي — *alif · sīn · mīm*, then the *yāʾ*

That one added letter is the whole difference between *a name* and *my name*, and it is the third job doing the work.

Grammar Lens: one unwritten vowel, two different words

The **ḥarakāt** are three marks written around a consonant, not letters: *fathā* above for *a*, *kasra* below for *i*, *damma* above for *u*. Arabic is an abjad, so everyday text leaves them out — and here is what that costs.

shape	makes	example
ـَ <i>ma-</i>	a place	<i>maktab</i> , an office
ـِ <i>mi-</i>	a tool	ملعقة <i>milʿaqa</i> , a spoon

A place and a tool are separated by **one mark that nobody prints**. **ملعقة** is the licking-tool, from the root **ل-ع-ق**, and the only thing marking it as a tool rather than a licking-place is a vowel you have to know.

This is the honest reason the repair kit exists. When the vowels are missing and the context is thin, a reader guesses — and a listener asks.

Before you move on

Name the one feature separating **ث ن ب**. (**The dots.**) Give *yāʾ*'s three jobs. (**Consonant y, long vowel ī, the suffix meaning my.**) Say whether the **ḥarakāt** appear in ordinary print. (**No.**) And say what separates **ـَ** from **ـِ**. (***Ma-* makes a place, *mi-* a tool — one unwritten vowel.**)

Chapter 42

Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Encounter

Modes: 🗣️ voice (3) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read familiar Arabic words without romanization, follow complete lines in right-to-left script, and understand a connected encounter from greeting through a choice to farewell.

One complete Arabic encounter made only from previously taught forms and glyphs, with the script carrying greeting, names, a choice and farewell without a romanized line underneath.

42.1 (reading) — six old words, with the training wheels gone

You have heard, said and written every word below. Nothing here is new.

What is new is the empty space beneath each word. There is no romanized line to catch you. Let the Arabic carry its own sound.

Read this

حَسَّنًا لَا نَعْمَ شَايَ شُكْرًا سَلَامَ

Read down once, right to left, without translating.

Read again. The first and third words stretch an **l** into a long sound, while شُكْرًا and حَسَّنًا share the little **ʔ** ending.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

Arabic letters change coat when they join, but they do not change identity. The ح in حسناً is the same hook body you learned in خير; the word only asks you to recognize it at speed. And ل is still the lām-alif pair from chapter five. Reading is not a new script lesson. It is trusting the shapes you already paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words in order, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which two words share the written ء ending? (حسنًا شكرًا.)
How many new Arabic words did you meet? (**None.**)

42.2 (reading) — six lines that already know each other

The last lesson gave you words standing alone. Now the words join other words, in the same way that the letters inside them join one another.

You have said every line. Read the Arabic first; let meaning arrive before any romanization does.

Read this

حبيب؟ أو شاي. سامي اسمي اسمك؟ ما. السلام وعليكم. عليكم السلام.
شاي.

Read all six lines once without stopping.

Read again. The question mark tells you where a voice asks; the full stop tells you where it answers. Arabic puts its question mark the other way round — ؟ — because the line itself runs the other way.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

سامي اسمي has no written word for *is*. The zero copula from chapter two is not missing ink; it is how an Arabic present-tense sentence works.

That is one gift of reading whole lines: the blank between ideas can carry grammar too. You already learned that blank by ear. Now you can see it.

Your turn

- *Say it*: the six lines in order, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which two lines ask questions? (حليب؟ أو شاي اسمك؟ ما)
Where is *is* in سامي اسمي? (Nowhere on the page — Arabic does not need it here.)

42.3 (reading) — the first whole encounter

Six words, then six lines. Now read one encounter from its first peace to its last.

Every form has appeared before. The only new thing is holding all of them together without a romanized line underneath.

Read this

سامي يا مرحبًا. سامي اسمي اسمك؟ ما. السلام وعليكم. عليكم السلام.
السلامة مع. شكرًا. حسنًا. نعم شاي؟ لا حليب؟ حليب؟ أو شاي

Read the whole encounter once. Do not stop to translate a word; let each turn answer the turn before it.

Read it again. This time notice the hinge: حليب؟ أو شاي One choice becomes two tiny questions, then a clear answer.

The word, taken apart — its root and its family

A connected passage does not have to be one speaker's paragraph. Here the connection is the work each line does: greeting invites reply, a name invites welcome, and أو شاي؟ حليب opens a choice. لا closes the first option. نعم accepts the second. حسناً closes the choice, and شكرًا acknowledges it. The passage is connected by meaning before it is connected by grammar. The first and last lines share م-ل-س. Arabic opens the encounter with peace and closes it with safety, so the oldest root in the book gives the whole reading a frame.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the whole encounter aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which line calls the learner by name? (سامي يا مرحبًا)
Which drink is declined, and which is accepted? (شاي: لا. حليب: نعم)
Which line closes the encounter? (السلامة مع)

Chapter 43

Writing — My Own Line

Modes: ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can write one line of Arabic about myself from a closed supply of known words, choosing not only the words but the shape each letter takes where it stands.

Complete AR-W02-satri-al-khass: one line chosen rather than copied, with the joins checked before anything else.

43.1 My own line — the first writing with no model

Everything you have written so far had something to reach for.

This does not. You choose the words, from a supply that is closed: only what this book has taught you.

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** about yourself, right to left.

And here is the extra decision Arabic asks for that most scripts do not. A letter does not have one shape. It has up to **four**, and which one you write depends on **where in the word it stands** — alone, at the start, in the middle, at the end.

Copying hid that from you: the model already showed the right shape. Choosing your own words means choosing the shapes too, and a letter you have only ever copied in the middle of a word is a letter you may not yet be able to start one with.

Write the line. Then read it back and check the **joins** before you check anything else — a letter that should have connected and did not is the error a reader notices first.

Before you move on

How many shapes can one Arabic letter have? (**Up to four.**)
And what decides which one you write? (**Where it stands in the word.**)

Chapter 44

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✍ pen (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: none of the 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can produce Arabic writing at my own ceiling inside the target's twenty-to-twenty-five minutes, knowing that the test adapts to what I write.

Complete AR-W03-maa-al-saaa: twenty minutes at the top of what you can actually do, rather than a rehearsed answer to a paper that does not exist.

44.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do.

Writing — timed production

What the target publishes. The writing section runs **20 to 25 minutes** and holds **three** prompts. Those numbers come out of `task-shapes/a1.json`.

Now the part that makes this different from every other timed paper, and it is worth knowing before the clock starts rather than during it: **the test is adaptive**. It chooses your next prompt from how you answered the last one. Two candidates sitting the same test do not see the same questions.

Three things follow, and they change how to practise rather than how to write:

One — there is no paper to rehearse. Memorising an answer buys nothing, because the question it answered may never be asked of you.

Two — a weak answer makes the next question easier, and an easier question caps the level you can be reported at. Guessing short to save time is not neutral here; it lowers the ceiling of everything after it.

Three — the result is not a pass mark. This test reports a separate benchmark level per skill and publishes no pass or fail. The A1 claim in this book is the project's own mapping, stated in the contract, not something the test awards.

Write for **twenty minutes** to one prompt of your choosing, at the top of what you can actually do. Stop when the time is up.

Before you move on

Did you write at your ceiling, or somewhere comfortably below it?
On a fixed paper the difference costs you a few marks. On an
adaptive one it costs you the questions you never got to see.

Chapter 45

Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Is Not A Word

Modes: ✓ pen (2) ⇌ Hands-free start: none of the 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write four connected lines of Arabic to a named reader, attaching the and-joiner to the following word and giving a reason with the because-word.

Complete AR-W04-arbaa-sutur: four lines to one reader, at least one joined with the attached and-letter and one reasoned, then check no space follows it.

45.1 Four lines, and the joiner that is not a separate word

The last lesson asked for writing **finished on time**. This one asks for writing that **holds together**.

Pick one person who will read it.

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can be connected; one long line can fail to be. What makes it connected is that a sentence stops standing on its own.

You hold three joiners. و adds. لكن sets against. لأن gives the reason.

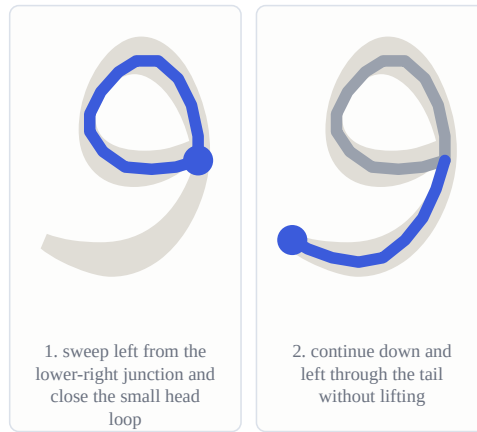
And the first of those does something the others do not. لكن and لأن stand as words, with space on both sides. و does not. It is written **onto the front of the next word**, with no space at all.

So in Arabic the join is not a word the eye can skip over on its way to the content. It is a letter the following word now begins with — the two things being joined are physically fastened, and a reader meets the joint before they meet the second thing.

A hand that leaves a space after 9 has not made a small typographic slip. It has written a letter that now belongs to nothing.

Writing — connected composition

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet و ي هـ, independent Waw at 00:45.7–00:46.9 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 9 is written, stroke by stroke

Write **four lines** to the person you picked, right to left.

At least one must use 9 — attached, no space. At least one must use لَانْ.

Use only words you already write. This lesson adds no vocabulary; the whole exercise is the joining.

Before you move on

Cover your first line and read the second alone. Does it still make sense without the first? If it does, you wrote a **list** — which is where you were one lesson ago.

Then look at every 9 you wrote. Is there a space after it? There

should not be.

45.2 The last page

Write خیر by hand, right to left, and say the one sentence that gets a lost conversation moving. Both were taught once, at opposite ends of this book.

Writing: the hook family, and the word it builds

ح ح خ share one body: a rounded **hook** flowing into a **tail that drops below the line**. Only the dot tells them apart — ح has none, خ takes one above, ح one below.

Write these out:

- خیر — *khāʾ* with its dot above, reaching left into *yāʾ*, then *rā*, and lift
- بخیر — glue ب on the front, one dot below, joining into the *khāʾ*

Nothing joins after ر, which is why the pen lifts. And خیر is the word that was hiding inside the morning greeting before anyone told you it was there; adding ب, *in*, turns *good* into the answer **in goodness**.

Script: the mark that is not a vowel

Say English *uh-oh* slowly and feel the catch between the halves. That catch is a **glottal stop**, and Arabic writes it as a real consonant: ء, the **hamza**. It is not one of the short-vowel marks. Sitting on an *alif* seat it becomes أ, which is how the word for *you* begins.

The short-vowel marks do something else entirely, and the clearest proof is the word for *you*: أنت is one consonant skeleton, and a single mark that ordinary print omits decides whether you have addressed أَنْتَ, a man, or أَنْتِ, a woman.

Your turn: the sentence to keep

فضلك من كَرَّر — *karrir min fadlik*

Say these aloud:

- you have not understood, then ask for the sentence back — *lā afham. karrir min faḍlik*
- call somebody first, then ask — *yā ..., karrir min faḍlik*

Of everything in this book, that is the line to carry out of it. The marks Arabic leaves off the page are the ones a beginner most needs, so a beginner will miss words — and the fix is not a better memory. It is four syllables asking for another pass.

Before you move on

Say whether hamza is a vowel mark and what it writes. (**No** — a glottal stop.) Say what tells ح, خ and ح apart. (**The dot** — none, one above, one below.) Say what َ adds to خير. (**In** — in goodness.) And give the sentence that rescues a conversation. (***Karrir min faḍlik.***)

Chapter 46

Letters From Your First Greetings

Modes: ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write shin, sad and dal, and find each one in a greeting or thanks I have said since the first chapters.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 46: i can write shin, sad and dal, and find each one in a greeting or thanks I have said since the first chapters.

46.1 ش (shīn) — the letter that opens شكرا

Before the new one: write ع and ه once each, and name them.

Now say شكرا (shukran), “thank you”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

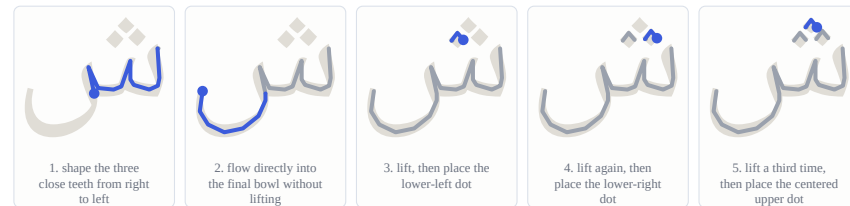
Script you’ll notice: ش

ش — shīn, the sound sh.

It opens شكرا (shukran), “thank you”, one of the first words in this book. You already write س (sīn): three small teeth and a bowl. ش is the same body with **three dots above**. One skeleton, and the dots decide the sound.

Writing: ش

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: س ش ص ض, independent Shiin at 00:00.7–00:03.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ش is written, stroke by stroke

- 1. start here: shape the three close teeth from right to left
- 2. flow directly into the final bowl without lifting
- 3. lift, then place the lower-left dot
- 4. lift again, then place the lower-right dot
- 5. lift a third time, then place the centered upper dot — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 3.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: ض ص ش س, independent Shiin at 00:00.7–00:03.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023).

Your turn

- *Look:* at شكرا and point at ش inside it
- *Trace it:* ش three times, saying *sh* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ه, then ش, from memory
- *Read it:* شكرا aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ش (shīn, sh.) Which word did it come from? شكرا, *shukran*, “thank you”.)

46.2 صباح (ṣād) — the letter that opens ص

Before the new one: write ه and ش once each, and name them.

Now say الخير صباح (*ṣabāḥ al-khayr*), “good morning”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

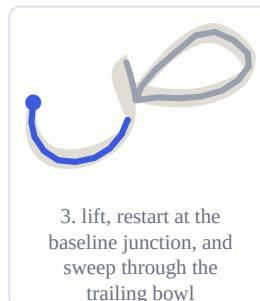
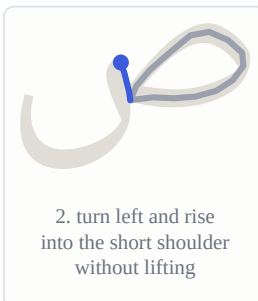
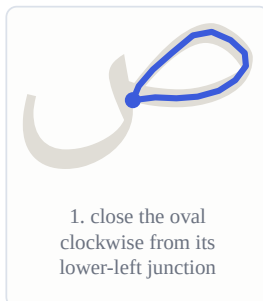
Script you’ll notice: ص

ص — *ṣād*, a heavy *s*.

It opens الخير صباح (*ṣabāḥ al-khayr*), “good morning”. Say *ṣabāḥ* and feel the tongue press low and the back of the mouth widen: that heaviness is what the dot under the romanization (*ṣ*) marks. The letter is a closed **oval** with a bowl trailing after it.

Writing: ص

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students,
Alphabet: س ش ص ض, independent Saad at 00:01.1–00:03.3 (University of Oregon Libraries
Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ص is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: close the oval clockwise from its lower-left junction
- **2.** turn left and rise into the short shoulder without lifting
- **3.** lift, restart at the baseline junction, and sweep through the trailing bowl — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: ض ص ش س, independent Saad at 00:01.1–00:03.3 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023).

Your turn

- *Look:* at الخير صباح and point at ص inside it
- *Trace it:* ص three times, saying ṣ as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ش, then ص, from memory
- *Read it:* الخير صباح aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ص? (ṣād, ṣ.) Which word did it come from? (الخير صباح, ṣabāḥ al-khayr, “good morning”.)

46.3 د (dāl) — the letter that ends الحمد

Before the new one: write ش and ص once each, and name them.

Now say الحمد لله (al-ḥamdu lillāh), “praise be to God”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

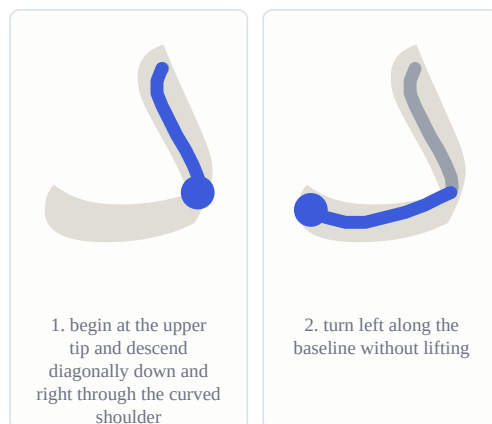
Script you’ll notice: د

د — dāl, the sound *d*.

It closes الحمد in الحمد لله (al-ḥamdu lillāh), the everyday answer to “how are you?”. د is a **non-connector**, like ل and ر: it joins to the letter before it but never to the one after, so a small gap always follows it.

Writing: د

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: د, independent Daal at 00:07.0–00:07.6 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How د is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: begin at the upper tip and descend diagonally down and right through the curved shoulder
- **2.** turn left along the baseline without lifting — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: د, independent Daal at 00:07.0–00:07.6 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023).

Your turn

- *Look:* at الله الحمد and point at د inside it
- *Trace it:* د three times, saying *d* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ص, then د, from memory
- *Read it:* الله الحمد aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — د? (**dāl**, *d*.) Which word did it come from?
(الله الحمد, *al-ḥamdu lillāh*, “praise be to God”.)

Chapter 47

Letters From Goodbyes and Pardons

Modes: ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write alif with hamza below, alif maqsura, fa and qaf, and find each one in a goodbye or a pardon I already say.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 47: i can write alif with hamza below, alif maqsura, fa and qaf, and find each one in a goodbye or a pardon I already say.

47.1 اِ (alif with hamza below) — the alif that opens إلى

Before the new one: write ص and د once each, and name them.

Now say إلى اللقاء (*ilā l-liqāʿ*), “see you”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you’ll notice: اِ

اِ — *alif* with a **hamza below**, read *i* at the start of a word.

It opens إلى (*ilā*), “until”, in إلى اللقاء (*ilā l-liqāʿ*), “see you”. You already write ا and the hamza ء. Put the small hamza **under** the alif and the word opens on *i*; put it over the alif (إ) and it opens on *a* or *u*.

Writing: اِ

Put your pen on اِ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start this character or which way to travel**. It is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at اللقاء إلى and point at اِ inside it
- *Trace it:* اِ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* د, then اِ, from memory
- *Read it:* اللقاء إلى aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — اِ? (**alif with hamza below, i.**) Which word did it come from? (اللقاء إلى, *ilā l-liqāʾ*, “see you”.)

47.2 اِ (alif maqṣūra) — the letter that ends

Before the new one: write د and اِ once each, and name them.

Now say اللقاء إلى (*ilā l-liqāʾ*), “see you”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

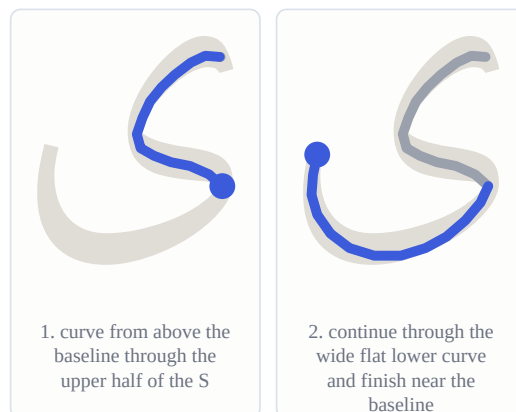
Script you’ll notice: اِ

اِ — *alif maqṣūra*, a long *ā* at the very end of a word.

It ends اِ (*ilā*) in اللقاء إلى. It looks like ي with its two dots taken away, and that is the whole trick: no dots, no *y*. It only ever stands at the end of a word, and there it is read as a long *ā*.

Writing: ي

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Arabic Language Learning Notes
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7F7F7F7F7F7F>), Learn How to Write Arabic Letters — Basic
Naskh: Alif Maqsurah ي, isolated form and stroke order
(updated 2025-01-29; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source
records where it varies.

How ي is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: curve from above the baseline through the upper half of the S
- **2.** without lifting, continue through the wide flat lower curve and finish near the baseline — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Arabic Language Learning Notes, Learn How to Write Arabic Letters — Basic Naskh: Alif Maqsurah ي, isolated form and stroke order (updated 2025-01-29; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at إلى and point at ي inside it
- *Trace it:* ي three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one

- Write it: اِ, then ي, from memory
- Read it: اللقاء إلى aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ي? (**alif maqṣūra**, *ā*.) Which word did it come from? (اللقاء *ilā l-liqāʾ*, “see you”.)

47.3 عفا (fāʾ) — the letter inside

Before the new one: write اِ and ي once each, and name them.

Now say عفا (*ʿafwan*), “you’re welcome”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

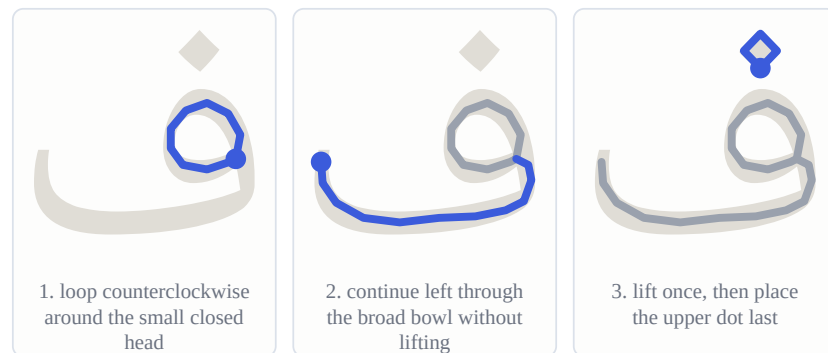
Script you’ll notice: ف

ف — *fāʾ*, the sound *f*.

It is the second letter of عفا (*ʿafwan*), “you’re welcome”. The letter is a small closed **head** on a broad bowl, with **one dot above**.

Writing: ف

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ف ق, independent Faa at 00:01.7–00:03.3 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ف is written, stroke by stroke

- 1. start here: loop counterclockwise around the small closed head
- 2. continue left through the broad bowl without lifting
- 3. lift once, then place the upper dot last — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ق ف, independent Faa at 00:01.7–00:03.3 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at عفا and point at ف inside it
- *Trace it:* ف three times, saying *f* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ع, then ف, from memory
- *Read it:* عفا aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ف? (fāʾ, *f*.) Which word did it come from? (عفا, *ʿafwan*, “you’re welcome”.)

47.4 القاء (qāf) — the letter inside

Before the new one: write ع and ف once each, and name them.

Now say القاء إلى (*ilā l-liqāʾ*), “see you”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

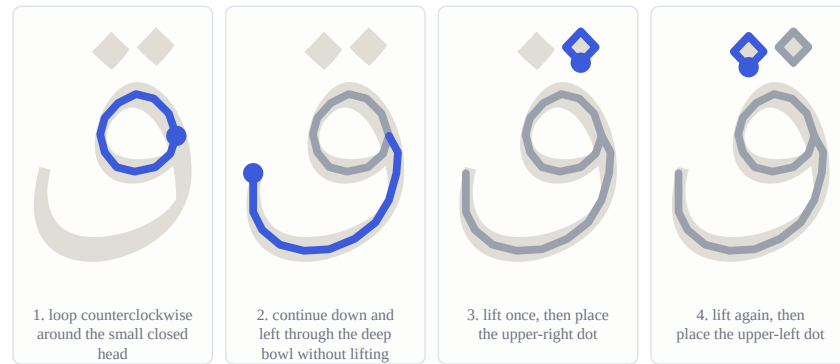
Script you'll notice: ق

ق — *qāf*, a *k* made far back in the throat.

It is inside اللقاء (*al-liqāʿ*), “the meeting”, in اللقاء إلى. Its head is the same as ف, which you wrote in the last lesson, but it carries **two dots** and, standing alone, its bowl dips deeper, below the line.

Writing: ق

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ف ق, independent Qaf at 00:01.5–00:03.5 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ق is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: loop counterclockwise around the small closed head
- **2.** continue down and left through the deep bowl without lifting
- **3.** lift once, then place the upper-right dot
- **4.** lift again, then place the upper-left dot — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 2.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ف ق, independent Qaf at 00:01.5–00:03.5 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at اللقاء إلى and point at ق inside it
- *Trace it:* ق three times, saying *q* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ف, then ق, from memory
- *Read it:* اللقاء إلى aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ق? (**qāf**, *q*.) Which word did it come from?
(اللقاء إلى, *ilā l-liqāʾ*, “see you”.)

Chapter 48

Letters From Please, Sorry and Tomorrow

Modes: ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write dad, alif madda, zay and ghayn, and find each one in a word I already say.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 48: i can write dad, alif madda, zay and ghayn, and find each one in a word I already say.

48.1 ض (ḍād) — the letter inside فضلك

Before the new one: write ف and ق once each, and name them.

Now say من فضلك (*min faḍlik*), “please”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

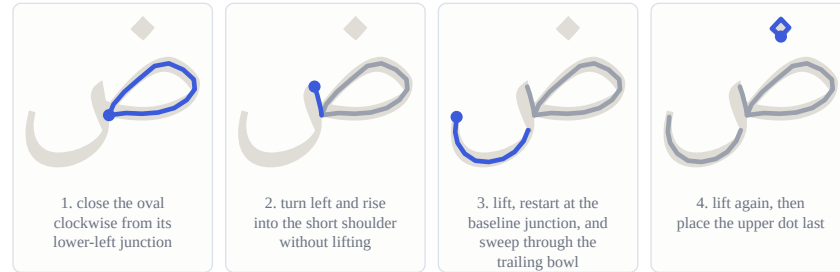
Script you’ll notice: ض

ض — ḍād, a heavy d.

It is inside من فضلك (*min faḍlik*), “please”. It is ص (*ṣād*), which you already write, with **one dot above**. Arabic is sometimes called *the language of the ḍād*, because the sound is so rare in other languages.

Writing: ض

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: س ش ص ض, independent Daad at 00:43.1–00:46.3 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ض is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: close the oval clockwise from its lower-left junction
- **2.** turn left and rise into the short shoulder without lifting
- **3.** lift, restart at the baseline junction, and sweep through the trailing bowl
- **4.** lift again, then place the upper dot last — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 2.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: س ش ص ض, independent Daad at 00:43.1–00:46.3 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023).

Your turn

- *Look:* at فضلك من and point at ض inside it
- *Trace it:* ض three times, saying *d* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ق, then ض, from memory
- *Read it:* فضلك من aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ض? (ḍād, ḍ.) Which word did it come from?
(فضلك, *min faḍlik*, “please”).

48.2 Ā (alif madda) — the alif that opens آسف

Before the new one: write ق and ض once each, and name them.

Now say آسف (*āsif*), “sorry”. You have read it for a long time.

This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you’ll notice: Ā

Ā — *alif* with a **madda**, a long *ā* at the start of a word.

It opens آسف (*āsif*), “sorry”. The wavy stroke on top, the *madda*, stretches the vowel: where a plain *l* at the start of a word needs a hamza to say *a*, Ā says a long *ā*.

Writing: Ā

Put your pen on Ā and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start this character or which way to travel**. It is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at آسف and point at Ā inside it
- *Trace it:* Ā three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ض, then Ā, from memory
- *Read it:* آسف aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — Ī? (**alif madda**, *ā*.) Which word did it come from? (آسف, *āsif*, “sorry”).

48.3 ز (zāy) — the letter inside أزرق

Before the new one: write ض and Ī once each, and name them.

Now say أزرق (*azraq*), “blue”. You have read it for a long time.

This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

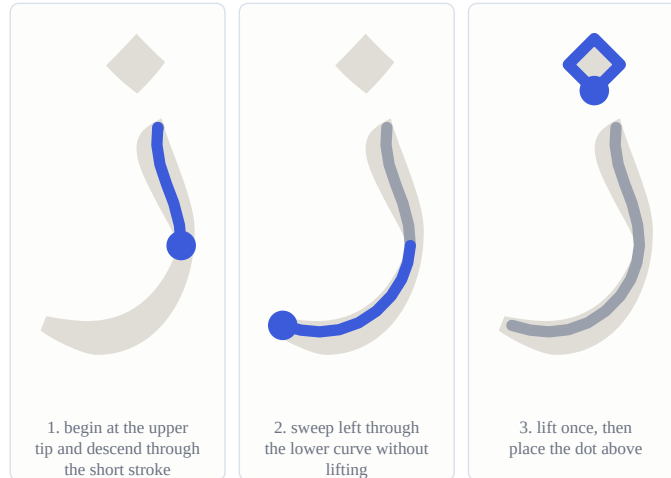
Script you’ll notice: ز

ز — *zāy*, the sound *z*.

It is inside أزرق (*azraq*), “blue”, from أزرق أحمر. It is ر (*rāʾ*), which you already write, with **one dot above**, and like ر it never joins to the letter after it.

Writing: ز

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ر ز و, independent Zay body followed by its upper dot (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ʒ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: begin at the upper tip and descend through the short stroke
- **2.** without lifting, sweep left through the lower curve without lifting
- **3.** lift once, then place the dot above — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet و ز ر, independent Zay body followed by its upper dot (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at أزرق and point at ʒ inside it
- *Trace it:* ʒ three times, saying *z* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ā, then ʒ, from memory
- *Read it:* أزرق aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ʒ? (**zāy**, *z*.) Which word did it come from? (أزرق, *azraq*, “blue”.)

48.4 غ (ghayn) — the letter inside الغد

Before the new one: write ā and ʒ once each, and name them.

Now say الغد إلى (*ilā l-ghad*), “see you tomorrow”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

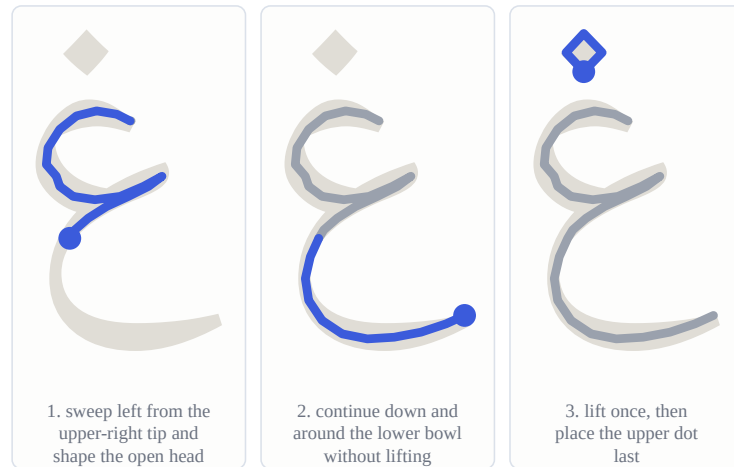
Script you'll notice: غ

غ — *ghayn*, a *gh* gargled at the back of the throat.

It is inside الغد إلى (*ilā l-ghad*), “see you tomorrow”. It is ع (*ʿayn*), which you already write, with **one dot above**, the third family where a single dot turns one sound into another.

Writing: غ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet غ ع, independent Ghayn at 00:02.4–00:04.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How غ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: sweep left from the upper-right tip and shape the open head
- **2.** continue down and around the lower bowl without lifting
- **3.** lift once, then place the upper dot last — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ع غ, independent Ghayn at 00:02.4–

00:04.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at إلى الغد and point at غ inside it
- *Trace it:* غ three times, saying *gh* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ز, then غ, from memory
- *Read it:* إلى الغد aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — غ? (**ghayn**, *gh*.) Which word did it come from? (إلى الغد, *ilā l-ghad*, “see you tomorrow”.)

Chapter 49

Letters From Food, Noon and Going

Modes: 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write ta, za and dhal, and I have now written every letter the words of this book use.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: i can write ta, za and dhal, and I have now written every letter the words of this book use.

49.1 ط (ṭāʾ) — the letter that opens طعام

Before the new one: write ج and غ once each, and name them.

Now say طعام (ṭaʿām), “food”. You have read it for a long time.

This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

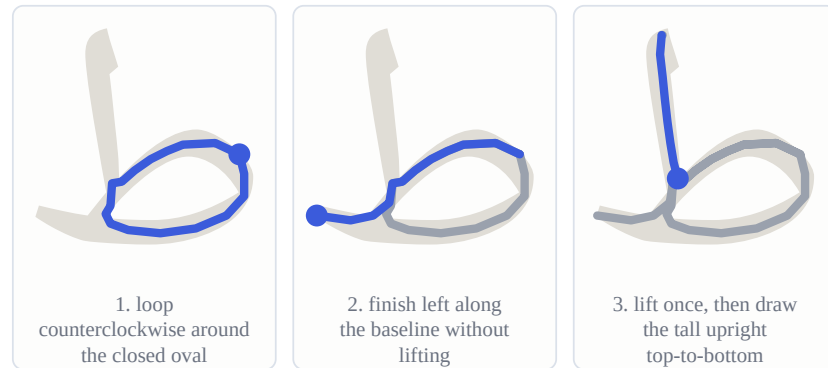
Script you’ll notice: ط

ط — ṭāʾ, a heavy *t*.

It opens طعام (ṭaʿām), “food”. A closed **oval** on the line, and a **tall upright** drawn last, from the top down.

Writing: ﺕ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ﺕ ﺕ, independent emphatic Taa at 00:01.2–00:03.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ﺕ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: loop counterclockwise around the closed oval
- **2.** finish left along the baseline without lifting
- **3.** lift once, then draw the tall upright top-to-bottom — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ﺕ ﺕ, independent emphatic Taa at 00:01.2–00:03.0 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at طعام and point at ﺕ inside it
- *Trace it:* ﺕ three times, saying *t̤* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* غ, then ﺕ, from memory

- *Read it:* طعام aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ط? (ṭāʾ, ṭ.) Which word did it come from? (طعام, ṭaʿām, “food”).

49.2 ظ (ẓāʾ) — the letter inside الظهر

Before the new one: write غ and ط once each, and name them.

Now say الظهر (aḏ-ẓuhr), “noon”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

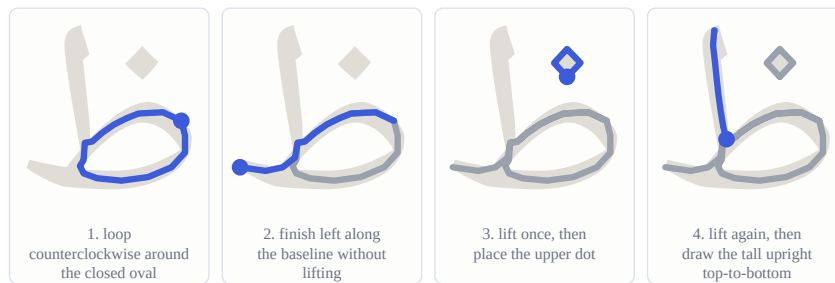
Script you’ll notice: ظ

ظ — ẓāʾ, a heavy *dh*.

It is inside الظهر (aḏ-ẓuhr), “noon”. It is ط, from the last lesson, with **one dot above**.

Writing: ظ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ط ظ, independent emphatic DHaa at 00:01.3-00:02.8 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ظ is written, stroke by stroke

- 1. start here: loop counterclockwise around the closed oval
- 2. finish left along the baseline without lifting

- **3.** lift once, then place the upper dot
- **4.** lift again, then draw the tall upright top-to-bottom — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 2.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet ط ظ, independent emphatic DHaa at 00:01.3–00:02.8 (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-23).

Your turn

- *Look:* at الظهر and point at ظ inside it
- *Trace it:* ظ three times, saying *z* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ط, then ظ, from memory
- *Read it:* الظهر aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ظ? (ḡāʾ, ḡ.) Which word did it come from? (الظهر, *aḡ-ḡuhr*, “noon”.)

49.3 ذ (dhāl) — the letter that opens ذهب

Before the new one: write ط and ظ once each, and name them.

Now say ذهب (*dhahaba*), “he went”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

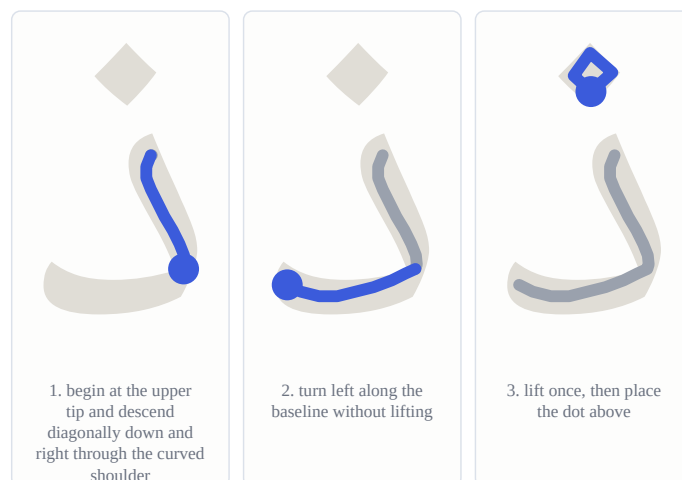
Script you’ll notice: ذ

ذ — *dhāl*, the *th* of English “this”.

It opens ذهب (*dhahaba*), “he went”, the first verb in this book. It is د (*dāl*) with **one dot above**, and like د it never joins to the letter after it.

Writing: ذ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: ذ, independent Dhaal body followed by its upper dot (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-21)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ذ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: begin at the upper tip and descend diagonally down and right through the curved shoulder
- **2.** turn left along the baseline without lifting
- **3.** lift once, then place the dot above — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Introduction to Arabic: Egyptian Arabic for first-year students, Alphabet: ذ, independent Dhaal body followed by its upper dot (University of Oregon Libraries Open Textbook, 2023; accessed 2026-08-21).

Your turn

- *Look:* at ذهب and point at ذ inside it

- *Trace it:* ذ three times, saying *dh* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ظ, then ذ, from memory
- *Read it:* ذهب aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ذ? (*dhāl*, *dh.*) Which word did it come from?
(ذهب, *dhahaba*, “he went”).

49.4 (fourteen letters) — Fourteen letters, fourteen words — a first pass

Write the letter that opens شكرًا, then the one that opens صباح.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
ش	<i>shān</i>	شكرا <i>shukran</i>
ص	<i>ṣād</i>	الخير صباح <i>ṣabāḥ</i> <i>al-khayr</i>
د	<i>dāl</i>	لله الحمد <i>al-ḥamdu lillāh</i>
إ	<i>alif with hamza below</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ى	<i>alif maqṣūra</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ف	<i>fāʾ</i>	عفوا <i>ʿafwan</i>
ق	<i>qāf</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ض	<i>ḍād</i>	من فضلك <i>min faḍlik</i>
آ	<i>alif madda</i>	آسف <i>āsif</i>
ز	<i>zāy</i>	أزرق <i>azraq</i>
غ	<i>ghayn</i>	إلى الغد <i>ilā l-ghad</i>
ط	<i>ṭāʾ</i>	طعام <i>ṭaʿām</i>
ظ	<i>ẓāʾ</i>	الظهر <i>az-ẓuhr</i>
ذ	<i>dhāl</i>	ذهب <i>dhahaba</i>

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from

- *Write it:* the four one-dot pairs side by side: ظ ط , ض ص , ز ر , ذ د

Before you move on

Which letters here never join to the letter after them? (ذ ز د, and the alifs ا إ.)

49.5 (fourteen letters) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Say *ilā l-liqāʿ*, then write the three new letters it holds.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
ش	<i>shīn</i>	شكرا <i>shukran</i>
ص	<i>ṣād</i>	الخير صباح <i>ṣabāḥ</i> <i>al-khayr</i>
د	<i>dāl</i>	الحمد لله <i>al-ḥamdu lillāh</i>
إ	<i>alif with hamza below</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ي	<i>alif maqṣūra</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ف	<i>fāʿ</i>	عفوا <i>ʿafwan</i>
ق	<i>qāf</i>	إلى اللقاء <i>ilā l-liqāʿ</i>
ض	<i>ḍād</i>	من فضلك <i>min faḍlik</i>
آ	<i>alif madda</i>	أسف <i>āsif</i>
ز	<i>zāy</i>	أزرق <i>azraq</i>
غ	<i>ghayn</i>	إلى الغد <i>ilā l-ghad</i>
ط	<i>ṭāʿ</i>	طعام <i>ṭaʿām</i>
ظ	<i>ẓāʿ</i>	الظهر <i>aẓ-ẓuhr</i>
ذ	<i>dhāl</i>	ذهب <i>dhahaba</i>

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* ف beside ق, and ع beside غ, and say how each pair differs
- *Write it:* ي beside ا, and إ beside ا

Before you move on

Which letter only ever ends a word? (ی, *alif maqṣūra*.) Which dot pattern makes ش from س? (**Three dots above.**)

Chapter 50

Eye, Ear, Nose, Mouth, Tooth

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an eye, an ear, a nose, a mouth and a tooth.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: i can say an eye, an ear, a nose, a mouth and a tooth.

50.1 عين (‘ayn) — an eye

Before the new one: say the Arabic for because, then the Arabic for when.

You’ll want to know: عين

عين — ‘ayn — “an eye”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ‘ayn
- Say it: ‘ayn, once more
- Say it: say ‘ayn

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for because, then the Arabic for when, then say *‘ayn* again

Before you move on

What does عين mean? (“An eye”.) Say it once more.

50.2 أذن (udhun) — an ear

Before the new one: say the Arabic for when, then the Arabic for an eye.

You’ll want to know: أذن

أذن — *udhun* — “an ear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *udhun*
- *Say it*: *udhun*, once more
- *Say it*: say *udhun*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for when, then the Arabic for an eye, then say *udhun* again

Before you move on

What does أذن mean? (“An ear”.) Say it once more.

50.3 أنف (anf) — a nose

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an eye, then the Arabic for an ear.

You'll want to know: أنف

أنف — *anf* — “a nose”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anf*
- *Say it: anf*, once more
- *Say it: say anf*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an eye, then the Arabic for an ear, then say *anf* again

Before you move on

What does أنف mean? (“A nose”.) Say it once more.

50.4 فم (fam) — a mouth

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an ear, then the Arabic for a nose.

You'll want to know: فم

فم — *fam* — “a mouth”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fam*
- *Say it: fam*, once more
- *Say it: say fam*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an ear, then the Arabic for a nose, then say *fam* again

Before you move on

What does فم mean? (“A mouth”.) Say it once more.

50.5 سن (sinn) — a tooth

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a nose, then the Arabic for a mouth.

You’ll want to know: سن

سن — *sinn* — “a tooth”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sinn*
- *Say it:* *sinn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sinn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a nose, then the Arabic for a mouth, then say *sinn* again

Before you move on

What does سن mean? (“A tooth”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Hair, Foot, Finger, Shoulder, Neck

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say hair, a foot, a finger, a shoulder and the neck.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: i can say hair, a foot, a finger, a shoulder and the neck.

51.1 شعر (sha^cr) — hair

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mouth, then the Arabic for a tooth.

You'll want to know: شعر

شعر — sha^cr — “hair”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: sha^cr
- Say it: sha^cr, once more
- Say it: say sha^cr

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a mouth, then the Arabic for a tooth, then say *sha^cr* again

Before you move on

What does شعر mean? (“Hair”.) Say it once more.

51.2 قدم (qadam) — a foot

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a tooth, then the Arabic for hair.

You’ll want to know: قدم

قدم — *qadam* — “a foot”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qadam*
- *Say it:* *qadam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qadam*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a tooth, then the Arabic for hair, then say *qadam* again

Before you move on

What does قدم mean? (“A foot”.) Say it once more.

51.3 إصبع (iṣba^c) — a finger

Before the new one: say the Arabic for hair, then the Arabic for a foot.

You'll want to know: إصبع

إصبع — *iṣba^c* — “a finger”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṣba^c*
- *Say it: iṣba^c, once more*
- *Say it: say iṣba^c*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for hair, then the Arabic for a foot, then say iṣba^c again*

Before you move on

What does إصبع mean? (“A finger”.) Say it once more.

51.4 كتف (katif) — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a foot, then the Arabic for a finger.

You'll want to know: كتف

كتف — *katif* — “a shoulder”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: katif*
- *Say it: katif, once more*
- *Say it: say katif*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a foot, then the Arabic for a finger, then say *katif* again

Before you move on

What does كنف mean? (“A shoulder”.) Say it once more.

51.5 رقبة (raqaba) — the neck

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a finger, then the Arabic for a shoulder.

You’ll want to know: رقبة

رقبة — *raqaba* — “the neck”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *raqaba*
- *Say it:* *raqaba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raqaba*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a finger, then the Arabic for a shoulder, then say *raqaba* again

Before you move on

What does رقبة mean? (“The neck”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Face, Blood, Knee, Back, Heart

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a face, blood, a knee, the back and the heart.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: i can say a face, blood, a knee, the back and the heart.

52.1 وجه (wajh) — a face

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a shoulder, then the Arabic for the neck.

You'll want to know: وجه

وجه — *wajh* — “a face”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wajh*
- *Say it: wajh, once more*
- *Say it: say wajh*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a shoulder, then the Arabic for the neck, then say *wajh* again

Before you move on

What does وجه mean? (“A face”.) Say it once more.

52.2 دم (dam) — blood

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the neck, then the Arabic for a face.

You’ll want to know: دم

دم — *dam* — “blood”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dam*
- *Say it:* *dam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dam*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the neck, then the Arabic for a face, then say *dam* again

Before you move on

What does دم mean? (“Blood”.) Say it once more.

52.3 ركبة (rukba) — a knee

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a face, then the Arabic for blood.

You'll want to know: ركبة

ركبة — *rukba* — “a knee”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rukba*
- *Say it: rukba*, once more
- *Say it: say rukba*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a face, then the Arabic for blood, then say *rukba* again

Before you move on

What does ركبة mean? (“A knee”.) Say it once more.

52.4 ظهر (*ẓahr*) — the back

Before the new one: say the Arabic for blood, then the Arabic for a knee.

You'll want to know: ظهر

ظهر — *ẓahr* — “the back”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ẓahr*
- *Say it: ẓahr*, once more
- *Say it: say ẓahr*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for blood, then the Arabic for a knee, then say *ẓahr* again

Before you move on

What does ظهر mean? (“The back”.) Say it once more.

52.5 قلب (qalb) — the heart

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a knee, then the Arabic for the back.

You’ll want to know: قلب

قلب — *qalb* — “the heart”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qalb*
- *Say it:* *qalb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qalb*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a knee, then the Arabic for the back, then say *qalb* again

Before you move on

What does قلب mean? (“The heart”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

Fever, Hospital, Ill, Pain, Medicine

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a fever, a hospital, ill, sick, pain and medicine.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: i can say a fever, a hospital, ill, sick, pain and medicine.

53.1 حمى (ḥummā) — a fever

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the back, then the Arabic for the heart.

You'll want to know: حمى

حمى — ḥummā — “a fever”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ḥummā
- Say it: ḥummā, once more
- Say it: say ḥummā

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for the back, then the Arabic for the heart, then say *ḥummā* again

Before you move on

What does حمى mean? (“A fever”.) Say it once more.

53.2 مستشفى (mustashfā) — a hospital

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the heart, then the Arabic for a fever.

You’ll want to know: مستشفى

مستشفى — *mustashfā* — “a hospital”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mustashfā*
- *Say it*: *mustashfā*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mustashfā*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for the heart, then the Arabic for a fever, then say *mustashfā* again

Before you move on

What does مستشفى mean? (“A hospital”.) Say it once more.

53.3 مريض (marīḍ) — ill, sick

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a fever, then the Arabic for a hospital.

You'll want to know: مريض

مريض — *marīḍ* — “ill, sick”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marīḍ*
- *Say it: marīḍ*, once more
- *Say it: say marīḍ*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a fever, then the Arabic for a hospital, then say marīḍ again*

Before you move on

What does مريض mean? (“Ill, sick”.) Say it once more.

53.4 ألم (alam) — pain

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a hospital, then the Arabic for ill.

You'll want to know: ألم

ألم — *alam* — “pain”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: alam*
- *Say it: alam*, once more
- *Say it: say alam*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a hospital, then the Arabic for ill, then say *alam* again

Before you move on

What does ألم mean? (“Pain”.) Say it once more.

53.5 دواء (dawāʾ) — medicine

Before the new one: say the Arabic for ill, then the Arabic for pain.

You’ll want to know: دواء

دواء — dawāʾ — “medicine”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* dawāʾ
- *Say it:* dawāʾ, once more
- *Say it:* say dawāʾ
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for ill, then the Arabic for pain, then say dawāʾ again

Before you move on

What does دواء mean? (“Medicine”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Hunger, Happy, Sad, Doctor, Grandfather

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say hunger, happy, sad, a doctor and a grandfather.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: i can say hunger, happy, sad, a doctor and a grandfather.

54.1 جوع (jū^c) — hunger

Before the new one: say the Arabic for pain, then the Arabic for medicine.

You'll want to know: جوع

جوع — jū^c — “hunger”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: jū^c
- Say it: jū^c, once more

- *Say it:* say $jū^c$
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for pain, then the Arabic for medicine, then say $jū^c$ again

Before you move on

What does جوع mean? (“Hunger”.) Say it once more.

54.2 سعيد ($sa^cīd$) — happy

Before the new one: say the Arabic for medicine, then the Arabic for hunger.

You’ll want to know: سعيد

سعيد — $sa^cīd$ — “happy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* $sa^cīd$
- *Say it:* $sa^cīd$, once more
- *Say it:* say $sa^cīd$
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for medicine, then the Arabic for hunger, then say $sa^cīd$ again

Before you move on

What does سعيد mean? (“Happy”.) Say it once more.

54.3 حزين ($ḥazīn$) — sad

Before the new one: say the Arabic for hunger, then the Arabic for happy.

You'll want to know: حزين

حزين — *ḥazīn* — “sad”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ḥazīn
- *Say it:* ḥazīn, once more
- *Say it:* say ḥazīn
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for hunger, then the Arabic for happy, then say ḥazīn again

Before you move on

What does حزين mean? (“Sad”.) Say it once more.

54.4 طبيب (ṭabīb) — a doctor

Before the new one: say the Arabic for happy, then the Arabic for sad.

You'll want to know: طبيب

طبيب — *ṭabīb* — “a doctor”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ṭabīb
- *Say it:* ṭabīb, once more
- *Say it:* say ṭabīb

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for happy, then the Arabic for sad, then say *ṭabīb* again

Before you move on

What does طيب mean? (“A doctor”.) Say it once more.

54.5 جد (jadd) — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the Arabic for sad, then the Arabic for a doctor.

You’ll want to know: جد

جد — *jadd* — “a grandfather”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jadd*
- *Say it:* *jadd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jadd*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for sad, then the Arabic for a doctor, then say *jadd* again

Before you move on

What does جد mean? (“A grandfather”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

Grandmother, Uncle, Uncle, Husband, Wife

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a grandmother, an uncle, an uncle, a husband and a wife.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: i can say a grandmother, an uncle, an uncle, a husband and a wife.

55.1 جدة (jadda) — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a doctor, then the Arabic for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: جدة

جدة — *jadda* — “a grandmother”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *jadda*
- Say it: *jadda*, once more

- *Say it:* say *jadda*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a doctor, then the Arabic for a grandfather, then say *jadda* again

Before you move on

What does جدة mean? (“A grandmother”). Say it once more.

55.2 عم (‘amm) — an uncle (father’s brother)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a grandfather, then the Arabic for a grandmother.

You’ll want to know: عم

عم — ‘amm — “an uncle (father’s brother)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ‘amm
- *Say it:* ‘amm, once more
- *Say it:* say ‘amm
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a grandfather, then the Arabic for a grandmother, then say ‘amm again

Before you move on

What does عم mean? (“An uncle (father’s brother)”). Say it once more.

55.3 خال (khāl) — an uncle (mother’s brother)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a grandmother, then the Arabic for an uncle.

You'll want to know: خال

خال — *khāl* — “an uncle (mother’s brother)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *khāl*
- *Say it:* *khāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khāl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a grandmother, then the Arabic for an uncle, then say *khāl* again

Before you move on

What does خال mean? (“An uncle (mother’s brother)”.) Say it once more.

55.4 زوج (zawj) — a husband

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an uncle, then the Arabic for an uncle.

You'll want to know: زوج

زوج — *zawj* — “a husband”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zawj*
- *Say it:* *zawj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zawj*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an uncle, then the Arabic for an uncle, then say *zawj* again

Before you move on

What does زوج mean? (“A husband”.) Say it once more.

55.5 زوجة (zawja) — a wife

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an uncle, then the Arabic for a husband.

You’ll want to know: زوجة

زوجة — *zawja* — “a wife”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zawja*
- *Say it:* *zawja*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zawja*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an uncle, then the Arabic for a husband, then say *zawja* again

Before you move on

What does زوجة mean? (“A wife”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

Child, Boy, Man, Woman, Guest

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a child, a boy, a man, a woman and a guest.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: i can say a child, a boy, a man, a woman and a guest.

56.1 طفل (ṭifl) — a child

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a husband, then the Arabic for a wife.

You'll want to know: طفل

طفل — ṭifl — “a child”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭifl
- Say it: ṭifl, once more
- Say it: say ṭifl

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a husband, then the Arabic for a wife, then say *tifl* again

Before you move on

What does **طفل** mean? (“A child”.) Say it once more.

56.2 ولد (walad) — a boy

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a wife, then the Arabic for a child.

You’ll want to know: ولد

ولد — *walad* — “a boy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *walad*
- *Say it:* *walad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *walad*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a wife, then the Arabic for a child, then say *walad* again

Before you move on

What does **ولد** mean? (“A boy”.) Say it once more.

56.3 رجل (rajul) — a man

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a child, then the Arabic for a boy.

You'll want to know: رجل

رجل — *rajul* — “a man”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rajul*
- *Say it: rajul*, once more
- *Say it: say rajul*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a child, then the Arabic for a boy, then say *rajul* again

Before you move on

What does رجل mean? (“A man”.) Say it once more.

56.4 امرأة (imraʿa) — a woman

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a boy, then the Arabic for a man.

You'll want to know: امرأة

امرأة — *imraʿa* — “a woman”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: imraʿa*
- *Say it: imraʿa*, once more
- *Say it: say imraʿa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a boy, then the Arabic for a man, then say *imraʿa* again

Before you move on

What does امرأة mean? (“A woman”.) Say it once more.

56.5 ضيف (ḍayf) — a guest

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a man, then the Arabic for a woman.

You’ll want to know: ضيف

ضيف — *ḍayf* — “a guest”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍayf*
- *Say it:* *ḍayf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍayf*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a man, then the Arabic for a woman, then say *ḍayf* again

Before you move on

What does ضيف mean? (“A guest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Teacher, To drink, To hear, To sit, To sleep

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a teacher, to drink, to hear, to sit and to sleep.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: i can say a teacher, to drink, to hear, to sit and to sleep.

57.1 معلم (mu^callim) — a teacher

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a woman, then the Arabic for a guest.

You'll want to know: معلم

معلم — *mu^callim* — “a teacher”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *mu^callim*
- Say it: *mu^callim*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mu‘allim*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a woman, then the Arabic for a guest, then say *mu‘allim* again

Before you move on

What does معلم mean? (“A teacher”.) Say it once more.

57.2 شرب (shariba) — to drink (he drank)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a guest, then the Arabic for a teacher.

You’ll want to know: شرب

شرب — *shariba* — “to drink (he drank)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *shariba*
- *Say it:* *shariba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shariba*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a guest, then the Arabic for a teacher, then say *shariba* again

Before you move on

What does شرب mean? (“To drink (he drank)”.) Say it once more.

57.3 سمع (sami‘a) — to hear (he heard)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a teacher, then the Arabic for to drink.

You'll want to know: سمع

سمع — *sami'a* — “to hear (he heard)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sami'a*
- *Say it: sami'a*, once more
- *Say it: say sami'a*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a teacher, then the Arabic for to drink, then say *sami'a* again

Before you move on

What does سمع mean? (“To hear (he heard)”). Say it once more.

57.4 جلس (*jalasa*) — to sit (he sat)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to drink, then the Arabic for to hear.

You'll want to know: جلس

جلس — *jalasa* — “to sit (he sat)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jalasa*
- *Say it: jalasa*, once more
- *Say it: say jalasa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to drink, then the Arabic for to hear, then say *jalasa* again

Before you move on

What does **جلس** mean? (“To sit (he sat)”). Say it once more.

57.5 نام (nāma) — to sleep (he slept)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to hear, then the Arabic for to sit.

You’ll want to know: نام

نام — *nāma* — “to sleep (he slept)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāma*
- *Say it:* *nāma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāma*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to hear, then the Arabic for to sit, then say *nāma* again

Before you move on

What does **نام** mean? (“To sleep (he slept)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 58

To stand up, To walk, To run, To play, To buy

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to stand up, to walk, to run, to play and to buy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: i can say to stand up, to walk, to run, to play and to buy.

58.1 قام (qāma) — to stand up (he stood up)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to sit, then the Arabic for to sleep.

You'll want to know: قام

قام — *qāma* — “to stand up (he stood up)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *qāma*
- Say it: *qāma*, once more

- *Say it:* say *qāma*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to sit, then the Arabic for to sleep, then say *qāma* again

Before you move on

What does قام mean? (“To stand up (he stood up)”). Say it once more.

58.2 مشى (mashā) — to walk (he walked)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to sleep, then the Arabic for to stand up.

You’ll want to know: مشى

مشى — *mashā* — “to walk (he walked)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mashā*
- *Say it:* *mashā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mashā*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to sleep, then the Arabic for to stand up, then say *mashā* again

Before you move on

What does مشى mean? (“To walk (he walked)”). Say it once more.

58.3 ركض (rakada) — to run (he ran)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to stand up, then the Arabic for to walk.

You'll want to know: ركض

ركض — *rakaḍa* — “to run (he ran)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rakaḍa*
- *Say it: rakaḍa, once more*
- *Say it: say rakaḍa*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for to stand up, then the Arabic for to walk, then say rakaḍa again*

Before you move on

What does ركض mean? (“To run (he ran)”). Say it once more.

58.4 لعب (*laʿiba*) — to play (he played)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to walk, then the Arabic for to run.

You'll want to know: لعب

لعب — *laʿiba* — “to play (he played)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laʿiba*
- *Say it: laʿiba, once more*
- *Say it: say laʿiba*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to walk, then the Arabic for to run, then say *la‘iba* again

Before you move on

What does لعب mean? (“To play (he played)”). Say it once more.

58.5 اشتری (ishtarā) — to buy (he bought)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to run, then the Arabic for to play.

You’ll want to know: اشتری

اشتری — *ishtarā* — “to buy (he bought)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ishtarā*
- *Say it:* *ishtarā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ishtarā*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to run, then the Arabic for to play, then say *ishtarā* again

Before you move on

What does اشتری mean? (“To buy (he bought)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 59

To sell, To give, To put, To open, To close

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to sell, to give, to put, to open and to close.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: i can say to sell, to give, to put, to open and to close.

59.1 باع (bā^ca) — to sell (he sold)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to play, then the Arabic for to buy.

You'll want to know: باع

باع — bā^ca — “to sell (he sold)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: bā^ca
- Say it: bā^ca, once more

- *Say it:* say $bā^c a$
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to play, then the Arabic for to buy, then say $bā^c a$ again

Before you move on

What does باع mean? (“To sell (he sold)”). Say it once more.

59.2 أعطى ($a^c t ā$) — to give (he gave)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to buy, then the Arabic for to sell.

You’ll want to know: أعطى

أعطى — $a^c t ā$ — “to give (he gave)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* $a^c t ā$
- *Say it:* $a^c t ā$, once more
- *Say it:* say $a^c t ā$
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to buy, then the Arabic for to sell, then say $a^c t ā$ again

Before you move on

What does أعطى mean? (“To give (he gave)”). Say it once more.

59.3 وضع ($wāḍ a^c a$) — to put (he put)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to sell, then the Arabic for to give.

You'll want to know: وضع

وضع — *wadaʿa* — “to put (he put)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wadaʿa*
- *Say it: wadaʿa*, once more
- *Say it: say wadaʿa*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for to sell, then the Arabic for to give, then say wadaʿa again*

Before you move on

What does وضع mean? (“To put (he put)”). Say it once more.

59.4 فتح (*fataḥa*) — to open (he opened)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to give, then the Arabic for to put.

You'll want to know: فتح

فتح — *fataḥa* — “to open (he opened)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fataḥa*
- *Say it: fataḥa*, once more
- *Say it: say fataḥa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to give, then the Arabic for to put, then say *fataḥa* again

Before you move on

What does فتح mean? (“To open (he opened).”) Say it once more.

59.5 أَغْلَقَ (aghlaqa) — to close (he closed)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to put, then the Arabic for to open.

You’ll want to know: أَغْلَقَ

أغْلَقَ — *aghlaqa* — “to close (he closed)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aghlaqa*
- *Say it:* *aghlaqa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aghlaqa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to put, then the Arabic for to open, then say *aghlaqa* again

Before you move on

What does أَغْلَقَ mean? (“To close (he closed).”) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

To cook, To wash, To laugh, To cry, To dance

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to cook, to wash, to laugh, to cry and to dance.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: i can say to cook, to wash, to laugh, to cry and to dance.

60.1 طبخ (ṭabakha) — to cook (he cooked)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to open, then the Arabic for to close.

You'll want to know: طبخ

طبخ — ṭabakha — “to cook (he cooked)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭabakha
- Say it: ṭabakha, once more

- *Say it:* say *ṭabakha*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to open, then the Arabic for to close, then say *ṭabakha* again

Before you move on

What does طبخ mean? (“To cook (he cooked)”). Say it once more.

60.2 غسل (ghasala) — to wash (he washed)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to close, then the Arabic for to cook.

You’ll want to know: غسل

غسل — *ghasala* — “to wash (he washed)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ghasala*
- *Say it:* *ghasala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghasala*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to close, then the Arabic for to cook, then say *ghasala* again

Before you move on

What does غسل mean? (“To wash (he washed)”). Say it once more.

60.3 ضحك (ḍahika) — to laugh (he laughed)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to cook, then the Arabic for to wash.

You'll want to know: ضحك

ضحك — *ḍaḥika* — “to laugh (he laughed)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍaḥika*
- *Say it:* *ḍaḥika*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍaḥika*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to cook, then the Arabic for to wash, then say *ḍaḥika* again

Before you move on

What does ضحك mean? (“To laugh (he laughed)”) Say it once more.

60.4 بكي (bakā) — to cry (he cried)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to wash, then the Arabic for to laugh.

You'll want to know: بكي

بكي — *bakā* — “to cry (he cried)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bakā*
- *Say it:* *bakā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bakā*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to wash, then the Arabic for to laugh, then say *bakā* again

Before you move on

What does بكي mean? (“To cry (he cried)”). Say it once more.

60.5 رقص (raqaṣa) — to dance (he danced)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to laugh, then the Arabic for to cry.

You’ll want to know: رقص

رقص — *raqaṣa* — “to dance (he danced)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *raqaṣa*
- *Say it:* *raqaṣa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raqaṣa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to laugh, then the Arabic for to cry, then say *raqaṣa* again

Before you move on

What does رقص mean? (“To dance (he danced)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 61

To learn, To forget, To want, To send, To cut

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to learn, to forget, to want, to send and to cut.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: i can say to learn, to forget, to want, to send and to cut.

61.1 تعلم (ta^callama) — to learn (he learned)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to cry, then the Arabic for to dance.

You'll want to know: تعلم

تعلم — ta^callama — “to learn (he learned)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ta^callama
- Say it: ta^callama, once more

- *Say it:* say *ta'allama*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to cry, then the Arabic for to dance, then say *ta'allama* again

Before you move on

What does **تعلم** mean? (“To learn (he learned)”). Say it once more.

61.2 نسي (nasiya) — to forget (he forgot)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to dance, then the Arabic for to learn.

You’ll want to know: نسي

نسي — *nasiya* — “to forget (he forgot)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nasiya*
- *Say it:* *nasiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nasiya*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to dance, then the Arabic for to learn, then say *nasiya* again

Before you move on

What does **نسي** mean? (“To forget (he forgot)”). Say it once more.

61.3 أراد (arāda) — to want (he wanted)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to learn, then the Arabic for to forget.

You'll want to know: أَرَادَ

أَرَادَ — *arāda* — “to want (he wanted)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arāda*
- *Say it: arāda, once more*
- *Say it: say arāda*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for to learn, then the Arabic for to forget, then say arāda again*

Before you move on

What does أَرَادَ mean? (“To want (he wanted)”). Say it once more.

61.4 أَرْسَلَ (*arsala*) — to send (he sent)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to forget, then the Arabic for to want.

You'll want to know: أَرْسَلَ

أَرْسَلَ — *arsala* — “to send (he sent)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arsala*
- *Say it: arsala, once more*
- *Say it: say arsala*

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for to forget, then the Arabic for to want, then say *arsala* again

Before you move on

What does أرسل mean? (“To send (he sent)”). Say it once more.

61.5 قطع (qaṭaʿa) — to cut (he cut)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to want, then the Arabic for to send.

You’ll want to know: قطع

قطع — *qaṭaʿa* — “to cut (he cut)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *qaṭaʿa*
- *Say it*: *qaṭaʿa*, once more
- *Say it*: say *qaṭaʿa*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for to want, then the Arabic for to send, then say *qaṭaʿa* again

Before you move on

What does قطع mean? (“To cut (he cut)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 62

To stop, To look for, To find, To wear, To leave

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to stop, to look for, to find, to wear and to leave.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: i can say to stop, to look for, to find, to wear and to leave.

62.1 وقف (waqafa) — to stop (he stopped)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to send, then the Arabic for to cut.

You'll want to know: وقف

وقف — *waqafa* — “to stop (he stopped)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *waqafa*
- Say it: *waqafa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *waqafa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to send, then the Arabic for to cut, then say *waqafa* again

Before you move on

What does وقف mean? (“To stop (he stopped)”). Say it once more.

62.2 بحث (baḥatha) — to look for (he looked for)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to cut, then the Arabic for to stop.

You’ll want to know: بحث

بحث — *baḥatha* — “to look for (he looked for)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baḥatha*
- *Say it:* *baḥatha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baḥatha*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to cut, then the Arabic for to stop, then say *baḥatha* again

Before you move on

What does بحث mean? (“To look for (he looked for)”). Say it once more.

62.3 وجد (wajada) — to find (he found)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to stop, then the Arabic for to look for.

You'll want to know: وجد

وجد — *wajada* — “to find (he found)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: wajada*
- *Say it: wajada*, once more
- *Say it: say wajada*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to stop, then the Arabic for to look for, then say *wajada* again

Before you move on

What does وجد mean? (“To find (he found)”). Say it once more.

62.4 لبس (labisa) — to wear (he wore)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to look for, then the Arabic for to find.

You'll want to know: لبس

لبس — *labisa* — “to wear (he wore)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: labisa*
- *Say it: labisa*, once more
- *Say it: say labisa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to look for, then the Arabic for to find, then say *labisa* again

Before you move on

What does لبس mean? (“To wear (he wore)”). Say it once more.

62.5 ترك (taraka) — to leave (he left)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to find, then the Arabic for to wear.

You’ll want to know: ترك

ترك — *taraka* — “to leave (he left)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taraka*
- *Say it:* *taraka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taraka*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to find, then the Arabic for to wear, then say *taraka* again

Before you move on

What does ترك mean? (“To leave (he left)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 63

To throw, To fly, To swim, To make, To enter

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to throw, to fly, to swim, to make and to enter.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: i can say to throw, to fly, to swim, to make and to enter.

63.1 رمى (ramā) — to throw (he threw)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to wear, then the Arabic for to leave.

You'll want to know: رمى

رمى — ramā — “to throw (he threw)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ramā
- Say it: ramā, once more

- *Say it:* say *ramā*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to wear, then the Arabic for to leave, then say *ramā* again

Before you move on

What does رمى mean? (“To throw (he threw).”) Say it once more.

63.2 طار (ṭāra) — to fly (he flew)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to leave, then the Arabic for to throw.

You’ll want to know: طار

طار — ṭāra — “to fly (he flew).”

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ṭāra
- *Say it:* ṭāra, once more
- *Say it:* say ṭāra
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to leave, then the Arabic for to throw, then say ṭāra again

Before you move on

What does طار mean? (“To fly (he flew).”) Say it once more.

63.3 سبح (sabaḥa) — to swim (he swam)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to throw, then the Arabic for to fly.

You'll want to know: سباح

سباح — *sabaḥa* — “to swim (he swam)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sabaḥa*
- *Say it: sabaḥa*, once more
- *Say it: say sabaḥa*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for to throw, then the Arabic for to fly, then say sabaḥa again*

Before you move on

What does سباح mean? (“To swim (he swam)”). Say it once more.

63.4 صنع (*ṣanaʿa*) — to make (he made)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to fly, then the Arabic for to swim.

You'll want to know: صنع

صنع — *ṣanaʿa* — “to make (he made)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṣanaʿa*
- *Say it: ṣanaʿa*, once more
- *Say it: say ṣanaʿa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to fly, then the Arabic for to swim, then say *ṣanaʿa* again

Before you move on

What does صنع mean? (“To make (he made)”). Say it once more.

63.5 دخل (dakhala) — to enter (he entered)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to swim, then the Arabic for to make.

You’ll want to know: دخل

دخل — *dakhala* — “to enter (he entered)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dakhala*
- *Say it:* *dakhala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dakhala*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to swim, then the Arabic for to make, then say *dakhala* again

Before you move on

What does دخل mean? (“To enter (he entered)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 64

To go out, To work, To live, To wait, To come back

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to go out, to work, to live, to wait and to come back.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: i can say to go out, to work, to live, to wait and to come back.

64.1 خرج (kharaja) — to go out (he went out)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to make, then the Arabic for to enter.

You'll want to know: خرج

خرج — *kharaja* — “to go out (he went out)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kharaja*
- Say it: *kharaja*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kharaja*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to make, then the Arabic for to enter, then say *kharaja* again

Before you move on

What does خرج mean? (“To go out (he went out)”). Say it once more.

64.2 عمل (*ʿamila*) — to work (he worked)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to enter, then the Arabic for to go out.

You’ll want to know: عمل

عمل — *ʿamila* — “to work (he worked)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ʿamila*
- *Say it:* *ʿamila*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ʿamila*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to enter, then the Arabic for to go out, then say *ʿamila* again

Before you move on

What does عمل mean? (“To work (he worked)”). Say it once more.

64.3 سكن (*sakana*) — to live (he lived)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to go out, then the Arabic for to work.

You'll want to know: سكن

سكن — *sakana* — “to live (he lived)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sakana*
- *Say it: sakana*, once more
- *Say it: say sakana*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for to go out, then the Arabic for to work, then say sakana again*

Before you move on

What does سكن mean? (“To live (he lived)”). Say it once more.

64.4 انتظر (*intazara*) — to wait (he waited)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to work, then the Arabic for to live.

You'll want to know: انتظر

انتظر — *intazara* — “to wait (he waited)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: intazara*
- *Say it: intazara*, once more
- *Say it: say intazara*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to work, then the Arabic for to live, then say *intazara* again

Before you move on

What does انتظر mean? (“To wait (he waited)”). Say it once more.

64.5 رجع (raja^a) — to come back (he came back)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to live, then the Arabic for to wait.

You’ll want to know: رجع

رجع — *raja^a* — “to come back (he came back)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *raja^a*
- *Say it:* *raja^a*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raja^a*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to live, then the Arabic for to wait, then say *raja^a* again

Before you move on

What does رجع mean? (“To come back (he came back)”). Say it once more.

Chapter 65

To speak, To carry, To win, To go down, Fish

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to speak, to carry, to win, to go down and fish.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: i can say to speak, to carry, to win, to go down and fish.

65.1 تكلم (takallama) — to speak (he spoke)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to wait, then the Arabic for to come back.

You'll want to know: تكلم

تكلم — *takallama* — “to speak (he spoke)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *takallama*
- Say it: *takallama*, once more

- *Say it:* say *takallama*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to wait, then the Arabic for to come back, then say *takallama* again

Before you move on

What does **تكلم** mean? (“To speak (he spoke)”). Say it once more.

65.2 حمل (*ḥamala*) — to carry (he carried)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to come back, then the Arabic for to speak.

You’ll want to know: حمل

حمل — *ḥamala* — “to carry (he carried)”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḥamala*
- *Say it:* *ḥamala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḥamala*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to come back, then the Arabic for to speak, then say *ḥamala* again

Before you move on

What does **حمل** mean? (“To carry (he carried)”). Say it once more.

65.3 فاز (*fāza*) — to win (he won)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to speak, then the Arabic for to carry.

You'll want to know: فاز

فاز — *fāza* — “to win (he won)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāza*
- *Say it: fāza*, once more
- *Say it: say fāza*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to speak, then the Arabic for to carry, then say *fāza* again

Before you move on

What does فاز mean? (“To win (he won)”). Say it once more.

65.4 نزل (*nazala*) — to go down (he went down)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to carry, then the Arabic for to win.

You'll want to know: نزل

نزل — *nazala* — “to go down (he went down)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nazala*
- *Say it: nazala*, once more
- *Say it: say nazala*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to carry, then the Arabic for to win, then say *nazala* again

Before you move on

What does نزل mean? (“To go down (he went down).”) Say it once more.

65.5 سمك (samak) — fish

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to win, then the Arabic for to go down.

You’ll want to know: سمك

سمك — *samak* — “fish”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *samak*
- *Say it:* *samak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samak*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to win, then the Arabic for to go down, then say *samak* again

Before you move on

What does سمك mean? (“Fish.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

Rice, Fruit, Apple, Bananas, Potatoes

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say rice, fruit, an apple, bananas and potatoes.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: i can say rice, fruit, an apple, bananas and potatoes.

66.1 أرز (aruzz) — rice

Before the new one: say the Arabic for to go down, then the Arabic for fish.

You'll want to know: أرز

أرز — *aruzz* — “rice”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *aruzz*
- Say it: *aruzz*, once more

- *Say it:* say *aruzz*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for to go down, then the Arabic for fish, then say *aruzz* again

Before you move on

What does أرز mean? (“Rice”.) Say it once more.

66.2 فاكهة (fākiha) — fruit

Before the new one: say the Arabic for fish, then the Arabic for rice.

You’ll want to know: فاكهة

فاكهة — *fākiha* — “fruit”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fākiha*
- *Say it:* *fākiha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fākiha*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for fish, then the Arabic for rice, then say *fākiha* again

Before you move on

What does فاكهة mean? (“Fruit”.) Say it once more.

66.3 تفاحة (tuffāḥa) — an apple

Before the new one: say the Arabic for rice, then the Arabic for fruit.

You'll want to know: تفاحة

تفاحة — *tuffāḥa* — “an apple”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tuffāḥa*
- *Say it:* *tuffāḥa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuffāḥa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for rice, then the Arabic for fruit, then say *tuffāḥa* again

Before you move on

What does تفاحة mean? (“An apple”.) Say it once more.

66.4 موز (mawz) — bananas

Before the new one: say the Arabic for fruit, then the Arabic for an apple.

You'll want to know: موز

موز — *mawz* — “bananas”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mawz*
- *Say it:* *mawz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mawz*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for fruit, then the Arabic for an apple, then say *mawz* again

Before you move on

What does موز mean? (“Bananas”.) Say it once more.

66.5 بطاطس (baṭāṭis) — potatoes

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an apple, then the Arabic for bananas.

You’ll want to know: بطاطس

بطاطس — *baṭāṭis* — “potatoes”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baṭāṭis*
- *Say it:* *baṭāṭis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṭāṭis*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an apple, then the Arabic for bananas, then say *baṭāṭis* again

Before you move on

What does بطاطس mean? (“Potatoes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Tomatoes, Carrots, Butter, Honey, Grapes

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say tomatoes, carrots, butter, honey and grapes.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: i can say tomatoes, carrots, butter, honey and grapes.

67.1 طماطم (ṭamāṭim) — tomatoes

Before the new one: say the Arabic for bananas, then the Arabic for potatoes.

You'll want to know: طماطم

طماطم — ṭamāṭim — “tomatoes”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭamāṭim
- Say it: ṭamāṭim, once more

- *Say it:* say *ṭamāṭim*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for bananas, then the Arabic for potatoes, then say *ṭamāṭim* again

Before you move on

What does طماطم mean? (“Tomatoes”.) Say it once more.

67.2 جزر (jazar) — carrots

Before the new one: say the Arabic for potatoes, then the Arabic for tomatoes.

You’ll want to know: جزر

جزر — *jazar* — “carrots”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jazar*
- *Say it:* *jazar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jazar*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for potatoes, then the Arabic for tomatoes, then say *jazar* again

Before you move on

What does جزر mean? (“Carrots”.) Say it once more.

67.3 زبدة (zubda) — butter

Before the new one: say the Arabic for tomatoes, then the Arabic for carrots.

You'll want to know: زبدة

زبدة — *zubda* — “butter”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zubda*
- *Say it:* *zubda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zubda*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for tomatoes, then the Arabic for carrots, then say *zubda* again

Before you move on

What does زبدة mean? (“Butter”.) Say it once more.

67.4 عسل (ʿasal) — honey

Before the new one: say the Arabic for carrots, then the Arabic for butter.

You'll want to know: عسل

عسل — *ʿasal* — “honey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ʿasal*
- *Say it:* *ʿasal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ʿasal*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for carrots, then the Arabic for butter, then say *ʿasal* again

Before you move on

What does عسل mean? (“Honey”.) Say it once more.

67.5 عنب (ʿinab) — grapes

Before the new one: say the Arabic for butter, then the Arabic for honey.

You’ll want to know: عنب

عنب — *ʿinab* — “grapes”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ʿinab*
- *Say it:* *ʿinab*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ʿinab*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for butter, then the Arabic for honey, then say *ʿinab* again

Before you move on

What does عنب mean? (“Grapes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Oranges, Lemons, Eggs, Onions, Breakfast

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say oranges, lemons, eggs, onions and breakfast.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: i can say oranges, lemons, eggs, onions and breakfast.

68.1 برتقال (burtuqāl) — oranges

Before the new one: say the Arabic for honey, then the Arabic for grapes.

You'll want to know: برتقال

برتقال — *burtuqāl* — “oranges”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *burtuqāl*
- Say it: *burtuqāl*, once more

- *Say it:* say *burtuqāl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for honey, then the Arabic for grapes, then say *burtuqāl* again

Before you move on

What does برتقال mean? (“Oranges”.) Say it once more.

68.2 ليمون (laymūn) — lemons

Before the new one: say the Arabic for grapes, then the Arabic for oranges.

You’ll want to know: ليمون

ليمون — *laymūn* — “lemons”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *laymūn*
- *Say it:* *laymūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laymūn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for grapes, then the Arabic for oranges, then say *laymūn* again

Before you move on

What does ليمون mean? (“Lemons”.) Say it once more.

68.3 بيض (bayḍ) — eggs

Before the new one: say the Arabic for oranges, then the Arabic for lemons.

You'll want to know: بيض

بيض — *bayḍ* — “eggs”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* bayḍ
- *Say it:* bayḍ, once more
- *Say it:* say bayḍ
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for oranges, then the Arabic for lemons, then say bayḍ again

Before you move on

What does بيض mean? (“Eggs”.) Say it once more.

68.4 بصل (baṣal) — onions

Before the new one: say the Arabic for lemons, then the Arabic for eggs.

You'll want to know: بصل

بصل — *baṣal* — “onions”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* baṣal
- *Say it:* baṣal, once more
- *Say it:* say baṣal

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for lemons, then the Arabic for eggs, then say *baṣal* again

Before you move on

What does بصل mean? (“Onions”.) Say it once more.

68.5 فطور (fuṭūr) — breakfast

Before the new one: say the Arabic for eggs, then the Arabic for onions.

You’ll want to know: فطور

فطور — *fuṭūr* — “breakfast”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fuṭūr*
- *Say it:* *fuṭūr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fuṭūr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for eggs, then the Arabic for onions, then say *fuṭūr* again

Before you move on

What does فطور mean? (“Breakfast”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Juice, Chicken, House, Room, Window

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say juice, chicken, a house, a room and a window.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: i can say juice, chicken, a house, a room and a window.

69.1 عصير (ʿaṣīr) — juice

Before the new one: say the Arabic for onions, then the Arabic for breakfast.

You'll want to know: عصير

عصير — ʿaṣīr — “juice”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ʿaṣīr
- Say it: ʿaṣīr, once more

- *Say it:* say *‘aṣīr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for onions, then the Arabic for breakfast, then say *‘aṣīr* again

Before you move on

What does عصير mean? (“Juice”.) Say it once more.

69.2 دجاج (dajāj) — chicken

Before the new one: say the Arabic for breakfast, then the Arabic for juice.

You’ll want to know: دجاج

دجاج — *dajāj* — “chicken”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dajāj*
- *Say it:* *dajāj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dajāj*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for breakfast, then the Arabic for juice, then say *dajāj* again

Before you move on

What does دجاج mean? (“Chicken”.) Say it once more.

69.3 منزل (manzil) — a house

Before the new one: say the Arabic for juice, then the Arabic for chicken.

You'll want to know: منزل

منزل — *manzil* — “a house”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manzil*
- *Say it: manzil*, once more
- *Say it: say manzil*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for juice, then the Arabic for chicken, then say manzil again*

Before you move on

What does منزل mean? (“A house”.) Say it once more.

69.4 غرفة (ghurfa) — a room

Before the new one: say the Arabic for chicken, then the Arabic for a house.

You'll want to know: غرفة

غرفة — *ghurfa* — “a room”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghurfa*
- *Say it: ghurfa*, once more
- *Say it: say ghurfa*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for chicken, then the Arabic for a house, then say *ghurfa* again

Before you move on

What does غرفة mean? (“A room”.) Say it once more.

69.5 نافذة (nāfidha) — a window

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a house, then the Arabic for a room.

You’ll want to know: نافذة

نافذة — *nāfidha* — “a window”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāfidha*
- *Say it:* *nāfidha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāfidha*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a house, then the Arabic for a room, then say *nāfidha* again

Before you move on

What does نافذة mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Chair, Table, Wall, Bed, Floor

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a chair, a table, a wall, a bed and the floor.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: i can say a chair, a table, a wall, a bed and the floor.

70.1 كرسي (kursī) — a chair

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a room, then the Arabic for a window.

You'll want to know: كرسي

كرسي — *kursī* — “a chair”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kursī*
- Say it: *kursī*, once more
- Say it: say *kursī*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a room, then the Arabic for a window, then say *kursī* again

Before you move on

What does كرسي mean? (“A chair”.) Say it once more.

70.2 طاولة (ṭāwila) — a table

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a window, then the Arabic for a chair.

You’ll want to know: طاولة

طاولة — ṭāwila — “a table”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ṭāwila
- *Say it:* ṭāwila, once more
- *Say it:* say ṭāwila
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a window, then the Arabic for a chair, then say ṭāwila again

Before you move on

What does طاولة mean? (“A table”.) Say it once more.

70.3 جدار (jidār) — a wall

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a chair, then the Arabic for a table.

You'll want to know: جدار

جدار — *jidār* — “a wall”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jidār*
- *Say it:* *jidār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jidār*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a chair, then the Arabic for a table, then say *jidār* again

Before you move on

What does جدار mean? (“A wall”.) Say it once more.

70.4 سرير (sarīr) — a bed

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a table, then the Arabic for a wall.

You'll want to know: سرير

سرير — *sarīr* — “a bed”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sarīr*
- *Say it:* *sarīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sarīr*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a table, then the Arabic for a wall, then say *sarīr* again

Before you move on

What does سرير mean? (“A bed”.) Say it once more.

70.5 أرض (ard) — the floor; the earth

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a wall, then the Arabic for a bed.

You’ll want to know: أرض

أرض — *ard* — “the floor; the earth”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ard*
- *Say it:* *ard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ard*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a wall, then the Arabic for a bed, then say *ard* again

Before you move on

What does أرض mean? (“The floor; the earth”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Mirror, Lamp, Key, Plate, Knife

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a mirror, a lamp, a key, a plate and a knife.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: i can say a mirror, a lamp, a key, a plate and a knife.

71.1 مرآة (mirʿāh) — a mirror

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bed, then the Arabic for the floor; the earth.

You'll want to know: مرآة

مرآة — *mirʿāh* — “a mirror”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *mirʿāh*
- Say it: *mirʿāh*, once more
- Say it: say *mirʿāh*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bed, then the Arabic for the floor; the earth, then say *mirʿāh* again

Before you move on

What does مرآة mean? (“A mirror”.) Say it once more.

71.2 مصباح (miṣbāḥ) — a lamp

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the floor; the earth, then the Arabic for a mirror.

You’ll want to know: مصباح

مصباح — *miṣbāḥ* — “a lamp”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *miṣbāḥ*
- *Say it:* *miṣbāḥ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miṣbāḥ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the floor; the earth, then the Arabic for a mirror, then say *miṣbāḥ* again

Before you move on

What does مصباح mean? (“A lamp”.) Say it once more.

71.3 مفتاح (miftāḥ) — a key

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mirror, then the Arabic for a lamp.

You'll want to know: مفتاح

مفتاح — *miṭāḥ* — “a key”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṭāḥ*
- *Say it: miṭāḥ*, once more
- *Say it: say miṭāḥ*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a mirror, then the Arabic for a lamp, then say miṭāḥ again*

Before you move on

What does مفتاح mean? (“A key”.) Say it once more.

71.4 صحن (ṣaḥn) — a plate

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a lamp, then the Arabic for a key.

You'll want to know: صحن

صحن — *ṣaḥn* — “a plate”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṣaḥn*
- *Say it: ṣaḥn*, once more
- *Say it: say ṣaḥn*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a lamp, then the Arabic for a key, then say *ṣaḥn* again

Before you move on

What does *صحن* mean? (“A plate”.) Say it once more.

71.5 سكين (sikkīn) — a knife

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a key, then the Arabic for a plate.

You’ll want to know: سكين

سكين — *sikkīn* — “a knife”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sikkīn*
- *Say it:* *sikkīn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sikkīn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a key, then the Arabic for a plate, then say *sikkīn* again

Before you move on

What does *سكين* mean? (“A knife”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Fork, Bottle, Door, Kitchen, Garden

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a fork, a bottle, a door, a kitchen and a garden.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: i can say a fork, a bottle, a door, a kitchen and a garden.

72.1 شوكة (shawka) — a fork

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a plate, then the Arabic for a knife.

You'll want to know: شوكة

شوكة — *shawka* — “a fork”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *shawka*
- Say it: *shawka*, once more

- *Say it:* say *shawka*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a plate, then the Arabic for a knife, then say *shawka* again

Before you move on

What does شوكة mean? (“A fork.”) Say it once more.

72.2 زجاجة (zujāja) — a bottle

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a knife, then the Arabic for a fork.

You’ll want to know: زجاجة

زجاجة — *zujāja* — “a bottle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zujāja*
- *Say it:* *zujāja*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zujāja*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a knife, then the Arabic for a fork, then say *zujāja* again

Before you move on

What does زجاجة mean? (“A bottle.”) Say it once more.

72.3 باب (bāb) — a door

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a fork, then the Arabic for a bottle.

You'll want to know: باب

باب — *bāb* — “a door”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāb*
- *Say it: bāb, once more*
- *Say it: say bāb*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a fork, then the Arabic for a bottle, then say bāb again*

Before you move on

What does باب mean? (“A door”.) Say it once more.

72.4 مطبخ (*maṭbakh*) — a kitchen

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bottle, then the Arabic for a door.

You'll want to know: مطبخ

مطبخ — *maṭbakh* — “a kitchen”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭbakh*
- *Say it: maṭbakh, once more*
- *Say it: say maṭbakh*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bottle, then the Arabic for a door, then say *maṭbakh* again

Before you move on

What does مطبخ mean? (“A kitchen”.) Say it once more.

72.5 حديقة (ḥadīqa) — a garden

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a door, then the Arabic for a kitchen.

You’ll want to know: حديقة

حديقة — ḥadīqa — “a garden”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ḥadīqa
- *Say it:* ḥadīqa, once more
- *Say it:* say ḥadīqa
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a door, then the Arabic for a kitchen, then say ḥadīqa again

Before you move on

What does حديقة mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Book, Notebook, Pen, Sheet of paper, School

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a book, a notebook, a pen, a sheet of paper and a school.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: i can say a book, a notebook, a pen, a sheet of paper and a school.

73.1 كتاب (kitāb) — a book

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a kitchen, then the Arabic for a garden.

You'll want to know: كتاب

كتاب — *kitāb* — “a book”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kitāb*
- Say it: *kitāb*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kitāb*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a kitchen, then the Arabic for a garden, then say *kitāb* again

Before you move on

What does كتاب mean? (“A book”.) Say it once more.

73.2 دفتر (daftar) — a notebook

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a garden, then the Arabic for a book.

You’ll want to know: دفتر

دفتر — *daftar* — “a notebook”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *daftar*
- *Say it:* *daftar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *daftar*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a garden, then the Arabic for a book, then say *daftar* again

Before you move on

What does دفتر mean? (“A notebook”.) Say it once more.

73.3 قلم (qalam) — a pen

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a book, then the Arabic for a notebook.

You'll want to know: قلم

قلم — *qalam* — “a pen”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qalam*
- *Say it: qalam*, once more
- *Say it: say qalam*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a book, then the Arabic for a notebook, then say *qalam* again

Before you move on

What does قلم mean? (“A pen.”) Say it once more.

73.4 ورقة (*waraqa*) — a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a notebook, then the Arabic for a pen.

You'll want to know: ورقة

ورقة — *waraqa* — “a sheet of paper”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: waraqa*
- *Say it: waraqa*, once more
- *Say it: say waraqa*

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for a notebook, then the Arabic for a pen, then say *warāqa* again

Before you move on

What does ورقة mean? (“A sheet of paper”.) Say it once more.

73.5 مدرسة (madrasa) — a school

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a pen, then the Arabic for a sheet of paper.

You’ll want to know: مدرسة

مدرسة — *madrasa* — “a school”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *madrasa*
- *Say it*: *madrasa*, once more
- *Say it*: say *madrasa*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for a pen, then the Arabic for a sheet of paper, then say *madrasa* again

Before you move on

What does مدرسة mean? (“A school”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Bag, Money, Map, Lesson, Answer

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bag, money, a map, a lesson and an answer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: i can say a bag, money, a map, a lesson and an answer.

74.1 حقيبة (ḥaqība) — a bag

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a sheet of paper, then the Arabic for a school.

You'll want to know: حقيبة

حقيبة — ḥaqība — “a bag”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ḥaqība
- Say it: ḥaqība, once more
- Say it: say ḥaqība

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a sheet of paper, then the Arabic for a school, then say *ḥaqība* again

Before you move on

What does حقيبة mean? (“A bag”.) Say it once more.

74.2 مال (māl) — money

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a school, then the Arabic for a bag.

You’ll want to know: مال

مال — *māl* — “money”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māl*
- *Say it:* *māl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a school, then the Arabic for a bag, then say *māl* again

Before you move on

What does مال mean? (“Money”.) Say it once more.

74.3 خريطة (kharīṭa) — a map

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bag, then the Arabic for money.

You'll want to know: خريطة

خريطة — *kharīṭa* — “a map”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kharīṭa*
- *Say it: kharīṭa*, once more
- *Say it: say kharīṭa*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a bag, then the Arabic for money, then say kharīṭa again*

Before you move on

What does خريطة mean? (“A map”.) Say it once more.

74.4 درس (dars) — a lesson

Before the new one: say the Arabic for money, then the Arabic for a map.

You'll want to know: درس

درس — *dars* — “a lesson”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dars*
- *Say it: dars*, once more
- *Say it: say dars*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for money, then the Arabic for a map, then say *dars* again

Before you move on

What does درس mean? (“A lesson”.) Say it once more.

74.5 جواب (jawāb) — an answer

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a map, then the Arabic for a lesson.

You’ll want to know: جواب

جواب — *jawāb* — “an answer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jawāb*
- *Say it:* *jawāb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jawāb*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a map, then the Arabic for a lesson, then say *jawāb* again

Before you move on

What does جواب mean? (“An answer”.) Say it once more.

74.6 The body, family, verbs and food — a first pass

Say the words for a lesson and an answer.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an eye, an ear, a nose, a mouth, a tooth
- hair, a foot, a finger, a shoulder, the neck
- a face, blood, a knee, the back, the heart
- a fever, a hospital, ill, pain, medicine
- hunger, happy, sad, a doctor, a grandfather
- a grandmother, an uncle, an uncle, a husband, a wife
- a child, a boy, a man, a woman, a guest
- a teacher, to drink, to hear, to sit, to sleep
- to stand up, to walk, to run, to play, to buy
- to sell, to give, to put, to open, to close
- to cook, to wash, to laugh, to cry, to dance
- to learn, to forget, to want, to send, to cut

Before you move on

An eye? (عين, *ʿayn*.) An ear? (أذن, *udhun*.) A nose? (أنف, *anf*.) A mouth? (فم, *fam*.) A tooth? (سن, *sinn*.) Hair? (شعر, *shaʿr*.) A foot? (قدم, *qadam*.) A finger? (إصبع, *iṣbaʿ*.) A shoulder? (كتف, *katif*.) The neck? (رقبة, *raqaba*.) A face? (وجه, *wajh*.) Blood? (دم, *dam*.) A knee? (ركبة, *rukba*.) The back? (ظهر, *zahr*.) The heart? (قلب, *qalb*.) A fever? (حمى, *ḥummā*.) A hospital? (مستشفى, *mustashfā*.) Ill? (مريض, *marīḍ*.) Pain? (ألم, *alam*.) Medicine? (دواء, *dawāʿ*.) Hunger? (جوع, *jūʿ*.) Happy? (سعيد, *saʿīd*.) Sad? (حزين, *ḥazīn*.) A doctor? (طبيب, *ṭabīb*.) A grandfather? (جد, *jadd*.) A grandmother? (جدة, *jadda*.) An uncle? (عم, *ʿamm*.) An uncle? (خال, *khāl*.) A husband? (زوج, *zawj*.) A wife? (زوجة, *zawja*.) A child? (طفل, *ṭifl*.) A boy? (ولد, *walad*.) A man? (رجل, *rajul*.) A woman? (امرأة, *imraʿa*.) A guest? (ضيف, *ḍayf*.) A teacher? (معلم, *muʿallim*.) To drink? (شرب, *shariba*.) To hear? (سمع, *samiʿa*.) To sit? (جلس, *jalasa*.) To sleep? (نام, *nam*.)

nāma.) To stand up? (قام, *qāma.*) To walk? (مشى, *mashā.*) To run? (ركض, *rakada.*) To play? (لعب, *la^ciba.*) To buy? (اشترى, *ishtarā.*) To sell? (باع, *bā^ca.*) To give? (أعطى, *a^ctā.*) To put? (وضع, *waḍa^ca.*) To open? (فتح, *fataḥa.*) To close? (أغلق, *aghlaqa.*) To cook? (طبخ, *ṭabakha.*) To wash? (غسل, *ghasala.*) To laugh? (ضحك, *ḍaḥika.*) To cry? (بكى, *bakā.*) To dance? (رقص, *raqaṣa.*) To learn? (تعلم, *ta^callama.*) To forget? (نسي, *nasiya.*) To want? (أراد, *arāda.*) To send? (أرسل, *arsala.*) To cut? (قطع, *qaṭa^ca.*)

74.7 Food, the home and school — a second pass

Say the words for to stop and to look for.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to stop, to look for, to find, to wear, to leave
- to throw, to fly, to swim, to make, to enter
- to go out, to work, to live, to wait, to come back
- to speak, to carry, to win, to go down, fish
- rice, fruit, an apple, bananas, potatoes
- tomatoes, carrots, butter, honey, grapes
- oranges, lemons, eggs, onions, breakfast
- juice, chicken, a house, a room, a window
- a chair, a table, a wall, a bed, the floor; the earth
- a mirror, a lamp, a key, a plate, a knife
- a fork, a bottle, a door, a kitchen, a garden
- a book, a notebook, a pen, a sheet of paper, a school
- a bag, money, a map, a lesson, an answer

Before you move on

To stop? (وقف, *waqafa*.) To look for? (بحث, *baḥatha*.) To find? (وجد, *wajada*.) To wear? (لبس, *labisa*.) To leave? (ترك, *taraka*.) To throw? (رمى, *ramā*.) To fly? (طار, *tāra*.) To swim? (سبح, *sabaḥa*.) To make? (صنع, *ṣanaʿa*.) To enter? (دخل, *dakhala*.) To go out? (خرج, *kharaja*.) To work? (عمل, *ʿamila*.) To live? (سكن, *sakana*.) To wait? (انتظر, *intaẓara*.) To come back? (رجع, *rajaʿa*.) To speak? (تكلم, *takallama*.) To carry? (حمل, *ḥamala*.) To win? (فاز, *fāza*.) To go down? (نزل, *nazala*.) Fish? (سمك, *samak*.) Rice? (أرز, *aruzz*.) Fruit? (فاكهة, *fākiha*.) An apple? (تفاحة, *tuffāḥa*.) Bananas? (موز, *mawz*.) Potatoes? (بطاطس, *baṭāṭis*.) Tomatoes? (طماطم, *ṭamāṭim*.) Carrots? (جزر, *jazar*.) Butter? (زبدة, *zubda*.) Honey? (عسل, *ʿasal*.) Grapes? (عنب, *ʿinab*.) Oranges? (برتقال, *burtuqāl*.) Lemons? (ليمون, *laymūn*.) Eggs? (بيض, *bayḍ*.) Onions? (بصل, *baṣal*.) Breakfast? (فطور, *fuṭūr*.) Juice? (عصير, *ʿaṣīr*.) Chicken? (دجاج, *dajāj*.) A house? (منزل, *manzil*.) A room? (غرفة, *ghurfa*.) A window? (نافذة, *nāfidha*.) A chair? (كرسي, *kursī*.) A table? (طاولة, *ṭāwila*.) A wall? (جدار, *jidār*.) A bed? (سرير, *sarīr*.) The floor; the earth? (أرض, *ard*.) A mirror? (مرآة, *mirʾāh*.) A lamp? (مصباح, *miṣbāḥ*.) A key? (مفتاح, *miftāḥ*.) A plate? (صحن, *ṣaḥn*.) A knife? (سكين, *sikkīn*.) A fork? (شوكة, *shawka*.) A bottle? (زجاجة, *zujāja*.) A door? (باب, *bāb*.) A kitchen? (مطبخ, *maṭbakh*.) A garden? (حديقة, *ḥadīqa*.) A book? (كتاب, *kitāb*.) A notebook? (دفتر, *daftar*.) A pen? (قلم, *qalam*.) A sheet of paper? (ورقة, *waraqa*.) A school? (مدرسة, *madrasa*.) A bag? (حقيبة, *ḥaqība*.) Money? (مال, *māl*.) A map? (خريطة, *kharīṭa*.) A lesson? (درس, *dars*.) An answer? (جواب, *jawāb*.)

Chapter 75

Word, Picture, Tree, Flower, Mountain

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a word, a picture, a tree, a flower and a mountain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: i can say a word, a picture, a tree, a flower and a mountain.

75.1 كلمة (kalima) — a word

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a lesson, then the Arabic for an answer.

You'll want to know: كلمة

كلمة — *kalima* — “a word”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kalima*
- Say it: *kalima*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kalima*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a lesson, then the Arabic for an answer, then say *kalima* again

Before you move on

What does كلمة mean? (“A word”.) Say it once more.

75.2 صورة (ṣūra) — a picture

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an answer, then the Arabic for a word.

You’ll want to know: صورة

صورة — ṣūra — “a picture”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ṣūra
- *Say it:* ṣūra, once more
- *Say it:* say ṣūra
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an answer, then the Arabic for a word, then say ṣūra again

Before you move on

What does صورة mean? (“A picture”.) Say it once more.

75.3 شجرة (shajara) — a tree

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a word, then the Arabic for a picture.

You'll want to know: شجرة

شجرة — *shajara* — “a tree”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shajara*
- *Say it: shajara*, once more
- *Say it: say shajara*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a word, then the Arabic for a picture, then say *shajara* again

Before you move on

What does شجرة mean? (“A tree”.) Say it once more.

75.4 زهرة (zahra) — a flower

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a picture, then the Arabic for a tree.

You'll want to know: زهرة

زهرة — *zahra* — “a flower”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zahra*
- *Say it: zahra*, once more
- *Say it: say zahra*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a picture, then the Arabic for a tree, then say *zahra* again

Before you move on

What does زهرة mean? (“A flower”.) Say it once more.

75.5 جبل (jabal) — a mountain

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a tree, then the Arabic for a flower.

You’ll want to know: جبل

جبل — *jabal* — “a mountain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jabal*
- *Say it:* *jabal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jabal*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a tree, then the Arabic for a flower, then say *jabal* again

Before you move on

What does جبل mean? (“A mountain”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Forest, River, Stone, Sand, Field

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a forest, a river, a stone, sand and a field.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: i can say a forest, a river, a stone, sand and a field.

76.1 غابة (ghāba) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a flower, then the Arabic for a mountain.

You'll want to know: غابة

غابة — *ghāba* — “a forest”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghāba*
- *Say it: ghāba, once more*
- *Say it: say ghāba*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a flower, then the Arabic for a mountain, then say *ghāba* again

Before you move on

What does غابة mean? (“A forest.”) Say it once more.

76.2 نهر (nahr) — a river

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mountain, then the Arabic for a forest.

You’ll want to know: نهر

نهر — *nahr* — “a river”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nahr*
- *Say it:* *nahr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nahr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a mountain, then the Arabic for a forest, then say *nahr* again

Before you move on

What does نهر mean? (“A river.”) Say it once more.

76.3 حجر (ḥajar) — a stone

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a forest, then the Arabic for a river.

You'll want to know: حجر

حجر — *ḥajar* — “a stone”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ḥajar
- *Say it:* ḥajar, once more
- *Say it:* say ḥajar
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a forest, then the Arabic for a river, then say ḥajar again

Before you move on

What does حجر mean? (“A stone”.) Say it once more.

76.4 رمل (raml) — sand

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a river, then the Arabic for a stone.

You'll want to know: رمل

رمل — *raml* — “sand”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* raml
- *Say it:* raml, once more
- *Say it:* say raml

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a river, then the Arabic for a stone, then say *raml* again

Before you move on

What does رمل mean? (“Sand”.) Say it once more.

76.5 حقل (ḥaql) — a field

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a stone, then the Arabic for sand.

You’ll want to know: حقل

حقل — ḥaql — “a field”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ḥaql
- *Say it:* ḥaql, once more
- *Say it:* say ḥaql
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a stone, then the Arabic for sand, then say ḥaql again

Before you move on

What does حقل mean? (“A field”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Star, Cloud, Sun, Moon, Sea

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a star, a cloud, the sun, the moon and the sea.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: i can say a star, a cloud, the sun, the moon and the sea.

77.1 نجم (najm) — a star

Before the new one: say the Arabic for sand, then the Arabic for a field.

You'll want to know: نجم

نجم — *najm* — “a star”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *najm*
- Say it: *najm*, once more
- Say it: say *najm*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for sand, then the Arabic for a field, then say *najm* again

Before you move on

What does نجم mean? (“A star”.) Say it once more.

77.2 سحابة (saḥāba) — a cloud

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a field, then the Arabic for a star.

You’ll want to know: سحابة

سحابة — *saḥāba* — “a cloud”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *saḥāba*
- *Say it:* *saḥāba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saḥāba*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a field, then the Arabic for a star, then say *saḥāba* again

Before you move on

What does سحابة mean? (“A cloud”.) Say it once more.

77.3 شمس (shams) — the sun

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a star, then the Arabic for a cloud.

You'll want to know: شمس

شمس — *shams* — “the sun”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shams*
- *Say it: shams*, once more
- *Say it: say shams*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a star, then the Arabic for a cloud, then say shams again*

Before you move on

What does شمس mean? (“The sun”.) Say it once more.

77.4 قمر (qamar) — the moon

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a cloud, then the Arabic for the sun.

You'll want to know: قمر

قمر — *qamar* — “the moon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qamar*
- *Say it: qamar*, once more
- *Say it: say qamar*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a cloud, then the Arabic for the sun, then say *qamar* again

Before you move on

What does قمر mean? (“The moon”.) Say it once more.

77.5 بحر (baḥr) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the sun, then the Arabic for the moon.

You’ll want to know: بحر

بحر — *baḥr* — “the sea”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baḥr*
- *Say it:* *baḥr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baḥr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the sun, then the Arabic for the moon, then say *baḥr* again

Before you move on

What does بحر mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 78

Fire, Snow, Wind, Sky, Horse

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say fire, snow, wind, the sky and a horse.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: i can say fire, snow, wind, the sky and a horse.

78.1 نَار (nār) — fire

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the moon, then the Arabic for the sea.

You'll want to know: نَار

نَار — *nār* — “fire”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nār*
- *Say it: nār, once more*
- *Say it: say nār*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the moon, then the Arabic for the sea, then say *nār* again

Before you move on

What does نَار mean? (“Fire”.) Say it once more.

78.2 ثَلَج (thalj) — snow

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the sea, then the Arabic for fire.

You’ll want to know: ثَلَج

ثَلَج — *thalj* — “snow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *thalj*
- *Say it:* *thalj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thalj*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the sea, then the Arabic for fire, then say *thalj* again

Before you move on

What does ثَلَج mean? (“Snow”.) Say it once more.

78.3 رِيح (rīḥ) — wind

Before the new one: say the Arabic for fire, then the Arabic for snow.

You'll want to know: ريح

ريح — *rīḥ* — “wind”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rīḥ*
- *Say it:* *rīḥ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rīḥ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for fire, then the Arabic for snow, then say *rīḥ* again

Before you move on

What does ريح mean? (“Wind”.) Say it once more.

78.4 سماء (*samāʿ*) — the sky

Before the new one: say the Arabic for snow, then the Arabic for wind.

You'll want to know: سماء

سماء — *samāʿ* — “the sky”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *samāʿ*
- *Say it:* *samāʿ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samāʿ*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for snow, then the Arabic for wind, then say *samāʾ* again

Before you move on

What does سماء mean? (“The sky”.) Say it once more.

78.5 حصان (ḥiṣān) — a horse

Before the new one: say the Arabic for wind, then the Arabic for the sky.

You’ll want to know: حصان

حصان — *ḥiṣān* — “a horse”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḥiṣān*
- *Say it:* *ḥiṣān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḥiṣān*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for wind, then the Arabic for the sky, then say *ḥiṣān* again

Before you move on

What does حصان mean? (“A horse”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

Cow, Goat, Sheep, Mouse, Lion

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a cow, a goat, a sheep, a mouse and a lion.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: i can say a cow, a goat, a sheep, a mouse and a lion.

79.1 بقرة (baqara) — a cow

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the sky, then the Arabic for a horse.

You'll want to know: بقرة

بقرة — *baqara* — “a cow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baqara*
- *Say it: baqara, once more*
- *Say it: say baqara*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the sky, then the Arabic for a horse, then say *baqara* again

Before you move on

What does بقرة mean? (“A cow”.) Say it once more.

79.2 ماعز (mā^ciz) — a goat

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a horse, then the Arabic for a cow.

You’ll want to know: ماعز

ماعز — mā^ciz — “a goat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* mā^ciz
- *Say it:* mā^ciz, once more
- *Say it:* say mā^ciz
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a horse, then the Arabic for a cow, then say mā^ciz again

Before you move on

What does ماعز mean? (“A goat”.) Say it once more.

79.3 خروف (kharūf) — a sheep

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a cow, then the Arabic for a goat.

You'll want to know: خروف

خروف — *kharūf* — “a sheep”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kharūf*
- *Say it: kharūf*, once more
- *Say it: say kharūf*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a cow, then the Arabic for a goat, then say kharūf again*

Before you move on

What does خروف mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

79.4 فأر (faʿr) — a mouse

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a goat, then the Arabic for a sheep.

You'll want to know: فأر

فأر — *faʿr* — “a mouse”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faʿr*
- *Say it: faʿr*, once more
- *Say it: say faʿr*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a goat, then the Arabic for a sheep, then say *faʿr* again

Before you move on

What does فأر mean? (“A mouse”.) Say it once more.

79.5 أسد (asad) — a lion

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a sheep, then the Arabic for a mouse.

You’ll want to know: أسد

أسد — *asad* — “a lion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *asad*
- *Say it:* *asad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *asad*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a sheep, then the Arabic for a mouse, then say *asad* again

Before you move on

What does أسد mean? (“A lion”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 80

Tiger, Elephant, Monkey, Snake, Bear

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a tiger, an elephant, a monkey, a snake and a bear.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: i can say a tiger, an elephant, a monkey, a snake and a bear.

80.1 نمر (namir) — a tiger

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mouse, then the Arabic for a lion.

You'll want to know: نمر

نمر — *namir* — “a tiger”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *namir*
- Say it: *namir*, once more

- *Say it:* say *namir*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a mouse, then the Arabic for a lion, then say *namir* again

Before you move on

What does نمر mean? (“A tiger”.) Say it once more.

80.2 فيل (fīl) — an elephant

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a lion, then the Arabic for a tiger.

You’ll want to know: فيل

فيل — *fīl* — “an elephant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fīl*
- *Say it:* *fīl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fīl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a lion, then the Arabic for a tiger, then say *fīl* again

Before you move on

What does فيل mean? (“An elephant”.) Say it once more.

80.3 قرد (qird) — a monkey

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a tiger, then the Arabic for an elephant.

You'll want to know: قرد

قرد — *qird* — “a monkey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qird*
- *Say it: qird*, once more
- *Say it: say qird*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a tiger, then the Arabic for an elephant, then say qird again*

Before you move on

What does قرد mean? (“A monkey”.) Say it once more.

80.4 ثعبان (*thu^cbān*) — a snake

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an elephant, then the Arabic for a monkey.

You'll want to know: ثعبان

ثعبان — *thu^cbān* — “a snake”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: thu^cbān*
- *Say it: thu^cbān*, once more
- *Say it: say thu^cbān*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an elephant, then the Arabic for a monkey, then say *thu^cbān* again

Before you move on

What does ثعبان mean? (“A snake”.) Say it once more.

80.5 دب (dubb) — a bear

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a monkey, then the Arabic for a snake.

You’ll want to know: دب

دب — *dubb* — “a bear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dubb*
- *Say it:* *dubb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dubb*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a monkey, then the Arabic for a snake, then say *dubb* again

Before you move on

What does دب mean? (“A bear”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

Camel, Donkey, Hen, Big, Small

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a camel, a donkey, a hen, big and small.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: i can say a camel, a donkey, a hen, big and small.

81.1 جمل (jamal) — a camel

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a snake, then the Arabic for a bear.

You'll want to know: جمل

جمل — *jamal* — “a camel”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jamal*
- *Say it: jamal, once more*
- *Say it: say jamal*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a snake, then the Arabic for a bear, then say *jamal* again

Before you move on

What does **جمل** mean? (“A camel”.) Say it once more.

81.2 حمار (ḥimār) — a donkey

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bear, then the Arabic for a camel.

You’ll want to know: حمار

حمار — *ḥimār* — “a donkey”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḥimār*
- *Say it:* *ḥimār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḥimār*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bear, then the Arabic for a camel, then say *ḥimār* again

Before you move on

What does **حمار** mean? (“A donkey”.) Say it once more.

81.3 دجاجة (dajāja) — a hen

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a camel, then the Arabic for a donkey.

You'll want to know: دجاجة

دجاجة — *dajāja* — “a hen”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dajāja*
- *Say it:* *dajāja*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dajāja*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a camel, then the Arabic for a donkey, then say *dajāja* again

Before you move on

What does دجاجة mean? (“A hen”.) Say it once more.

81.4 كبير (kabīr) — big

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a donkey, then the Arabic for a hen.

You'll want to know: كبير

كبير — *kabīr* — “big”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kabīr*
- *Say it:* *kabīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kabīr*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a donkey, then the Arabic for a hen, then say *kabīr* again

Before you move on

What does كبير mean? (“Big”.) Say it once more.

81.5 صغير (ṣaghīr) — small

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a hen, then the Arabic for big.

You’ll want to know: صغير

صغير — ṣaghīr — “small”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ṣaghīr
- *Say it:* ṣaghīr, once more
- *Say it:* say ṣaghīr
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a hen, then the Arabic for big, then say ṣaghīr again

Before you move on

What does صغير mean? (“Small”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 82

New, Old, Good, Long, Short

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say new, old, good, long, tall and short.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: i can say new, old, good, long, tall and short.

82.1 جديد (jadīd) — new

Before the new one: say the Arabic for big, then the Arabic for small.

You'll want to know: جديد

جديد — *jadīd* — “new”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *jadīd*
- Say it: *jadīd*, once more
- Say it: say *jadīd*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for big, then the Arabic for small, then say *jadīd* again

Before you move on

What does جديد mean? (“New.”) Say it once more.

82.2 قديم (qadīm) — old

Before the new one: say the Arabic for small, then the Arabic for new.

You’ll want to know: قديم

قديم — *qadīm* — “old”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qadīm*
- *Say it:* *qadīm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qadīm*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for small, then the Arabic for new, then say *qadīm* again

Before you move on

What does قديم mean? (“Old.”) Say it once more.

82.3 جيد (jayyid) — good

Before the new one: say the Arabic for new, then the Arabic for old.

You'll want to know: جيد

جيد — *jayyid* — “good”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jayyid*
- *Say it: jayyid*, once more
- *Say it: say jayyid*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for new, then the Arabic for old, then say jayyid again*

Before you move on

What does جيد mean? (“Good”.) Say it once more.

82.4 طويل (ṭawīl) — long, tall

Before the new one: say the Arabic for old, then the Arabic for good.

You'll want to know: طويل

طويل — *ṭawīl* — “long, tall”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭawīl*
- *Say it: ṭawīl*, once more
- *Say it: say ṭawīl*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for old, then the Arabic for good, then say *ṭawīl* again

Before you move on

What does طویل mean? (“Long, tall”.) Say it once more.

82.5 قصير (qaṣīr) — short

Before the new one: say the Arabic for good, then the Arabic for long.

You’ll want to know: قصير

قصير — *qaṣīr* — “short”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qaṣīr*
- *Say it:* *qaṣīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qaṣīr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for good, then the Arabic for long, then say *qaṣīr* again

Before you move on

What does قصير mean? (“Short”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Slow, Fast, Easy, Difficult, Cheap

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say slow, fast, easy, difficult and cheap.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: i can say slow, fast, easy, difficult and cheap.

83.1 بطيء (baṭīʾ) — slow

Before the new one: say the Arabic for long, then the Arabic for short.

You'll want to know: بطيء

بطيء — baṭīʾ — “slow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: baṭīʾ
- Say it: baṭīʾ, once more
- Say it: say baṭīʾ

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for long, then the Arabic for short, then say *baṭīʿ* again

Before you move on

What does بطيء mean? (“Slow”.) Say it once more.

83.2 سريع (sarīʿ) — fast

Before the new one: say the Arabic for short, then the Arabic for slow.

You’ll want to know: سريع

سريع — *sarīʿ* — “fast”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sarīʿ*
- *Say it:* *sarīʿ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sarīʿ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for short, then the Arabic for slow, then say *sarīʿ* again

Before you move on

What does سريع mean? (“Fast”.) Say it once more.

83.3 سهل (sahl) — easy

Before the new one: say the Arabic for slow, then the Arabic for fast.

You'll want to know: سهل

سهل — *sahl* — “easy”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sahl*
- *Say it: sahl*, once more
- *Say it: say sahl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for slow, then the Arabic for fast, then say *sahl* again

Before you move on

What does سهل mean? (“Easy”.) Say it once more.

83.4 صعب (ṣaʿb) — difficult

Before the new one: say the Arabic for fast, then the Arabic for easy.

You'll want to know: صعب

صعب — *ṣaʿb* — “difficult”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṣaʿb*
- *Say it: ṣaʿb*, once more
- *Say it: say ṣaʿb*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for fast, then the Arabic for easy, then say *ṣaʿb* again

Before you move on

What does **صعب** mean? (“Difficult.”) Say it once more.

83.5 رخيص (rakhīṣ) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Arabic for easy, then the Arabic for difficult.

You’ll want to know: رخيص

رخيص — *rakhīṣ* — “cheap”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rakhīṣ*
- *Say it:* *rakhīṣ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rakhīṣ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for easy, then the Arabic for difficult, then say *rakhīṣ* again

Before you move on

What does **رخيص** mean? (“Cheap.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

Empty, Rich, Poor, Clean, Dirty

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say empty, rich, poor, clean and dirty.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: i can say empty, rich, poor, clean and dirty.

84.1 فارغ (fārigh) — empty

Before the new one: say the Arabic for difficult, then the Arabic for cheap.

You'll want to know: فارغ

فارغ — *fārigh* — “empty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fārigh*
- *Say it: fārigh, once more*
- *Say it: say fārigh*

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for difficult, then the Arabic for cheap, then say *fārigh* again

Before you move on

What does فارغ mean? (“Empty”.) Say it once more.

84.2 غني (ghanī) — rich

Before the new one: say the Arabic for cheap, then the Arabic for empty.

You’ll want to know: غني

غني — *ghanī* — “rich”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *ghanī*
- *Say it*: *ghanī*, once more
- *Say it*: say *ghanī*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for cheap, then the Arabic for empty, then say *ghanī* again

Before you move on

What does غني mean? (“Rich”.) Say it once more.

84.3 فقير (faqīr) — poor

Before the new one: say the Arabic for empty, then the Arabic for rich.

You'll want to know: فقير

فقير — *faqīr* — “poor”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *faqīr*
- *Say it:* *faqīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faqīr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for empty, then the Arabic for rich, then say *faqīr* again

Before you move on

What does فقير mean? (“Poor”.) Say it once more.

84.4 نظيف (*naẓīf*) — clean

Before the new one: say the Arabic for rich, then the Arabic for poor.

You'll want to know: نظيف

نظيف — *naẓīf* — “clean”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naẓīf*
- *Say it:* *naẓīf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naẓīf*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for rich, then the Arabic for poor, then say *nazīf* again

Before you move on

What does نظيف mean? (“Clean.”) Say it once more.

84.5 وسخ (wasikh) — dirty

Before the new one: say the Arabic for poor, then the Arabic for clean.

You’ll want to know: وسخ

وسخ — *wasikh* — “dirty”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *wasikh*
- *Say it:* *wasikh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *wasikh*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for poor, then the Arabic for clean, then say *wasikh* again

Before you move on

What does وسخ mean? (“Dirty.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Light, Heavy, Correct, Mistake, Important

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say light, heavy, correct, true, a mistake and important.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 85: i can say light, heavy, correct, true, a mistake and important.

85.1 خفيف (khafif) — light (in weight)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for clean, then the Arabic for dirty.

You'll want to know: خفيف

خفيف — *khafif* — “light (in weight)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *khafif*
- Say it: *khafif*, once more

- *Say it:* say *khafīf*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for clean, then the Arabic for dirty, then say *khafīf* again

Before you move on

What does خفيف mean? (“Light (in weight)”). Say it once more.

85.2 ثَقِيل (thaqīl) — heavy

Before the new one: say the Arabic for dirty, then the Arabic for light.

You’ll want to know: ثَقِيل

ثَقِيل — *thaqīl* — “heavy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *thaqīl*
- *Say it:* *thaqīl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thaqīl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for dirty, then the Arabic for light, then say *thaqīl* again

Before you move on

What does ثَقِيل mean? (“Heavy”). Say it once more.

85.3 صَحِيح (ṣaḥīḥ) — correct, true

Before the new one: say the Arabic for light, then the Arabic for heavy.

You'll want to know: صحيح

صحيح — ṣaḥīḥ — “correct, true”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṣaḥīḥ
- Say it: ṣaḥīḥ, once more
- Say it: say ṣaḥīḥ
- Recall: say the Arabic for light, then the Arabic for heavy, then say ṣaḥīḥ again

Before you move on

What does صحيح mean? (“Correct, true”.) Say it once more.

85.4 خطأ (khaṭaʾ) — a mistake; wrong

Before the new one: say the Arabic for heavy, then the Arabic for correct.

You'll want to know: خطأ

خطأ — khaṭaʾ — “a mistake; wrong”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: khaṭaʾ
- Say it: khaṭaʾ, once more
- Say it: say khaṭaʾ

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for heavy, then the Arabic for correct, then say *khata*² again

Before you move on

What does خطأ mean? (“A mistake; wrong”). Say it once more.

85.5 مهم (muhimm) — important

Before the new one: say the Arabic for correct, then the Arabic for a mistake; wrong.

You’ll want to know: مهم

مهم — *muhimm* — “important”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *muhimm*
- *Say it:* *muhimm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muhimm*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for correct, then the Arabic for a mistake; wrong, then say *muhimm* again

Before you move on

What does مهم mean? (“Important”). Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Beautiful, Brown, Week, Month, Minute

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say beautiful, brown, a week, a month and a minute.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 86: i can say beautiful, brown, a week, a month and a minute.

86.1 جميل (jamāl) — beautiful

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mistake; wrong, then the Arabic for important.

You'll want to know: جميل

جميل — *jamāl* — “beautiful”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *jamāl*
- Say it: *jamāl*, once more

- *Say it:* say *jamāl*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a mistake; wrong, then the Arabic for important, then say *jamāl* again

Before you move on

What does جميل mean? (“Beautiful”.) Say it once more.

86.2 بني (bunnī) — brown

Before the new one: say the Arabic for important, then the Arabic for beautiful.

You’ll want to know: بني

بني — *bunnī* — “brown”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bunnī*
- *Say it:* *bunnī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bunnī*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for important, then the Arabic for beautiful, then say *bunnī* again

Before you move on

What does بني mean? (“Brown”.) Say it once more.

86.3 أسبوع (usbūʿ) — a week

Before the new one: say the Arabic for beautiful, then the Arabic for brown.

You'll want to know: أسبوع

أسبوع — *usbū^c* — “a week”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: usbū^c*
- *Say it: usbū^c, once more*
- *Say it: say usbū^c*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for beautiful, then the Arabic for brown, then say usbū^c again*

Before you move on

What does أسبوع mean? (“A week”.) Say it once more.

86.4 شهر (shahr) — a month

Before the new one: say the Arabic for brown, then the Arabic for a week.

You'll want to know: شهر

شهر — *shahr* — “a month”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shahr*
- *Say it: shahr, once more*
- *Say it: say shahr*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for brown, then the Arabic for a week, then say *shahr* again

Before you move on

What does شهر mean? (“A month”.) Say it once more.

86.5 دقيقة (daqīqa) — a minute

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a week, then the Arabic for a month.

You’ll want to know: دقيقة

دقيقة — *daqīqa* — “a minute”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *daqīqa*
- *Say it:* *daqīqa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *daqīqa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a week, then the Arabic for a month, then say *daqīqa* again

Before you move on

What does دقيقة mean? (“A minute”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Yesterday, Tomorrow, Now, Sometimes, Before

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say yesterday, tomorrow, now, sometimes and before.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: i can say yesterday, tomorrow, now, sometimes and before.

87.1 أَمْسَ (ams) — yesterday

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a month, then the Arabic for a minute.

You'll want to know: أَمْسَ

أَمْسَ — *ams* — “yesterday”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *ams*
- Say it: *ams*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ams*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a month, then the Arabic for a minute, then say *ams* again

Before you move on

What does أمس mean? (“Yesterday”.) Say it once more.

87.2 غدا (ghadan) — tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a minute, then the Arabic for yesterday.

You’ll want to know: غدا

غدا — *ghadan* — “tomorrow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ghadan*
- *Say it:* *ghadan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghadan*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a minute, then the Arabic for yesterday, then say *ghadan* again

Before you move on

What does غدا mean? (“Tomorrow”.) Say it once more.

87.3 الآن (al-ān) — now

Before the new one: say the Arabic for yesterday, then the Arabic for tomorrow.

You'll want to know: الآن

الآن — *al-ān* — “now”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: al-ān*
- *Say it: al-ān, once more*
- *Say it: say al-ān*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for yesterday, then the Arabic for tomorrow, then say al-ān again*

Before you move on

What does الآن mean? (“Now”.) Say it once more.

87.4 أحيانا (*aḥyānan*) — sometimes

Before the new one: say the Arabic for tomorrow, then the Arabic for now.

You'll want to know: أحيانا

أحيانا — *aḥyānan* — “sometimes”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aḥyānan*
- *Say it: aḥyānan, once more*
- *Say it: say aḥyānan*

- *Recall*: say the Arabic for tomorrow, then the Arabic for now, then say *aḥyānan* again

Before you move on

What does أحيانا mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

87.5 قبل (qabla) — before

Before the new one: say the Arabic for now, then the Arabic for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: قبل

قبل — *qabla* — “before”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *qabla*
- *Say it*: *qabla*, once more
- *Say it*: say *qabla*
- *Recall*: say the Arabic for now, then the Arabic for sometimes, then say *qabla* again

Before you move on

What does قبل mean? (“Before”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

After, Time, Far, Near, Inside

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say after, time, far, near and inside.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: i can say after, time, far, near and inside.

88.1 بعد (ba^cda) — after

Before the new one: say the Arabic for sometimes, then the Arabic for before.

You'll want to know: بعد

بعد — ba^cda — “after”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ba^cda
- Say it: ba^cda, once more
- Say it: say ba^cda

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for sometimes, then the Arabic for before, then say *baʿda* again

Before you move on

What does بعد mean? (“After”.) Say it once more.

88.2 وقت (waqt) — time

Before the new one: say the Arabic for before, then the Arabic for after.

You’ll want to know: وقت

وقت — *waqt* — “time”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *waqt*
- *Say it:* *waqt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *waqt*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for before, then the Arabic for after, then say *waqt* again

Before you move on

What does وقت mean? (“Time”.) Say it once more.

88.3 بعيد (baʿīd) — far

Before the new one: say the Arabic for after, then the Arabic for time.

You'll want to know: بعيد

بعيد — *ba^cīd* — “far”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ba^cīd*
- *Say it:* *ba^cīd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ba^cīd*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for after, then the Arabic for time, then say *ba^cīd* again

Before you move on

What does بعيد mean? (“Far”.) Say it once more.

88.4 قريب (qarīb) — near

Before the new one: say the Arabic for time, then the Arabic for far.

You'll want to know: قريب

قريب — *qarīb* — “near”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qarīb*
- *Say it:* *qarīb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qarīb*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for time, then the Arabic for far, then say *qarīb* again

Before you move on

What does قَرِيب mean? (“Near.”) Say it once more.

88.5 داخل (dākhil) — inside

Before the new one: say the Arabic for far, then the Arabic for near.

You’ll want to know: داخل

داخل — *dākhil* — “inside”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dākhil*
- *Say it:* *dākhil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dākhil*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for far, then the Arabic for near, then say *dākhil* again

Before you move on

What does داخل mean? (“Inside.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Outside, Above, Below, In front of, Behind

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say outside, above, below, in front of and behind.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: i can say outside, above, below, in front of and behind.

89.1 خارج (khārij) — outside

Before the new one: say the Arabic for near, then the Arabic for inside.

You'll want to know: خارج

خارج — *khārij* — “outside”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *khārij*
- Say it: *khārij*, once more

- *Say it:* say *khārij*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for near, then the Arabic for inside, then say *khārij* again

Before you move on

What does خارج mean? (“Outside”.) Say it once more.

89.2 فوق (fawqa) — above

Before the new one: say the Arabic for inside, then the Arabic for outside.

You’ll want to know: فوق

فوق — *fawqa* — “above”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fawqa*
- *Say it:* *fawqa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fawqa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for inside, then the Arabic for outside, then say *fawqa* again

Before you move on

What does فوق mean? (“Above”.) Say it once more.

89.3 تحت (taḥta) — below

Before the new one: say the Arabic for outside, then the Arabic for above.

You'll want to know: تحت

تحت — *taḥta* — “below”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taḥta*
- *Say it: taḥta*, once more
- *Say it: say taḥta*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for outside, then the Arabic for above, then say *taḥta* again

Before you move on

What does تحت mean? (“Below”.) Say it once more.

89.4 أمام (amāma) — in front of

Before the new one: say the Arabic for above, then the Arabic for below.

You'll want to know: أمام

أمام — *amāma* — “in front of”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amāma*
- *Say it: amāma*, once more
- *Say it: say amāma*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for above, then the Arabic for below, then say *amāma* again

Before you move on

What does أمام mean? (“In front of”.) Say it once more.

89.5 وراء (warāʿa) — behind

Before the new one: say the Arabic for below, then the Arabic for in front of.

You’ll want to know: وراء

وراء — *warāʿa* — “behind”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *warāʿa*
- *Say it:* *warāʿa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *warāʿa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for below, then the Arabic for in front of, then say *warāʿa* again

Before you move on

What does وراء mean? (“Behind”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Here, There, Right, Shop, Street

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say here, there, right, a shop and a street.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: i can say here, there, right, a shop and a street.

90.1 هنا (hunā) — here

Before the new one: say the Arabic for in front of, then the Arabic for behind.

You'll want to know: هنا

هنا — *hunā* — “here”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *hunā*
- Say it: *hunā*, once more
- Say it: say *hunā*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for in front of, then the Arabic for behind, then say *hunā* again

Before you move on

What does هنا mean? (“Here”.) Say it once more.

90.2 هناك (hunāka) — there

Before the new one: say the Arabic for behind, then the Arabic for here.

You’ll want to know: هناك

هناك — *hunāka* — “there”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hunāka*
- *Say it:* *hunāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hunāka*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for behind, then the Arabic for here, then say *hunāka* again

Before you move on

What does هناك mean? (“There”.) Say it once more.

90.3 يمين (yamīn) — right (side)

Before the new one: say the Arabic for here, then the Arabic for there.

You'll want to know: يمين

يمين — *yamīn* — “right (side)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yamīn*
- *Say it:* *yamīn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yamīn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for here, then the Arabic for there, then say *yamīn* again

Before you move on

What does يمين mean? (“Right (side)”). Say it once more.

90.4 متجر (matjar) — a shop

Before the new one: say the Arabic for there, then the Arabic for right.

You'll want to know: متجر

متجر — *matjar* — “a shop”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *matjar*
- *Say it:* *matjar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *matjar*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for there, then the Arabic for right, then say *matjar* again

Before you move on

What does متجر mean? (“A shop”.) Say it once more.

90.5 شارع (shāriʿ) — a street

Before the new one: say the Arabic for right, then the Arabic for a shop.

You’ll want to know: شارع

شارع — *shāriʿ* — “a street”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *shāriʿ*
- *Say it:* *shāriʿ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shāriʿ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for right, then the Arabic for a shop, then say *shāriʿ* again

Before you move on

What does شارع mean? (“A street”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Road, Bank, Station, Car, Bus

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a road, a bank, a station, a car and a bus.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: i can say a road, a bank, a station, a car and a bus.

91.1 طريق (ṭarīq) — a road

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a shop, then the Arabic for a street.

You'll want to know: طريق

طريق — ṭarīq — “a road”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ṭarīq
- Say it: ṭarīq, once more
- Say it: say ṭarīq

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a shop, then the Arabic for a street, then say *ṭarīq* again

Before you move on

What does طريق mean? (“A road”.) Say it once more.

91.2 بنك (bank) — a bank

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a street, then the Arabic for a road.

You’ll want to know: بنك

بنك — *bank* — “a bank”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bank*
- *Say it:* *bank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bank*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a street, then the Arabic for a road, then say *bank* again

Before you move on

What does بنك mean? (“A bank”.) Say it once more.

91.3 محطة (maḥaṭṭa) — a station

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a road, then the Arabic for a bank.

You'll want to know: محطة

محطة — *maḥaṭṭa* — “a station”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maḥaṭṭa*
- *Say it: maḥaṭṭa*, once more
- *Say it: say maḥaṭṭa*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for a road, then the Arabic for a bank, then say maḥaṭṭa again*

Before you move on

What does محطة mean? (“A station”.) Say it once more.

91.4 سيارة (sayyāra) — a car

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bank, then the Arabic for a station.

You'll want to know: سيارة

سيارة — *sayyāra* — “a car”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sayyāra*
- *Say it: sayyāra*, once more
- *Say it: say sayyāra*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bank, then the Arabic for a station, then say *sayyāra* again

Before you move on

What does سيارة mean? (“A car”.) Say it once more.

91.5 حافلة (ḥāfila) — a bus

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a station, then the Arabic for a car.

You’ll want to know: حافلة

حافلة — ḥāfila — “a bus”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ḥāfila
- *Say it:* ḥāfila, once more
- *Say it:* say ḥāfila
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a station, then the Arabic for a car, then say ḥāfila again

Before you move on

What does حافلة mean? (“A bus”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Train, Bridge, Mosque, Hotel, Office

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a train, a bridge, a mosque, a hotel and an office.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: i can say a train, a bridge, a mosque, a hotel and an office.

92.1 قطار (qiṭār) — a train

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a car, then the Arabic for a bus.

You'll want to know: قطار

قطار — *qiṭār* — “a train”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *qiṭār*
- Say it: *qiṭār*, once more

- *Say it:* say *qīṭār*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a car, then the Arabic for a bus, then say *qīṭār* again

Before you move on

What does قطار mean? (“A train”.) Say it once more.

92.2 جسر (jisr) — a bridge

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bus, then the Arabic for a train.

You’ll want to know: جسر

جسر — *jisr* — “a bridge”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jisr*
- *Say it:* *jisr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jisr*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bus, then the Arabic for a train, then say *jisr* again

Before you move on

What does جسر mean? (“A bridge”.) Say it once more.

92.3 مسجد (masjid) — a mosque

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a train, then the Arabic for a bridge.

You'll want to know: مسجد

مسجد — *masjid* — “a mosque”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: masjid*
- *Say it: masjid*, once more
- *Say it: say masjid*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a train, then the Arabic for a bridge, then say *masjid* again

Before you move on

What does مسجد mean? (“A mosque”.) Say it once more.

92.4 فندق (funduq) — a hotel

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a bridge, then the Arabic for a mosque.

You'll want to know: فندق

فندق — *funduq* — “a hotel”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: funduq*
- *Say it: funduq*, once more
- *Say it: say funduq*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a bridge, then the Arabic for a mosque, then say *funduq* again

Before you move on

What does فندق mean? (“A hotel”.) Say it once more.

92.5 مكتب (maktab) — an office; a desk

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a mosque, then the Arabic for a hotel.

You’ll want to know: مكتب

مكتب — *maktab* — “an office; a desk”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maktab*
- *Say it:* *maktab*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maktab*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a mosque, then the Arabic for a hotel, then say *maktab* again

Before you move on

What does مكتب mean? (“An office; a desk”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

Police, Market, Village, City, Restaurant

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the police, a market, a village, a city and a restaurant.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: i can say the police, a market, a village, a city and a restaurant.

93.1 شرطة (shurṭa) — the police

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a hotel, then the Arabic for an office; a desk.

You'll want to know: شرطة

شرطة — *shurṭa* — “the police”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *shurṭa*
- Say it: *shurṭa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *shurṭa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a hotel, then the Arabic for an office; a desk, then say *shurṭa* again

Before you move on

What does شرطة mean? (“The police”.) Say it once more.

93.2 سوق (sūq) — a market

Before the new one: say the Arabic for an office; a desk, then the Arabic for the police.

You’ll want to know: سوق

سوق — *sūq* — “a market”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sūq*
- *Say it:* *sūq*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūq*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for an office; a desk, then the Arabic for the police, then say *sūq* again

Before you move on

What does سوق mean? (“A market”.) Say it once more.

93.3 قرية (qarya) — a village

Before the new one: say the Arabic for the police, then the Arabic for a market.

You'll want to know: قرية

قرية — *qarya* — “a village”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qarya*
- *Say it: qarya*, once more
- *Say it: say qarya*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for the police, then the Arabic for a market, then say *qarya* again

Before you move on

What does قرية mean? (“A village”.) Say it once more.

93.4 مدينة (madīna) — a city

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a market, then the Arabic for a village.

You'll want to know: مدينة

مدينة — *madīna* — “a city”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: madīna*
- *Say it: madīna*, once more
- *Say it: say madīna*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a market, then the Arabic for a village, then say *madīna* again

Before you move on

What does مدينة mean? (“A city”.) Say it once more.

93.5 مطعم (maṭʿam) — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a village, then the Arabic for a city.

You’ll want to know: مطعم

مطعم — *maṭʿam* — “a restaurant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṭʿam*
- *Say it:* *maṭʿam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭʿam*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a village, then the Arabic for a city, then say *maṭʿam* again

Before you move on

What does مطعم mean? (“A restaurant”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

Clothes, Shirt, Dress, Trousers, Sock

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say clothes, a shirt, a dress, trousers and a sock.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: i can say clothes, a shirt, a dress, trousers and a sock.

94.1 ملابس (malābis) — clothes

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a city, then the Arabic for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: ملابس

ملابس — *malābis* — “clothes”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *malābis*
- Say it: *malābis*, once more

- *Say it:* say *malābis*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a city, then the Arabic for a restaurant, then say *malābis* again

Before you move on

What does ملابس mean? (“Clothes”). Say it once more.

94.2 قميص (qamīṣ) — a shirt

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a restaurant, then the Arabic for clothes.

You’ll want to know: قميص

قميص — *qamīṣ* — “a shirt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qamīṣ*
- *Say it:* *qamīṣ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qamīṣ*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a restaurant, then the Arabic for clothes, then say *qamīṣ* again

Before you move on

What does قميص mean? (“A shirt”). Say it once more.

94.3 فستان (fustān) — a dress

Before the new one: say the Arabic for clothes, then the Arabic for a shirt.

You'll want to know: فستان

فستان — *fustān* — “a dress”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fustān*
- *Say it: fustān*, once more
- *Say it: say fustān*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for clothes, then the Arabic for a shirt, then say *fustān* again

Before you move on

What does فستان mean? (“A dress”.) Say it once more.

94.4 سروال (sirwāl) — trousers

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a shirt, then the Arabic for a dress.

You'll want to know: سروال

سروال — *sirwāl* — “trousers”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sirwāl*
- *Say it: sirwāl*, once more
- *Say it: say sirwāl*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a shirt, then the Arabic for a dress, then say *sirwāl* again

Before you move on

What does سروال mean? (“Trousers”.) Say it once more.

94.5 جورب (jawrab) — a sock

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a dress, then the Arabic for trousers.

You’ll want to know: جورب

جورب — *jawrab* — “a sock”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jawrab*
- *Say it:* *jawrab*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jawrab*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a dress, then the Arabic for trousers, then say *jawrab* again

Before you move on

What does جورب mean? (“A sock”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Pocket, Ring, Hat, Shoe, Coat

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a pocket, a ring, a hat, a shoe and a coat.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: i can say a pocket, a ring, a hat, a shoe and a coat.

95.1 جيب (jayb) — a pocket

Before the new one: say the Arabic for trousers, then the Arabic for a sock.

You'll want to know: جيب

جيب — *jayb* — “a pocket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *jayb*
- Say it: *jayb*, once more
- Say it: say *jayb*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for trousers, then the Arabic for a sock, then say *jayb* again

Before you move on

What does جيب mean? (“A pocket.”) Say it once more.

95.2 خاتم (khātam) — a ring

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a sock, then the Arabic for a pocket.

You’ll want to know: خاتم

خاتم — *khātam* — “a ring”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *khātam*
- *Say it:* *khātam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khātam*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a sock, then the Arabic for a pocket, then say *khātam* again

Before you move on

What does خاتم mean? (“A ring.”) Say it once more.

95.3 قبعة (qubbaʿa) — a hat

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a pocket, then the Arabic for a ring.

You'll want to know: قبعة

قبعة — *qubba^ca* — “a hat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qubba^ca*
- *Say it:* *qubba^ca*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qubba^ca*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a pocket, then the Arabic for a ring, then say *qubba^ca* again

Before you move on

What does قبعة mean? (“A hat”.) Say it once more.

95.4 حذاء (*ḥidhā^ṣ*) — a shoe

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a ring, then the Arabic for a hat.

You'll want to know: حذاء

حذاء — *ḥidhā^ṣ* — “a shoe”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḥidhā^ṣ*
- *Say it:* *ḥidhā^ṣ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḥidhā^ṣ*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a ring, then the Arabic for a hat, then say *ḥidhāʿ* again

Before you move on

What does حذاء mean? (“A shoe”.) Say it once more.

95.5 معطف (miʿṭaf) — a coat

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a hat, then the Arabic for a shoe.

You’ll want to know: معطف

معطف — *miʿṭaf* — “a coat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *miʿṭaf*
- *Say it:* *miʿṭaf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miʿṭaf*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a hat, then the Arabic for a shoe, then say *miʿṭaf* again

Before you move on

What does معطف mean? (“A coat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Belt, Six, Seven, Eight, Nine

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a belt, six, seven, eight and nine.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: i can say a belt, six, seven, eight and nine.

96.1 حزام (ḥizām) — a belt

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a shoe, then the Arabic for a coat.

You'll want to know: حزام

حزام — ḥizām — “a belt”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ḥizām
- Say it: ḥizām, once more
- Say it: say ḥizām

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a shoe, then the Arabic for a coat, then say *ḥizām* again

Before you move on

What does حزام mean? (“A belt.”) Say it once more.

96.2 ستة (sitta) — six

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a coat, then the Arabic for a belt.

You’ll want to know: ستة

ستة — *sitta* — “six”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sitta*
- *Say it:* *sitta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sitta*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a coat, then the Arabic for a belt, then say *sitta* again

Before you move on

What does ستة mean? (“Six.”) Say it once more.

96.3 سبعة (sabʿa) — seven

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a belt, then the Arabic for six.

You'll want to know: سبعة

سبعة — *sab^ca* — “seven”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sab^ca*
- *Say it:* *sab^ca*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sab^ca*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a belt, then the Arabic for six, then say *sab^ca* again

Before you move on

What does سبعة mean? (“Seven”.) Say it once more.

96.4 ثمانية (thamāniya) — eight

Before the new one: say the Arabic for six, then the Arabic for seven.

You'll want to know: ثمانية

ثمانية — *thamāniya* — “eight”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *thamāniya*
- *Say it:* *thamāniya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thamāniya*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for six, then the Arabic for seven, then say *thamāniya* again

Before you move on

What does ثمانية mean? (“Eight”.) Say it once more.

96.5 تسعة (tis^ca) — nine

Before the new one: say the Arabic for seven, then the Arabic for eight.

You’ll want to know: تسعة

تسعة — *tis^ca* — “nine”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tis^ca*
- *Say it:* *tis^ca*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tis^ca*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for seven, then the Arabic for eight, then say *tis^ca* again

Before you move on

What does تسعة mean? (“Nine”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

Ten, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Thousand

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say ten, thirty, forty, fifty and a thousand.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: i can say ten, thirty, forty, fifty and a thousand.

97.1 عشرة (‘ashara) — ten

Before the new one: say the Arabic for eight, then the Arabic for nine.

You’ll want to know: عشرة

عشرة — ‘ashara — “ten”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: ‘ashara
- Say it: ‘ashara, once more
- Say it: say ‘ashara

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for eight, then the Arabic for nine, then say *‘ashara* again

Before you move on

What does عشرة mean? (“Ten”.) Say it once more.

97.2 ثلاثون (thalāthūn) — thirty

Before the new one: say the Arabic for nine, then the Arabic for ten.

You’ll want to know: ثلاثون

ثلاثون — *thalāthūn* — “thirty”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *thalāthūn*
- *Say it:* *thalāthūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thalāthūn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for nine, then the Arabic for ten, then say *thalāthūn* again

Before you move on

What does ثلاثون mean? (“Thirty”.) Say it once more.

97.3 أربعون (arba‘ūn) — forty

Before the new one: say the Arabic for ten, then the Arabic for thirty.

You'll want to know: أربعون

أربعون — *arbaʿūn* — “forty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *arbaʿūn*
- *Say it:* *arbaʿūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arbaʿūn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for ten, then the Arabic for thirty, then say *arbaʿūn* again

Before you move on

What does أربعون mean? (“Forty”.) Say it once more.

97.4 خمسون (*khamṣūn*) — fifty

Before the new one: say the Arabic for thirty, then the Arabic for forty.

You'll want to know: خمسون

خمسون — *khamṣūn* — “fifty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *khamṣūn*
- *Say it:* *khamṣūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khamṣūn*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for thirty, then the Arabic for forty, then say *khamṣūn* again

Before you move on

What does خمسون mean? (“Fifty”.) Say it once more.

97.5 ألف (alf) — a thousand

Before the new one: say the Arabic for forty, then the Arabic for fifty.

You’ll want to know: ألف

ألف — *alf* — “a thousand”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alf*
- *Say it:* *alf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alf*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for forty, then the Arabic for fifty, then say *alf* again

Before you move on

What does ألف mean? (“A thousand”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Colour, Song, Journey, Holiday, Love

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a colour, a song, a journey, a holiday and love.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: i can say a colour, a song, a journey, a holiday and love.

98.1 لون (lawn) — a colour

Before the new one: say the Arabic for fifty, then the Arabic for a thousand.

You'll want to know: لون

لون — *lawn* — “a colour”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *lawn*
- Say it: *lawn*, once more

- *Say it:* say *lawn*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for fifty, then the Arabic for a thousand, then say *lawn* again

Before you move on

What does لون mean? (“A colour”.) Say it once more.

98.2 أغنية (ughniya) — a song

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a thousand, then the Arabic for a colour.

You’ll want to know: أغنية

أغنية — *ughniya* — “a song”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ughniya*
- *Say it:* *ughniya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ughniya*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a thousand, then the Arabic for a colour, then say *ughniya* again

Before you move on

What does أغنية mean? (“A song”.) Say it once more.

98.3 رحلة (riḥla) — a journey

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a colour, then the Arabic for a song.

You'll want to know: رحلة

رحلة — *riḥla* — “a journey”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *riḥla*
- *Say it:* *riḥla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *riḥla*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a colour, then the Arabic for a song, then say *riḥla* again

Before you move on

What does رحلة mean? (“A journey”.) Say it once more.

98.4 عطلة (*ʿuṭla*) — a holiday

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a song, then the Arabic for a journey.

You'll want to know: عطلة

عطلة — *ʿuṭla* — “a holiday”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ʿuṭla*
- *Say it:* *ʿuṭla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ʿuṭla*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a song, then the Arabic for a journey, then say *ʿutla* again

Before you move on

What does عطلة mean? (“A holiday”.) Say it once more.

98.5 حب (ḥubb) — love

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a journey, then the Arabic for a holiday.

You’ll want to know: حب

حب — *ḥubb* — “love”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḥubb*
- *Say it:* *ḥubb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḥubb*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a journey, then the Arabic for a holiday, then say *ḥubb* again

Before you move on

What does حب mean? (“Love”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Music, News, Country, Language, Story

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say music, news, a country, a language and a story.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: i can say music, news, a country, a language and a story.

99.1 موسيقى (mūsīqā) — music

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a holiday, then the Arabic for love.

You'll want to know: موسيقى

موسيقى — *mūsīqā* — “music”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *mūsīqā*
- Say it: *mūsīqā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mūsīqā*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a holiday, then the Arabic for love, then say *mūsīqā* again

Before you move on

What does *موسيقى* mean? (“Music”.) Say it once more.

99.2 أخبار (akhbār) — news

Before the new one: say the Arabic for love, then the Arabic for music.

You’ll want to know: أخبار

أخبار — *akhbār* — “news”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *akhbār*
- *Say it:* *akhbār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akhbār*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for love, then the Arabic for music, then say *akhbār* again

Before you move on

What does *أخبار* mean? (“News”.) Say it once more.

99.3 بلد (balad) — a country

Before the new one: say the Arabic for music, then the Arabic for news.

You'll want to know: بلد

بلد — *balad* — “a country”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: balad*
- *Say it: balad*, once more
- *Say it: say balad*
- *Recall: say the Arabic for music, then the Arabic for news, then say balad again*

Before you move on

What does بلد mean? (“A country”.) Say it once more.

99.4 لغة (lugha) — a language

Before the new one: say the Arabic for news, then the Arabic for a country.

You'll want to know: لغة

لغة — *lugha* — “a language”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lugha*
- *Say it: lugha*, once more
- *Say it: say lugha*

- *Recall:* say the Arabic for news, then the Arabic for a country, then say *lughā* again

Before you move on

What does **لغة** mean? (“A language”.) Say it once more.

99.5 قصة (qiṣṣa) — a story

Before the new one: say the Arabic for a country, then the Arabic for a language.

You’ll want to know: قصة

قصة — *qiṣṣa* — “a story”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qiṣṣa*
- *Say it:* *qiṣṣa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qiṣṣa*
- *Recall:* say the Arabic for a country, then the Arabic for a language, then say *qiṣṣa* again

Before you move on

What does **قصة** mean? (“A story”.) Say it once more.

99.6 Nature, animals and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for a language and a story.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a word, a picture, a tree, a flower, a mountain
- a forest, a river, a stone, sand, a field
- a star, a cloud, the sun, the moon, the sea
- fire, snow, wind, the sky, a horse
- a cow, a goat, a sheep, a mouse, a lion
- a tiger, an elephant, a monkey, a snake, a bear
- a camel, a donkey, a hen, big, small
- new, old, good, long, short
- slow, fast, easy, difficult, cheap
- empty, rich, poor, clean, dirty
- light, heavy, correct, a mistake; wrong, important
- beautiful, brown, a week, a month, a minute

Before you move on

A word? (كلمة, *kalima*.) A picture? (صورة, *ṣūra*.) A tree? (شجرة, *shajara*.) A flower? (زهرة, *zahra*.) A mountain? (جبل, *jabal*.) A forest? (غابة, *ghāba*.) A river? (نهر, *nahr*.) A stone? (حجر, *ḥajar*.) Sand? (رمل, *raml*.) A field? (حقل, *ḥaql*.) A star? (نجم, *naʿjm*.) A cloud? (سحابة, *saḥāba*.) The sun? (شمس, *shams*.) The moon? (قمر, *qamar*.) The sea? (بحر, *baḥr*.) Fire? (نار, *nār*.) Snow? (ثلج, *thalj*.) Wind? (ريح, *rīḥ*.) The sky? (سماء, *samāʿ*.) A horse? (حصان, *ḥiṣān*.) A cow? (بقرة, *baqara*.) A goat? (ماعز, *māʿiz*.) A sheep? (خروف, *kharūf*.) A mouse? (فأر, *faʿr*.) A lion? (أسد, *asad*.) A tiger? (نمر, *namir*.) An elephant? (فيل, *fīl*.) A monkey? (قرد, *qird*.) A snake? (ثعبان, *thuʿbān*.) A bear? (دب, *dubb*.) A camel? (جمل, *jamal*.) A donkey? (حمار, *ḥimār*.) A hen? (دجاجة, *dajāja*.) Big? (كبير, *kabīr*.) Small? (صغير, *ṣaghīr*.) New? (جديد, *jadīd*.) Old? (قديم, *qadīm*.) Good? (جيد, *jayyid*.) Long? (طويل, *ṭawīl*.) Short? (قصير, *qaṣīr*.)

Slow? (بطيء, *batīʿ*.) Fast? (سريع, *sarīʿ*.) Easy? (سهل, *sahl*.)
 Difficult? (صعب, *ṣaʿb*.) Cheap? (رخيص, *rakhīṣ*.) Empty? (فارغ, *fārigh*.)
 Rich? (غني, *ghanī*.) Poor? (فقير, *faqīr*.) Clean? (نظيف, *naẓīf*.)
 Dirty? (وسخ, *wasikh*.) Light? (خفيف, *khafīf*.) Heavy? (ثقليل, *thaqīl*.)
 Correct? (صحيح, *ṣaḥīḥ*.) A mistake; wrong? (خطأ, *khaṭaʿ*.)
 Important? (مهم, *muhimm*.) Beautiful? (جميل, *jamīl*.) Brown? (بني, *bunnī*.)
 A week? (أسبوع, *usbūʿ*.) A month? (شهر, *shahr*.) A minute? (دقيقة, *daqīqa*.)

99.7 Time, places, the town, clothes and numbers — a second pass

Say the words for yesterday and tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- yesterday, tomorrow, now, sometimes, before
- after, time, far, near, inside
- outside, above, below, in front of, behind
- here, there, right, a shop, a street
- a road, a bank, a station, a car, a bus
- a train, a bridge, a mosque, a hotel, an office; a desk
- the police, a market, a village, a city, a restaurant
- clothes, a shirt, a dress, trousers, a sock
- a pocket, a ring, a hat, a shoe, a coat
- a belt, six, seven, eight, nine
- ten, thirty, forty, fifty, a thousand
- a colour, a song, a journey, a holiday, love
- music, news, a country, a language, a story

Before you move on

Yesterday? (أمس, *ams.*) Tomorrow? (غدا, *ghadan.*) Now? (الآن, *al-ān.*) Sometimes? (أحياناً, *aḥyānan.*) Before? (قبل, *qabla.*) After? (بعد, *baʿda.*) Time? (وقت, *waqt.*) Far? (بعيد, *baʿīd.*) Near? (قريب, *qarīb.*) Inside? (داخل, *dākhil.*) Outside? (خارج, *khārij.*) Above? (فوق, *fawqa.*) Below? (تحت, *taḥta.*) In front of? (أمام, *amāma.*) Behind? (وراء, *warāʿa.*) Here? (هنا, *hunā.*) There? (هناك, *hunāka.*) Right? (يمين, *yamīn.*) A shop? (متجر, *matjar.*) A street? (شارع, *shāriʿ.*) A road? (طريق, *ṭarīq.*) A bank? (بنك, *bank.*) A station? (محطة, *maḥaṭṭa.*) A car? (سيارة, *sayyāra.*) A bus? (حافلة, *ḥāfila.*) A train? (قطار, *qitār.*) A bridge? (جسر, *jisr.*) A mosque? (مسجد, *masjid.*) A hotel? (فندق, *funduq.*) An office; a desk? (مكتب, *maktab.*) The police? (شرطة, *shurṭa.*) A market? (سوق, *sūq.*) A village? (قرية, *qarya.*) A city? (مدينة, *madīna.*) A restaurant? (مطعم, *maṭʿam.*) Clothes? (ملابس, *malābis.*) A shirt? (قميص, *qamiṣ.*) A dress? (فستان, *fustān.*) Trousers? (سروال, *sirwāl.*) A sock? (جورب, *jawrab.*) A pocket? (جيب, *jayb.*) A ring? (خاتم, *khātam.*) A hat? (قبعة, *qubbaʿa.*) A shoe? (حذاء, *ḥidhāʿ.*) A coat? (معطف, *miʿṭaf.*) A belt? (حزام, *ḥizām.*) Six? (ستة, *sitta.*) Seven? (سبعة, *sabʿa.*) Eight? (ثمانية, *thamāniya.*) Nine? (تسعة, *tisʿa.*) Ten? (عشرة, *ʿashara.*) Thirty? (ثلاثون, *thalāthūn.*) Forty? (أربعون, *arbaʿūn.*) Fifty? (خمسون, *khamṣūn.*) A thousand? (ألف, *alf.*) A colour? (لون, *lawn.*) A song? (أغنية, *ughniya.*) A journey? (رحلة, *riḥla.*) A holiday? (عطلة, *ʿuṭla.*) Love? (حب, *ḥubb.*) Music? (موسيقى, *mūsīqā.*) News? (أخبار, *akhbār.*) A country? (بلد, *balad.*) A language? (لغة, *lughā.*) A story? (قصة, *qiṣṣa.*)

Pronunciation & Script — a reference

A **reference**, not a chapter — a place to look things up as you go, never a wall to climb first. Chapter 1 (the reading course) teaches you to decode the script from zero, letter by letter, each letter introduced as a word needs it; this page just collects the sound-and-script facts in one spot. Lessons name the sounds they need and link here.

Transliteration note: this curriculum writes Arabic in both the **script** (مرحبا) and a **Latin transliteration** (*marḥaban*), with a dot under a letter marking the “heavy”/emphatic or throaty consonants.

The script, in one breath

- **Right to left.** Eyes and writing both go right → left.
- **Letters connect.** Most letters join to the next, so a letter has up to four shapes (isolated / initial / medial / final). You don’t drill these — you re-meet them inside real words.
- **Short vowels are often unwritten.** *a, i, u* are usually diacritics (harakāt) left off in everyday text; long vowels (ā, ī, ū) are written as letters (ا و ي).

Consonants with no English equivalent

- **ha-heavy** — ح (ḥ): a “heavy” *h*, breathed hard from deep in the throat (vs. the light ه *h*). *marḥaban, ṣabāḥ*.
- **kha** — خ (kh): a guttural scrape at the back of the throat = Scottish *loch*, German *Bach*, **Spanish** *j* (*jueves*). *khayr*.

- **ayn** — ع (ʿ, “cayn”): a tightening deep in the throat, voiced. No English equivalent; approximate it. *ʿalaykum*, *ʿafwan*.
- **hamza** — ء (ʾ): a **glottal stop**, the catch in “uh-oh.” *masāʾ*?
- غ (gh): like a French/guttural *r* (gargled *g*). ق (q): a *k* made far back, at the uvula.

Emphatic (“heavy”) consonants

- **emphatic-sad** — ص (ṣ), ض (ḍ), ط (ṭ), ظ (ẓ): heavier, deeper versions of *s*, *d*, *t*, *dh*, made with the tongue lower and the mouth fuller. They genuinely change the word (ص *ṣ* ≠ س *s*). *ṣabāḥ*.

Light consonants (close to English)

- **shin** — ش (sh) = English *sh* (*shukran*). س (s) = plain *s*. ب (b), ل (l), م (m), ر (r, a tapped/rolled *r* like Spanish), ن (n), ك (k), ت (t) — all near their English values.

The definite article and “sun/moon letters”

- **sun-moon** — ال (al-, “the”) attaches to its noun. Before a **sun letter** (ن ل ظ ط ض ص ش س ز ر ذ د ت) the *l* assimilates and the letter doubles: *al-salām* → **as-salām**, *al-nūr* → **an-nūr**. Before a **moon letter** (the rest, e.g. ب ك ق خ) the *l* stays: **al-khayr**. You can hear the sun-letter rule fossilized in Spanish *azúcar* (← *as-sukkar*).

The root system (structure, not pronunciation)

- Most words are built on a **three-consonant root** carrying a core meaning, poured into fixed vowel **patterns**: k-t-b (writing) → *kitāb* (book), *kātib* (writer), *maktab* (office). Learn a root and a few patterns, and you generate a whole family. See the first lesson.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

أغلق *aghlaqa*

to close (he closed)

Introduced in Chapter 59.

أهلاً *ahlan*

welcome

Introduced in Chapter 2.

أحياناً *aḥyānan*

sometimes

Introduced in Chapter 87.

أكل *akala*

“he ate” — no new letters, no English cousin, and a Hebrew twin close enough to hear; the sixth verb, closing the set

Introduced in Chapter 30.

أخبار *akhbār*

news

Introduced in Chapter 99.

الآن *al-ān*

now

Introduced in Chapter 87.

الحمد لله *al-ḥamdu lillāh*

praise be to God — the everyday answer to ‘how are you?’

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ألم *alam*

pain

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ألف *alf*

a thousand

Introduced in Chapter 97.

أمام *amāma*

in front of

Introduced in Chapter 89.

أمس *ams*

yesterday

Introduced in Chapter 87.

أنف *anf*

a nose

Introduced in Chapter 50.

أراد *arāda*

to want (he wanted)

Introduced in Chapter 61.

أربعون *arba^cūn*

forty

Introduced in Chapter 97.

أرض *arḍ*

the floor; the earth

Introduced in Chapter 70.

أرسل *arsala*

to send (he sent)

Introduced in Chapter 61.

أرز *aruzz*

rice

Introduced in Chapter 66.

السلامة *as-salāma*

the safety — Chapter 1's salām, plus a pattern and a feminine ending

Introduced in Chapter 4.

as-salāmu °alaykum

peace be upon you

Introduced in Chapter 1.

أسد *asad*

a lion

Introduced in Chapter 79.

أو *aw*

or — two letters, and the word an offer cannot be made without

Introduced in Chapter 38.

أعطى *a^cṭā*

to give (he gave)

Introduced in Chapter 59.

باب *bāb*

a door

Introduced in Chapter 72.

بحث *baḥatha*

to look for (he looked for)

Introduced in Chapter 62.

بحر *baḥr*

the sea

Introduced in Chapter 77.

بكى *bakā*

to cry (he cried)

Introduced in Chapter 60.

بلد *balad*

a country

Introduced in Chapter 99.

بنك *bank*

a bank

Introduced in Chapter 91.

بقرة *baqara*

a cow

Introduced in Chapter 79.

بصل *baṣal*

onions

Introduced in Chapter 68.

بطاطس *baṭāṭis*

potatoes

Introduced in Chapter 66.

بطيء *baṭīʿ*

slow

Introduced in Chapter 83.

بيض *bayḍ*

eggs

Introduced in Chapter 68.

باع *bāʿa*

to sell (he sold)

Introduced in Chapter 59.

بعد *baʿda*

after

Introduced in Chapter 88.

بعيد *baʿīd*

far

Introduced in Chapter 88.

بخير *bi-khayr*

well, fine — literally 'in goodness'

Introduced in Chapter 3.

بني *bunnī*

brown

Introduced in Chapter 86.

برتقال *burtuqāl*

oranges

Introduced in Chapter 68.

دفتر *daftar*

a notebook

Introduced in Chapter 73.

ضحك *ḍaḥika*

to laugh (he laughed)

Introduced in Chapter 60.

دجاج *daǰāj*

chicken

Introduced in Chapter 69.

دجاجة *daǰāja*

a hen

Introduced in Chapter 81.

دخل *dakhala*

to enter (he entered)

Introduced in Chapter 63.

داخل *dākhil*

inside

Introduced in Chapter 88.

دم *dam*

blood

Introduced in Chapter 52.

دقيقة *daqāqa*

a minute

Introduced in Chapter 86.

درس *dars*

a lesson

Introduced in Chapter 74.

دواء *dawāʿ*

medicine

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ضيف *ḍayf*

a guest

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ذهب *dhahaba*

he went” — the track’s first verb, and the clearest possible view of the root-and-pattern engine, since the same three consonants also give “gold” and “a school of law

Introduced in Chapter 28.

دب *dubb*

a bear

Introduced in Chapter 80.

فهم *fahima*

“he understood” — the first verb whose middle vowel is not an a, marking it a state rather than a deed, and the done-to shape that turns it into the word for a concept

Introduced in Chapter 31.

فاكهة *fākiha*

fruit

Introduced in Chapter 66.

فكر *fakkara*

“he thought” — the first verb that is not a bare root at all, but a root rebuilt by doubling its middle letter, and the mu- doer that comes with the rebuild

Introduced in Chapter 32.

فم *fam*

a mouth

Introduced in Chapter 50.

فقير *faqīr*

poor

Introduced in Chapter 84.

فارغ *fāriḡh*

empty

Introduced in Chapter 84.

فتح *fataḥa*

to open (he opened)

Introduced in Chapter 59.

فوق *fawqa*

above

Introduced in Chapter 89.

فاز *fāza*

to win (he won)

Introduced in Chapter 65.

فأر *faʿr*

a mouse

Introduced in Chapter 79.

فيل *fil*

an elephant

Introduced in Chapter 80.

فندق *funduq*

a hotel

Introduced in Chapter 92.

فستان *fustān*

a dress

Introduced in Chapter 94.

فطور *fuṭūr*

breakfast

Introduced in Chapter 68.

غابة *ghāba*

a forest

Introduced in Chapter 76.

غدا *ghadan*

tomorrow

Introduced in Chapter 87.

غني *ghanī*

rich

Introduced in Chapter 84.

غسل *ghasala*

to wash (he washed)

Introduced in Chapter 60.

غرفة *ghurfa*

a room

Introduced in Chapter 69.

حديقة *ḥadīqa*

a garden

Introduced in Chapter 72.

حافلة *ḥāfila*

a bus

Introduced in Chapter 91.

حجر *ḥajar*

a stone

Introduced in Chapter 76.

حاج *ḥājj*

a pilgrim

Introduced in Chapter 3.

حال *ḥāl*

state, condition — the thing Arabic actually asks about

Introduced in Chapter 3.

حليب *ḥalīb*

“milk” — the opposite case to *shāy*: a home-grown noun sitting straight on the verb for milking, and a Hebrew twin that is the same word
Introduced in Chapter 33.

حمل *ḥamala*

to carry (he carried)
Introduced in Chapter 65.

حقيبة *ḥaqība*

a bag
Introduced in Chapter 74.

حقل *ḥaql*

a field
Introduced in Chapter 76.

حسنًا *ḥasanan*

all right, fine, very well — the backchannel this track had no word for, and the first way a learner can agree with somebody
Introduced in Chapter 38.

حزين *ḥazīn*

sad
Introduced in Chapter 54.

حذاء *ḥidhāʿ*

a shoe
Introduced in Chapter 95.

حمار *ḥimār*

a donkey
Introduced in Chapter 81.

حينما *ḥīnamā*

when — the clause joiner that puts one event beside another in time, with the same ما inside it the last chapter taught twice
Introduced in Chapter 40.

حصان *ḥiṣān*

a horse
Introduced in Chapter 78.

حزام *ḥizām*

a belt
Introduced in Chapter 96.

حب *ḥubb*

love
Introduced in Chapter 98.

حمى *ḥummā*

a fever
Introduced in Chapter 53.

هنا *hunā*

here

Introduced in Chapter 90.

هناك *hunāka*

there

Introduced in Chapter 90.

ابن بنت *ibn, bint*

son and daughter — one pair gendered by a single added ت, exactly as أخ and أخت were, and the ibn that stands in the middle of names English already knows

Introduced in Chapter 35.

إلى الغد *ilā l-ghad*

see you tomorrow — literally 'until tomorrow', reusing the same ilā ('until') already met in see you later

Introduced in Chapter 24.

إلى اللقاء *ilā l-liqāʿ*

see you — literally 'until the meeting', the structure Spanish borrowed a word for

Introduced in Chapter 4.

امرأة *imraʿa*

a woman

Introduced in Chapter 56.

انتظر *intaẓara*

to wait (he waited)

Introduced in Chapter 64.

إصبع *iṣbaʿ*

a finger

Introduced in Chapter 51.

اشتري *ishtarā*

to buy (he bought)

Introduced in Chapter 58.

جبل *jabal*

a mountain

Introduced in Chapter 75.

جد *jadd*

a grandfather

Introduced in Chapter 54.

جدة *jadda*

a grandmother

Introduced in Chapter 55.

جديد *jadīd*

new

Introduced in Chapter 82.

جلس *jalasa*

to sit (he sat)

Introduced in Chapter 57.

جمل *jamal*

a camel

Introduced in Chapter 81.

جميل *jamīl*

beautiful

Introduced in Chapter 86.

جار *jār*

“neighbour” — the person you introduce most often, built on a hollow root whose middle letter hides exactly as *qāla*’s does

Introduced in Chapter 35.

جواب *jawāb*

an answer

Introduced in Chapter 74.

جورب *jawrab*

a sock

Introduced in Chapter 94.

جيب *jayb*

a pocket

Introduced in Chapter 95.

جيد *jayyid*

good

Introduced in Chapter 82.

جزر *jazar*

carrots

Introduced in Chapter 67.

جاء *jāʾa*

“he came” — the partner of *dhahaba*, and the first root whose middle letter is weak enough to vanish, showing that even Arabic’s irregularities are patterned

Introduced in Chapter 28.

جدار *jidār*

a wall

Introduced in Chapter 70.

جسر *jīsr*

a bridge

Introduced in Chapter 92.

جبين *jubn*

“cheese” — and an honest limit on the root system, because the very same three letters also spell cowardice and the two are not one idea

Introduced in Chapter 34.

جوع *jū^c*

hunger

Introduced in Chapter 54.

كبير *kabīr*

big

Introduced in Chapter 81.

كلمة *kalima*

a word

Introduced in Chapter 75.

كّرر فضلك من كّرر *karrir min faḍlik*

say it again, please — the second half of a repair kit whose first half arrived four chapters ago, and the first command this book has ever given

Introduced in Chapter 41.

كتب *kataba*

“he wrote” — the chapter’s payoff, where one root and the patterns you already own hand you a book, a writer, an office and a library with nothing new to memorise

Introduced in Chapter 31.

كتف *katif*

a shoulder

Introduced in Chapter 51.

كيف *kayfa*

how

Introduced in Chapter 3.

حالك؟ كيف *kayfa ḥāluka / kayfa ḥāluki*

how are you? — literally ‘how [is] your state?’, gendered -ka / -ki

Introduced in Chapter 3.

خفيف *khafīf*

light (in weight)

Introduced in Chapter 85.

خال *khāl*

an uncle (mother’s brother)

Introduced in Chapter 55.

خمسون *khamsūn*

fifty

Introduced in Chapter 97.

خرج *kharaja*

to go out (he went out)

Introduced in Chapter 64.

خارج *khārij*

outside

Introduced in Chapter 89.

خريطة *kharīṭa*

a map

Introduced in Chapter 74.

خروف *kharūf*

a sheep

Introduced in Chapter 79.

خاتم *khātam*

a ring

Introduced in Chapter 95.

خطأ *khataʿ*

a mistake; wrong

Introduced in Chapter 85.

كتاب *kitāb*

a book

Introduced in Chapter 73.

كوب *kūb*

“a cup” — the word that opens Arabic’s broken plural, where more than one is not made by adding anything but by re-pouring the word into a new shape

Introduced in Chapter 36.

كوخ *kūkh*

a hut

Introduced in Chapter 1.

كرسي *kursī*

a chair

Introduced in Chapter 70.

لا أفهم *lā afham*

I do not understand — the one hole in an otherwise strong repair kit, one present-tense form away since chapter thirty-one

Introduced in Chapter 37.

لبس *labisa*

to wear (he wore)

Introduced in Chapter 62.

لحم *lahm*

“meat” — one Semitic root that Arabic settled on meat and Hebrew settled on bread, with Bethlehem sitting on the seam between them

Introduced in Chapter 34.

لكن *lākin*

but — the first word in this book that can set one clause against another, and three letters the reader has owned since chapter two

Introduced in Chapter 38.

لون *lawn*

a colour

Introduced in Chapter 98.

ليمون *laymūn*

lemons

Introduced in Chapter 68.

ليس *laysa*

is not — the denial of the nominal sentence, which is the one thing this book teaches productively and could not deny

Introduced in Chapter 39.

لعب *la^ciba*

to play (he played)

Introduced in Chapter 58.

لأن *li-anna*

because — the answer to the question the lesson before taught, and the same ل with a complementiser behind it

Introduced in Chapter 40.

لماذا؟ *limādhā?*

why — the question this book has never been able to ask, built out of the preposition ل and the word for “what”

Introduced in Chapter 40.

لغة *lugha*

a language

Introduced in Chapter 99.

مدينة *madīna*

a city

Introduced in Chapter 93.

مدرسة *madrasa*

a school

Introduced in Chapter 73.

محطة *maḥaṭṭa*

a station

Introduced in Chapter 91.

مكتب *maktab*

an office; a desk

Introduced in Chapter 92.

مال *māl*

money

Introduced in Chapter 74.

ملابس *malābis*

clothes

Introduced in Chapter 94.

منزل *manzil*

a house

Introduced in Chapter 69.

marḥaban

hello / welcome — there is room for you

Introduced in Chapter 1.

مريض *marīḍ*

ill, sick

Introduced in Chapter 53.

مشى *mashā*

to walk (he walked)

Introduced in Chapter 58.

مسجد *masjid*

a mosque

Introduced in Chapter 92.

مطبخ *maṭbakh*

a kitchen

Introduced in Chapter 72.

متجر *maṭjar*

a shop

Introduced in Chapter 90.

مطعم *maṭʿam*

a restaurant

Introduced in Chapter 93.

موز *mawz*

bananas

Introduced in Chapter 66.

مع *maʿa*

with

Introduced in Chapter 4.

مع السلامة *maʿa s-salāma*

goodbye — literally ‘with safety’, closing the greeting arc on the root that opened it

Introduced in Chapter 4.

ماعز *māʿiz*

a goat

Introduced in Chapter 79.

مفتاح *miṭṭāḥ*

a key

Introduced in Chapter 71.

ملح *milḥ*

“salt” — a plain Semitic word whose root also gives Arabic its sailor and its word for handsome, and which shows ḥāʾ in its final shape

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ملعقة *mil^ʿaqā*

“a spoon” — the closing payoff, where the mi- tool shape stands beside the ma- place shape you already own, and where sound and broken plurals finally sort themselves out

Introduced in Chapter 36.

مرآة *mir^ʾāh*

a mirror

Introduced in Chapter 71.

مصباح *miṣbāḥ*

a lamp

Introduced in Chapter 71.

معطف *mi^ʿṭaf*

a coat

Introduced in Chapter 95.

مُدَرِّس *mudarris*

a teacher

Introduced in Chapter 2.

مهم *muḥimm*

important

Introduced in Chapter 85.

موسيقى *mūsīqā*

music

Introduced in Chapter 99.

مستشفى *mustashfā*

a hospital

Introduced in Chapter 53.

معلم *mu^ʿallim*

a teacher

Introduced in Chapter 57.

نافذة *nāfidha*

a window

Introduced in Chapter 69.

نهر *nahr*

a river

Introduced in Chapter 76.

نجم *najm*

a star

Introduced in Chapter 77.

نام *nāma*

to sleep (he slept)

Introduced in Chapter 57.

نمر *namir*

a tiger

Introduced in Chapter 80.

نار *nār*

fire

Introduced in Chapter 78.

نسي *nasiya*

to forget (he forgot)

Introduced in Chapter 61.

نزل *nazala*

to go down (he went down)

Introduced in Chapter 65.

نظيف *naẓīf*

clean

Introduced in Chapter 84.

قبل *qabla*

before

Introduced in Chapter 87.

قدم *qadam*

a foot

Introduced in Chapter 51.

قديم *qadīm*

old

Introduced in Chapter 82.

قهوة *qahwa*

“coffee” — the chapter’s payoff, where the tied *tāʾ* finally earns its keep as Arabic’s visible gender marker, and where you can order everything the chapter taught

Introduced in Chapter 33.

قال *qāla*

“he said” — the letter *qāf* finally named, and one root that yields a saying, an article, a speaker and a spoken thing

Introduced in Chapter 29.

قلم *qalam*

a pen

Introduced in Chapter 73.

قلب *qalb*

the heart

Introduced in Chapter 52.

قام *qāma*

to stand up (he stood up)

Introduced in Chapter 58.

قمر *qamar*

the moon

Introduced in Chapter 77.

قميص *qamīṣ*

a shirt

Introduced in Chapter 94.

قرأ *qaraʿa*

“he read, he recited” — hamza’s three seats sorted out at last, and the one root in this chapter that really did give English a word

Introduced in Chapter 31.

قريب *qarīb*

near

Introduced in Chapter 88.

قرية *qarya*

a village

Introduced in Chapter 93.

قصير *qaṣīr*

short

Introduced in Chapter 82.

قطع *qaṭaʿa*

to cut (he cut)

Introduced in Chapter 61.

قرد *qird*

a monkey

Introduced in Chapter 80.

قصة *qiṣṣa*

a story

Introduced in Chapter 99.

قطار *qiṭār*

a train

Introduced in Chapter 92.

قبعة *qubbaʿa*

a hat

Introduced in Chapter 95.

رجع *rajaʿa*

to come back (he came back)

Introduced in Chapter 64.

رجل *rajul*

a man

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ركض *rakaḍa*

to run (he ran)

Introduced in Chapter 58.

رخيص *rakhāṣ*

cheap

Introduced in Chapter 83.

رمى *ramā*

to throw (he threw)

Introduced in Chapter 63.

رمل *raml*

sand

Introduced in Chapter 76.

رقبة *raqaba*

the neck

Introduced in Chapter 51.

رقص *raqaṣa*

to dance (he danced)

Introduced in Chapter 60.

رأى *raʾā*

“he saw” — the dotless alif maqṣūra named at last, and a root whose seeing turns into opinion and into the word for a mirror

Introduced in Chapter 29.

ريح *rīḥ*

wind

Introduced in Chapter 78.

رحلة *riḥla*

a journey

Introduced in Chapter 98.

ركبة *rukba*

a knee

Introduced in Chapter 52.

سبح *sabaḥa*

to swim (he swam)

Introduced in Chapter 63.

سبعة *sabʿa*

seven

Introduced in Chapter 96.

صديق *ṣadīq*

“friend” — the chapter’s payoff, where a root meaning truth explains the word, the faʿīl pattern turns up for the third time, and every family word you own lines up behind it

Introduced in Chapter 35.

صغير *ṣaghīr*

small

Introduced in Chapter 81.

سحابة *saḥāba*

a cloud

Introduced in Chapter 77.

صحيح *ṣaḥīḥ*

correct, true

Introduced in Chapter 85.

سهل *sahl*

easy

Introduced in Chapter 83.

صحن *ṣaḥn*

a plate

Introduced in Chapter 71.

سكن *sakana*

to live (he lived)

Introduced in Chapter 64.

salām

peace / hello

Introduced in Chapter 1.

سمك *samak*

fish

Introduced in Chapter 65.

سماء *samā^ʔ*

the sky

Introduced in Chapter 78.

سمع *sami^ca*

to hear (he heard)

Introduced in Chapter 57.

صنع *ṣana^ca*

to make (he made)

Introduced in Chapter 63.

سرير *sarīr*

a bed

Introduced in Chapter 70.

سريع *sarī^c*

fast

Introduced in Chapter 83.

سيارة *sayyāra*

a car

Introduced in Chapter 91.

سأل *sa^ʔala*

“he asked” — one root that builds a question, a problem, an asker and the word for being answerable, plus the Hebrew twin hiding inside the name Saul

Introduced in Chapter 31.

ساعد *sā^cada*

“he helped” — a root that means good fortune, stretched by one long vowel into a verb aimed at somebody else, and the family name behind the word Saudi
Introduced in Chapter 32.

صعب *ṣa^cb*

difficult

Introduced in Chapter 83.

سعيد *sa^cīd*

happy

Introduced in Chapter 54.

شهر *shahr*

a month

Introduced in Chapter 86.

شجرة *shajara*

a tree

Introduced in Chapter 75.

شمس *shams*

the sun

Introduced in Chapter 77.

شرب *shariba*

to drink (he drank)

Introduced in Chapter 57.

شارع *shāri^c*

a street

Introduced in Chapter 90.

شوكة *shawka*

a fork

Introduced in Chapter 72.

شاي *shāy*

“tea” — the first noun in this book with no Arabic root at all, and a word that reached Arabic and English from the same Chinese original by two different roads
Introduced in Chapter 33.

شعر *sha^cr*

hair

Introduced in Chapter 51.

شرطة *shurṭa*

the police

Introduced in Chapter 93.

سكين *sikkīn*

a knife

Introduced in Chapter 71.

سن *sinn*

a tooth

Introduced in Chapter 50.

سروال *sirwāl*

trousers

Introduced in Chapter 94.

ستة *sitta*

six

Introduced in Chapter 96.

سكر *sukkar*

“sugar” — a word that crossed Asia and Europe, and the one that shows Arabic’s own al- fused onto the front of a Spanish noun

Introduced in Chapter 33.

سوق *sūq*

a market

Introduced in Chapter 93.

صورة *ṣūra*

a picture

Introduced in Chapter 75.

طبخ *ṭabakha*

to cook (he cooked)

Introduced in Chapter 60.

طبق *ṭabaq*

“a plate” — a second broken plural in the very same shape as *akwāb*, which turns a surprise into a pattern, and a root whose other child is a storey of a building

Introduced in Chapter 36.

طبيب *ṭabīb*

a doctor

Introduced in Chapter 54.

تحت *taḥta*

below

Introduced in Chapter 89.

تكلم *takallama*

to speak (he spoke)

Introduced in Chapter 65.

طماطم *ṭamāṭim*

tomatoes

Introduced in Chapter 67.

طار *ṭāra*

to fly (he flew)

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ترك *taraka*

to leave (he left)

Introduced in Chapter 62.

طريق *ṭarīq*

a road

Introduced in Chapter 91.

طويل *ṭawīl*

long, tall

Introduced in Chapter 82.

طاولة *ṭāwila*

a table

Introduced in Chapter 70.

تعلم *taʿallama*

to learn (he learned)

Introduced in Chapter 61.

طعام *ṭaʿām*

“food” — the chapter’s payoff, where a root you have never met hands you the word for restaurant free of charge, because you already own the pattern

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ثابت *thābit*

steady, firm

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ثلاثون *thalāthūn*

thirty

Introduced in Chapter 97.

ثلج *thalj*

snow

Introduced in Chapter 78.

ثمن *thaman*

a price

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ثمانية *thamāniya*

eight

Introduced in Chapter 96.

ثقيل *thaqīl*

heavy

Introduced in Chapter 85.

ثعبان *thuʿbān*

a snake

Introduced in Chapter 80.

طفل *ṭifl*

a child

Introduced in Chapter 56.

تسعة *tisʿa*

nine

Introduced in Chapter 96.

تفاحة *tuffāḥa*

an apple

Introduced in Chapter 66.

خير على تصبح *tuṣbiḥ ʿalā khayr*

“good night” — but honestly, it doesn’t wish you a good NIGHT at all; it wishes you a good morning, reusing both roots from ṣabāḥ al-khayr and masāʾ al-khayr
Introduced in Chapter 27.

أذن *udhun*

an ear

Introduced in Chapter 50.

أغنية *ughniya*

a song

Introduced in Chapter 98.

أسبوع *usbūʿ*

a week

Introduced in Chapter 86.

و *wa-*

and — the commonest word in written Arabic, glossed once in chapter one inside
a fixed reply and taught never

Introduced in Chapter 38.

وضع *waḍaʿa*

to put (he put)

Introduced in Chapter 59.

وجد *wajada*

to find (he found)

Introduced in Chapter 62.

وجه *wajh*

a face

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ولد *walad*

a boy

Introduced in Chapter 56.

وقف *waqafa*

to stop (he stopped)

Introduced in Chapter 62.

وقت *waqt*

time

Introduced in Chapter 88.

ورقة *waraqā*

a sheet of paper

Introduced in Chapter 73.

وراء *warāʿa*

behind

Introduced in Chapter 89.

وسخ *wasikh*

dirty

Introduced in Chapter 84.

يمين *yamīn*

right (side)

Introduced in Chapter 90.

ظهر *ẓahr*

the back

Introduced in Chapter 52.

زهرة *zahrā*

a flower

Introduced in Chapter 75.

زوج *zawj*

a husband

Introduced in Chapter 55.

زوجة *zawja*

a wife

Introduced in Chapter 55.

زيت *zayt*

“oil” — one new letter that is only *rā* wearing a dot, and a second Spanish word carrying Arabic’s article welded to its front

Introduced in Chapter 36.

زبدة *zubda*

butter

Introduced in Chapter 67.

زجاجة *zujāja*

a bottle

Introduced in Chapter 72.

أحبّ *ʾaḥabba*

“he loved” — the chapter’s payoff, closing the ladder of four verb shapes, and the root behind the *ḥabībī* of every second Arabic song

Introduced in Chapter 32.

أخذ *ʾakhadha*

“he took” — the last plain-shaped verb in the book, kept as the control against the three rebuilt verbs that follow, with a Hebrew twin reached by two regular consonant swaps

Introduced in Chapter 32.

عمل *ʿamila*

to work (he worked)

Introduced in Chapter 64.

عم *ʿamm*

an uncle (father’s brother)

Introduced in Chapter 55.

عرف *ʿarafa*

“he knew, he recognised” — one of Arabic’s two words for knowing, whose root reached Spain and named a palace in Granada

Introduced in Chapter 30.

عسل *ʿasal*

honey

Introduced in Chapter 67.

عشرة *ʿashara*

ten

Introduced in Chapter 97.

عصير *ʿaṣīr*

juice

Introduced in Chapter 69.

عين *ʿayn*

an eye

Introduced in Chapter 50.

عيد *ʿīd*

a feast day

Introduced in Chapter 1.

عنب *ʿinab*

grapes

Introduced in Chapter 67.

عطلة *ʿuṭla*

a holiday

Introduced in Chapter 98.

أم أب

father and mother — ancient Semitic roots, cousins of Hebrew’s own family words

Introduced in Chapter 10.

عشرون — عشر أحد

11-15, plain “X-and-ten” compounds — then twenty, NOT “two-ten” but its OWN plural form of “ten”

Introduced in Chapter 20.

أزرق أحمر

red and blue — the same gendered color template as black and white

Introduced in Chapter 9.

أخت أخ

brother and sister — one shared Semitic root, gendered by a single added letter
Introduced in Chapter 10.

أصفر, أخضر

green and yellow — akhdar's root also gives “vegetables” (echoing English's own “greens”), and asfar shares its root with sifr, “zero” — the very word behind English “zero” and “cipher”
Introduced in Chapter 22.

آسفة / آسف

sorry (āsif masc. / āsifa fem. — a GENDERED adjective, from asifa “to grieve, regret”)
Introduced in Chapter 7.

اسم

name

Introduced in Chapter 2.

... اسمي

my name is... (with no “is”)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

أبيض أسود

black and white — color adjectives that change shape with gender, more than “sorry” did
Introduced in Chapter 9.

ال

the (al- — the attached article)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

الخميس الأربعاء الثلاثاء الإثنين الأحد

Sunday–Thursday — Arabic counts its weekdays instead of naming them for planets
Introduced in Chapter 8.

السبت الجمعة

Friday and Saturday — the two days that break the counting pattern
Introduced in Chapter 8.

الساعة

hour / o'clock — and the same word Arabic uses for “clock” and “a while”
Introduced in Chapter 16.

الطقس

weather — the SAME root also gives “rite, religious ceremony”; hot/cold are verbless adjectives, but rain gets its own personal verb
Introduced in Chapter 18.

الليل منتصف الظهر

noon (also the name of the midday Islamic prayer) and midnight (“the half of the night”)
Introduced in Chapter 15.

أنت

you (anta m. / anti f.)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

تشرّفنا

pleased to meet you (literally “we have been honoured”)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

رأس

the head — a Semitic root cognate with Hebrew rosh, and the source of “president” in Arabic itself

Introduced in Chapter 11.

شتاء خريف صيف ربيع

the four seasons — Modern Standard Arabic’s set, though the classical calendar didn’t always carve up the year this way

Introduced in Chapter 12.

شكرا

thank you (shukran)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

الخير صباح

good morning (ṣabāḥ al-khayr — “morning of goodness”)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

عفوًا

“you’re welcome” (also “excuse me/pardon/sorry,” depending on context) — root ʿ-f-w, “to erase, to pardon”; grammatically the same construction as shukran itself

Introduced in Chapter 23.

قط, كلب

dog and cat — kalb is a solid, well-attested Semitic root (cousin of Hebrew’s own dog-word), unlike the tangled dog-words of Spanish, Hindi, and English; qitt most likely closes the loop, widely compared to the SAME ancient root behind Latin’s cattus/gato/chat/Katze, though the exact relationship is still debated

Introduced in Chapter 21.

عمرڪ؟ كم

how old are you? — literally “how much [is] your lifetime?”; age as a NOUN you possess, not a verb you conjugate

Introduced in Chapter 17.

لا

no (lā)

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ليل

“night” — the word already hiding inside muntaṣaf al-layl (‘midnight’), and yawm’s pan-Semitic partner, cognate with Hebrew layla

Introduced in Chapter 26.

ما

what

Introduced in Chapter 2.

اسمك؟ ما

what's your name?

Introduced in Chapter 2.

خبز ماء

water and bread — one of Arabic's most irregular common words, and one built on a clean, ordinary Semitic root

Introduced in Chapter 13.

الخير مساء

good evening (masāʾ al-khayr — “evening of goodness”)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

فضلك من

please (min faḍlik — literally “from your grace”)

Introduced in Chapter 6.

نعم

yes (naʿam)

Introduced in Chapter 5.

خمسة أربعة ثلاثة اثنان واحد

one through five — the Arabic WORDS for numbers, genuinely different from “Arabic numerals” (the written digit shapes 0-9), which actually trace back to India

Introduced in Chapter 19.

ي

my (possessive suffix -ī)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

يد

the hand — an ancient Semitic root, nearly unchanged since its Hebrew cousin

Introduced in Chapter 11.

ديسمبر نوفمبر أكتوبر سبتمبر أغسطس يوليو يونيو مايو أبريل مارس فبراير يناير

the Gregorian months — Latin names borrowed almost intact, running ALONGSIDE the Islamic calendar's own, entirely different lunar months

Introduced in Chapter 14.

يوم

day” — a true pan-Semitic word, cognate with Hebrew yom (as in Yom Kippur), and possibly tracing all the way back to an ancient word for “sun

Introduced in Chapter 25.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 3

3.1 ،ح ،خ ح — *the dots trick, on a brand-new body*

Where is the dot on خ?

Chapter 42

42.1 (*reading*) — *six old words, with the training wheels gone*

Which written word means tea?

42.2 (*reading*) — *six lines that already know each other*

Which written line asks for the other person's name?

42.3 (*reading*) — *the first whole encounter*

Which drink is accepted in the passage?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 3

3.1 ح، خ، ج — *the dots trick, on a brand-new body*

Answer: above

Also accepted: one above; above the body

Chapter 42

42.1 (*reading*) — *six old words, with the training wheels gone*

Answer: شاي

Also accepted: shay; shāy; tea

42.2 (*reading*) — *six lines that already know each other*

Answer: اسمك؟ ما

Also accepted: اسمك ما; ma ismuka; mā ismuka

42.3 (*reading*) — *the first whole encounter*

Answer: tea

Also accepted: شاي; shay; shāy

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic.
Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced;
the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

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**11-15, plain “X-and-ten” compounds — then twenty, NOT
“two-ten” but its OWN plural form of “ten” عشرون — عشر أحد**
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A

a bag حقيبة (ḥaqība)

Chapter 74, p. 377

a bank بنك (bank)

Chapter 91, p. 449

a bear دب (dubb)

Chapter 80, p. 405

a bed سرير (sarīr)

Chapter 70, p. 361

a belt حزام (ḥizām)

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a book كتاب (kitāb)

Chapter 73, p. 373

a bottle زجاجة (zujāja)

Chapter 72, p. 369

a boy ولد (walad)

Chapter 56, p. 305

a bridge جسر (jīsr)

Chapter 92, p. 453

a bus حافلة (ḥāfila)

Chapter 91, p. 449

a camel جمل (jamal)

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a car سيارة (sayyāra)

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a chair كرسي (kursī)

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a city مدينة (madīna)

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a cloud سحابة (saḥāba)

Chapter 77, p. 393

a coat معطف (mi^cṭaf)

Chapter 95, p. 465

a colour لون (lawn)

Chapter 98, p. 477

a country بلد (balad)

Chapter 99, p. 481

a cow بقرة (baqara)

Chapter 79, p. 401

“a cup” — the word that opens Arabic’s broken plural, where more than one is not made by adding anything but by re-pouring the word into a new shape كوب (kūb)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 195

a doctor طبيب (ṭabīb)

Chapter 54, p. 297

a donkey حمار (ḥimār)

Chapter 81, p. 409

a door باب (bāb)

Chapter 72, p. 369

a dress فستان (fustān)

Chapter 94, p. 461

a face وجه (wajh)

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a feast day عيد (ʿīd)

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a fever حمى (ḥummā)

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a field حقل (ḥaql)

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a finger إصبع (iṣba^c)

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a flower زهرة (zahra)

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- a fork** شوكة (shawka)
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- a garden** حديقة (ḥadīqa)
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- a goat** ماعز (mā^ciz)
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- a grandfather** جد (jadd)
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- a hen** دجاجة (dajāja)
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- a holiday** عطلة (ʿuṭla)
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- a horse** حصان (ḥiṣān)
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- a hospital** مستشفى (mustashfā)
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- a hotel** فندق (funduq)
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- a mirror** مرآة (mirʾāh)
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- a mistake; wrong** خطأ (khaṭaʾ)
Chapter 85, p. 425
- a monkey** قرد (qird)
Chapter 80, p. 405
- a month** شهر (shahr)
Chapter 86, p. 429
- a mosque** مسجد (masjid)
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- a mountain** جبل (jabal)
Chapter 75, p. 385
- a mouse** فأر (faʾr)
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- a mouth** فم (fam)
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“a plate” — a second broken plural in the very same shape as akwāb, which turns a surprise into a pattern, and a root whose other child is a storey of a building طبق (ṭabaq)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 195

a pocket جيب (jayb)

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a ring خاتم (khātam)

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a room غرفة (ghurfa)

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a sheep خروف (kharūf)

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a sheet of paper ورقة (waraqā)

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a shirt قميص (qamīṣ)

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a shoe حذاء (ḥidhāʿ)

Chapter 95, p. 465

a shop متجر (matjar)

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a shoulder كتف (katif)

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a snake ثعبان (thuʿbān)

Chapter 80, p. 405

a sock جورب (jawrab)

Chapter 94, p. 461

a song أغنية (ughniya)

Chapter 98, p. 477

“a spoon” — the closing payoff, where the mi- tool shape stands beside the ma- place shape you already own, and where sound and broken plurals finally sort themselves out ملعقة (milʿaqa)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 195

- a star** نجم (najm)
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- a station** محطة (maḥaṭṭa)
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- a stone** حجر (ḥajar)
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- a week** أسبوع (usbū^c)
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- a wife** زوجة (zawja)
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- a window** نافذة (nāfidha)
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- after** بعد (ba^cda)
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After, Time, Far, Near, Inside

chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 437

all right, fine, very well — the backchannel this track had no word for, and the first way a learner can agree with**somebody** حسناً (ḥasanan)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 38, p. 209

an answer جواب (jawāb)

Chapter 74, p. 377

an apple تفاحة (tuffāḥa)

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an ear أذن (udhun)

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an elephant فيل (fil)

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an eye عين (ʿayn)

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an office; a desk مكتب (maktab)

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an uncle (father’s brother) عم (ʿamm)

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an uncle (mother’s brother) خال (khāl)

Chapter 55, p. 301

and — the commonest word in written Arabic, glossed once in chapter one inside a fixed reply and taught never و (wa-)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 209

as-salāmu ʿalaykum — hear, write, repair

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

Asking for a Drink

chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 169

Asking for Food

chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 177

Asking Someone’s Age

chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 109

B**Bag, Money, Map, Lesson, Answer**

chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 377

bananas موز (mawz)

Chapter 66, p. 345

beautiful جميل (jamīl)

Chapter 86, p. 429

Beautiful, Brown, Week, Month, Minute

chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 429

**because — the answer to the question the lesson before taught,
and the same ل with a complementiser behind it** لأن (li-anna)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 40, p. 225

before قبل (qabla)

Chapter 87, p. 433

behind وراء (warāʿa)

Chapter 89, p. 441

below تحت (taḥta)

Chapter 89, p. 441

Belt, Six, Seven, Eight, Nine

chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 469

big كبير (kabīr)

Chapter 81, p. 409

**black and white — color adjectives that change shape with
gender, more than “sorry” did** أبيض أسود

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 9, p. 81

blood دم (dam)

Chapter 52, p. 289

Book, Notebook, Pen, Sheet of paper, School

chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 373

breakfast فطور (fuṭūr)

Chapter 68, p. 353

**brother and sister — one shared Semitic root, gendered by a
single added letter** أخت أخ

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 85

brown بني (bunnī)

Chapter 86, p. 429

**but — the first word in this book that can set one clause against
another, and three letters the reader has owned since chapter****two** لكن (lākin)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 209

butter زبدة (zubda)

Chapter 67, p. 349

C**Calling Somebody, and Asking Again**

chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 233

Camel, Donkey, Hen, Big, Small

chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 409

carrots جزر (jazar)

Chapter 67, p. 349

Chair, Table, Wall, Bed, Floor

chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 361

cheap رخيص (rakhīṣ)

Chapter 83, p. 417

“cheese” — and an honest limit on the root system, because the very same three letters also spell cowardice and the two are not one idea جبن (jubn)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 177

chicken دجاج (daḡāj)

Chapter 69, p. 357

Child, Boy, Man, Woman, Guest

chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 305

clean نظيف (naẓīf)

Chapter 84, p. 421

clothes ملابس (malābis)

Chapter 94, p. 461

Clothes, Shirt, Dress, Trousers, Sock

chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 461

“coffee” — the chapter’s payoff, where the tied tāʾ finally earns its keep as Arabic’s visible gender marker, and where you can order everything the chapter taught قهوة (qahwa)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 169

Colour, Song, Journey, Holiday, Love

chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 477

correct, true صحيح (ṣaḡīḡ)

Chapter 85, p. 425

Cow, Goat, Sheep, Mouse, Lion

chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 401

Cups, Plates, and More Than One

chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 195

D

Day

chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 133

day” — a true pan-Semitic word, cognate with Hebrew yom (as in Yom Kippur), and possibly tracing all the way back to an ancient word for “sun يوم

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 25, p. 133

Days of the Week

chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 77

Denying, and Asking

chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 217

difficult صعب (ṣaʿb)

Chapter 83, p. 417

dirty وسخ (wasikh)

Chapter 84, p. 421

Dog and Cat

chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 119

dog and cat — **kalb** is a solid, well-attested Semitic root (cousin of Hebrew's own dog-word), unlike the tangled dog-words of Spanish, Hindi, and English; **qitt** most likely closes the loop, widely compared to the SAME ancient root behind Latin's **cattus/gato/chat/Katze**, though the exact relationship is still debated قط, كلب

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 119

E**easy** سهل (sahl)

Chapter 83, p. 417

eggs بيض (bayḍ)

Chapter 68, p. 353

eight ثمانية (thamāniya)

Chapter 96, p. 469

empty فارغ (fārigh)

Chapter 84, p. 421

Empty, Rich, Poor, Clean, Dirty

chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 421

Eye, Ear, Nose, Mouth, Tooth

chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 281

F**Face, Blood, Knee, Back, Heart**

chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 289

Family

chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 85

far بعيد (baʿīd)

Chapter 88, p. 437

Farewells

chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 53

fast سريع (sarī^c)

Chapter 83, p. 417

father and mother — ancient Semitic roots, cousins of Hebrew’s own family words أم أب

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 85

Fever, Hospital, Ill, Pain, Medicine

chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 293

fifty خمسون (khamsūn)

Chapter 97, p. 473

fire نار (nār)

Chapter 78, p. 397

Fire, Snow, Wind, Sky, Horse

chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 397

fish سمك (samak)

Chapter 65, p. 341

“food” — the chapter’s payoff, where a root you have never met hands you the word for restaurant free of charge, because you already own the pattern طعام (ṭa^cām)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 177

Forest, River, Stone, Sand, Field

chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 389

Fork, Bottle, Door, Kitchen, Garden

chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 369

forty أربعون (arba^cūn)

Chapter 97, p. 473

Four Core Colours

chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 81

Four lines, and the joiner that is not a separate word

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 45, p. 247

Friday and Saturday — the two days that break the counting

pattern السبت الجمعة

Chapter 8, p. 77

“friend” — the chapter’s payoff, where a root meaning truth explains the word, the fa^cīl pattern turns up for the third time, and every family word you own lines up behind it صديق (ṣadīq)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 187

fruit فاكهة (fākiha)

Chapter 66, p. 345

G

Going and Coming

chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 141

good جيد (jayyid)

Chapter 82, p. 413

good evening (masāʾ al-khayr — “evening of goodness”) الخير مساء

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

good morning (ṣabāḥ al-khayr — “morning of goodness”) صباح

الخير

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

Good Night

chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 137

“good night” — but honestly, it doesn’t wish you a good NIGHT at all; it wishes you a good morning, reusing both roots from

ṣabāḥ al-khayr and masāʾ al-khayr خير على تصبح (tuṣbiḥ ʿalā khayr)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 27, p. 137

goodbye — literally ‘with safety’, closing the greeting arc on the root that opened it مع السلامة (maʿa s-salāma)

Chapter 4, p. 53

Grandmother, Uncle, Uncle, Husband, Wife

chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 301

grapes عنب (ʿinab)

Chapter 67, p. 349

Green and Yellow

chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 121

green and yellow — akhdar’s root also gives “vegetables”

(echoing English’s own “greens”), and asfar shares its root with

sifr, “zero” — the very word behind English “zero” and

“cipher” أصفر, أخضر

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 22, p. 121

Greetings

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

H

hair شعر (shaʿr)

Chapter 51, p. 285

Hair, Foot, Finger, Shoulder, Neck

chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 285

happy سعيد (saʿīd)

Chapter 54, p. 297

“he asked” — one root that builds a question, a problem, an

asker and the word for being answerable, plus the Hebrew twin

hiding inside the name Saul سأل (saʿala)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 153

“he ate” — no new letters, no English cousin, and a Hebrew twin close enough to hear; the sixth verb, closing the set أكل (akala)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 149

“he came” — the partner of dhahaba, and the first root whose middle letter is weak enough to vanish, showing that even

Arabic’s irregularities are patterned جاء (jāʿa)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 28, p. 141

“he helped” — a root that means good fortune, stretched by one long vowel into a verb aimed at somebody else, and the family

name behind the word Saudi ساعد (sāʿada)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 161

“he knew, he recognised” — one of Arabic’s two words for knowing, whose root reached Spain and named a palace in

Granada عرف (ʿarafa)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 149

“he loved” — the chapter’s payoff, closing the ladder of four verb shapes, and the root behind the ḥabībī of every second Arabic

song أحبّ (ʾaḥabba)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 161

“he read, he recited” — hamza’s three seats sorted out at last, and the one root in this chapter that really did give English a

word قرأ (qaraʾa)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 153

“he said” — the letter qāf finally named, and one root that

yields a saying, an article, a speaker and a spoken thing قال (qāla)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 145

“he saw” — the dotless alif maqṣūra named at last, and a root whose seeing turns into opinion and into the word for a

mirror رأى (raʾā)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 145

“he thought” — the first verb that is not a bare root at all, but a root rebuilt by doubling its middle letter, and the mu- doer that

comes with the rebuild فكّر (fakkara)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 161

“he took” — the last plain-shaped verb in the book, kept as the control against the three rebuilt verbs that follow, with a Hebrew

twin reached by two regular consonant swaps أخذ (ʾakhadha)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 161

“he understood” — the first verb whose middle vowel is not an a, marking it a state rather than a deed, and the done-to shape

that turns it into the word for a concept فهم (fahima)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 153

he went — the track’s first verb, and the clearest possible view of the root-and-pattern engine, since the same three consonants also give “gold” and “a school of law” ذهب (dhahaba)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 141

“he wrote” — the chapter’s payoff, where one root and the patterns you already own hand you a book, a writer, an office and a library with nothing new to memorise كتب (kataba)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 153

Head and Hand

chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 91

heavy ثقیل (thaqīl)

Chapter 85, p. 425

hello / welcome — there is room for you marḥaban

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

here هنا (hunā)

Chapter 90, p. 445

Here, There, Right, Shop, Street

chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 445

honey عسل (ʿasal)

Chapter 67, p. 349

hour / o’clock — and the same word Arabic uses for “clock” and “a while” الساعة

explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 105

how كيف (kayfa)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 37

How Are You?

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 37

how are you? — literally ‘how [is] your state?’, gendered -ka /

-ki حالک؟ كيف (kayfa ḥāluka / kayfa ḥāluki)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 3, p. 37

how old are you? — literally “how much [is] your lifetime?”; age

as a NOUN you possess, not a verb you conjugate عمرك؟ کم

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 109

hunger جوع (jūʿ)

Chapter 54, p. 297

Hunger, Happy, Sad, Doctor, Grandfather

chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 297

I

I do not understand — the one hole in an otherwise strong repair kit, one present-tense form away since chapter

thirty-one لا أفهم (lā afham)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 37, p. 205

ill, sick مريض (marīḍ)

Chapter 53, p. 293

important مهم (muhimm)

Chapter 85, p. 425

in front of أمام (amāma)

Chapter 89, p. 441

inside داخل (dākhil)

Chapter 88, p. 437

Introducing Yourself

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 19

is not — the denial of the nominal sentence, which is the one thing this book teaches productively and could not

deny ليس (laysa)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 217

J

juice عصير (ʿaṣīr)

Chapter 69, p. 357

Juice, Chicken, House, Room, Window

chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 357

K

Knowing and Eating

chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 149

L

lemons ليمون (laymūn)

Chapter 68, p. 353

Letters From Food, Noon and Going

chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 273

Letters From Goodbyes and Pardons

chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 257

Letters From Please, Sorry and Tomorrow

chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 265

Letters From Your First Greetings

chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 251

Light, Heavy, Correct, Mistake, Important

chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 425

light (in weight) خفيف (khafīf)

Chapter 85, p. 425

long, tall طويل (ṭawīl)

Chapter 82, p. 413

love حب (ḥubb)

Chapter 98, p. 477

M

“meat” — one Semitic root that Arabic settled on meat and Hebrew settled on bread, with Bethlehem sitting on the seam between them لحم (laḥm)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 177

medicine دواء (dawāʿ)

Chapter 53, p. 293

“milk” — the opposite case to shāy: a home-grown noun sitting straight on the verb for milking, and a Hebrew twin that is the same word حليب (ḥalīb)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 169

Mirror, Lamp, Key, Plate, Knife

chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 365

money مال (māl)

Chapter 74, p. 377

Months

chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 99

music موسيقى (mūsīqā)

Chapter 99, p. 481

Music, News, Country, Language, Story

chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 481

my name is... (with no “is”) اسمي ...

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 19

My own line — the first writing with no model

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 43, p. 243

my (possessive suffix -ī) ي

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 19

N

name اسم

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 19

near قريب (qarīb)

Chapter 88, p. 437

“neighbour” — the person you introduce most often, built on a hollow root whose middle letter hides exactly as qāla’s

does جار (jār)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 187

new جديد (jadīd)

Chapter 82, p. 413

New, Old, Good, Long, Short

chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 413

news أخبار (akhbār)

Chapter 99, p. 481

Night

chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 135

“night” — the word already hiding inside muntaṣaf al-layl (‘midnight’), and yawm’s pan-Semitic partner, cognate with

Hebrew layla ليل

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 26, p. 135

nine تسعة (tis‘a)

Chapter 96, p. 469

no (lā) لا

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 5, p. 69

noon (also the name of the midday Islamic prayer) and midnight (“the half of the night”) الليل منتصف الظهر

Chapter 15, p. 103

Noon and Midnight

chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 103

now الآن (al-ān)

Chapter 87, p. 433

Numbers Eleven to Twenty

chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 117

Numbers One to Five

chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 115

O

“oil” — one new letter that is only rā wearing a dot, and a second Spanish word carrying Arabic’s article welded to its front زيت (zayt)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 195

old قديم (qadīm)

Chapter 82, p. 413

one through five — the Arabic WORDS for numbers, genuinely different from “Arabic numerals” (the written digit shapes 0-9), which actually trace back to India خمسة أربعة ثلاثة اثنان واحد

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 19, p. 115

onions بصل (baṣal)

Chapter 68, p. 353

or — two letters, and the word an offer cannot be made

without أو (aw)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 209

oranges برتقال (burtuqāl)

Chapter 68, p. 353

Oranges, Lemons, Eggs, Onions, Breakfast

chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 353

outside خارج (khārij)

Chapter 89, p. 441

Outside, Above, Below, In front of, Behind

chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 441

P

pain ألم (alam)

Chapter 53, p. 293

peace be upon you *as-salāmu ‘alaykum*

explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 1, p. 1

peace / hello *salām*

explicit focus: pronunciation, writing, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Please

chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 73

please (min faḍlik — literally “from your grace”) فضلك من

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 73

pleased to meet you (literally “we have been honoured”) تشرفنا

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 19

Pocket, Ring, Hat, Shoe, Coat

chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 465

Police, Market, Village, City, Restaurant

chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 457

poor فقير (faqīr)

Chapter 84, p. 421

potatoes بطاطس (baṭāṭis)

Chapter 66, p. 345

praise be to God — the everyday answer to 'how are you?' الحمد لله

(al-ḥamdu lillāh)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 37

R**Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Encounter**

chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 239

red and blue — the same gendered color template as black and**white** أزرق أحمر

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 9, p. 81

rice أرز (aruzz)

Chapter 66, p. 345

Rice, Fruit, Apple, Bananas, Potatoes

chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 345

rich غني (ghanī)

Chapter 84, p. 421

right (side) يمين (yamīn)

Chapter 90, p. 445

Road, Bank, Station, Car, Bus

chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 449

S**sad** حزين (ḥazīn)

Chapter 54, p. 297

“salt” — a plain Semitic word whose root also gives Arabic its**sailor and its word for handsome, and which shows ḥā³ in its****final shape** ملح (milḥ)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 177

sand رمل (raml)

Chapter 76, p. 389

say it again, please — the second half of a repair kit whose first**half arrived four chapters ago, and the first command this book****has ever given** فضلك من كرّر (karrir min faḍlik)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 41, p. 233

Saying and Seeing

chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 145

Seasons

chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 95

see you — literally 'until the meeting', the structure Spanish**borrowed a word for** اللقاء إلى (ilā l-liqāʾ)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 53

See You Tomorrow

chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 129

see you tomorrow — literally 'until tomorrow', reusing the same

ilā ('until') already met in see you later الغد إلى (ilā l-ghad)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 24, p. 129

seven سبعة (sabʿa)

Chapter 96, p. 469

short قصير (qaṣīr)

Chapter 82, p. 413

six ستة (sitta)

Chapter 96, p. 469

slow بطيء (baṭīʾ)

Chapter 83, p. 417

Slow, Fast, Easy, Difficult, Cheap

chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 417

small صغير (ṣaghīr)

Chapter 81, p. 409

snow ثلج (thalj)

Chapter 78, p. 397

sometimes أحيانا (aḥyānan)

Chapter 87, p. 433

son and daughter — one pair gendered by a single added ت,

exactly as أخ and أخت were, and the ibn that stands in the middle

of names English already knows بنت ابن (ibn, bint)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 187

Sorry

chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 75

sorry (āsif masc. / āsifa fem. — a GENDERED adjective, from

āsifa “to grieve, regret”) آسفة / آسف

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 75

Star, Cloud, Sun, Moon, Sea

chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 393

state, condition — the thing Arabic actually asks about حال (ḥāl)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 37

steady, firm ثابت (thābit)

Chapter 1, p. 1

◌ْ◌◌ — **stop, double, or add -an**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 19

“sugar” — a word that crossed Asia and Europe, and the one that shows Arabic’s own al- fused onto the front of a Spanish noun سكر (sukkar)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 169

Sunday–Thursday — Arabic counts its weekdays instead of naming them for planets الخميس الأربعاء الثلاثاء الإثنين الأحد

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 8, p. 77

T

Taking, Thinking, Helping, Loving

chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 161

“tea” — the first noun in this book with no Arabic root at all, and a word that reached Arabic and English from the same Chinese original by two different roads شاي (shāy)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 169

Teacher, To drink, To hear, To sit, To sleep

chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 309

Telling Time

chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 105

ten عشرة (ʿashara)

Chapter 97, p. 473

Ten, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Thousand

chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 473

thank you (shukran) شكرا

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

the (al- — the attached article) ال

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

the back ظهر (zahr)

Chapter 52, p. 289

the floor; the earth أرض (arḍ)

Chapter 70, p. 361

the four seasons — Modern Standard Arabic’s set, though the classical calendar didn’t always carve up the year this way ربيع

شتاء خريف صيف

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 12, p. 95

the Gregorian months — Latin names borrowed almost intact, running ALONGSIDE the Islamic calendar’s own, entirely different lunar months أغسطس يوليو يونيو مايو أبريل مارس فبراير يناير

ديسمبر نوفمبر أكتوبر سبتمبر

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 14, p. 99

the hand — an ancient Semitic root, nearly unchanged since its
Hebrew cousin يد

Chapter 11, p. 91

the head — a Semitic root cognate with Hebrew rosh, and the
source of “president” in Arabic itself رأس

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 91

the heart قلب (qalb)

Chapter 52, p. 289

the moon قمر (qamar)

Chapter 77, p. 393

the neck رقبة (raqaba)

Chapter 51, p. 285

The People You Introduce

chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 187

the police شرطة (shurṭa)

Chapter 93, p. 457

the safety — Chapter 1’s salām, plus a pattern and a feminine
ending السلامة (as-salāma)

Chapter 4, p. 53

The same writing, with a clock

script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 44, p. 245

the sea بحر (baḥr)

Chapter 77, p. 393

َ ُ — **the short vowels the abjad usually hides**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 19

the sky سماء (samāʾ)

Chapter 78, p. 397

the sun شمس (shams)

Chapter 77, p. 393

The Tense That Was Missing

chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 205

there هناك (hunāka)

Chapter 90, p. 445

thirty ثلاثون (thalāthūn)

Chapter 97, p. 473

Tiger, Elephant, Monkey, Snake, Bear

chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 405

time وقت (waqt)

Chapter 88, p. 437

to buy (he bought) اشترى (ishtarā)

Chapter 58, p. 313

to carry (he carried) حمل (ḥamala)

Chapter 65, p. 341

- to close (he closed)** أغلق (aghlaqa)
Chapter 59, p. 317
- to come back (he came back)** رجع (raja^ca)
Chapter 64, p. 337
- to cook (he cooked)** طبخ (ṭabakha)
Chapter 60, p. 321
- To cook, To wash, To laugh, To cry, To dance**
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 321
- to cry (he cried)** بكى (bakā)
Chapter 60, p. 321
- to cut (he cut)** قطع (qaṭa^ca)
Chapter 61, p. 325
- to dance (he danced)** رقص (raqaṣa)
Chapter 60, p. 321
- to drink (he drank)** شرب (shariba)
Chapter 57, p. 309
- to enter (he entered)** دخل (dakhala)
Chapter 63, p. 333
- to find (he found)** وجد (wajada)
Chapter 62, p. 329
- to fly (he flew)** طار (ṭāra)
Chapter 63, p. 333
- to forget (he forgot)** نسي (nasiya)
Chapter 61, p. 325
- to give (he gave)** أعطى (a^cṭā)
Chapter 59, p. 317
- to go down (he went down)** نزل (nazala)
Chapter 65, p. 341
- to go out (he went out)** خرج (kharaja)
Chapter 64, p. 337
- To go out, To work, To live, To wait, To come back**
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 337
- to hear (he heard)** سمع (sami^ca)
Chapter 57, p. 309
- to laugh (he laughed)** ضحك (ḍaḥika)
Chapter 60, p. 321
- to learn (he learned)** تعلم (ta^callama)
Chapter 61, p. 325
- To learn, To forget, To want, To send, To cut**
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 325
- to leave (he left)** ترك (taraka)
Chapter 62, p. 329
- to live (he lived)** سكن (sakana)
Chapter 64, p. 337

- to look for (he looked for)** بحث (baḥatha)
Chapter 62, p. 329
- to make (he made)** صنع (ṣana^ca)
Chapter 63, p. 333
- to open (he opened)** فتح (fataḥa)
Chapter 59, p. 317
- to play (he played)** لعب (la^ciba)
Chapter 58, p. 313
- to put (he put)** وضع (waḍa^ca)
Chapter 59, p. 317
- to run (he ran)** ركض (rakaḍa)
Chapter 58, p. 313
- to sell (he sold)** باع (bā^ca)
Chapter 59, p. 317
- To sell, To give, To put, To open, To close**
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 317
- to send (he sent)** أرسل (arsala)
Chapter 61, p. 325
- to sit (he sat)** جلس (jalasa)
Chapter 57, p. 309
- to sleep (he slept)** نام (nāma)
Chapter 57, p. 309
- to speak (he spoke)** تكلم (takallama)
Chapter 65, p. 341
- To speak, To carry, To win, To go down, Fish**
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 341
- to stand up (he stood up)** قام (qāma)
Chapter 58, p. 313
- To stand up, To walk, To run, To play, To buy**
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 313
- to stop (he stopped)** وقف (waqafa)
Chapter 62, p. 329
- To stop, To look for, To find, To wear, To leave**
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 329
- to swim (he swam)** سبح (sabaḥa)
Chapter 63, p. 333
- to throw (he threw)** رمى (ramā)
Chapter 63, p. 333
- To throw, To fly, To swim, To make, To enter**
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 333
- to wait (he waited)** انتظر (intaẓara)
Chapter 64, p. 337
- to walk (he walked)** مشى (mashā)
Chapter 58, p. 313

to want (he wanted) أراد (arāda)

Chapter 61, p. 325

to wash (he washed) غسل (ghasala)

Chapter 60, p. 321

to wear (he wore) لبس (labisa)

Chapter 62, p. 329

to win (he won) فاز (fāza)

Chapter 65, p. 341

to work (he worked) عمل (ʿamila)

Chapter 64, p. 337

tomatoes طماطم (ṭamāṭim)

Chapter 67, p. 349

Tomatoes, Carrots, Butter, Honey, Grapes

chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 349

tomorrow غدا (ghadan)

Chapter 87, p. 433

Train, Bridge, Mosque, Hotel, Office

chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 453

trousers سروال (sirwāl)

Chapter 94, p. 461

Two at Once

chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 209

U

Understanding, Reading, Writing

chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 153

W

Water and Bread

chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 97

water and bread — one of Arabic’s most irregular common words, and one built on a clean, ordinary Semitic root خبز ماء

Chapter 13, p. 97

Weather

chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 113

weather — the SAME root also gives “rite, religious ceremony”;
hot/cold are verbless adjectives, but rain gets its own personal

verb الطقس

Chapter 18, p. 113

welcome أَهْلًا (ahlan)

Chapter 2, p. 19

well, fine — literally 'in goodness' بخير (bi-khayr)

Chapter 3, p. 37

what ما

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 19

what's your name? اسمك؟ ما

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 19

when — the clause joiner that puts one event beside another in time, with the same ما inside it the last chapter taught

twice حينما (ḥīnamā)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 225

Why, That, and When

chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 225

why — the question this book has never been able to ask, built out of the preposition ل and the word for “what” لماذا؟ (limādhā?)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 225

wind ريح (rīḥ)

Chapter 78, p. 397

with مع (maʿa)

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 53

Word, Picture, Tree, Flower, Mountain

chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 385

Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Is Not A Word

chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 247

Writing — My Own Line

chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 243

Writing — With A Clock

chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 245

Y

Yes and No

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 69

yes (naʿam) نعم

Chapter 5, p. 69

yesterday أمس (ams)

Chapter 87, p. 433

Yesterday, Tomorrow, Now, Sometimes, Before

chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 433

you (anta m. / anti f.) أنت

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 19

You're Welcome

chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 125

“you’re welcome” (also **“excuse me/pardon/sorry,”** depending on context) — root ^c-f-w, **“to erase, to pardon”**; grammatically the same construction as **shukran** itself عفو
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 125

Other

ء and أ — the glottal catch

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 19

آ (alif madda) — the alif that opens آسف

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 48, p. 265

إ (alif with hamza below) — the alif that opens إلى

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 47, p. 257

ا and م — finish سلام **without a cliff**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

أكتب (aktub) — the tense that was missing

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 37, p. 205

أن (anna) — that

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 40, p. 225

ب ث ت — one bowl, three dot choices

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ج خ ح — the dots trick, on a brand-new body

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 37

خير and بخير — writing “good,” and how you say you’re well

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 37

د (dāl) — the letter that ends الحمد

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 46, p. 251

ذ (dhāl) — the letter that opens ذهب

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 49, p. 273

ر and ح — two shapes inside marḥaban

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

ز (zāy) — the letter inside أزرق

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 48, p. 265

س and ل — recall one shape, add one

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ش (shīn) — the letter that opens شكرا

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 46, p. 251

ص (ṣād) — the letter that opens صباح

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 46, p. 251

ض (ḍād) — the letter inside فضلك

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 48, p. 265

ط (ṭāʾ) — the letter that opens طعام

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 49, p. 273

ظ (ẓāʾ) — **the letter inside** الظهر

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 49, p. 273

ع and ي — **open** *‘alaykum* gently

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

ع (‘ayn) — **the eye that became an O**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 53

غ (ghayn) — **the letter inside** الغد

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 48, p. 265

ف (fāʾ) — **the letter inside** عفوا

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 47, p. 257

ق (qāf) — **the letter inside** اللقاء

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 47, p. 257

ك and ر — **an angular k, and an r that won’t hold hands**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 37

ك and و — **complete the greeting after the sound**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

لا ... ولا ... — **neither, nor**

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 39, p. 217

ما (mā) — **did not**

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 217

مع السلامة — **the goodbye, and a word you already know**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 53

ن، ت، ث — **one bowl, four dot-patterns**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 19

ه and ة — **the loop, and the ending that means “feminine”**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 53

هل (hal) — **a question is coming**

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 39, p. 217

إلى (alif maqṣūra) — **the letter that ends**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 47, p. 257

ي (yāʾ) — **the last dot-letter, and “my name”**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 19

يا (yā) — **calling somebody**

grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 233